POETRY

The Hesperides & Noble Numbers: Vol. 1 and 2

Robert Herrick

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ROBERT HERRICK

THE HESPERIDES & NOBLE NUMBERS: EDITED BY ALFRED POLLARD WITH A PREFACE BY A. C. SWINBURNE

VOL. I.

REVISED EDITION

[Illustration]

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Transcriber's Note:

Original spelling and punctuation has been retained.

^ indicates 'superscript' within the text.

Obvious typesetting errors have been corrected without note, however additional corrections have been recorded in the Transcriber's Endnotes at the end each volume.

EDITOR'S NOTE.

In this edition of Herrick quotation is for the first time facilitated by the poems being numbered according to their order in the original edition. This numbering has rendered it possible to print those Epigrams, which successive editors have joined in deploring, in a detachable Appendix, their place in the original being indicated by the numeration. It remains to be added that the footnotes in this edition are intended to explain, as unobtrusively as possible, difficulties of phrase or allusion which might conceivably hinder the understanding of Herrick's meaning. In the longer Notes at the end of each volume earlier versions of some important poems are printed from manuscripts at the British Museum, and an endeavour has been made to extend the list of Herrick's debts to classical sources, and to identify some of his friends who have hitherto escaped research. An editor is always apt to mention his predecessors rather for blame than praise, and I therefore take this opportunity of acknowledging my general indebtedness to the pioneer work of Mr. Hazlitt and Dr. Grosart, upon whose foundations all editors of Herrick must necessarily build.

ALFRED W. POLLARD.

PREFACE.

It is singular that the first great age of English lyric poetry should have been also the one great age of English dramatic poetry: but it is hardly less singular that the lyric school should have advanced as steadily as the dramatic school declined from the promise of its dawn. Born with Marlowe, it rose at once with Shakespeare to heights inaccessible before and since and for ever, to sink through bright gradations of glorious decline to its final and beautiful sunset in Shirley: but the lyrical record that

begins with the author of "Euphues" and "Endymion" grows fuller if not brighter through a whole chain of constellations till it culminates in the crowning star of Herrick. Shakespeare's last song, the exquisite and magnificent overture to "The Two Noble Kinsmen," is hardly so limpid in its flow, so liquid in its melody, as the two great songs in "Valentinian": but Herrick, our last poet of that incomparable age or generation, has matched them again and again. As a creative and inventive singer, he surpasses all his rivals in quantity of good work; in quality of spontaneous instinct and melodious inspiration he reminds us, by frequent and flawless evidence, who above all others must beyond all doubt have been his first master and his first model in lyric poetry--the author of "The Passionate Shepherd to his Love".

The last of his line, he is and will probably be always the first in rank and station of English song-writers. We have only to remember how rare it is to find a perfect song, good to read and good to sing, combining the merits of Coleridge and Shelley with the capabilities of Tommy Moore and Haynes Bayly, to appreciate the unique and unapproachable excellence of Herrick. The lyrist who wished to be a butterfly, the lyrist who fled or flew to a lone vale at the hour (whatever hour it may be) "when stars are weeping," have left behind them such stuff as may be sung, but certainly cannot be read and endured by any one with an ear for verse. The author of the Ode on France and the author of the Ode to the West Wind have left us hardly more than a song a-piece which has been found fit for setting to music: and, lovely as they are, the fame of their authors does not mainly depend on the song of Glycine or the song of which Leigh Hunt so justly and so critically said that Beaumont and Fletcher never wrote anything of the kind more lovely. Herrick, of course, lives simply by virtue of his songs; his more ambitious or pretentious lyrics are merely magnified and prolonged and elaborated songs. Elegy or litany, epicede or epithalamium, his work is always a song-writer's; nothing more, but nothing less, than the work of the greatest song-writer--as surely as Shakespeare is the greatest dramatist--ever born of English race. The apparent or external variety of his versification is, I should suppose, incomparable; but by some happy tact or instinct he was too naturally unambitious to attempt, like Jonson, a flight in the wake of Pindar. He knew what he could not do: a rare and invaluable gift. Born a blackbird or a thrush, he did not take himself (or try) to be a nightingale.

It has often been objected that he did mistake himself for a sacred poet: and it cannot be denied that his sacred verse at its worst is as offensive as his secular verse at its worst; nor can it be denied that no severer sentence of condemnation can be passed upon any poet's work. But neither Herbert nor Crashaw could have bettered such a divinely beautiful triplet as this:--

"We see Him come, and know Him ours, Who with His sunshine and His showers Turns all the patient ground to flowers".

That is worthy of Miss Rossetti herself: and praise of such work can go no higher.

But even such exquisite touches or tones of colour may be too often repeated in fainter shades or more glaring notes of assiduous and facile reiteration. The sturdy student who tackles his Herrick as a schoolboy is expected to tackle his Horace, in a

spirit of pertinacious and stolid straightforwardness, will probably find himself before long so nauseated by the incessant inhalation of spices and flowers, condiments and kisses, that if a musk-rat had run over the page it could hardly be less endurable to the physical than it is to the spiritual stomach. The fantastic and the brutal blemishes which deform and deface the loveliness of his incomparable genius are hardly so damaging to his fame as his general monotony of matter and of manner. It was doubtless in order to relieve this saccharine and "mellisonant" monotony that he thought fit to intersperse these interminable droppings of natural or artificial perfume with others of the rankest and most intolerable odour: but a diet of alternate sweetmeats and emetics is for the average of eaters and drinkers no less unpalatable than unwholesome. It is useless and thankless to enlarge on such faults or such defects, as it would be useless and senseless to ignore. But how to enlarge, to expatiate, to insist on the charm of Herrick at his best--a charm so incomparable and so inimitable that even English poetry can boast of nothing quite like it or worthy to be named after it--the most appreciative reader will be the slowest to affirm or imagine that he can conjecture. This, however, he will hardly fail to remark: that Herrick, like most if not all other lyric poets, is not best known by his best work. If we may judge by frequency of quotation or of reference, the ballad of the ride from Ghent to Aix is a far more popular, more generally admired and accredited specimen of Mr. Browning's work than "The Last Ride Together"--and "The Lost Leader" than "The Lost Mistress". Yet the superiority of the less-popular poem is in either case beyond all question or comparison: in depth and in glow of spirit and of harmony, in truth and charm of thought and word, undeniable and indescribable. No two men of genius were ever more unlike than the authors of "Paracelsus" and "Hesperides": and yet it is as true of Herrick as of Browning that his best is not always his best-known work. Everyone knows the song, "Gather ye rosebuds while ye may"; few, I fear, by comparison, know the yet sweeter and better song, "Ye have been fresh and green". The general monotony of style and motive which fatigues and irritates his too-persevering reader is here and there relieved by a change of key which anticipates the note of a later and very different lyric school. The brilliant simplicity and pointed grace of the three stanzas to Œnone ("What conscience, say, is it in thee") recall the lyrists of the Restoration in their cleanlier and happier mood. And in the very fine epigram headed by the words "Devotion makes the Deity" he has expressed for once a really high and deep thought in words of really noble and severe propriety. His "Mad Maid's Song," again, can only be compared with Blake's; which has more of passionate imagination, if less of pathetic sincerity.

A. C. SWINBURNE.

LIFE OF HERRICK.

Of the lives of many poets we know too much; of some few too little. Lovers of Herrick are almost ideally fortunate. Just such a bare outline of his life has come down to us as is sufficient to explain the allusions in his poems, and, on the other hand, there is no temptation to substitute chatter about his relations with Julia and Dianeme for enjoyment of his delightful verse. The recital of the bare outline need detain us but a few minutes: only the least imaginative of readers will have any

difficulty in filling it in from the poems themselves.

From early in the fourteenth century onwards we hear of the family of Eyrick or Herrick at Stretton, in Leicestershire. At the beginning of the sixteenth century we find a branch of it settled in Leicester itself, where John Eyrick, the poet's grandfather, was admitted a freeman in 1535, and afterwards acted as Mayor. This John's second son, Nicholas, migrated to London, became a goldsmith in Wood Street, Cheapside, and, according to a licence issued by the Bishop of London, December 8, 1582, married Julian, daughter of William Stone, sister of Anne, wife of Sir Stephen Soame, Lord Mayor of London in 1598. The marriage was not unfruitful. A William[A] Herrick was baptized at St. Vedast's, Foster Lane, November 24, 1585; Martha, January 22, 1586; Mercy, December 22, 1586; Thomas, May 7, 1588; Nicholas, April 22, 1589; Anne, July 26, 1590; and Robert himself, August 24, 1591.

[A] A second William is said to have been born, posthumously, in "Harry Campion's house at Hampton," in 1593.

Fifteen months after the poet's birth, on November 7, 1592, Nicholas Herrick made his will, estimating his property as worth £3000, and devising it, as to one-third to his wife, and as to the other two-thirds to his children in equal shares. In the will he described himself as "of perfect memorye in sowle, but sicke in bodye". Two days after its execution he was buried, having died, not from disease, but from a fall from an upper window. His death had so much the appearance of self-destruction that £220 had to be paid to the High Almoner, Dr. Fletcher, Bishop of Bristol, in satisfaction of his official claim to the goods and chattels of suicides. Herrick's biographers have not failed to vituperate the Bishop for his avarice, but dues allowed by law are hardly to be abandoned because a baby of fifteen months is destined to become a brilliant poet, and no other exceptional circumstances are alleged. The estate of Nicholas Herrick could the better afford the fine inasmuch as it realized £2000 more than was expected.

By the will Robert and William Herrick were appointed "overseers," or trustees for the children. The former was the poet's godfather, and in his will of 1617 left him £5. To William Herrick, then recently knighted for his services as goldsmith, jeweller, and moneylender to James I., the young Robert was apprenticed for ten years, September 25, 1607. An allusion to "beloved Westminster," in his _Tears to Thamesis_, has been taken to refer to Westminster school, and alleged as proof that he was educated there. Dr. Grosart even presses the mention of Richmond, Kingston, and Hampton Court to support a conjecture that Herrick may have travelled up and down to school from Hampton. If so, one wonders what his headmaster had to say to the "soft-smooth virgins, for our chaste disport" by whom he was accompanied. But the references in the poem are surely to his courtier-life in London, and after his father's death the apprenticeship to his uncle in 1607 is the first fact in his life of which we can be sure.

In 1607, Herrick was fifteen, and, even if we conjecture that he may have been allowed to remain at school some little time after his apprenticeship nominally began, he must have served his uncle for five or six years. Sir William had himself been bound apprentice in a similar way to the poet's father, and we have no evidence that

he exacted any premium. At any rate, when in 1614, his nephew, then of age, desired to leave the business and go to Cambridge, the ten years' apprenticeship did not stand in his way, and he entered as a Fellow Commoner at St. John's. His uncle plainly still managed his affairs, for an amusing series of fourteen letters has been preserved at Beaumanor, until lately the seat of Sir William's descendants, in which the poet asks sometimes for payment of a quarterly stipend of £10, sometimes for a formal loan, sometimes for the help of his avuncular Mæcenas. It seems a fair inference from this variety of requests that, since Herrick's share of his father's property could hardly have yielded a yearly income of £40, he was allowed to draw on his capital for this sum, but that his uncle and Lady Herrick occasionally made him small presents, which may account for his tone of dependence.

The quarterly stipend was paid through various booksellers, but irregularly, so that the poor poet was frequently reduced to great straits, though £40 a-year (£200 of our money) was no bad allowance. After two years he migrated from St. John's to Trinity Hall, to study law and curtail his expenses. He took his Bachelor's degree from there in January, 1617, and his Master's in 1620. The fourteen letters show that he had prepared himself for University life by cultivating a very florid prose style which frequently runs into decasyllabics, perhaps a result of a study of the dramatists. Sir William Herrick is sometimes addressed in them as his most "careful" uncle, but at the time of his migration the poet speaks of his "ebbing estate," and as late as 1629 he was still £10 16s. 9d. in debt to the College Steward. We can thus hardly imagine that he was possessed of any considerable private income when he returned to London, to live practically on his wits, and a study of his poems suggests that, the influence of the careful uncle removed, whatever capital he possessed was soon likely to vanish.[B] His verses to the Earl of Pembroke, to Endymion Porter and to others, show that he was glad of "pay" as well as "praise," but the system of patronage brought no discredit with it, and though the absence of any poetical mention of his uncle suggests that the rich goldsmith was not well-pleased with his nephew, with the rest of his well-to-do relations Herrick seems to have remained on excellent terms.

[B] Yet in his _Farewell to Poetry_ he distinctly says:--

"I've more to bear my charge than way to go";

the line, however, is a translation from his favourite Seneca, Ep. 77.

Besides patrons, such as Pembroke, Westmoreland, Newark, Buckingham, Herrick had less distinguished friends at Court, Edward Norgate, Jack Crofts and others. He composed the words for two New Year anthems which were set to music by Henry Lawes, and he was probably personally known both to the King and Queen. Outside the Court he reckoned himself one of Ben Jonson's disciples, "Sons of Ben" as they were called, had friends at the Inns of Court, knew the organist of Westminster Abbey and his pretty daughters, and had every temptation to live an amusing and expensive life. His poems were handed about in manuscript after the fashion of the time, and wherever music and poetry were loved he was sure to be a welcome guest.

Mr. Hazlitt's conjecture that Herrick at this time may have held some small post in the Chapel at Whitehall is not unreasonable, but at what date he took Holy Orders is

not known. In 1627 he obtained the post of chaplain to the unlucky expedition to the Isle of Rhé, and two years later (September 30, 1629) he was presented by the King to the Vicarage of Dean Prior, in Devonshire, which the promotion of its previous incumbent, Dr. Potter, to the Bishopric of Carlisle, had left in the royal gift. The annual value of the living was only £50 (£250 present value), no great prize, but the poem entitled _Mr. Robert Hericke: his farwell unto Poetrie_ (not printed in _Hesperides_, but extant in more than one manuscript version) shows that the poet was not unaware of the responsibilities of his profession. "But unto me," he says to his Muse:

"But unto me be only hoarse, since now (Heaven and my soul bear record of my vow) I my desires screw from thee and direct Them and my thoughts to that sublime respect And conscience unto priesthood. 'Tis not need (The scarecrow unto mankind) that doth breed Wiser conclusions in me, since I know I've more to bear my charge than way to go; Or had I not, I'd stop the spreading itch Of craving more: so in conceit be rich; But 'tis the God of nature who intends And shapes my function for more glorious ends."

Perhaps it was at this time too that Herrick wrote his _Farewell to Sack_, and although he returned both to sack and to poetry we should be wrong in imagining him as a "blind mouth," using his office merely as a means of gain. He celebrated the births of Charles II and his brother in verse, perhaps with an eye to future royal favours, but no more than Chaucer's good parson does he seem to have "run to London unto Seynte Poules" in search of the seventeenth century equivalent for a chauntry, and many of his poems show him living the life of a contented country clergyman, sharing the contents of bin and cruse with his poor parishioners, and jotting down sermon-notes in verse.

The great majority of Herrick's poems cannot be dated, and it is idle to enquire which were written before his ordination and which afterwards. His conception of religion was medieval in its sensuousness, and he probably repeated the stages of sin, repentance and renewed assurance with some facility. He lived with an old servant, Prudence Baldwin, the "Prew" of many of his poems; kept a spaniel named Tracy, and, so says tradition, a tame pig. When his parishioners annoyed him he seems to have comforted himself with epigrams on them; when they slumbered during one of his sermons the manuscript was suddenly hurled at them with a curse for their inattention.

In the same year that Herrick was appointed to his country vicarage his mother died while living with her daughter, Mercy, the poet's dearest sister (see 818), then for some time married to John Wingfield of Brantham in Suffolk (see 590), by whom she had three sons and a daughter, also called Mercy. His eldest brother, Thomas, had been placed with a Mr. Massam, a merchant, but as early as 1610 had retired to live a country life in Leicestershire (see 106). He appears to have married a wife named Elizabeth, whose loss Herrick laments (see 72). Nicholas, the next brother was more adventurous. He had become a merchant trading to the Levant, and in this capacity had visited the Holy Land (see 1100). To his wife Susanna, daughter of William Salter, Herrick addresses two poems (522 and 977). There were three sons

and four daughters in this family, and Herrick wrote a poem to one of the daughters, Bridget (562), and an elegy on another, Elizabeth (376). When Mrs. Herrick died the bulk of her property was left to the Wingfields, but William Herrick received a legacy of £100, with ten pounds apiece to his two children, and a ring of twenty shillings to his wife. Nicholas and Robert were only left twenty-shilling rings, and the administration of the will was entrusted to William Herrick and the Wingfields. The will may have been the result of a family arrangement, and we have no reason to believe that the unequal division gave rise to any ill-feeling. Herrick's address to "his dying brother, Master William Herrick" (186), shows abundant affection, and there is every reason to believe that it was addressed to the William who administered to Mrs. Herrick's will.

While little nephews and nieces were springing up around him, Herrick remained unmarried, and frequently congratulates himself on his freedom from the yoke matrimonial. He imagined how he would bid farewell to his wife, if he had one (465), and wrote magnificent epithalamia for his friends, but lived and died a bachelor. When first civil troubles and then civil war cast a shadow over the land, it is not very easy to say how he viewed the contending parties. He was devoted to Charles and Henrietta Maria and the young Prince of Wales, and rejoiced at every Royalist success. Many also of his poems breathe the spirit of unquestioning loyalty, but in others he is less certain of kingly wisdom. Something, however, must be allowed for his evident habit of versifying any phrase or epigram which impressed him, and not all his poems need be regarded as expressions of his personal opinions. But with whatever doubts his loyalty was qualified, it was sufficiently obvious to procure his ejection from his living in 1648; and, making the best of his loss, he bade farewell to Dean Prior, shook the dust of "loathed Devonshire" off his feet, and returned gaily to London, where he appears to have discarded his clerical habit and to have been made abundantly welcome by his friends.

Free from the cares of his incumbency, and free also from the restraints it imposed, Herrick's thoughts turned to the publication of his poems. As we have said, in his old Court-days these had found some circulation in manuscript, and in 1635 one of his fairy poems was printed, probably without his leave (see Appendix). In 1639 his poem (575) _The Apparition of his Mistress calling him to Elysium_ was licensed at Stationers' Hall under the title of _His Mistress' Shade_, and it was included the next year in an edition of Shakespeare's Poems (see Notes). On April 29, 1640, "The severall poems written by Master Robert Herrick," were entered as to be published by Andrew Crook, but no trace of such a volume has been discovered, and it was only in 1648 that _Hesperides_ at length appeared. Two years later upwards of eighty of the poems in it were printed in the 1650 edition of _Witt's Recreations_, but a small number of these show considerable variations from the _Hesperides_ versions, and it is probable that they were printed from the poet's manuscript. Compilers of other miscellanies and song books laid Herrick under contribution, but, with the one exception of his contribution to the _Lacrymæ Musarum_ in 1649, no fresh production of his pen has been preserved, and we know nothing further of his life save that he returned to Dean Prior after the Restoration (August 24, 1662), and that according to the parish register "Robert Herrick, Vicker, was buried ye 15th day

October, 1674."

ALFRED W. POLLARD

NOTE TO SECOND EDITION.

In this edition some trifling errors, which had crept into the text and the numeration of the poems, have been corrected, and many fresh illustrations of Herrick's reading added in the notes, which have elsewhere been slightly compressed to make room for them. Almost all of the new notes have been supplied from the manuscript collections of a veteran student of Herrick who placed himself in correspondence with me after the publication of my first edition. To my great regret I am not allowed to make my acknowledgments to him by name.

A. W. P.

HESPERIDES: OR, THE WORKS BOTH HUMANE & DIVINE OF ROBERT HERRICK _Esq._

OVID.

Effugient avidos Carmina nostra Rogos.

LONDON.

Printed for _John Williams_, and _Francis Eglesfield_, and are to be sold by _Tho: Hunt_, Book-seller in _Exon._ 1648.

TO THE MOST ILLUSTRIOUS AND MOST HOPEFUL PRINCE. CHARLES, PRINCE OF WALES.

Well may my book come forth like public day When such a light as you are leads the way, Who are my work's creator, and alone The flame of it, and the expansion. And look how all those heavenly lamps acquire Light from the sun, that inexhausted fire, So all my morn and evening stars from you Have their existence, and their influence too. Full is my book of glories; but all these By you become immortal substances.

HESPERIDES.

1. THE ARGUMENT OF HIS BOOK.

I sing of brooks, of blossoms, birds and bowers, Of April, May, of June and July-flowers; I sing of May-poles, hock-carts, wassails, wakes, Of bridegrooms, brides and of their bridal cakes; I write of youth, of love, and have access By these to sing of cleanly wantonness; I sing of dews, of rains, and piece by piece Of balm, of oil, of spice and ambergris; I sing of times trans-shifting, and I write How roses first came red and lilies white; I write of groves, of twilights, and I sing The Court of Mab, and of the Fairy King; I write of hell; I sing (and ever shall) Of heaven, and hope to have it after all.

Hock-cart, the last cart from the harvest-field. _Wakes_, village festivals, properly on the dedication-day of a church. _Ambergris_, 'grey amber,' much used in perfumery.

2. TO HIS MUSE.

Whither, mad maiden, wilt thou roam? Far safer 'twere to stay at home, Where thou mayst sit and piping please The poor and private cottages, Since cotes and hamlets best agree With this thy meaner minstrelsy. There with the reed thou mayst express The shepherd's fleecy happiness, And with thy eclogues intermix Some smooth and harmless bucolics. There on a hillock thou mayst sing Unto a handsome shepherdling, Or to a girl, that keeps the neat, With breath more sweet than violet. There, there, perhaps, such lines as these May take the simple villages; But for the court, the country wit Is despicable unto it. Stay, then, at home, and do not go Or fly abroad to seek for woe. Contempts in courts and cities dwell, No critic haunts the poor man's cell, Where thou mayst hear thine own lines read By no one tongue there censured. That man's unwise will search for ill, And may prevent it, sitting still.

3. TO HIS BOOK.

While thou didst keep thy candour undefil'd, Dearly I lov'd thee as my first-born child, But when I saw thee wantonly to roam From house to house, and never stay at home, I brake my bonds of love, and bade thee go, Regardless whether well thou sped'st or no. On with thy fortunes then, whate'er they be: If good, I'll smile; if bad, I'll sigh for thee.

4. ANOTHER.

To read my book the virgin shy May blush while Brutus standeth by, But when he's gone, read through what's writ, And never stain a cheek for it.

Brutus, see Martial, xi. 16, quoted in Note at the end of the volume.

7. TO HIS BOOK.

Come thou not near those men who are like bread O'er-leaven'd, or like cheese o'er-renneted.

8. WHEN HE WOULD HAVE HIS VERSES READ.

In sober mornings, do not thou rehearse The holy incantation of a verse; But when that men have both well drunk and fed, Let my enchantments then be sung or read. When laurel spirts i'th' fire, and when the hearth Smiles to itself, and gilds the roof with mirth; When up the thyrse[C] is rais'd, and when the sound Of sacred orgies[D] flies, a round, a round. When the rose reigns, and locks with ointments shine, Let rigid Cato read these lines of mine.

Round, a rustic dance. _Cato_, see Martial, x. 17, quoted in Note.

[C] "A javelin twined with ivy" (Note in the original edition).

[D] "Songs to Bacchus" (Note in the original edition.)

9. UPON JULIA'S RECOVERY.

Droop, droop no more, or hang the head, Ye roses almost withered; Now strength and newer purple get, Each here declining violet. O primroses! let this day be A resurrection unto ye; And to all flowers ally'd in blood, Or sworn to that sweet sisterhood: For health on Julia's cheek hath shed Claret and cream commingled; And those her lips do now appear As beams of coral, but more clear.

Beams, perhaps here = branches: but cp. 440.

10. TO SILVIA TO WED.

Let us, though late, at last, my Silvia, wed, And loving lie in one devoted bed. Thy watch may stand, my minutes fly post-haste; No sound calls back the year that once is past. Then, sweetest Silvia, let's no longer stay; _True love, we know, precipitates delay._ Away with doubts, all scruples hence remove; _No man at one time can be wise and love._

11. THE PARLIAMENT OF ROSES TO JULIA.

I dreamt the roses one time went To meet and sit in parliament; The place for these, and for the rest Of flowers, was thy spotless breast, Over the which a state was drawn Of tiffanie or cobweb lawn. Then in that parly all those powers Voted the rose the queen of flowers; But so as that herself should be The maid of honour unto thee.

State, a canopy. _Tiffanie_, gauze. _Parly_, a parliament.

12. NO BASHFULNESS IN BEGGING.

To get thine ends, lay bashfulness aside; _Who fears to ask doth teach to be deny'd._

13. THE FROZEN HEART.

I freeze, I freeze, and nothing dwells In me but snow and icicles. For pity's sake, give your advice, To melt this snow and thaw this ice. I'll drink down flames; but if so be Nothing but love can supple me, I'll rather keep this frost and snow Than to be thaw'd or heated so.

14. TO PERILLA.

Ah, my Perilla! dost thou grieve to see Me, day by day, to steal away from thee? Age calls me hence, and my grey hairs bid come, And haste away to mine eternal home; 'Twill not be long, Perilla, after this, That I must give thee the supremest kiss. Dead when I am, first cast in salt, and bring Part of the cream from that religious spring; With which, Perilla, wash my hands and feet; That done, then wind me in that very sheet Which wrapt thy smooth limbs when thou didst implore The gods' protection but the night before. Follow me weeping to my turf, and there Let fall a primrose, and with it a tear: Then, lastly, let some weekly-strewings be Devoted to the memory of me: Then shall my ghost not walk about, but keep Still in the cool and silent shades of sleep.

Weekly strewings, _i.e._, of flowers on his grave. _First cast in salt_, cp. 769.

15. A SONG TO THE MASKERS.

Come down and dance ye in the toil Of pleasures to a heat; But if to moisture, let the oil Of roses be your sweat.

Not only to yourselves assume These sweets, but let them fly From this to that, and so perfume E'en all the standers by;

As goddess Isis, when she went Or glided through the street, Made all that touched her, with her scent, And whom she touched, turn sweet.

16. TO PERENNA.

When I thy parts run o'er, I can't espy In any one the least indecency; But every line and limb diffused thence A fair and unfamiliar excellence: So that the more I look the more I prove There's still more cause why I the more should love.

Indecency, uncomeliness.

17. TREASON.

The seeds of treason choke up as they spring: _He acts the crime that gives it cherishing_.

18. TWO THINGS ODIOUS.

Two of a thousand things are disallow'd: A lying rich man, and a poor man proud.

19. TO HIS MISTRESSES.

Help me! help me! now I call To my pretty witchcrafts all; Old I am, and cannot do That I was accustomed to. Bring your magics, spells, and charms, To enflesh my thighs and arms. Is there no way to beget In my limbs their former heat? Æson had, as poets feign, Baths that made him young again: Find that medicine, if you can, For your dry decrepit man Who would fain his strength renew, Were it but to pleasure you.

Æson, rejuvenated by Medea; see Ovid, Met. vii.

20. THE WOUNDED HEART.

Come bring your sampler, and with art Draw in't a wounded heart And dropping here and there: Not that I think that any dart Can make yours bleed a tear, Or pierce it anywhere; Yet do it to this end: that I May by This secret see, Though you can make That heart to bleed, yours ne'er will ache For me.

21. NO LOATHSOMENESS IN LOVE.

What I fancy I approve, _No dislike there is in love_. Be my mistress short or tall, And distorted therewithal: Be she likewise one of those That an acre hath of nose: Be her forehead and her eyes Full of incongruities: Be her cheeks so shallow too As to show her tongue wag through; Be her lips ill hung or set, And her grinders black as jet: Has she thin hair, hath she none, She's to me a paragon.

22. TO ANTHEA.

If, dear Anthea, my hard fate it be To live some few sad hours after thee, Thy sacred corse with odours I will burn, And with my laurel crown thy golden urn. Then

holding up there such religious things As were, time past, thy holy filletings, Near to thy reverend pitcher I will fall Down dead for grief, and end my woes withal: So three in one small plat of ground shall lie-- Anthea, Herrick, and his poetry.

23. THE WEEPING CHERRY.

I saw a cherry weep, and why? Why wept it? but for shame Because my Julia's lip was by, And did out-red the same. But, pretty fondling, let not fall A tear at all for that: Which rubies, corals, scarlets, all For tincture wonder at.

24. SOFT MUSIC.

The mellow touch of music most doth wound The soul when it doth rather sigh than sound.

25. THE DIFFERENCE BETWIXT KINGS AND SUBJECTS.

'Twixt kings and subjects there's this mighty odds: Subjects are taught by men; kings by the gods.

26. HIS ANSWER TO A QUESTION.

Some would know Why I so Long still do tarry, And ask why Here that I Live and not marry. Thus I those Do oppose: What man would be here Slave to thrall, If at all He could live free here?

27. UPON JULIA'S FALL.

Julia was careless, and withal She rather took than got a fall, The wanton ambler chanc'd to see Part of her legs' sincerity: And ravish'd thus, it came to pass, The nag (like to the prophet's ass) Began to speak, and would have been A-telling what rare sights he'd seen: And had told all; but did refrain Because his tongue was tied again.

28. EXPENSES EXHAUST.

Live with a thrifty, not a needy fate; _Small shots paid often waste a vast estate_.

Shots, debts.

29. LOVE, WHAT IT IS.

Love is a circle that doth restless move In the same sweet eternity of love.

30. PRESENCE AND ABSENCE.

When what is lov'd is present, love doth spring; But being absent, love lies languishing.

31. NO SPOUSE BUT A SISTER.

A bachelor I will Live as I have liv'd still, And never take a wife To crucify my life; But this I'll tell ye too, What now I mean to do: A sister (in the stead Of wife) about I'll lead; Which I will keep embrac'd, And kiss, but yet be chaste.

32. THE POMANDER BRACELET.

To me my Julia lately sent A bracelet richly redolent: The beads I kissed, but most lov'd her That did perfume the pomander.

Pomander, a ball of scent.

33. THE SHOE-TYING.

Anthea bade me tie her shoe; I did; and kissed the instep too: And would have kissed unto her knee, Had not her blush rebuked me.

34. THE CARCANET.

Instead of orient pearls of jet I sent my love a carcanet; About her spotless neck she knit The lace, to honour me or it: Then think how rapt was I to see My jet t'enthral such ivory.

Carcanet, necklace. _Lace_, any kind of girdle; used here for the necklace.

35. HIS SAILING FROM JULIA.

When that day comes, whose evening says I'm gone Unto that watery desolation, Devoutly to thy closet-gods then pray That my wing'd ship may meet no remora. Those deities which circum-walk the seas, And look upon our dreadful passages, Will from all dangers re-deliver me For one drink-offering poured out by thee. Mercy and truth live with thee! and forbear (In my short absence) to unsluice a tear; But yet for love's sake let thy lips do this, Give my dead picture one engendering kiss: Work that to life, and let me ever dwell In thy remembrance, Julia. So farewell.

Closet-gods, the Roman Lares. _Remora_, the sea Lamprey or suckstone, believed to check the course of ships by clinging to their keels.

36. HOW THE WALL-FLOWER CAME FIRST, AND WHY SO CALLED.

Why this flower is now call'd so, List, sweet maids, and you shall know. Understand, this firstling was Once a brisk and bonnie lass, Kept as close as Danaë was: Who a sprightly springall lov'd, And to have it fully prov'd, Up she got upon a wall, Tempting down to slide withal: But the silken twist untied, So she fell, and, bruis'd, she died. Love, in pity of the deed, And her loving-luckless speed, Turn'd her to this plant we call Now _the flower of the wall_.

Tempting, trying.

37. WHY FLOWERS CHANGE COLOUR.

These fresh beauties (we can prove) Once were virgins sick of love. Turn'd to flowers,--still in some Colours go and colours come.

38. TO HIS MISTRESS OBJECTING TO HIM NEITHER TOYING OR TALKING.

You say I love not, 'cause I do not play Still with your curls, and kiss the time away. You blame me too, because I can't devise Some sport to please those babies in your eyes: By love's religion, I must here confess it, The most I love when I the least express it. _Small griefs find tongues_: full casks are ever found To give (if any, yet) but little sound. _Deep waters noiseless are_; and this we know, _That chiding streams betray small depth below_. So, when love speechless is, she doth express A

depth in love and that depth bottomless. Now, since my love is tongueless, know me such Who speak but little 'cause I love so much.

Babies in your eyes, see Note.

39. UPON THE LOSS OF HIS MISTRESSES.

I have lost, and lately, these Many dainty mistresses: Stately Julia, prime of all: Sappho next, a principal: Smooth Anthea for a skin White, and heaven-like crystalline: Sweet Electra, and the choice Myrrha for the lute and voice: Next Corinna, for her wit, And the graceful use of it: With Perilla: all are gone; Only Herrick's left alone For to number sorrow by Their departures hence, and die.

40. THE DREAM.

Methought last night Love in an anger came And brought a rod, so whipt me with the same; Myrtle the twigs were, merely to imply Love strikes, but 'tis with gentle cruelty. Patient I was: Love pitiful grew then And strok'd the stripes, and I was whole again. Thus, like a bee, Love gentle still doth bring Honey to salve where he before did sting.

42. TO LOVE.

I'm free from thee; and thou no more shalt hear My puling pipe to beat against thine ear. Farewell my shackles, though of pearl they be; Such precious thraldom ne'er shall fetter me. He loves his bonds who, when the first are broke, Submits his neck unto a second yoke.

43. ON HIMSELF.

Young I was, but now am old, But I am not yet grown cold; I can play, and I can twine 'Bout a virgin like a vine: In her lap too I can lie Melting, and in fancy die; And return to life if she Claps my cheek, or kisseth me: Thus, and thus it now appears That our love outlasts our years.

44. LOVE'S PLAY AT PUSH-PIN.

Love and myself, believe me, on a day At childish push-pin, for our sport, did play; I put, he pushed, and, heedless of my skin, Love pricked my finger with a golden pin; Since which it festers so that I can prove 'Twas but a trick to poison me with love: Little the wound was, greater was the smart, The finger bled, but burnt was all my heart.

Push-pin, a game in which pins are pushed with an endeavor to cross them.

45. THE ROSARY.

One ask'd me where the roses grew: I bade him not go seek, But forthwith bade my Julia show A bud in either cheek.

46. UPON CUPID.

Old wives have often told how they Saw Cupid bitten by a flea; And thereupon, in tears half drown'd, He cried aloud: Help, help the wound! He wept, he sobb'd, he call'd to some To bring him lint and balsamum, To make a tent, and put it in Where

the stiletto pierced the skin; Which, being done, the fretful pain Assuaged, and he was well again.

Tent, a roll of lint for probing wounds.

47. THE PARCÆ; OR, THREE DAINTY DESTINIES: THE ARMILLET.

Three lovely sisters working were, As they were closely set, Of soft and dainty maidenhair A curious armillet. I, smiling, asked them what they did, Fair Destinies all three, Who told me they had drawn a thread Of life, and 'twas for me. They show'd me then how fine 'twas spun, And I reply'd thereto,-- "I care not now how soon 'tis done, Or cut, if cut by you".

48. SORROWS SUCCEED.

When one is past, another care we have: _Thus woe succeeds a woe, as wave a wave_.

49. CHERRY-PIT.

Julia and I did lately sit Playing for sport at cherry-pit: She threw; I cast; and, having thrown, I got the pit, and she the stone.

Cherry-pit, a game in which cherry-stones were pitched into a small hole.

50. TO ROBIN REDBREAST.

Laid out for dead, let thy last kindness be With leaves and moss-work for to cover me: And while the wood-nymphs my cold corpse inter, Sing thou my dirge, sweet-warbling chorister! For epitaph, in foliage, next write this: _Here, here the tomb of Robin Herrick is_.

51. DISCONTENTS IN DEVON.

More discontents I never had Since I was born than here, Where I have been, and still am sad, In this dull Devonshire; Yet, justly too, I must confess I ne'er invented such Ennobled numbers for the press, Than where I loathed so much.

52. TO HIS PATERNAL COUNTRY.

O earth! earth! earth! hear thou my voice, and be Loving and gentle for to cover me: Banish'd from thee I live, ne'er to return, Unless thou giv'st my small remains an urn.

53. CHERRY-RIPE.

Cherry-ripe, ripe, ripe, I cry, Full and fair ones; come and buy. If so be you ask me where They do grow, I answer: There, Where my Julia's lips do smile; There's the land, or cherry-isle, Whose plantations fully show All the year where cherries grow.

54. TO HIS MISTRESSES.

Put on your silks, and piece by piece Give them the scent of ambergris; And for your breaths, too, let them smell Ambrosia-like, or nectarel; While other gums their sweets perspire, By your own jewels set on fire.

55. TO ANTHEA.

Now is the time, when all the lights wax dim; And thou, Anthea, must withdraw from him Who was thy servant. Dearest, bury me Under that Holy-oak or Gospel-tree, Where, though thou see'st not, thou may'st think upon Me, when thou yearly go'st procession; Or, for mine honour, lay me in that tomb In which thy sacred relics shall have room. For my embalming, sweetest, there will be No spices wanting when I'm laid by thee.

Holy oak, the oak under which the minister read the Gospel in the procession round the parish bounds in Rogation week.

56. THE VISION TO ELECTRA.

I dreamed we both were in a bed Of roses, almost smothered: The warmth and sweetness had me there Made lovingly familiar, But that I heard thy sweet breath say, Faults done by night will blush by day. I kissed thee, panting, and, I call Night to the record! that was all. But, ah! if empty dreams so please, Love give me more such nights as these.

57. DREAMS.

Here we are all by day; by night we're hurl'd By dreams, each one into a sev'ral world.

58. AMBITION.

In man ambition is the common'st thing; Each one by nature loves to be a king.

59. HIS REQUEST TO JULIA.

Julia, if I chance to die Ere I print my poetry, I most humbly thee desire To commit it to the fire: Better 'twere my book were dead Than to live not perfected.

60. MONEY GETS THE MASTERY.

Fight thou with shafts of silver and o'ercome, When no force else can get the masterdom.

61. THE SCARE-FIRE.

Water, water I desire, Here's a house of flesh on fire; Ope the fountains and the springs, And come all to bucketings: What ye cannot quench pull down; Spoil a house to save a town: Better 'tis that one should fall, Than by one to hazard all.

Scare-fire, fire-alarm.

62. UPON SILVIA, A MISTRESS.

When some shall say, Fair once my Silvia was, Thou wilt complain, False now's thy looking-glass, Which renders that quite tarnished which was green, And priceless now what peerless once had been. Upon thy form more wrinkles yet will fall, And, coming down, shall make no noise at all.

Priceless, valueless.

63. CHEERFULNESS IN CHARITY; OR, THE SWEET SACRIFICE.

'Tis not a thousand bullocks' thighs Can please those heav'nly deities, If the vower don't express In his offering cheerfulness.

65. SWEETNESS IN SACRIFICE.

'Tis not greatness they require To be offer'd up by fire; But 'tis sweetness that doth please Those _Eternal Essences_.

66. STEAM IN SACRIFICE.

If meat the gods give, I the steam High-towering will devote to them, Whose easy natures like it well, If we the roast have, they the smell.

67. UPON JULIA'S VOICE.

So smooth, so sweet, so silv'ry is thy voice, As, could they hear, the damn'd would make no noise, But listen to thee, walking in thy chamber, Melting melodious words to lutes of amber.

Amber, used here merely for any rich material: cp. "Treading on amber with their silver feet".

68. AGAIN.

When I thy singing next shall hear, I'll wish I might turn all to ear To drink in notes and numbers such As blessed souls can't hear too much; Then melted down, there let me lie Entranc'd and lost confusedly, And, by thy music stricken mute, Die and be turn'd into a lute.

69. ALL THINGS DECAY AND DIE.

All things decay with time: the forest sees The growth and downfall of her aged trees; That timber tall, which threescore lusters stood The proud dictator of the state-like wood,-- I mean (the sovereign of all plants) the oak-- Droops, dies, and falls without the cleaver's stroke.

Lusters, the Roman reckoning of five years.

70. THE SUCCESSION OF THE FOUR SWEET MONTHS.

First, April, she with mellow showers Opens the way for early flowers; Then after her comes smiling May, In a more rich and sweet array; Next enters June, and brings us more Gems than those two that went before: Then (lastly) July comes, and she More wealth brings in than all those three.

71. NO SHIPWRECK OF VIRTUE. TO A FRIEND.

Thou sail'st with others in this Argus here; Nor wreck or bulging thou hast cause to fear; But trust to this, my noble passenger; Who swims with virtue, he shall still be sure (Ulysses-like) all tempests to endure, And 'midst a thousand gulfs to be secure.

Bulging, leaking.

72. UPON HIS SISTER-IN-LAW, MISTRESS ELIZABETH HERRICK.

First, for effusions due unto the dead, My solemn vows have here accomplished: Next, how I love thee, that my grief must tell, Wherein thou liv'st for ever. Dear, farewell.

Effusions, drink-offerings.

73. OF LOVE. A SONNET.

How love came in I do not know, Whether by the eye, or ear, or no; Or whether with the soul it came (At first) infused with the same; Whether in part 'tis here or there, Or, like the soul, whole everywhere, This troubles me: but I as well As any other this can tell: That when from hence she does depart The outlet then is from the heart.

74. TO ANTHEA.

Ah, my Anthea! Must my heart still break? (_Love makes me write, what shame forbids to speak_.) Give me a kiss, and to that kiss a score; Then to that twenty add a hundred more: A thousand to that hundred: so kiss on, To make that thousand up a million. Treble that million, and when that is done Let's kiss afresh, as when we first begun. But yet, though love likes well such scenes as these, There is an act that will more fully please: Kissing and glancing, soothing, all make way But to the acting of this private play: Name it I would; but, being blushing red, The rest I'll speak when we meet both in bed.

75. THE ROCK OF RUBIES, AND THE QUARRY OF PEARLS.

Some ask'd me where the rubies grew, And nothing I did say: But with my finger pointed to The lips of Julia. Some ask'd how pearls did grow, and where; Then spoke I to my girl, To part her lips, and show'd them there The quarrelets of Pearl.

Quarrelets, little squares.

76. CONFORMITY.

Conformity was ever known A foe to dissolution: Nor can we that a ruin call, Whose crack gives crushing unto all.

77. TO THE KING, UPON HIS COMING WITH HIS ARMY INTO THE WEST.

Welcome, most welcome to our vows and us, Most great and universal genius! The drooping West, which hitherto has stood As one in long-lamented widowhood, Looks like a bride now, or a bed of flowers Newly refresh'd both by the sun and showers. War, which before was horrid, now appears Lovely in you, brave prince of cavaliers! A deal of courage in each bosom springs By your access, O you the best of kings! Ride on with all white omens; so that where Your standard's up, we fix a conquest there.

78. UPON ROSES.

Under a lawn, than skies more clear, Some ruffled roses nestling were: And, snugging there, they seem'd to lie As in a flowery nunnery: They blush'd, and look'd more fresh than flowers Quicken'd of late by pearly showers, And all because they were possess'd But of the heat of Julia's breast: Which, as a warm and moisten'd

spring, Gave them their ever-flourishing.

79. TO THE KING AND QUEEN UPON THEIR UNHAPPY DISTANCES.

Woe, woe to them, who, by a ball of strife, Do, and have parted here a man and wife: CHARLES the best husband, while MARIA strives To be, and is, the very best of wives, Like streams, you are divorc'd; but 'twill come when These eyes of mine shall see you mix again. Thus speaks the oak here; C. and M. shall meet, Treading on amber, with their silver-feet, Nor will't be long ere this accomplish'd be: The words found true, C. M., remember me.

Oak, the prophetic tree.

80. DANGERS WAIT ON KINGS.

As oft as night is banish'd by the morn, So oft we'll think we see a king new born.

81. THE CHEAT OF CUPID; OR, THE UNGENTLE GUEST.

One silent night of late, When every creature rested, Came one unto my gate And, knocking, me molested.

Who's that, said I, beats there, And troubles thus the sleepy? Cast off, said he, all fear, And let not locks thus keep ye.

For I a boy am, who By moonless nights have swerved; And all with show'rs wet through, And e'en with cold half starved.

I pitiful arose, And soon a taper lighted; And did myself disclose Unto the lad benighted.

I saw he had a bow And wings, too, which did shiver; And, looking down below, I spied he had a quiver.

I to my chimney's shine Brought him, as Love professes, And chafed his hands with mine, And dried his drooping tresses.

But when he felt him warm'd: Let's try this bow of ours, And string, if they be harm'd, Said he, with these late showers.

Forthwith his bow he bent, And wedded string and arrow, And struck me, that it went Quite through my heart and marrow.

Then, laughing loud, he flew Away, and thus said, flying: Adieu, mine host, adieu, I'll leave thy heart a-dying.

82. TO THE REVEREND SHADE OF HIS RELIGIOUS FATHER.

That for seven lusters I did never come To do the rites to thy religious tomb; That neither hair was cut, or true tears shed By me, o'er thee, as justments to the dead, Forgive, forgive me; since I did not know Whether thy bones had here their rest or no, But now 'tis known, behold! behold, I bring Unto thy ghost th' effused offering: And look what smallage, night-shade, cypress, yew, Unto the shades have been, or now are due, Here I devote; and something more than so; I come to pay a debt of birth I owe. Thou gav'st me life, but mortal; for that one Favour I'll make full

satisfaction; For my life mortal rise from out thy hearse. And take a life immortal from my verse.

Seven lusters, five and thirty years. _Hair was cut_, according to the Greek custom. _Justments_, dues. _Smallage_, water parsley.

83. DELIGHT IN DISORDER.

A sweet disorder in the dress Kindles in clothes a wantonness: A lawn about the shoulders thrown Into a fine distraction: An erring lace which here and there Enthralls the crimson stomacher: A cuff neglectful, and thereby Ribbons to flow confusedly: A winning wave, deserving note, In the tempestuous petticoat: A careless shoe-string, in whose tie I see a wild civility: Do more bewitch me than when art Is too precise in every part.

84. TO HIS MUSE.

Were I to give thee baptism, I would choose To christen thee, the bride, the bashful Muse, Or Muse of roses: since that name does fit Best with those virgin-verses thou hast writ: Which are so clean, so chaste, as none may fear Cato the censor, should he scan each here.

85. UPON LOVE.

Love scorch'd my finger, but did spare The burning of my heart; To signify in love my share Should be a little part.

Little I love; but if that he Would but that heat recall; That joint to ashes burnt should be,[E] Ere I would love at all.

[E] Orig. ed., _should be burnt_.

86. TO DEAN BOURN, A RUDE RIVER IN DEVON, BY WHICH SOMETIMES HE LIVED.

Dean Bourn, farewell; I never look to see Dean, or thy watery[F] incivility. Thy rocky bottom, that doth tear thy streams And makes them frantic even to all extremes, To my content I never should behold, Were thy streams silver, or thy rocks all gold. Rocky thou art, and rocky we discover Thy men, and rocky are thy ways all over. O men, O manners, now and ever known To be a rocky generation! A people currish, churlish as the seas, And rude almost as rudest savages, With whom I did, and may re-sojourn when Rocks turn to rivers, rivers turn to men.

[F] Orig. ed., _warty_.

87. KISSING USURY.

Bianca, let Me pay the debt I owe thee for a kiss Thou lend'st to me, And I to thee Will render ten for this.

If thou wilt say Ten will not pay For that so rich a one; I'll clear the sum, If it will come Unto a million.

By this, I guess, Of happiness Who has a little measure, He must of right To th' utmost mite Make payment for his pleasure.

88. TO JULIA.

How rich and pleasing thou, my Julia, art In each thy dainty and peculiar part! First, for thy queenship, on thy head is set Of flowers a sweet commingled coronet: About thy neck a carcanet is bound, Made of the ruby, pearl and diamond: A golden ring that shines upon thy thumb: About thy wrist, the rich dardanium.[G] Between thy breasts (than down of swans more white) There plays the sapphire with the chrysolite. No part besides must of thyself be known, But by the topaz, opal, chalcedon.

Carcanet, necklace.

[G] _Dardanium_, a bracelet, from Dardanus so called. (Note in the original edition.)

89. TO LAURELS.

A funeral stone Or verse I covet none, But only crave Of you that I may have A sacred laurel springing from my grave: Which being seen, Blest with perpetual green, May grow to be Not so much call'd a tree As the eternal monument of me.

90. HIS CAVALIER.

Give me that man that dares bestride The active sea-horse, and with pride Through that huge field of waters ride.

Who with his looks, too, can appease The ruffling winds and raging seas, In midst of all their outrages.

This, this a virtuous man can do, Sail against rocks, and split them too; Ay, and a world of pikes pass through.

91. ZEAL REQUIRED IN LOVE.

I'll do my best to win whene'er I woo: _That man loves not who is not zealous too_.

92. THE BAG OF THE BEE.

About the sweet bag of a bee Two cupids fell at odds, And whose the pretty prize should be They vow'd to ask the gods.

Which Venus hearing, thither came, And for their boldness stripp'd them, And, taking thence from each his flame, With rods of myrtle whipp'd them.

Which done, to still their wanton cries, When quiet grown she'd seen them, She kiss'd, and wip'd their dove-like eyes, And gave the bag between them.

93. LOVE KILLED BY LACK.

Let me be warm, let me be fully fed, _Luxurious love by wealth is nourished_. Let me be lean, and cold, and once grown poor, I shall dislike what once I lov'd before.

94. TO HIS MISTRESS.

Choose me your valentine, Next let us marry-- Love to the death will pine If we long tarry.

Promise, and keep your vows, Or vow ye never-- Love's doctrine disallows Troth-breakers ever.

You have broke promise twice, Dear, to undo me, If you prove faithless thrice None then will woo ye.

95. TO THE GENEROUS READER.

See and not see, and if thou chance t'espy Some aberrations in my poetry, Wink at small faults; the greater, ne'ertheless, Hide, and with them their father's nakedness. Let's do our best, our watch and ward to keep; Homer himself, in a long work, may sleep.

96. TO CRITICS.

I'll write, because I'll give You critics means to live; For should I not supply The cause, th' effect would die.

97. DUTY TO TYRANTS.

Good princes must be pray'd for; for the bad They must be borne with, and in rev'rence had. Do they first pill thee, next pluck off thy skin? _Good children kiss the rods that punish sin_. Touch not the tyrant; let the gods alone To strike him dead that but usurps a throne.

Pill, plunder.

98. BEING ONCE BLIND, HIS REQUEST TO BIANCA.

When age or chance has made me blind, So that the path I cannot find, And when my falls and stumblings are More than the stones i' th' street by far, Go thou afore, and I shall well Follow thy perfumes by the smell; Or be my guide, and I shall be Led by some light that flows from thee. Thus held or led by thee, I shall In ways confus'd nor slip or fall.

100. NO WANT WHERE THERE'S LITTLE.

To bread and water none is poor; And having these, what need of more? Though much from out the cess be spent, _Nature with little is content_.

Cess, the parish assessment for church purposes.

101. BARLEY-BREAK; OR, LAST IN HELL.

We two are last in hell; what may we fear To be tormented or kept pris'ners here? Alas! if kissing be of plagues the worst, We'll wish in hell we had been last and first.

Barley-break, a country game resembling prisoners' base. See Note. _Hell_, the "middle den," the occupants of which had to catch the other players.

102. THE DEFINITION OF BEAUTY.

Beauty no other thing is than a beam Flashed out between the middle and extreme.

103. TO DIANEME.

Dear, though to part it be a hell, Yet, Dianeme, now farewell: Thy frown last night did bid me go, But whither only grief does know. I do beseech thee ere we part, If merciful as fair thou art, Or else desir'st that maids should tell Thy pity by love's chronicle, O Dianeme, rather kill Me, than to make me languish still! 'Tis cruelty in thee to th' height Thus, thus to wound, not kill outright; Yet there's a way found, if you please, By sudden death to give me ease; And thus devis'd, do thou but this-- Bequeath to me one parting kiss, So sup'rabundant joy shall be The executioner of me.

104. TO ANTHEA LYING IN BED.

So looks Anthea, when in bed she lies O'ercome or half betray'd by tiffanies, Like to a twilight, or that simpering dawn That roses show when misted o'er with lawn. Twilight is yet, till that her lawns give way; Which done, that dawn turns then to perfect day.

Tiffanies, gauzes. _Lawn_, fine linen.

105. TO ELECTRA.

More white than whitest lilies far, Or snow, or whitest swans you are: More white than are the whitest creams, Or moonlight tinselling the streams: More white than pearls, or Juno's thigh, Or Pelops' arm of ivory. True, I confess, such whites as these May me delight, not fully please; Till like Ixion's cloud you be White, warm, and soft to lie with me.

Pelops' arm, which Jove gave him to replace the one eaten by Ceres at the feast of Tantalus. _Ixion's cloud_, to which Jove, for his deception, gave the form of Juno.

106. A COUNTRY-LIFE: TO HIS BROTHER, MR. THO. HERRICK.

Thrice, and above, bless'd, my soul's half, art thou In thy both last and better vow: Could'st leave the city, for exchange, to see The country's sweet simplicity: And it to know and practise, with intent To grow the sooner innocent By studying to know virtue, and to aim More at her nature than her name. The last is but the least; the first doth tell Ways less to live than to live well: And both are known to thee, who now can'st live Led by thy conscience; to give Justice to soon-pleased nature; and to show Wisdom and she together go And keep one centre: this with that conspires To teach man to confine desires And know that riches have their proper stint In the contented mind, not mint: And can'st instruct that those who have the itch Of craving more are never rich. These things thou know'st to th' height, and dost prevent That plague; because thou art content With that heav'n gave thee with a wary hand, More blessed in thy brass than land, To keep cheap nature even and upright; To cool, not cocker appetite. Thus thou canst tersely live to satisfy The belly chiefly, not the eye; Keeping the barking stomach wisely quiet, Less with a neat than needful diet. But that which most makes sweet thy country life Is the fruition of a wife: Whom, stars consenting with thy fate, thou hast Got not so beautiful as chaste: By whose warm side thou dost securely sleep, While love the sentinel doth keep, With those deeds done by day, which ne'er affright Thy silken slumbers in the night. Nor has the darkness power to usher in Fear to those sheets that know no sin; But still thy wife, by chaste intentions

led, Gives thee each night a maidenhead. The damask'd meadows and the pebbly streams Sweeten and make soft your dreams: The purling springs, groves, birds, and well-weav'd bowers, With fields enamelled with flowers, Present their shapes; while fantasy discloses Millions of lilies mix'd with roses. Then dream ye hear the lamb by many a bleat Woo'd to come suck the milky teat: While Faunus in the vision comes to keep From rav'ning wolves the fleecy sheep. With thousand such enchanting dreams, that meet To make sleep not so sound as sweet: Nor can these figures so thy rest endear As not to rise when Chanticlere Warns the last watch; but with the dawn dost rise To work, but first to sacrifice; Making thy peace with heav'n, for some late fault, With holy-meal and spirting-salt. Which done, thy painful thumb this sentence tells us, _Jove for our labour all things sells us_. Nor are thy daily and devout affairs Attended with those desp'rate cares Th' industrious merchant has; who, for to find Gold, runneth to the Western Inde, And back again, tortured with fears, doth fly, Untaught to suffer poverty. But thou at home, bless'd with securest ease, Sitt'st, and believ'st that there be seas And watery dangers; while thy whiter hap But sees these things within thy map. And viewing them with a more safe survey Mak'st easy fear unto thee say,-- _"A heart thrice wall'd with oak and brass that man Had, first durst plough the ocean"_. But thou at home, without or tide or gale, Can'st in thy map securely sail: Seeing those painted countries, and so guess By those fine shades their substances: And, from thy compass taking small advice, Buy'st travel at the lowest price. Nor are thine ears so deaf but thou canst hear, Far more with wonder than with fear, Fame tell of states, of countries, courts, and kings, And believe there be such things: When of these truths thy happier knowledge lies More in thine ears than in thine eyes. And when thou hear'st by that too true report Vice rules the most or all at court, Thy pious wishes are, though thou not there, Virtue had, and mov'd her sphere. But thou liv'st fearless; and thy face ne'er shows Fortune when she comes or goes, But with thy equal thoughts prepared dost stand, To take her by the either hand; Nor car'st which comes the first, the foul or fair: _A wise man ev'ry way lies square_, And, like a surly oak with storms perplex'd, Grows still the stronger, strongly vex'd. Be so, bold spirit; stand centre-like, unmov'd; And be not only thought, but prov'd To be what I report thee; and inure Thyself, if want comes to endure: And so thou dost, for thy desires are Confin'd to live with private lar: Not curious whether appetite be fed Or with the first or second bread, Who keep'st no proud mouth for delicious cates: Hunger makes coarse meats delicates. Canst, and unurg'd, forsake that larded fare, Which art, not nature, makes so rare, To taste boil'd nettles, colworts, beets, and eat These and sour herbs as dainty meat, While soft opinion makes thy Genius say, _Content makes all ambrosia_. Nor is it that thou keep'st this stricter size So much for want as exercise: To numb the sense of dearth, which should sin haste it, Thou might'st but only see't, not taste it. Yet can thy humble roof maintain a choir Of singing crickets by the fire: And the brisk mouse may feast herself with crumbs Till that the green-eyed kitling comes, Then to her cabin blest she can escape The sudden danger of a rape: And thus thy little well-kept stock doth prove _Wealth cannot make a life, but love_. Nor art thou so close-handed but canst spend, Counsel concurring with the end, As well as spare, still conning o'er this theme, To shun the first and last extreme. Ordaining that thy small stock find no breach, Or to exceed thy tether's reach: But to live round, and close, and wisely true

To thine own self, and known to few. Thus let thy rural sanctuary be Elysium to thy wife and thee; There to disport yourselves with golden measure: _For seldom use commends the pleasure_. Live, and live blest, thrice happy pair; let breath, But lost to one, be the other's death. And as there is one love, one faith, one troth, Be so one death, one grave to both. Till when, in such assurance live ye may, Nor fear or wish your dying day.

Brass, money. _Cocker_, pamper. _Neat_, dainty. _Spirting-salt_, the "saliente mica" of Horace, See Note. _Lar_, the "closet-gods," or gods of the house. _Colworts_, cabbages. _Size_ or _assize_, a fixed allowance of food, a ration.

107. DIVINATION BY A DAFFODIL.

When a daffodil I see, Hanging down his head towards me, Guess I may what I must be: First, I shall decline my head; Secondly, I shall be dead; Lastly, safely buried.

108. TO THE PAINTER, TO DRAW HIM A PICTURE.

Come, skilful Lupo, now, and take Thy bice, thy umber, pink, and lake; And let it be thy pencil's strife, To paint a Bridgeman to the life: Draw him as like too, as you can, An old, poor, lying, flattering man: His cheeks bepimpled, red and blue; His nose and lips of mulberry hue. Then, for an easy fancy, place A burling iron for his face: Next, make his cheeks with breath to swell, And for to speak, if possible: But do not so, for fear lest he Should by his breathing, poison thee.

Bice, properly a brown grey, but by transference from "blue bice" and "green bice," used for blue and green. _Burling iron_, pincers for extracting knots.

111. A LYRIC TO MIRTH.

While the milder fates consent, Let's enjoy our merriment: Drink, and dance, and pipe, and play; Kiss our dollies night and day: Crowned with clusters of the vine, Let us sit, and quaff our wine. Call on Bacchus, chant his praise; Shake the thyrse, and bite the bays: Rouse Anacreon from the dead, And return him drunk to bed: Sing o'er Horace, for ere long Death will come and mar the song: Then shall Wilson and Gotiere Never sing or play more here.

Wilson, Dr. John Wilson, the singer and composer, one of the king's musicians (1594-1673). _Gotiere_, Jacques Gaultier, a French lutist at the court of Charles I.

112. TO THE EARL OF WESTMORELAND.

When my date's done, and my grey age must die, Nurse up, great lord, this my posterity: Weak though it be, long may it grow and stand, Shored up by you, brave Earl of Westmoreland.

113. AGAINST LOVE.

Whene'er my heart love's warmth but entertains, Oh frost! oh snow! oh hail! forbid the banes. One drop now deads a spark, but if the same Once gets a force, floods cannot quench the flame. Rather than love, let me be ever lost, Or let me 'gender with eternal frost.

114. UPON JULIA'S RIBAND.

As shows the air when with a rainbow grac'd, So smiles that riband 'bout my Julia's waist: Or like--nay 'tis that zonulet of love, Wherein all pleasures of the world are wove.

115. THE FROZEN ZONE; OR, JULIA DISDAINFUL.

Whither? say, whither shall I fly, To slack these flames wherein I fry? To the treasures, shall I go, Of the rain, frost, hail, and snow? Shall I search the underground, Where all damps and mists are found? Shall I seek (for speedy ease) All the floods and frozen seas? Or descend into the deep, Where eternal cold does keep? These may cool; but there's a zone Colder yet than anyone: That's my Julia's breast, where dwells Such destructive icicles, As that the congelation will Me sooner starve than those can kill.

116. AN EPITAPH UPON A SOBER MATRON.

With blameless carriage, I lived here To the almost seven and fortieth year. Stout sons I had, and those twice three One only daughter lent to me: The which was made a happy bride But thrice three moons before she died. My modest wedlock, that was known Contented with the bed of one.

117. TO THE PATRON OF POETS, M. END. PORTER.

Let there be patrons, patrons like to thee, Brave Porter! poets ne'er will wanting be: Fabius and Cotta, Lentulus, all live In thee, thou man of men! who here do'st give Not only subject-matter for our wit, But likewise oil of maintenance to it: For which, before thy threshold, we'll lay down Our thyrse for sceptre, and our bays for crown. For, to say truth, all garlands are thy due: The laurel, myrtle, oak, and ivy too.

118. THE SADNESS OF THINGS FOR SAPPHO'S SICKNESS.

Lilies will languish; violets look ill; Sickly the primrose; pale the daffodil; That gallant tulip will hang down his head, Like to a virgin newly ravished; Pansies will weep, and marigolds will wither, And keep a fast and funeral together; Sappho droop, daisies will open never, But bid good-night, and close their lids for ever.

119. LEANDER'S OBSEQUIES.

When as Leander young was drown'd No heart by Love receiv'd a wound, But on a rock himself sat by, There weeping sup'rabundantly. Sighs numberless he cast about, And, all his tapers thus put out, His head upon his hand he laid, And sobbing deeply, thus he said: "Ah, cruel sea," and, looking on't, Wept as he'd drown the Hellespont. And sure his tongue had more express'd But that his tears forbade the rest.

120. HOPE HEARTENS.

None goes to warfare but with this intent-- The gains must dead the fears of detriment.

121. FOUR THINGS MAKE US HAPPY HERE.

Health is the first good lent to men; A gentle disposition then: Next, to be rich by no by-ways; Lastly, with friends t'enjoy our days.

122. HIS PARTING FROM MRS. DOROTHY KENNEDY.

When I did go from thee I felt that smart Which bodies do when souls from them depart. Thou did'st not mind it; though thou then might'st see Me turn'd to tears; yet did'st not weep for me. 'Tis true, I kiss'd thee; but I could not hear Thee spend a sigh t'accompany my tear. Methought 'twas strange that thou so hard should'st prove, Whose heart, whose hand, whose every part spake love. Prithee, lest maids should censure thee, but say Thou shed'st one tear, whenas I went away; And that will please me somewhat: though I know, And Love will swear't, my dearest did not so.

123. THE TEAR SENT TO HER FROM STAINES.

Glide, gentle streams, and bear Along with you my tear To that coy girl Who smiles, yet slays Me with delays, And strings my tears as pearl.

See! see, she's yonder set, Making a carcanet Of maiden-flowers! There, there present This orient And pendant pearl of ours.

Then say I've sent one more Gem to enrich her store; And that is all Which I can send, Or vainly spend, For tears no more will fall.

Nor will I seek supply Of them, the spring's once dry; But I'll devise, Among the rest, A way that's best How I may save mine eyes.

Yet say--should she condemn Me to surrender them Then say my part Must be to weep Out them, to keep A poor, yet loving heart.

Say too, she would have this; She shall: then my hope is, That when I'm poor And nothing have To send or save, I'm sure she'll ask no more.

Carcanet, necklace.

124. UPON ONE LILY, WHO MARRIED WITH A MAID CALLED ROSE.

What times of sweetness this fair day foreshows, Whenas the Lily marries with the Rose! What next is look'd for? but we all should see To spring from thee a sweet posterity.

125. AN EPITAPH UPON A CHILD.

Virgins promis'd when I died That they would each primrose-tide Duly, morn and evening, come, And with flowers dress my tomb. Having promis'd, pay your debts, Maids, and here strew violets.

127. THE HOUR-GLASS.

That hour-glass which there you see With water fill'd, sirs, credit me, The humour was, as I have read, But lovers' tears incrystalled. Which, as they drop by drop do pass From th' upper to the under-glass, Do in a trickling manner tell, By many a watery syllable, That lovers' tears in lifetime shed Do restless run when they are dead.

Humour, moisture.

128. HIS FAREWELL TO SACK.

Farewell thou thing, time past so known, so dear To me as blood to life and spirit; near, Nay, thou more near than kindred, friend, man, wife, Male to the female, soul to body; life To quick action, or the warm soft side Of the resigning, yet resisting bride. The kiss of virgins, first fruits of the bed, Soft speech, smooth touch, the lips, the maidenhead: These and a thousand sweets could never be So near or dear as thou wast once to me. O thou, the drink of gods and angels! wine That scatter'st spirit and lust, whose purest shine More radiant than the summer's sunbeams shows; Each way illustrious, brave, and like to those Comets we see by night, whose shagg'd portents Foretell the coming of some dire events, Or some full flame which with a pride aspires, Throwing about his wild and active fires; 'Tis thou, above nectar, O divinest soul! Eternal in thyself, that can'st control That which subverts whole nature, grief and care, Vexation of the mind, and damn'd despair. 'Tis thou alone who, with thy mystic fan, Work'st more than wisdom, art, or nature can To rouse the sacred madness and awake The frost-bound blood and spirits, and to make Them frantic with thy raptures flashing through The soul like lightning, and as active too. 'Tis not Apollo can, or those thrice three Castalian sisters, sing, if wanting thee. Horace, Anacreon, both had lost their fame, Had'st thou not fill'd them with thy fire and flame. Phœbean splendour! and thou, Thespian spring! Of which sweet swans must drink before they sing Their true-pac'd numbers and their holy lays, Which makes them worthy cedar and the bays. But why, why longer do I gaze upon Thee with the eye of admiration? Since I must leave thee, and enforc'd must say To all thy witching beauties, Go, away. But if thy whimpering looks do ask me why, Then know that nature bids thee go, not I. 'Tis her erroneous self has made a brain Uncapable of such a sovereign As is thy powerful self. Prithee not smile, Or smile more inly, lest thy looks beguile My vows denounc'd in zeal, which thus much show thee That I have sworn but by thy looks to know thee. Let others drink thee freely, and desire Thee and their lips espous'd, while I admire And love thee, but not taste thee. Let my muse Fail of thy former helps, and only use Her inadult'rate strength: what's done by me Hereafter shall smell of the lamp, not thee.

Shagg'd, rough-haired. _Mystic fan_, the "mystica vannus Iacchi" of Georgic, i. 166. _Cedar_, _i.e._, cedar oil, used for the preservation of manuscripts.

130. UPON MRS. ELIZABETH WHEELER, UNDER THE NAME OF AMARILLIS.

Sweet Amarillis by a spring's Soft and soul-melting murmurings Slept, and thus sleeping, thither flew A robin-redbreast, who, at view, Not seeing her at all to stir, Brought leaves and moss to cover her; But while he perking there did pry About the arch of either eye, The lid began to let out day, At which poor robin flew away, And seeing her not dead, but all disleav'd, He chirp'd for joy to see himself deceiv'd.

132. TO MYRRHA, HARD-HEARTED.

Fold now thine arms and hang the head, Like to a lily withered; Next look thou like a sickly moon, Or like Jocasta in a swoon; Then weep and sigh and softly go, Like to a widow drown'd in woe, Or like a virgin full of ruth For the lost sweetheart of her

youth; And all because, fair maid, thou art Insensible of all my smart, And of those evil days that be Now posting on to punish thee. The gods are easy, and condemn All such as are not soft like them.

133. THE EYE.

Make me a heaven, and make me there Many a less and greater sphere: Make me the straight and oblique lines, The motions, lations and the signs. Make me a chariot and a sun, And let them through a zodiac run; Next place me zones and tropics there, With all the seasons of the year. Make me a sunset and a night, And then present the morning's light Cloth'd in her chamlets of delight. To these make clouds to pour down rain, With weather foul, then fair again. And when, wise artist, that thou hast With all that can be this heaven grac't, Ah! what is then this curious sky But only my Corinna's eye?

Lations, astral attractions. _Chamlets_, _i.e._, camlets, stuffs made from camels' hair.

134. UPON THE MUCH-LAMENTED MR. J. WARR.

What wisdom, learning, wit or worth Youth or sweet nature could bring forth Rests here with him who was the fame, The volume of himself and name. If, reader, then, thou wilt draw near And do an honour to thy tear, Weep then for him for whom laments Not one, but many monuments.

136. THE SUSPICION UPON HIS OVER-MUCH FAMILIARITY WITH A GENTLEWOMAN.

And must we part, because some say Loud is our love, and loose our play, And more than well becomes the day? Alas for pity! and for us Most innocent, and injured thus! Had we kept close, or played within, Suspicion now had been the sin, And shame had followed long ere this, T' have plagued what now unpunished is. But we, as fearless of the sun, As faultless, will not wish undone What now is done, since _where no sin Unbolts the door, no shame comes in_. Then, comely and most fragrant maid, Be you more wary than afraid Of these reports, because you see The fairest most suspected be. The common forms have no one eye Or ear of burning jealousy To follow them: but chiefly where Love makes the cheek and chin a sphere To dance and play in, trust me, there Suspicion questions every hair. Come, you are fair, and should be seen While you are in your sprightful green: And what though you had been embraced By me--were you for that unchaste? No, no! no more than is yond' moon Which, shining in her perfect noon, In all that great and glorious light, Continues cold as is the night. Then, beauteous maid, you may retire; And as for me, my chaste desire Shall move towards you, although I see Your face no more. So live you free From fame's black lips, as you from me.

137. SINGLE LIFE MOST SECURE.

Suspicion, discontent, and strife Come in for dowry with a wife.

138. THE CURSE. A SONG.

Go, perjured man; and if thou e'er return To see the small remainders in mine urn, When thou shalt laugh at my religious dust, And ask: where's now the colour, form and trust Of woman's beauty? and with hand more rude Rifle the flowers which the virgins strewed: Know I have prayed to Fury that some wind May blow my ashes up, and strike thee blind.

139. THE WOUNDED CUPID. SONG.

Cupid, as he lay among Roses, by a bee was stung; Whereupon, in anger flying To his mother, said thus, crying: Help! oh help! your boy's a-dying. And why, my pretty lad, said she? Then, blubbering, replied he: A winged snake has bitten me, Which country people call a bee. At which she smiled; then, with her hairs And kisses drying up his tears: Alas! said she, my wag, if this Such a pernicious torment is, Come tell me then, how great's the smart Of those thou woundest with thy dart!

140. TO DEWS. A SONG.

I burn, I burn; and beg of you To quench or cool me with your dew. I fry in fire, and so consume, Although the pile be all perfume. Alas! the heat and death's the same, Whether by choice or common flame, To be in oil of roses drowned, Or water; where's the comfort found? Both bring one death; and I die here Unless you cool me with a tear: Alas! I call; but ah! I see Ye cool and comfort all but me.

141. SOME COMFORT IN CALAMITY.

To conquered men, some comfort 'tis to fall By the hand of him who is the general.

142. THE VISION.

Sitting alone, as one forsook, Close by a silver-shedding brook, With hands held up to love, I wept; And after sorrows spent I slept: Then in a vision I did see A glorious form appear to me: A virgin's face she had; her dress Was like a sprightly Spartaness. A silver bow, with green silk strung, Down from her comely shoulders hung: And as she stood, the wanton air Dangled the ringlets of her hair. Her legs were such Diana shows When, tucked up, she a-hunting goes; With buskins shortened to descry The happy dawning of her thigh: Which when I saw, I made access To kiss that tempting nakedness: But she forbade me with a wand Of myrtle she had in her hand: And, chiding me, said: Hence, remove, Herrick, thou art too coarse to love.

143. LOVE ME LITTLE, LOVE ME LONG.

You say, to me-wards your affection's strong; Pray love me little, so you love me long. Slowly goes far: the mean is best: desire, Grown violent, does either die or tire.

144. UPON A VIRGIN KISSING A ROSE.

'Twas but a single rose, Till you on it did breathe; But since, methinks, it shows Not so much rose as wreath.

145. UPON A WIFE THAT DIED MAD WITH JEALOUSY.

In this little vault she lies, Here, with all her jealousies: Quiet yet; but if ye make Any noise they both will wake, And such spirits raise 'twill then Trouble death to lay

again.

146. UPON THE BISHOP OF LINCOLN'S IMPRISONMENT.

Never was day so over-sick with showers But that it had some intermitting hours; Never was night so tedious but it knew The last watch out, and saw the dawning too; Never was dungeon so obscurely deep Wherein or light or day did never peep; Never did moon so ebb, or seas so wane, But they left hope-seed to fill up again. So you, my lord, though you have now your stay, Your night, your prison, and your ebb, you may Spring up afresh, when all these mists are spent, And star-like, once more gild our firmament. Let but that mighty Cæsar speak, and then All bolts, all bars, all gates shall cleave; as when That earthquake shook the house, and gave the stout Apostles way, unshackled, to go out. This, as I wish for, so I hope to see; Though you, my lord, have been unkind to me, To wound my heart, and never to apply, When you had power, the meanest remedy. Well, though my grief by you was gall'd the more, Yet I bring balm and oil to heal your sore.

147. DISSUASIONS FROM IDLENESS.

Cynthius, pluck ye by the ear, That ye may good doctrine hear; Play not with the maiden-hair, For each ringlet there's a snare. Cheek, and eye, and lip, and chin-- These are traps to take fools in. Arms, and hands, and all parts else, Are but toils, or manacles, Set on purpose to enthral Men, but slothfuls most of all. Live employed, and so live free From these fetters; like to me, Who have found, and still can prove, _The lazy man the most doth love_.

149. AN EPITHALAMY TO SIR THOMAS SOUTHWELL AND HIS LADY.

I.

Now, now's the time, so oft by truth Promis'd should come to crown your youth. Then, fair ones, do not wrong Your joys by staying long; Or let love's fire go out, By lingering thus in doubt; But learn that time once lost Is ne'er redeem'd by cost. Then away; come, Hymen, guide To the bed the bashful bride.

II.

Is it, sweet maid, your fault these holy Bridal rites go on so slowly? Dear, is it this you dread The loss of maidenhead? Believe me, you will most Esteem it when 'tis lost; Then it no longer keep, Lest issue lie asleep. Then, away; come, Hymen, guide To the bed the bashful bride.

III.

These precious, pearly, purling tears But spring from ceremonious fears. And 'tis but native shame That hides the loving flame, And may a while control The soft and am'rous soul; But yet love's fire will waste Such bashfulness at last. Then, away; come, Hymen, guide To the bed the bashful bride.

IV.

Night now hath watch'd herself half blind, Yet not a maidenhead resign'd! 'Tis strange, ye will not fly To love's sweet mystery. Might yon full moon the sweets Have, promised to your sheets, She soon would leave her sphere, To be admitted there. Then, away; come, Hymen, guide To the bed the bashful bride.

V.

On, on devoutly, make no stay; While Domiduca leads the way, And Genius, who attends The bed for lucky ends. With Juno goes the Hours And Graces strewing flowers. And the boys with sweet tunes sing: Hymen, O Hymen, bring Home the turtles; Hymen, guide To the bed the bashful bride.

VI.

Behold! how Hymen's taper-light Shows you how much is spent of night. See, see the bridegroom's torch Half wasted in the porch. And now those tapers five, That show the womb shall thrive, Their silv'ry flames advance, To tell all prosp'rous chance Still shall crown the happy life Of the goodman and the wife.

VII.

Move forward then your rosy feet, And make whate'er they touch turn sweet. May all, like flowery meads, Smell where your soft foot treads; And everything assume To it the like perfume, As Zephyrus when he 'spires Through woodbine and sweetbriars. Then, away; come, Hymen, guide To the bed the bashful bride.

VIII.

And now the yellow veil at last Over her fragrant cheek is cast. Now seems she to express A bashful willingness: Showing a heart consenting, As with a will repenting. Then gently lead her on With wise suspicion; For that, matrons say, a measure Of that passion sweetens pleasure.

IX.

You, you that be of her nearest kin, Now o'er the threshold force her in. But to avert the worst Let her her fillets first Knit to the posts, this point Remembering, to anoint The sides, for 'tis a charm Strong against future harm; And the evil deads, the which There was hidden by the witch.

X.

O Venus! thou to whom is known The best way how to loose the zone Of virgins, tell the maid She need not be afraid, And bid the youth apply Close kisses if she cry, And

charge he not forbears Her though she woo with tears. Tell them now they must adventure, Since that love and night bid enter.

XI.

No fatal owl the bedstead keeps, With direful notes to fright your sleeps; No furies here about To put the tapers out, Watch or did make the bed: 'Tis omen full of dread; But all fair signs appear Within the chamber here. Juno here far off doth stand, Cooling sleep with charming wand.

XII.

Virgins, weep not; 'twill come when, As she, so you'll be ripe for men. Then grieve her not with saying She must no more a-maying, Or by rosebuds divine Who'll be her valentine. Nor name those wanton reaks You've had at barley-breaks, But now kiss her and thus say, "Take time, lady, while ye may".

XIII.

Now bar the doors; the bridegroom puts The eager boys to gather nuts. And now both love and time To their full height do climb: Oh! give them active heat And moisture both complete: Fit organs for increase, To keep and to release That which may the honour'd stem Circle with a diadem.

XIV.

And now, behold! the bed or couch That ne'er knew bride's or bridegroom's touch, Feels in itself a fire; And, tickled with desire, Pants with a downy breast, As with a heart possesst, Shrugging as it did move Ev'n with the soul of love. And, oh! had it but a tongue, Doves, 'twould say, ye bill too long.

XV.

O enter then! but see ye shun A sleep until the act be done. Let kisses in their close, Breathe as the damask rose, Or sweet as is that gum Doth from Panchaia come. Teach nature now to know Lips can make cherries grow Sooner than she ever yet In her wisdom could beget.

XVI.

On your minutes, hours, days, months, years, Drop the fat blessing of the spheres. That good which heav'n can give To make you bravely live Fall like a spangling dew By day and night on you. May fortune's lily-hand Open at your command; With all lucky birds to side With the bridegroom and the bride.

XVII.

Let bounteous Fate[s] your spindles full Fill, and wind up with whitest wool. Let them not cut the thread Of life until ye bid. May death yet come at last, And not with desp'rate haste, But when ye both can say "Come, let us now away," Be ye to the barn then borne, Two, like two ripe shocks of corn.

Domiduca, Juno, the goddess of marriage, the "home-bringer". _Reaks_, pranks. _Barley-break_, a country game, see 101. _Panchaia_, the land of spices: _cf_, Virg. G. ii. 139; Æn. iv. 379.

150. TEARS ARE TONGUES.

When Julia chid I stood as mute the while As is the fish or tongueless crocodile. Air coin'd to words my Julia could not hear, But she could see each eye to stamp a tear; By which mine angry mistress might descry Tears are the noble language of the eye. And when true love of words is destitute The eyes by tears speak, while the tongue is mute.

151. UPON A YOUNG MOTHER OF MANY CHILDREN.

Let all chaste matrons, when they chance to see My num'rous issue, praise and pity me: Praise me for having such a fruitful womb, Pity me, too, who found so soon a tomb.

152. TO ELECTRA.

I'll come to thee in all those shapes As Jove did when he made his rapes, Only I'll not appear to thee As he did once to Semele. Thunder and lightning I'll lay by, To talk with thee familiarly. Which done, then quickly we'll undress To one and th' other's nakedness, And, ravish'd, plunge into the bed, Bodies and souls commingled, And kissing, so as none may hear, We'll weary all the fables there.

Fables, _i.e._, of Jove's amours.

153. HIS WISH.

It is sufficient if we pray To Jove, who gives and takes away: Let him the land and living find; Let me alone to fit the mind.

154. HIS PROTESTATION TO PERILLA.

Noonday and midnight shall at once be seen: Trees, at one time, shall be both sere and green: Fire and water shall together lie In one self-sweet-conspiring sympathy: Summer and winter shall at one time show Ripe ears of corn, and up to th' ears in snow: Seas shall be sandless; fields devoid of grass; Shapeless the world, as when all chaos was, Before, my dear Perilla, I will be False to my vow, or fall away from thee.

155. LOVE PERFUMES ALL PARTS.

If I kiss Anthea's breast, There I smell the phœnix nest: If her lip, the most sincere Altar of incense I smell there-- Hands, and thighs, and legs are all Richly aromatical. Goddess Isis can't transfer Musks and ambers more from her: Nor can Juno sweeter be, When she lies with Jove, than she.

156. TO JULIA.

Permit me, Julia, now to go away; Or by thy love decree me here to stay. If thou wilt say that I shall live with thee, Here shall my endless tabernacle be: If not, as banish'd, I will live alone There where no language ever yet was known.

157. ON HIMSELF.

Love-sick I am, and must endure A desperate grief, that finds no cure. Ah me! I try; and trying, prove _No herbs have power to cure love._ Only one sovereign salve I know, And that is death, the end of woe.

158. VIRTUE IS SENSIBLE OF SUFFERING.

Though a wise man all pressures can sustain, His virtue still is sensible of pain: Large shoulders though he has, and well can bear, He feels when packs do pinch him, and the where.

159. THE CRUEL MAID.

And cruel maid, because I see You scornful of my love and me, I'll trouble you no more; but go My way where you shall never know What is become of me: there I Will find me out a path to die, Or learn some way how to forget You and your name for ever: yet, Ere I go hence, know this from me, What will, in time, your fortune be: This to your coyness I will tell, And, having spoke it once, farewell. The lily will not long endure, Nor the snow continue pure; The rose, the violet, one day, See, both these lady-flowers decay: And you must fade as well as they. And it may chance that Love may turn, And, like to mine, make your heart burn And weep to see't; yet this thing do, That my last vow commends to you: When you shall see that I am dead, For pity let a tear be shed; And, with your mantle o'er me cast, Give my cold lips a kiss at last: If twice you kiss you need not fear That I shall stir or live more here. Next, hollow out a tomb to cover Me--me, the most despisèd lover, And write thereon: _This, reader, know: Love kill'd this man_. No more, but so.

160. TO DIANEME.

Sweet, be not proud of those two eyes Which, starlike, sparkle in their skies; Nor be you proud that you can see All hearts your captives, yours yet free; Be you not proud of that rich hair Which wantons with the love-sick air; Whenas that ruby which you wear, Sunk from the tip of your soft ear, Will last to be a precious stone When all your world of beauty's gone.

161. TO THE KING, TO CURE THE EVIL.

To find that tree of life whose fruits did feed And leaves did heal all sick of human seed: To find Bethesda and an angel there Stirring the waters, I am come; and here, At last, I find (after my much to do) The tree, Bethesda and the angel too: And all in your blest hand, which has the powers Of all those suppling-healing herbs and flowers. To that soft charm, that spell, that magic bough, That high enchantment, I betake me now, And to that hand (the branch of heaven's fair tree), I kneel for help; O! lay that hand on me, Adored Cæsar! and my faith is such I shall be heal'd if that my king but touch. The evil is not yours: my sorrow sings, "Mine is the evil, but the

cure the king's".

162. HIS MISERY IN A MISTRESS.

Water, water I espy; Come and cool ye, all who fry In your loves; but none as I.

Though a thousand showers be Still a-falling, yet I see Not one drop to light on me.

Happy you who can have seas For to quench ye, or some ease From your kinder mistresses.

I have one, and she alone, Of a thousand thousand known, Dead to all compassion.

Such an one as will repeat Both the cause and make the heat More by provocation great.

Gentle friends, though I despair Of my cure, do you beware Of those girls which cruel are.

164. TO A GENTLEWOMAN OBJECTING TO HIM HIS GRAY HAIRS.

Am I despised because you say, And I dare swear, that I am gray? Know, lady, you have but your day: And time will come when you shall wear Such frost and snow upon your hair; And when (though long, it comes to pass) You question with your looking-glass; And in that sincere crystal seek, But find no rose-bud in your cheek: Nor any bed to give the show Where such a rare carnation grew. Ah! then too late, close in your chamber keeping, It will be told That you are old, By those true tears y'are weeping.

165. TO CEDARS.

If 'mongst my many poems I can see One only worthy to be wash'd by thee, I live for ever, let the rest all lie In dens of darkness or condemn'd to die.

Cedars, oil of cedar was used for preserving manuscripts (carmina linenda cedro. _Hor._ Ars Poet., 331.)

166. UPON CUPID.

Love like a gipsy lately came, And did me much importune To see my hand, that by the same He might foretell my fortune.

He saw my palm, and then, said he, I tell thee by this score here, That thou within few months shalt be The youthful Prince d'Amour here.

I smil'd, and bade him once more prove, And by some cross-line show it, That I could ne'er be prince of love, Though here the princely poet.

167. HOW PRIMROSES CAME GREEN.

Virgins, time-past, known were these, Troubled with green-sicknesses: Turn'd to flowers, still the hue, Sickly girls, they bear of you.

168. TO JOS., LORD BISHOP OF EXETER.

Whom should I fear to write to if I can Stand before you, my learn'd diocesan? And never show blood-guiltiness or fear To see my lines excathedrated here. Since none

so good are but you may condemn, Or here so bad but you may pardon them. If then, my lord, to sanctify my muse One only poem out of all you'll choose, And mark it for a rapture nobly writ, 'Tis good confirm'd, for you have bishop'd it.

Blood-guiltiness, guilt betrayed by blushing; cp. 837. _Excathedrated_, condemned _ex cathedra_.

169. UPON A BLACK TWIST ROUNDING THE ARM OF THE COUNTESS OF CARLISLE.

I saw about her spotless wrist, Of blackest silk, a curious twist; Which, circumvolving gently, there Enthrall'd her arm as prisoner. Dark was the jail, but as if light Had met t'engender with the night; Or so as darkness made a stay To show at once both night and day. One fancy more! but if there be Such freedom in captivity, I beg of Love that ever I May in like chains of darkness lie.

170. ON HIMSELF.

I fear no earthly powers, But care for crowns of flowers; And love to have my beard With wine and oil besmear'd. This day I'll drown all sorrow: Who knows to live to-morrow?

172. A RING PRESENTED TO JULIA.

Julia, I bring To thee this ring, Made for thy finger fit; To show by this That our love is (Or should be) like to it.

Close though it be The joint is free; So, when love's yoke is on, It must not gall, Or fret at all With hard oppression.

But it must play Still either way, And be, too, such a yoke As not too wide To overslide, Or be so strait to choke.

So we who bear This beam must rear Ourselves to such a height As that the stay Of either may Create the burden light.

And as this round Is nowhere found To flaw, or else to sever: So let our love As endless prove, And pure as gold for ever.

173. TO THE DETRACTOR.

Where others love and praise my verses, still Thy long black thumb-nail marks them out for ill: A fellon take it, or some whitflaw come For to unslate or to untile that thumb! But cry thee mercy: exercise thy nails To scratch or claw, so that thy tongue not rails: Some numbers prurient are, and some of these Are wanton with their itch; scratch, and 'twill please.

Fellon, a sore, especially in the finger. _Whitflaw_, or whitlow.

174. UPON THE SAME.

I ask'd thee oft what poets thou hast read, And lik'st the best. Still thou reply'st: The dead. I shall, ere long, with green turfs cover'd be; Then sure thou'lt like or thou wilt envy me.

175. JULIA'S PETTICOAT.

Thy azure robe I did behold As airy as the leaves of gold, Which, erring here, and wandering there, Pleas'd with transgression ev'rywhere: Sometimes 'twould pant, and sigh, and heave, As if to stir it scarce had leave: But, having got it, thereupon 'Twould make a brave expansion. And pounc'd with stars it showed to me Like a celestial canopy. Sometimes 'twould blaze, and then abate, Like to a flame grown moderate: Sometimes away 'twould wildly fling, Then to thy thighs so closely cling That some conceit did melt me down As lovers fall into a swoon: And, all confus'd, I there did lie Drown'd in delights, but could not die. That leading cloud I follow'd still, Hoping t' have seen of it my fill; But ah! I could not: should it move To life eternal, I could love.

Pounc'd, sprinkled.

176. TO MUSIC.

Begin to charm, and, as thou strok'st mine ears With thy enchantment, melt me into tears. Then let thy active hand scud o'er thy lyre, And make my spirits frantic with the fire. That done, sink down into a silvery strain, And make me smooth as balm and oil again.

177. DISTRUST.

To safeguard man from wrongs, there nothing must Be truer to him than a wise distrust. And to thyself be best this sentence known: _Hear all men speak, but credit few or none_.

178. CORINNA'S GOING A-MAYING.

Get up, get up for shame, the blooming morn Upon her wings presents the god unshorn. See how Aurora throws her fair Fresh-quilted colours through the air: Get up, sweet slug-a-bed, and see The dew bespangling herb and tree. Each flower has wept and bow'd toward the east Above an hour since: yet you not dress'd; Nay! not so much as out of bed? When all the birds have matins said And sung their thankful hymns, 'tis sin, Nay, profanation to keep in, Whereas a thousand virgins on this day Spring, sooner than the lark, to fetch in May.

Rise and put on your foliage, and be seen To come forth, like the spring-time, fresh and green, And sweet as Flora. Take no care For jewels for your gown or hair: Fear not; the leaves will strew Gems in abundance upon you: Besides, the childhood of the day has kept, Against you come, some orient pearls unwept; Come and receive them while the light Hangs on the dew-locks of the night: And Titan on the eastern hill Retires himself, or else stands still Till you come forth. Wash, dress, be brief in praying: Few beads are best when once we go a-Maying.

Come, my Corinna, come; and, coming, mark How each field turns a street, each street a park Made green and trimm'd with trees: see how Devotion gives each house a bough Or branch: each porch, each door ere this An ark, a tabernacle is, Made up of white-thorn neatly interwove; As if here were those cooler shades of love. Can such delights be in the street And open fields and we not see't? Come, we'll abroad; and

let's obey The proclamation made for May: And sin no more, as we have done, by staying; But, my Corinna, come, let's go a-Maying.

There's not a budding boy or girl this day But is got up, and gone to bring in May. A deal of youth, ere this, is come Back, and with white-thorn laden home. Some have despatch'd their cakes and cream Before that we have left to dream: And some have wept, and woo'd, and plighted troth, And chose their priest, ere we can cast off sloth: Many a green-gown has been given; Many a kiss, both odd and even: Many a glance too has been sent From out the eye, love's firmament; Many a jest told of the keys betraying This night, and locks pick'd, yet we're not a-Maying.

Come, let us go while we are in our prime; And take the harmless folly of the time. We shall grow old apace, and die Before we know our liberty. Our life is short, and our days run As fast away as does the sun; And, as a vapour or a drop of rain, Once lost, can ne'er be found again, So when or you or I are made A fable, song, or fleeting shade, All love, all liking, all delight Lies drowned with us in endless night. Then while time serves, and we are but decaying, Come, my Corinna, come, let's go a-Maying.

Beads, prayers. _Left to dream_, ceased dreaming. _Green-gown_, tumble on the grass.

179. ON JULIA'S BREATH.

Breathe, Julia, breathe, and I'll protest, Nay more, I'll deeply swear, That all the spices of the east Are circumfused there.

Circumfused, spread around.

180. UPON A CHILD. AN EPITAPH.

But born, and like a short delight, I glided by my parents' sight. That done, the harder fates denied My longer stay, and so I died. If, pitying my sad parents' tears, You'll spill a tear or two with theirs, And with some flowers my grave bestrew, Love and they'll thank you for't. Adieu.

181. A DIALOGUE BETWIXT HORACE AND LYDIA, TRANSLATED ANNO 1627, AND SET BY MR. RO. RAMSEY.

Hor. While, Lydia, I was loved of thee, Nor any was preferred 'fore me To hug thy whitest neck, than I The Persian king lived not more happily.

Lyd. While thou no other didst affect, Nor Chloe was of more respect Than Lydia, far-famed Lydia, I flourished more than Roman Ilia.

Hor. Now Thracian Chloe governs me, Skilful i' th' harp and melody; For whose affection, Lydia, I (So fate spares her) am well content to die.

Lyd. My heart now set on fire is By Ornithes' son, young Calais, For whose commutual flames here I, To save his life, twice am content to die.

Hor. Say our first loves we should revoke, And, severed, join in brazen yoke; Admit I Chloe put away, And love again love-cast-off Lydia?

Lyd. Though mine be brighter than the star, Thou lighter than the cork by far, Rough as the Adriatic sea, yet I Will live with thee, or else for thee will die.

182. THE CAPTIV'D BEE, OR THE LITTLE FILCHER.

As Julia once a-slumbering lay It chanced a bee did fly that way, After a dew or dew-like shower, To tipple freely in a flower. For some rich flower he took the lip Of Julia, and began to sip; But when he felt he sucked from thence Honey, and in the quintessence, He drank so much he scarce could stir, So Julia took the pilferer. And thus surprised, as filchers use, He thus began himself t' excuse: Sweet lady-flower, I never brought Hither the least one thieving thought; But, taking those rare lips of yours For some fresh, fragrant, luscious flowers, I thought I might there take a taste, Where so much syrup ran at waste. Besides, know this: I never sting The flower that gives me nourishing; But with a kiss, or thanks, do pay For honey that I bear away. This said, he laid his little scrip Of honey 'fore her ladyship: And told her, as some tears did fall, That that he took, and that was all. At which she smiled, and bade him go And take his bag; but thus much know: When next he came a-pilfering so, He should from her full lips derive Honey enough to fill his hive.

185. AN ODE TO MASTER ENDYMION PORTER, UPON HIS BROTHER'S DEATH.

Not all thy flushing suns are set, Herrick, as yet; Nor doth this far-drawn hemisphere Frown and look sullen ev'rywhere. Days may conclude in nights, and suns may rest As dead within the west; Yet, the next morn, regild the fragrant east.

Alas! for me, that I have lost E'en all almost; Sunk is my sight, set is my sun, And all the loom of life undone: The staff, the elm, the prop, the shelt'ring wall Whereon my vine did crawl, Now, now blown down; needs must the old stock fall.

Yet, Porter, while thou keep'st alive, In death I thrive: And like a phœnix re-aspire From out my nard and fun'ral fire: And as I prune my feathered youth, so I Do mar'l how I could die When I had thee, my chief preserver, by.

I'm up, I'm up, and bless that hand Which makes me stand Now as I do, and but for thee I must confess I could not be. The debt is paid; for he who doth resign Thanks to the gen'rous vine Invites fresh grapes to fill his press with wine.

Mar'l, marvel.

186. TO HIS DYING BROTHER, MASTER WILLIAM HERRICK.

Life of my life, 'take not so soon thy flight, But stay the time till we have bade good-night. Thou hast both wind and tide with thee; thy way As soon despatch'd is by the night as day. Let us not then so rudely henceforth go Till we have wept, kissed, sigh'd, shook hands, or so. There's pain in parting, and a kind of hell, When once true lovers take their last farewell. What! shall we two our endless leaves take here Without a sad look or a solemn tear? He knows not love that hath not this truth proved, _Love is most loth to leave the thing beloved_. Pay we our vows and go; yet when we part, Then, even then, I will bequeath my heart Into thy loving hands; for I'll keep none To warm my breast when thou, my pulse, art gone. No, here I'll last, and walk (a harmless shade) About this urn wherein thy dust is laid, To guard it so as

nothing here shall be Heavy to hurt those sacred seeds of thee.

187. THE OLIVE BRANCH.

Sadly I walk'd within the field, To see what comfort it would yield; And as I went my private way An olive branch before me lay, And seeing it I made a stay, And took it up and view'd it; then Kissing the omen, said Amen; Be, be it so, and let this be A divination unto me; That in short time my woes shall cease And Love shall crown my end with peace.

189. TO CHERRY-BLOSSOMS.

Ye may simper, blush and smile, And perfume the air awhile; But, sweet things, ye must be gone, Fruit, ye know, is coming on; Then, ah! then, where is your grace, Whenas cherries come in place?

190. HOW LILIES CAME WHITE.

White though ye be, yet, lilies, know, From the first ye were not so; But I'll tell ye What befell ye: Cupid and his mother lay In a cloud, while both did play, He with his pretty finger press'd The ruby niplet of her breast; Out of which the cream of light, Like to a dew, Fell down on you And made ye white.

191. TO PANSIES.

Ah, cruel love! must I endure Thy many scorns and find no cure? Say, are thy medicines made to be Helps to all others but to me? I'll leave thee and to pansies come, Comforts you'll afford me some; You can ease my heart and do What love could ne'er be brought unto.

192. ON GILLY-FLOWERS BEGOTTEN.

What was't that fell but now From that warm kiss of ours? Look, look! by love I vow They were two gilly-flowers.

Let's kiss and kiss again, For if so be our closes Make gilly-flowers, then I'm sure they'll fashion roses.

193. THE LILY IN A CRYSTAL.

You have beheld a smiling rose When virgins' hands have drawn O'er it a cobweb-lawn; And here you see this lily shows, Tomb'd in a crystal stone, More fair in this transparent case Than when it grew alone And had but single grace.

You see how cream but naked is Nor dances in the eye Without a strawberry, Or some fine tincture like to this, Which draws the sight thereto More by that wantoning with it Than when the paler hue No mixture did admit.

You see how amber through the streams More gently strokes the sight With some conceal'd delight Than when he darts his radiant beams Into the boundless air; Where either too much light his worth Doth all at once impair, Or set it little forth.

Put purple grapes or cherries in- To glass, and they will send More beauty to commend Them from that clean and subtle skin Than if they naked stood, And had no other pride at all But their own flesh and blood And tinctures natural.

Thus lily, rose, grape, cherry, cream, And strawberry do stir More love when they transfer A weak, a soft, a broken beam, Than if they should discover At full their proper excellence; Without some scene cast over To juggle with the sense.

Thus let this crystal'd lily be A rule how far to teach Your nakedness must reach; And that no further than we see Those glaring colours laid By art's wise hand, but to this end They should obey a shade, Lest they too far extend.

So though you're white as swan or snow, And have the power to move A world of men to love, Yet when your lawns and silks shall flow, And that white cloud divide Into a doubtful twilight, then, Then will your hidden pride Raise greater fires in men.

Tincture, colour, dye. _Scene_, a covering.

194. TO HIS BOOK.

Like to a bride, come forth, my book, at last, With all thy richest jewels overcast; Say, if there be, 'mongst many gems here, one Deserveless of the name of paragon; Blush not at all for that, since we have set Some pearls on queens that have been counterfeit.

195. UPON SOME WOMEN.

Thou who wilt not love, do this, Learn of me what woman is. Something made of thread and thrum. A mere botch of all and some. Pieces, patches, ropes of hair; Inlaid garbage everywhere. Outside silk and outside lawn; Scenes to cheat us neatly drawn. False in legs, and false in thighs; False in breast, teeth, hair, and eyes; False in head, and false enough; Only true in shreds and stuff.

Thrum, a small thread. _All and some_, anything and everything.

196. SUPREME FORTUNE FALLS SOONEST.

While leanest beasts in pastures feed, _The fattest ox the first must bleed_.

197. THE WELCOME TO SACK.

So soft streams meet, so springs with gladder smiles Meet after long divorcement by the isles; When love, the child of likeness, urgeth on Their crystal natures to a union: So meet stolen kisses, when the moony nights Call forth fierce lovers to their wish'd delights; So kings and queens meet, when desire convinces All thoughts but such as aim at getting princes, As I meet thee. Soul of my life and fame! Eternal lamp of love! whose radiant flame Out-glares the heaven's Osiris,[H] and thy gleams Out-shine the splendour of his mid-day beams. Welcome, O welcome, my illustrious spouse; Welcome as are the ends unto my vows; Aye! far more welcome than the happy soil The sea-scourged merchant, after all his toil, Salutes with tears of joy, when fires betray The smoky chimneys of his Ithaca. Where hast thou been so long from my embraces, Poor pitied exile? Tell me, did thy graces Fly discontented hence, and for a time Did rather choose to bless another clime? Or went'st thou to this end, the more to move me, By thy short absence, to desire and love thee? Why frowns my sweet? Why won't my saint confer Favours on me, her fierce idolater? Why are those looks, those looks the which have been Time-past so fragrant, sickly now drawn in

Like a dull twilight? Tell me, and the fault I'll expiate with sulphur, hair and salt; And, with the crystal humour of the spring, Purge hence the guilt and kill this quarrelling. Wo't thou not smile or tell me what's amiss? Have I been cold to hug thee, too remiss, Too temp'rate in embracing? Tell me, has desire To thee-ward died i' th' embers, and no fire Left in this rak'd-up ash-heap as a mark To testify the glowing of a spark? Have I divorc'd thee only to combine In hot adult'ry with another wine? True, I confess I left thee, and appeal 'Twas done by me more to confirm my zeal And double my affection on thee, as do those Whose love grows more inflam'd by being foes. But to forsake thee ever, could there be A thought of such-like possibility? When thou thyself dar'st say thy isles shall lack Grapes before Herrick leaves canary sack. Thou mak'st me airy, active to be borne, Like Iphiclus, upon the tops of corn. Thou mak'st me nimble, as the winged hours, To dance and caper on the heads of flowers, And ride the sunbeams. Can there be a thing Under the heavenly Isis[I] that can bring More love unto my life, or can present My genius with a fuller blandishment? Illustrious idol! could th' Egyptians seek Help from the garlic, onion and the leek And pay no vows to thee, who wast their best God, and far more transcendent than the rest? Had Cassius, that weak water-drinker, known Thee in thy vine, or had but tasted one Small chalice of thy frantic liquor, he, As the wise Cato, had approv'd of thee. Had not Jove's son,[J] that brave Tirynthian swain, Invited to the Thesbian banquet, ta'en Full goblets of thy gen'rous blood, his sprite Ne'er had kept heat for fifty maids that night. Come, come and kiss me; love and lust commends Thee and thy beauties; kiss, we will be friends Too strong for fate to break us. Look upon Me with that full pride of complexion As queens meet queens, or come thou unto me As Cleopatra came to Anthony, When her high carriage did at once present To the triumvir love and wonderment. Swell up my nerves with spirit; let my blood Run through my veins like to a hasty flood. Fill each part full of fire, active to do What thy commanding soul shall put it to; And till I turn apostate to thy love, Which here I vow to serve, do not remove Thy fires from me, but Apollo's curse Blast these-like actions, or a thing that's worse. When these circumstants shall but live to see The time that I prevaricate from thee. Call me the son of beer, and then confine Me to the tap, the toast, the turf; let wine Ne'er shine upon me; may my numbers all Run to a sudden death and funeral. And last, when thee, dear spouse, I disavow, Ne'er may prophetic Daphne crown my brow.

Convinces, overcomes. _Ithaca_, the home of the wanderer Ulysses. _Iphiclus_ won the foot-race at the funeral games of Pelias. _Circumstants_, surroundings.

[H] The sun. (Note in the original edition.)

[I] The moon. (Note in the original edition.)

[J] Hercules. (Note in the original edition.)

198. IMPOSSIBILITIES TO HIS FRIEND.

My faithful friend, if you can see The fruit to grow up, or the tree; If you can see the colour come Into the blushing pear or plum; If you can see the water grow To cakes of ice or flakes of snow; If you can see that drop of rain Lost in the wild sea once again; If you can see how dreams do creep Into the brain by easy sleep: Then

there is hope that you may see Her love me once who now hates me.

201. TO LIVE MERRILY AND TO TRUST TO GOOD VERSES.

Now is the time for mirth, Nor cheek or tongue be dumb; For, with the flowery earth, The golden pomp is come.

The golden pomp is come; For now each tree does wear. Made of her pap and gum, Rich beads of amber here.

Now reigns the rose, and now Th' Arabian dew besmears My uncontrolled brow And my retorted hairs.

Homer, this health to thee, In sack of such a kind That it would make thee see Though thou wert ne'er so blind.

Next, Virgil I'll call forth To pledge this second health In wine, whose each cup's worth An Indian commonwealth.

A goblet next I'll drink To Ovid, and suppose, Made he the pledge, he'd think The world had all one nose.

Then this immensive cup Of aromatic wine, Catullus, I quaff up To that terse muse of thine.

Wild I am now with heat: O Bacchus, cool thy rays! Or, frantic, I shall eat Thy thyrse and bite the bays.

Round, round the roof does run, And, being ravish'd thus, Come, I will drink a tun To my Propertius.

Now, to Tibullus, next, This flood I drink to thee: But stay, I see a text That this presents to me.

Behold, Tibullus lies Here burnt, whose small return Of ashes scarce suffice To fill a little urn.

Trust to good verses then; They only will aspire When pyramids, as men, Are lost i' th' funeral fire.

And when all bodies meet In Lethe to be drown'd, Then only numbers sweet With endless life are crown'd.

Retorted, bound back, "retorto crine," _Martial_. _Immensive_, measureless.

202. FAIR DAYS: OR, DAWNS DECEITFUL.

Fair was the dawn, and but e'en now the skies Show'd like to cream inspir'd with strawberries, But on a sudden all was chang'd and gone That smil'd in that first sweet complexion. Then thunder-claps and lightning did conspire To tear the world, or set it all on fire. What trust to things below, whenas we see, As men, the heavens have their hypocrisy?

203. LIPS TONGUELESS.

For my part, I never care For those lips that tongue-tied are: Tell-tales I would have them be Of my mistress and of me. Let them prattle how that I Sometimes freeze and sometimes fry: Let them tell how she doth move Fore or backward in her love: Let them speak by gentle tones, One and th' other's passions: How we watch, and seldom sleep; How by willows we do weep; How by stealth we meet, and then Kiss, and sigh, so part again. This the lips we will permit For to tell, not publish it.

204. TO THE FEVER, NOT TO TROUBLE JULIA.

Thou'st dar'd too far; but, fury, now forbear To give the least disturbance to her hair: But less presume to lay a plait upon Her skin's most smooth and clear expansion. 'Tis like a lawny firmament as yet, Quite dispossess'd of either fray or fret. Come thou not near that film so finely spread, Where no one piece is yet unlevelled. This if thou dost, woe to thee, fury, woe, I'll send such frost, such hail, such sleet, and snow, Such flesh-quakes, palsies, and such fears as shall Dead thee to th' most, if not destroy thee all. And thou a thousand thousand times shalt be More shak'd thyself than she is scorch'd by thee.

205. TO VIOLETS.

Welcome, maids-of-honour! You do bring In the spring, And wait upon her.

She has virgins many, Fresh and fair; Yet you are More sweet than any.

You're the maiden posies, And so grac'd To be plac'd 'Fore damask roses.

Yet, though thus respected, By-and-by Ye do lie, Poor girls, neglected.

207. TO CARNATIONS. A SONG.

Stay while ye will, or go And leave no scent behind ye: Yet, trust me, I shall know The place where I may find ye.

Within my Lucia's cheek, Whose livery ye wear, Play ye at hide or seek, I'm sure to find ye there.

208. TO THE VIRGINS, TO MAKE MUCH OF TIME.

Gather ye rosebuds while ye may, Old time is still a-flying: And this same flower that smiles to-day To-morrow will be dying.

The glorious lamp of heaven, the sun, The higher he's a-getting, The sooner will his race be run, And nearer he's to setting.

That age is best which is the first, When youth and blood are warmer; But being spent, the worse, and worst Times still succeed the former.

Then be not coy, but use your time, And while ye may go marry: For having lost but once your prime You may for ever tarry.

209. SAFETY TO LOOK TO ONESELF.

For my neighbour I'll not know, Whether high he builds or no: Only this I'll look upon, Firm be my foundation. Sound or unsound, let it be! 'Tis the lot ordain'd for me. He who to the ground does fall _Has not whence to sink at all_.

210. TO HIS FRIEND, ON THE UNTUNABLE TIMES.

Play I could once; but, gentle friend, you see My harp hung up here on the willow tree. Sing I could once; and bravely, too, inspire With luscious numbers my melodious lyre. Draw I could once, although not stocks or stones, Amphion-like, men made of flesh and bones, Whither I would; but ah! I know not how, I feel in me this transmutation now. Grief, my dear friend, has first my harp unstrung, Wither'd my hand, and palsy-struck my tongue.

211. HIS POETRY HIS PILLAR.

Only a little more I have to write, Then I'll give o'er, And bid the world good-night.

'Tis but a flying minute That I must stay, Or linger in it; And then I must away.

O time that cut'st down all And scarce leav'st here Memorial Of any men that were.

How many lie forgot In vaults beneath? And piecemeal rot Without a fame in death?

Behold this living stone I rear for me, Ne'er to be thrown Down, envious Time, by thee.

Pillars let some set up If so they please: Here is my hope And my Pyramides.

212. SAFETY ON THE SHORE.

What though the sea be calm? Trust to the shore, Ships have been drown'd where late they danc'd before.

213. A PASTORAL UPON THE BIRTH OF PRINCE CHARLES. PRESENTED TO THE KING, AND SET BY MR. NIC. LANIERE.

The Speakers, Mirtillo, Amintas _and_ Amarillis.

Amin. Good-day, Mirtillo. _Mirt._ And to you no less, And all fair signs lead on our shepherdess. _Amar._ With all white luck to you. _Mirt._ But say, what news Stirs in our sheep-walk? _Amin._ None, save that my ewes, My wethers, lambs, and wanton kids are well, Smooth, fair and fat! none better I can tell: Or that this day Menalcas keeps a feast For his sheep-shearers. _Mirt._ True, these are the least; But, dear Amintas and sweet Amarillis, Rest but a while here, by this bank of lilies, And lend a gentle ear to one report The country has. _Amin._ From whence? _Amar._ From whence? _Mirt._ The Court. Three days before the shutting in of May (With whitest wool be ever crown'd that day!) To all our joy a sweet-fac'd child was born, More tender than the childhood of the morn. _Chor._ Pan pipe to him, and bleats of lambs and sheep Let lullaby the pretty prince asleep! _Mirt._ And that his birth should be more singular At noon of day was seen a silver star, Bright as the wise men's torch which guided them To God's sweet babe, when born at Bethlehem; While golden angels (some have told to me) Sung out his birth with heavenly minstrelsy. _Amin._ O rare! But is't a trespass if we three Should wend along his babyship to see? _Mirt._ Not so, not so. _Chor._ But if it chance to prove At most a fault, 'tis but a fault of love. _Amar._ But, dear Mirtillo, I have heard it told Those learned men brought incense, myrrh and gold From countries far, with store of spices sweet, And laid them down

for offerings at his feet. _Mirt._ 'Tis true, indeed; and each of us will bring Unto our smiling and our blooming king A neat, though not so great an offering. _Amar._ A garland for my gift shall be Of flowers ne'er suck'd by th' thieving bee; And all most sweet; yet all less sweet than he. _Amin._ And I will bear, along with you, Leaves dropping down the honeyed dew, With oaten pipes as sweet as new. _Mirt._ And I a sheep-hook will bestow, To have his little kingship know, As he is prince, he's shepherd too. _Chor._ Come, let's away, and quickly let's be dress'd, And quickly give--_the swiftest grace is best_. And when before him we have laid our treasures, We'll bless the babe, then back to country pleasures.

White, favourable.

214. TO THE LARK.

Good speed, for I this day Betimes my matins say: Because I do Begin to woo, Sweet-singing lark, Be thou the clerk, And know thy when To say, Amen. And if I prove Bless'd in my love, Then thou shalt be High-priest to me, At my return, To incense burn; And so to solemnise Love's and my sacrifice.

215. THE BUBBLE. A SONG.

To my revenge and to her desperate fears Fly, thou made bubble of my sighs and tears. In the wild air when thou hast rolled about, And, like a blasting planet, found her out. Stoop, mount, pass by to take her eye, then glare Like to a dreadful comet in the air: Next, when thou dost perceive her fixed sight For thy revenge to be most opposite, Then, like a globe or ball of wild-fire, fly, And break thyself in shivers on her eye.

216. A MEDITATION FOR HIS MISTRESS.

You are a tulip seen to-day, But, dearest, of so short a stay That where you grew scarce man can say.

You are a lovely July-flower, Yet one rude wind or ruffling shower Will force you hence, and in an hour.

You are a sparkling rose i' th' bud, Yet lost ere that chaste flesh and blood Can show where you or grew or stood.

You are a full-spread, fair-set vine, And can with tendrils love entwine, Yet dried ere you distil your wine.

You are like balm enclosed well In amber, or some crystal shell, Yet lost ere you transfuse your smell.

You are a dainty violet, Yet wither'd ere you can be set Within the virgin's coronet.

You are the queen all flowers among, But die you must, fair maid, ere long, As he, the maker of this song.

217. THE BLEEDING HAND; OR, THE SPRIG OF EGLANTINE GIVEN TO A MAID.

From this bleeding hand of mine Take this sprig of eglantine, Which, though sweet unto your smell, Yet the fretful briar will tell, He who plucks the sweets shall prove

Many thorns to be in love.

218. LYRIC FOR LEGACIES.

Gold I've none, for use or show, Neither silver to bestow At my death; but this much know; That each lyric here shall be Of my love a legacy, Left to all posterity. Gentle friends, then do but please To accept such coins as these As my last remembrances.

219. A DIRGE UPON THE DEATH OF THE RIGHT VALIANT LORD, BERNARD STUART.

Hence, hence, profane! soft silence let us have While we this trental sing about thy grave.

Had wolves or tigers seen but thee, They would have showed civility; And, in compassion of thy years, Washed those thy purple wounds with tears. But since thou'rt slain, and in thy fall The drooping kingdom suffers all;

Chor. This we will do, we'll daily come And offer tears upon thy tomb: And if that they will not suffice, Thou shall have souls for sacrifice. Sleep in thy peace, while we with spice perfume thee, And cedar wash thee, that no times consume thee.

Live, live thou dost, and shall; for why? _Souls do not with their bodies die_: Ignoble offsprings, they may fall Into the flames of funeral: Whenas the chosen seed shall spring Fresh, and for ever flourishing.

Chor. And times to come shall, weeping, read thy glory Less in these marble stones than in thy story.

Trental, a dirge; but see Note. _Cedar_, oil of cedar.

220. TO PERENNA, A MISTRESS.

Dear Perenna, prithee come And with smallage dress my tomb: Add a cypress sprig thereto, With a tear, and so Adieu.

Smallage, water-parsley.

223. THE FAIRY TEMPLE; OR, OBERON'S CHAPEL DEDICATED TO MR. JOHN MERRIFIELD, COUNSELLOR-AT-LAW.

Rare temples thou hast seen, I know, And rich for in and outward show: Survey this chapel, built alone, Without or lime, or wood, or stone: Then say if one thou'st seen more fine Than this, the fairies' once, now thine.

THE TEMPLE.

A way enchased with glass and beads There is, that to the chapel leads: Whose structure, for his holy rest, Is here the halcyon's curious nest: Into the which who looks shall see His temple of idolatry, Where he of godheads has such store, As Rome's pantheon had not more. His house of Rimmon this he calls, Girt with small bones instead of walls. First, in a niche, more black than jet, His idol-cricket there is set: Then in a polished oval by There stands his idol-beetle-fly: Next in an arch, akin to this, His idol-canker seated is: Then in a round is placed by these His golden god,

Cantharides. So that, where'er ye look, ye see, No capital, no cornice free, Or frieze, from this fine frippery. Now this the fairies would have known, Theirs is a mixed religion: And some have heard the elves it call Part pagan, part papistical. If unto me all tongues were granted, I could not speak the saints here painted. Saint Tit, Saint Nit, Saint Is, Saint Itis, Who 'gainst Mab's-state placed here right is; Saint Will o' th' Wisp, of no great bigness, But _alias_ called here _Fatuus ignis_; Saint Frip, Saint Trip, Saint Fill, Saint Fillie Neither those other saintships will I Here go about for to recite Their number, almost infinite, Which one by one here set down are In this most curious calendar. First, at the entrance of the gate A little puppet-priest doth wait, Who squeaks to all the comers there: "_Favour your tongues who enter here; Pure hands bring hither without stain._" A second pules: "_Hence, hence, profane!_" Hard by, i' th' shell of half a nut, The holy-water there is put: A little brush of squirrel's hairs (Composed of odd, not even pairs,) Stands in the platter, or close by, To purge the fairy family. Near to the altar stands the priest, There off'ring up the Holy Grist, Ducking in mood and perfect tense, With (much-good-do-'t him) reverence. The altar is not here four-square, Nor in a form triangular, Nor made of glass, or wood, or stone, But of a little transverse bone; Which boys and bruckel'd children call (Playing for points and pins) cockal. Whose linen drapery is a thin Subtile and ductile codlin's skin: Which o'er the board is smoothly spread With little seal-work damasked. The fringe that circumbinds it too Is spangle-work of trembling dew, Which, gently gleaming, makes a show Like frost-work glitt'ring on the snow. Upon this fetuous board doth stand Something for show-bread, and at hand, Just in the middle of the altar, Upon an end, the fairy-psalter, Grac'd with the trout-flies' curious wings, Which serve for watchet ribbonings. Now, we must know, the elves are led Right by the rubric which they read. And, if report of them be true, They have their text for what they do; Aye, and their book of canons too. And, as Sir Thomas Parson tells, They have their book of articles; And, if that fairy-knight not lies, They have their book of homilies; And other scriptures that design A short but righteous discipline. The basin stands the board upon To take the free oblation: A little pin-dust, which they hold More precious than we prize our gold Which charity they give to many Poor of the parish, if there's any. Upon the ends of these neat rails, Hatch'd with the silver-light of snails, The elves in formal manner fix Two pure and holy candlesticks: In either which a small tall bent Burns for the altar's ornament. For sanctity they have to these Their curious copes and surplices Of cleanest cobweb hanging by In their religious vestery. They have their ash-pans and their brooms To purge the chapel and the rooms; Their many mumbling Mass-priests here, And many a dapper chorister, Their ush'ring vergers, here likewise Their canons and their chanteries. Of cloister-monks they have enow, Aye, and their abbey-lubbers too; And, if their legend do not lie, They much affect the papacy. And since the last is dead, there's hope _Elf Boniface shall next be pope_. They have their cups and chalices; Their pardons and indulgences; Their beads of nits, bells, books, and wax Candles, forsooth, and other knacks; Their holy oil, their fasting spittle; Their sacred salt here, not a little; Dry chips, old shoes, rags, grease and bones; Beside their fumigations To drive the devil from the cod-piece Of the friar (of work an odd piece). Many a trifle, too, and trinket, And for what use, scarce man would think it. Next, then, upon the chanters' side An apple's core is hung up dri'd, With rattling kernels, which is rung To call to morn and

even-song. The saint to which the most he prays And offers incense nights and days, The lady of the lobster is, Whose foot-pace he doth stroke and kiss; And humbly chives of saffron brings For his most cheerful offerings. When, after these, h'as paid his vows He lowly to the altar bows; And then he dons the silk-worm's shed, Like a Turk's turban on his head, And reverently departeth thence, Hid in a cloud of frankincense, And by the glow-worm's light well guided, Goes to the feast that's now provided.

Halcyon, king-fisher. _Saint Tit_, etc., see Note. _Mab's-state_, Mab's chair of state. _Bruckel'd_, begrimed. _Cockal_, a game played with four huckle-bones. _Codlin_, an apple. _Fetuous_, feat, neat. _Watchet_, pale blue. _Hatch'd_, inlaid. _Bent_, bent grass. _Nits_, nuts. _The lady of the lobster_, part of the lobster's apparatus for digestion. _Foot-pace_, a mat. _Chives_, shreds.

224. TO MISTRESS KATHERINE BRADSHAW, THE LOVELY, THAT CROWNED HIM WITH LAUREL.

My muse in meads has spent her many hours, Sitting, and sorting several sorts of flowers To make for others garlands, and to set On many a head here many a coronet; But, amongst all encircled here, not one Gave her a day of coronation, Till you, sweet mistress, came and interwove A laurel for her, ever young as love-- You first of all crown'd her: she must of due Render for that a crown of life to you.

225. THE PLAUDITE, OR END OF LIFE.

If, after rude and boisterous seas, My wearied pinnace here finds ease; If so it be I've gained the shore With safety of a faithful oar; If, having run my barque on ground, Ye see the aged vessel crown'd: What's to be done, but on the sands Ye dance and sing and now clap hands? The first act's doubtful, but we say It is the last commends the play.

226. TO THE MOST VIRTUOUS MISTRESS POT, WHO MANY TIMES ENTERTAINED HIM.

When I through all my many poems look, And see yourself to beautify my book, Methinks that only lustre doth appear A light fulfilling all the region here. Gild still with flames this firmament, and be A lamp eternal to my poetry. Which, if it now or shall hereafter shine, 'Twas by your splendour, lady, not by mine. The oil was yours; and that I owe for yet: _He pays the half who does confess the debt_.

227. TO MUSIC, TO BECALM HIS FEVER.

Charm me asleep and melt me so With thy delicious numbers, That, being ravished, hence I go Away in easy slumbers. Ease my sick head And make my bed, Thou power that canst sever From me this ill; And quickly still, Though thou not kill, My fever.

Thou sweetly canst convert the same From a consuming fire Into a gentle-licking flame, And make it thus expire. Then make me weep My pains asleep; And give me such reposes That I, poor I, May think thereby I live and die 'Mongst roses.

Fall on me like a silent dew, Or like those maiden showers Which, by the peep of day, do strew A baptism o'er the flowers. Melt, melt my pains With thy soft strains; That, having ease me given, With full delight I leave this light, And take my flight For heaven.

228. UPON A GENTLEWOMAN WITH A SWEET VOICE.

So long you did not sing or touch your lute, We knew 'twas flesh and blood that there sat mute. But when your playing and your voice came in, 'Twas no more you then, but a cherubin.

229. UPON CUPID.

As lately I a garland bound, 'Mongst roses I there Cupid found; I took him, put him in my cup, And drunk with wine, I drank him up. Hence then it is that my poor breast Could never since find any rest.

230. UPON JULIA'S BREASTS.

Display thy breasts, my Julia--there let me Behold that circummortal purity, Between whose glories there my lips I'll lay, Ravish'd in that fair _via lactea_.

Circummortal, more than mortal.

231. BEST TO BE MERRY.

Fools are they who never know How the times away do go; But for us, who wisely see Where the bounds of black death be, Let's live merrily, and thus Gratify the Genius.

232. THE CHANGES TO CORINNA.

Be not proud, but now incline Your soft ear to discipline. You have changes in your life-- Sometimes peace and sometimes strife; You have ebbs of face and flows, As your health or comes or goes; You have hopes, and doubts, and fears Numberless, as are your hairs. You have pulses that do beat High, and passions less of heat. You are young, but must be old, And, to these, ye must be told Time ere long will come and plough Loathed furrows in your brow: And the dimness of your eye Will no other thing imply But you must die As well as I.

234. NEGLECT.

Art quickens nature; care will make a face; Neglected beauty perisheth apace.

235. UPON HIMSELF.

Mop-eyed I am, as some have said, Because I've lived so long a maid: But grant that I should wedded be, Should I a jot the better see? No, I should think that marriage might, Rather than mend, put out the light.

Mop-eyed, shortsighted.

236. UPON A PHYSICIAN.

Thou cam'st to cure me, doctor, of my cold, And caught'st thyself the more by twenty fold: Prithee go home; and for thy credit be First cured thyself, then come and

cure me.

238. TO THE ROSE. A SONG.

Go, happy rose, and interwove With other flowers, bind my love. Tell her, too, she must not be Longer flowing, longer free, That so oft has fetter'd me.

Say, if she's fretful, I have bands Of pearl and gold to bind her hands. Tell her, if she struggle still, I have myrtle rods (at will) For to tame, though not to kill.

Take thou my blessing, thus, and go And tell her this, but do not so, Lest a handsome anger fly, Like a lightning, from her eye, And burn thee up as well as I.

240. TO HIS BOOK.

Thou art a plant sprung up to wither never, But like a laurel to grow green for ever.

241. UPON A PAINTED GENTLEWOMAN.

Men say y'are fair, and fair ye are, 'tis true; But, hark! we praise the painter now, not you.

243. DRAW-GLOVES.

At draw-gloves we'll play, And prithee let's lay A wager, and let it be this: Who first to the sum Of twenty shall come, Shall have for his winning a kiss.

Draw-gloves, a game of talking by the fingers.

244. TO MUSIC, TO BECALM A SWEET-SICK YOUTH.

Charms, that call down the moon from out her sphere, On this sick youth work your enchantments here: Bind up his senses with your numbers so As to entrance his pain, or cure his woe. Fall gently, gently, and a while him keep Lost in the civil wilderness of sleep: That done, then let him, dispossessed of pain, Like to a slumb'ring bride, awake again.

245. TO THE HIGH AND NOBLE PRINCE GEORGE, DUKE, MARQUIS, AND EARL OF BUCKINGHAM.

Never my book's perfection did appear Till I had got the name of Villars here: Now 'tis so full that when therein I look I see a cloud of glory fills my book. Here stand it still to dignify our Muse, Your sober handmaid, who doth wisely choose Your name to be a laureate wreath to her Who doth both love and fear you, honoured sir.

246. HIS RECANTATION.

Love, I recant, And pardon crave That lately I offended; But 'twas, Alas! To make a brave, But no disdain intended.

No more I'll vaunt, For now I see Thou only hast the power To find And bind A heart that's free, And slave it in an hour.

247. THE COMING OF GOOD LUCK.

So good luck came, and on my roof did light, Like noiseless snow, or as the dew of night: Not all at once, but gently, as the trees Are by the sunbeams tickled by degrees.

248. THE PRESENT; OR, THE BAG OF THE BEE.

Fly to my mistress, pretty pilfering bee, And say thou bring'st this honey bag from me: When on her lip thou hast thy sweet dew placed, Mark if her tongue but slyly steal a taste. If so, we live; if not, with mournful hum Toll forth my death; next, to my burial come.

249. ON LOVE.

Love bade me ask a gift, And I no more did move But this, that I might shift Still with my clothes my love: That favour granted was; Since which, though I love many, Yet so it comes to pass That long I love not any.

250. THE HOCK-CART OR HARVEST HOME. TO THE RIGHT HONOURABLE MILDMAY, EARL OF WESTMORELAND.

Come, sons of summer, by whose toil We are the lords of wine and oil: By whose tough labours and rough hands We rip up first, then reap our lands. Crowned with the ears of corn, now come, And to the pipe sing harvest home. Come forth, my lord, and see the cart Dressed up with all the country art: See here a maukin, there a sheet, As spotless pure as it is sweet: The horses, mares, and frisking fillies, Clad all in linen white as lilies. The harvest swains and wenches bound For joy, to see the hock-cart crowned. About the cart, hear how the rout Of rural younglings raise the shout; Pressing before, some coming after, Those with a shout, and these with laughter. Some bless the cart, some kiss the sheaves, Some prank them up with oaken leaves: Some cross the fill-horse, some with great Devotion stroke the home-borne wheat: While other rustics, less attent To prayers than to merriment, Run after with their breeches rent. Well, on, brave boys, to your lord's hearth, Glitt'ring with fire, where, for your mirth, Ye shall see first the large and chief Foundation of your feast, fat beef: With upper stories, mutton, veal And bacon (which makes full the meal), With sev'ral dishes standing by, As here a custard, there a pie, And here all-tempting frumenty. And for to make the merry cheer, If smirking wine be wanting here, There's that which drowns all care, stout beer; Which freely drink to your lord's health, Then to the plough, the commonwealth, Next to your flails, your fans, your fats, Then to the maids with wheaten hats: To the rough sickle, and crook'd scythe, Drink, frolic boys, till all be blithe. Feed, and grow fat; and as ye eat Be mindful that the lab'ring neat, As you, may have their fill of meat. And know, besides, ye must revoke The patient ox unto the yoke, And all go back unto the plough And harrow, though they're hanged up now. And, you must know, your lord's word's true, Feed him ye must, whose food fills you; And that this pleasure is like rain, Not sent ye for to drown your pain, But for to make it spring again.

Maukin, a cloth. _Fill-horse_, shaft-horse. _Frumenty_, wheat boiled in milk. _Fats_, vats.

251. THE PERFUME.

To-morrow, Julia, I betimes must rise, For some small fault to offer sacrifice: The altar's ready: fire to consume The fat; breathe thou, and there's the rich perfume.

252. UPON HER VOICE.

Let but thy voice engender with the string, And angels will be born while thou dost sing.

253. NOT TO LOVE.

He that will not love must be My scholar, and learn this of me: There be in love as many fears As the summer's corn has ears: Sighs, and sobs, and sorrows more Than the sand that makes the shore: Freezing cold and fiery heats, Fainting swoons and deadly sweats; Now an ague, then a fever, Both tormenting lovers ever. Would'st thou know, besides all these, How hard a woman 'tis to please, How cross, how sullen, and how soon She shifts and changes like the moon. How false, how hollow she's in heart: And how she is her own least part: How high she's priz'd, and worth but small; Little thou'lt love, or not at all.

254. TO MUSIC. A SONG.

Music, thou queen of heaven, care-charming spell, That strik'st a stillness into hell: Thou that tam'st tigers, and fierce storms that rise, With thy soul-melting lullabies, Fall down, down, down from those thy chiming spheres, To charm our souls, as thou enchant'st our ears.

255. TO THE WESTERN WIND.

Sweet western wind, whose luck it is, Made rival with the air, To give Perenna's lip a kiss, And fan her wanton hair.

Bring me but one, I'll promise thee, Instead of common showers, Thy wings shall be embalm'd by me, And all beset with flowers.

256. UPON THE DEATH OF HIS SPARROW. AN ELEGY.

Why do not all fresh maids appear To work love's sampler only here, Where spring-time smiles throughout the year? Are not here rosebuds, pinks, all flowers Nature begets by th' sun and showers, Met in one hearse-cloth to o'erspread The body of the under-dead? Phil, the late dead, the late dead dear, O! may no eye distil a tear For you once lost, who weep not here! Had Lesbia, too-too kind, but known This sparrow, she had scorn'd her own: And for this dead which under lies Wept out her heart, as well as eyes. But, endless peace, sit here and keep My Phil the time he has to sleep; And thousand virgins come and weep To make these flowery carpets show Fresh as their blood, and ever grow, Till passengers shall spend their doom: Not Virgil's gnat had such a tomb.

Phil, otherwise Philip or Phip, was a pet name for a sparrow. _Virgil's gnat_, the _Culex_ attributed to Virgil.

257. TO PRIMROSES FILLED WITH MORNING DEW.

Why do ye weep, sweet babes? can tears Speak grief in you, Who were but born Just as the modest morn Teem'd her refreshing dew? Alas! you have not known that shower That mars a flower, Nor felt th' unkind Breath of a blasting wind, Nor are ye worn with years, Or warp'd as we, Who think it strange to see Such pretty flowers, like to orphans young, To speak by tears before ye have a tongue.

Speak, whimp'ring younglings, and make known The reason why Ye droop and weep; Is it for want of sleep? Or childish lullaby? Or that ye have not seen as yet The violet? Or brought a kiss From that sweetheart to this? No, no, this sorrow shown By your tears shed Would have this lecture read: That things of greatest, so of meanest worth, Conceiv'd with grief are, and with tears brought forth.

258. HOW ROSES CAME RED.

Roses at first were white, Till they could not agree, Whether my Sappho's breast Or they more white should be.

But, being vanquish'd quite, A blush their cheeks bespread; Since which, believe the rest, The roses first came red.

259. COMFORT TO A LADY UPON THE DEATH OF HER HUSBAND.

Dry your sweet cheek, long drown'd with sorrow's rain, Since, clouds dispers'd, suns gild the air again. Seas chafe and fret, and beat, and overboil, But turn soon after calm as balm or oil. Winds have their time to rage; but when they cease The leafy trees nod in a still-born peace. Your storm is over; lady, now appear Like to the peeping springtime of the year. Off then with grave clothes; put fresh colours on, And flow and flame in your vermilion. Upon your cheek sat icicles awhile; Now let the rose reign like a queen, and smile.

260. HOW VIOLETS CAME BLUE.

Love on a day, wise poets tell, Some time in wrangling spent, Whether the violets should excel, Or she, in sweetest scent.

But Venus having lost the day, Poor girls, she fell on you: And beat ye so, as some dare say, Her blows did make ye blue.

262. TO THE WILLOW-TREE.

Thou art to all lost love the best, The only true plant found, Wherewith young men and maids distres't, And left of love, are crown'd.

When once the lover's rose is dead, Or laid aside forlorn: Then willow-garlands 'bout the head Bedew'd with tears are worn.

When with neglect, the lovers' bane, Poor maids rewarded be, For their love lost, their only gain Is but a wreath from thee.

And underneath thy cooling shade, When weary of the light, The love-spent youth and love-sick maid Come to weep out the night.

263. MRS. ELIZ. WHEELER, UNDER THE NAME OF THE LOST SHEPHERDESS.

Among the myrtles as I walk'd, Love and my sighs thus intertalk'd: Tell me, said I, in deep distress, Where I may find my shepherdess. Thou fool, said Love, know'st thou not this? In everything that's sweet she is. In yond' carnation go and seek, There thou shalt find her lip and cheek: In that enamell'd pansy by, There thou shalt have her curious eye: In bloom of peach and rose's bud, There waves the streamer of her blood. 'Tis true, said I, and thereupon I went to pluck them one by one, To make of parts a union: But on a sudden all were gone. At which I stopp'd; said Love, these be The true resemblances of thee; For, as these flowers, thy joys must die, And in the turning of an eye: And all thy hopes of her must wither, Like those short sweets, ere knit together.

264. TO THE KING.

If when these lyrics, Cæsar, you shall hear, And that Apollo shall so touch your ear As for to make this, that, or any one, Number your own, by free adoption; That verse, of all the verses here, shall be The heir to this _great realm of poetry_.

265. TO THE QUEEN.

Goddess of youth, and lady of the spring, Most fit to be the consort to a king, Be pleas'd to rest you in this sacred grove Beset with myrtles, whose each leaf drops love. Many a sweet-fac'd wood-nymph here is seen, Of which chaste order you are now the queen: Witness their homage when they come and strew Your walks with flowers, and give their crowns to you. Your leafy throne, with lily-work possess, And be both princess here and poetess.

266. THE POET'S GOOD WISHES FOR THE MOST HOPEFUL AND HANDSOME PRINCE, THE DUKE OF YORK.

May his pretty dukeship grow Like t'a rose of Jericho: Sweeter far than ever yet Showers or sunshines could beget. May the Graces and the Hours Strew his hopes and him with flowers: And so dress him up with love As to be the chick of Jove. May the thrice-three sisters sing Him the sovereign of their spring: And entitle none to be Prince of Helicon but he. May his soft foot, where it treads, Gardens thence produce and meads: And those meadows full be set With the rose and violet. May his ample name be known To the last succession: And his actions high be told Through the world, but writ in gold.

267. TO ANTHEA, WHO MAY COMMAND HIM ANYTHING.

Bid me to live, and I will live Thy Protestant to be, Or bid me love, and I will give A loving heart to thee.

A heart as soft, a heart as kind, A heart as sound and free As in the whole world thou canst find, That heart I'll give to thee.

Bid that heart stay, and it will stay To honour thy decree: Or bid it languish quite away, And't shall do so for thee.

Bid me to weep, and I will weep While I have eyes to see: And, having none, yet I will keep A heart to weep for thee.

Bid me despair, and I'll despair Under that cypress-tree: Or bid me die, and I will dare E'en death to die for thee.

Thou art my life, my love, my heart, The very eyes of me: And hast command of every part To live and die for thee.

268. PREVISION OR PROVISION.

That prince takes soon enough the victor's room Who first provides not to be overcome.

269. OBEDIENCE IN SUBJECTS.

The gods to kings the judgment give to sway: The subjects only glory to obey.

270. MORE POTENT, LESS PECCANT.

He that may sin, sins least: leave to transgress Enfeebles much the seeds of wickedness.

271. UPON A MAID THAT DIED THE DAY SHE WAS MARRIED.

That morn which saw me made a bride, The evening witness'd that I died. Those holy lights, wherewith they guide Unto the bed the bashful bride, Serv'd but as tapers for to burn And light my relics to their urn. This epitaph, which here you see, Supplied the epithalamy.

274. TO MEADOWS.

Ye have been fresh and green, Ye have been fill'd with flowers, And ye the walks have been Where maids have spent their hours. You have beheld how they With wicker arks did come To kiss and bear away The richer cowslips home.

Y'ave heard them sweetly sing, And seen them in a round: Each virgin like a spring, With honeysuckles crown'd.

But now we see none here Whose silvery feet did tread, And with dishevell'd hair Adorn'd this smoother mead.

Like unthrifts, having spent Your stock and needy grown, Y'are left here to lament Your poor estates, alone.

Round, a rustic dance.

275. CROSSES.

Though good things answer many good intents, _Crosses do still bring forth the best events_.

276. MISERIES.

Though hourly comforts from the gods we see, _No life is yet life-proof from misery_.

278. TO HIS HOUSEHOLD GODS.

Rise, household gods, and let us go; But whither I myself not know. First, let us dwell on rudest seas; Next, with severest savages; Last, let us make our best abode Where human foot as yet ne'er trod: Search worlds of ice, and rather there Dwell than in loathed Devonshire.

279. TO THE NIGHTINGALE AND ROBIN REDBREAST.

When I departed am, ring thou my knell, Thou pitiful and pretty Philomel: And when I'm laid out for a corse, then be Thou sexton, redbreast, for to cover me.

280. TO THE YEW AND CYPRESS TO GRACE HIS FUNERAL.

Both you two have Relation to the grave: And where The funeral-trump sounds, you are there,

I shall be made, Ere long, a fleeting shade: Pray, come And do some honour to my tomb.

Do not deny My last request; for I Will be Thankful to you, or friends, for me.

281. I CALL AND I CALL.

I call, I call: who do ye call? The maids to catch this cowslip ball: But since these cowslips fading be, Troth, leave the flowers, and, maids, take me. Yet, if that neither you will do, Speak but the word and I'll take you.

282. ON A PERFUMED LADY.

You say you're sweet; how should we know Whether that you be sweet or no? From powders and perfumes keep free, Then we shall smell how sweet you be.

283. A NUPTIAL SONG OR EPITHALAMY ON SIR CLIPSEBY CREW AND HIS LADY.

What's that we see from far? the spring of day Bloom'd from the east, or fair enjewell'd May Blown out of April, or some new Star filled with glory to our view, Reaching at heaven, To add a nobler planet to the seven? Say, or do we not descry Some goddess in a cloud of tiffany To move, or rather the Emergent Venus from the sea?

'Tis she! 'tis she! or else some more divine Enlightened substance; mark how from the shrine Of holy saints she paces on, Treading upon vermilion And amber: spic- ing the chaft air with fumes of Paradise. Then come on, come on and yield A savour like unto a blessed field When the bedabbled morn Washes the golden ears of corn.

See where she comes; and smell how all the street Breathes vineyards and pomegranates: O how sweet! As a fir'd altar is each stone, Perspiring pounded cinnamon. The phœnix' nest, Built up of odours, burneth in her breast. Who, therein, would not consume His soul to ash-heaps in that rich perfume? Bestroking fate the while He burns to embers on the pile.

Hymen, O Hymen! tread the sacred ground; Show thy white feet and head with marjoram crown'd: Mount up thy flames and let thy torch Display the bridegroom in the porch, In his desires More towering, more disparkling than thy fires: Show her

how his eyes do turn And roll about, and in their motions burn Their balls to cinders: haste Or else to ashes he will waste.

Glide by the banks of virgins, then, and pass The showers of roses, lucky four-leav'd grass: The while the cloud of younglings sing And drown ye with a flowery spring; While some repeat Your praise and bless you, sprinkling you with wheat; While that others do divine, _Bless'd is the bride on whom the sun doth shine_; And thousands gladly wish You multiply as doth a fish.

And, beauteous bride, we do confess y'are wise In dealing forth these bashful jealousies: In love's name do so; and a price Set on yourself by being nice: But yet take heed; What now you seem be not the same indeed, And turn apostate: love will, Part of the way be met or sit stone-still. On, then, and though you slow- ly go, yet, howsoever, go.

And now y'are entered; see the coddled cook Runs from his torrid zone to pry and look And bless his dainty mistress: see The aged point out, "This is she Who now must sway The house (love shield her) with her yea and nay": And the smirk butler thinks it Sin in's napery not to express his wit; Each striving to devise Some gin wherewith to catch your eyes.

To bed, to bed, kind turtles, now, and write This the short'st day, and this the longest night; But yet too short for you: 'tis we Who count this night as long as three, Lying alone, Telling the clock strike ten, eleven, twelve, one. Quickly, quickly then prepare, And let the young men and the bride-maids share Your garters; and their joints Encircle with the bridegroom's points.

By the bride's eyes, and by the teeming life Of her green hopes, we charge ye that no strife (Farther than gentleness tends) gets place Among ye, striving for her lace: O do not fall Foul in these noble pastimes, lest ye call Discord in, and so divide The youthful bridegroom and the fragrant bride: Which love forfend; but spoken Be't to your praise, no peace was broken.

Strip her of springtime, tender-whimpering maids, Now autumn's come, when all these flowery aids Of her delays must end; dispose That lady-smock, that pansy, and that rose Neatly apart, But for prick-madam and for gentle-heart, And soft maidens'-blush, the bride Makes holy these, all others lay aside: Then strip her, or unto her Let him come who dares undo her.

And to enchant ye more, see everywhere About the roof a siren in a sphere, As we think, singing to the din Of many a warbling cherubin. O mark ye how The soul of nature melts in numbers: now See, a thousand Cupids fly To light their tapers at the bride's bright eye. To bed, or her they'll tire, Were she an element of fire.

And to your more bewitching, see, the proud Plump bed bear up, and swelling like a cloud, Tempting the two too modest; can Ye see it brusle like a swan, And you be cold To meet it when it woos and seems to fold The arms to hug it? Throw, throw Yourselves into the mighty overflow Of that white pride, and drown The night with you in floods of down.

The bed is ready, and the maze of love Looks for the treaders; everywhere is wove Wit and new mystery; read, and Put in practice, to understand And know each wile, Each hieroglyphic of a kiss or smile; And do it to the full; reach High in your own conceit, and some way teach Nature and art one more Play than they ever knew before.

If needs we must for ceremony's sake, Bless a sack-posset, luck go with it, take The night-charm quickly, you have spells And magics for to end, and hells To pass; but such And of such torture as no one would grutch To live therein for ever: fry And consume, and grow again to die And live, and, in that case, Love the confusion of the place.

But since it must be done, despatch, and sew Up in a sheet your bride, and what if so It be with rock or walls of brass Ye tower her up, as Danae was; Think you that this Or hell itself a powerful bulwark is? I tell ye no; but like a Bold bolt of thunder he will make his way, And rend the cloud, and throw The sheet about like flakes of snow.

All now is hushed in silence: midwife-moon With all her owl-eyed issue begs a boon, Which you must grant; that's entrance; with Which extract, all we can call pith And quintessence Of planetary bodies, so commence, All fair constellations Looking upon ye, that two nations, Springing from two such fires May blaze the virtue of their sires.

Tiffany, gauze. _More disparkling_, more widespreading. _Nice_, fastidious. _Coddled_, lit. boiled. _Lace_, girdle. _Brusle_, raise its feathers. _Grutch_, grumble.

284. THE SILKEN SNAKE.

For sport my Julia threw a lace Of silk and silver at my face: Watchet the silk was, and did make A show as if't had been a snake: The suddenness did me afright, But though it scar'd, it did not bite.

Lace, a girdle. _Watchet_, pale blue.

285. UPON HIMSELF.

I am sieve-like, and can hold Nothing hot or nothing cold. Put in love, and put in too Jealousy, and both will through: Put in fear, and hope, and doubt; What comes in runs quickly out: Put in secrecies withal, Whate'er enters, out it shall: But if you can stop the sieve, For mine own part, I'd as lief Maids should say or virgins sing, Herrick keeps, as holds nothing.

286. UPON LOVE.

Love's a thing, as I do hear, Ever full of pensive fear; Rather than to which I'll fall, Trust me, I'll not like at all. If to love I should intend, Let my hair then stand an end: And that terror likewise prove Fatal to me in my love. But if horror cannot slake Flames which would an entrance make Then the next thing I desire Is, to love and live i' th' fire.

An end, on end.

287. REVERENCE TO RICHES.

Like to the income must be our expense; _Man's fortune must be had in reverence_.

288. DEVOTION MAKES THE DEITY.

Who forms a godhead out of gold or stone Makes not a god, but he that prays to one.

289. TO ALL YOUNG MEN THAT LOVE.

I could wish you all who love, That ye could your thoughts remove From your mistresses, and be Wisely wanton, like to me, I could wish you dispossessed Of that _fiend that mars your rest_, And with tapers comes to fright Your weak senses in the night. I could wish ye all who fry Cold as ice, or cool as I; But if flames best like ye, then, Much good do 't ye, gentlemen. I a merry heart will keep, While you wring your hands and weep.

290. THE EYES.

'Tis a known principle in war, The eyes be first that conquered are.

291. NO FAULT IN WOMEN.

No fault in women to refuse The offer which they most would choose. No fault in women to confess How tedious they are in their dress. No fault in women to lay on The tincture of vermilion: And there to give the cheek a dye Of white, where nature doth deny. No fault in women to make show Of largeness when they're nothing so: (When true it is the outside swells With inward buckram, little else). No fault in women, though they be But seldom from suspicion free. No fault in womankind at all If they but slip and never fall.

293. OBERON'S FEAST.

Shapcot! to thee the fairy state I, with discretion, dedicate. Because thou prizest things that are Curious and unfamiliar. Take first the feast; these dishes gone, We'll see the Fairy Court anon.

A little mushroom table spread, After short prayers, they set on bread; A moon-parch'd grain of purest wheat, With some small glittering grit to eat His choice bits with; then in a trice They make a feast less great than nice. But all this while his eye is serv'd, We must not think his ear was sterv'd; But that there was in place to stir His spleen, the chirring grasshopper, The merry cricket, puling fly, The piping gnat for minstrelsy. And now we must imagine first, The elves present, to quench his thirst, A pure seed-pearl of infant dew Brought and besweetened in a blue And pregnant violet, which done, His kitling eyes begin to run Quite through the table, where he spies The horns of papery butterflies: Of which he eats, and tastes a little Of that we call the cuckoo's spittle. A little fuzz-ball pudding stands By, yet not blessed by his hands; That was too coarse: but then forthwith He ventures boldly on the pith Of sugar'd rush, and eats the sagg And well-bestrutted bee's sweet bag: Gladding his palate with some store Of emmets' eggs; what would he more? But beards of mice, a newt's stewed thigh, A bloated earwig and a fly; With the red-capp'd worm that's shut Within the concave of a nut, Brown as his tooth. A little moth Late fatten'd in a piece

of cloth: With withered cherries, mandrakes' ears, Moles' eyes; to these the slain stag's tears The unctuous dewlaps of a snail, The broke-heart of a nightingale O'ercome in music; with a wine Ne'er ravish'd from the flattering vine, But gently press'd from the soft side Of the most sweet and dainty bride, Brought in a dainty daisy, which He fully quaffs up to bewitch His blood to height; this done, commended Grace by his priest; _the feast is ended_.

Sagg, laden. _Bestrutted_, swollen.

294. EVENT OF THINGS NOT IN OUR POWER.

By time and counsel do the best we can, Th' event is never in the power of man.

295. UPON HER BLUSH.

When Julia blushes she does show Cheeks like to roses when they blow.

296. MERITS MAKE THE MAN.

Our honours and our commendations be Due to the merits, not authority.

297. TO VIRGINS.

Hear, ye virgins, and I'll teach What the times of old did preach. Rosamond was in a bower Kept, as Danae in a tower: But yet Love, who subtle is, Crept to that, and came to this. Be ye lock'd up like to these, Or the rich Hesperides, Or those babies in your eyes, In their crystal nunneries; Notwithstanding Love will win, Or else force a passage in: And as coy be as you can, Gifts will get ye, or the man.

Babies in your eyes, see Note to p. 17.

298. VIRTUE.

Each must in virtue strive for to excel; _That man lives twice that lives the first life well_.

299. THE BELLMAN.

From noise of scare-fires rest ye free, From murders _Benedicite_. From all mischances that may fright Your pleasing slumbers in the night, Mercy secure ye all, and keep The goblin from ye while ye sleep. Past one o'clock, and almost two! My masters all, good-day to you.

Scare-fires, alarms of fire.

300. BASHFULNESS.

Of all our parts, the eyes express The sweetest kind of bashfulness.

301. TO THE MOST ACCOMPLISHED GENTLEMAN, MASTER EDWARD NORGATE, CLERK OF THE SIGNET TO HIS MAJESTY. EPIG.

For one so rarely tun'd to fit all parts, For one to whom espous'd are all the arts, Long have I sought for, but could never see Them all concentr'd in one man, but thee. Thus, thou that man art whom the fates conspir'd To make but one, and that's thyself, admir'd.

302. UPON PRUDENCE BALDWIN: HER SICKNESS.

Prue, my dearest maid, is sick, Almost to be lunatic: Æsculapius! come and bring Means for her recovering; And a gallant cock shall be Offer'd up by her to thee.

Cock, the traditional offering to Æsculapius; cp. the last words of Socrates; cp. Ben Jonson, Epig. xiii.

303. TO APOLLO. A SHORT HYMN.

Phœbus! when that I a verse Or some numbers more rehearse, Tune my words that they may fall Each way smoothly musical: For which favour there shall be Swans devoted unto thee.

304. A HYMN TO BACCHUS.

Bacchus, let me drink no more; Wild are seas that want a shore. When our drinking has no stint, There is no one pleasure in't. I have drank up, for to please Thee, that great cup Hercules: Urge no more, and there shall be Daffodils given up to thee.

306. ON HIMSELF.

Here down my wearied limbs I'll lay; My pilgrim's staff, my weed of gray, My palmer's hat, my scallop's shell, My cross, my cord, and all, farewell. For having now my journey done, Just at the setting of the sun, Here I have found a chamber fit, God and good friends be thanked for it, Where if I can a lodger be, A little while from tramplers free, At my up-rising next I shall, If not requite, yet thank ye all. Meanwhile, the holy-rood hence fright The fouler fiend and evil sprite From scaring you or yours this night.

307. CASUALTIES.

Good things that come of course, far less do please Than those which come by sweet contingencies.

308. BRIBES AND GIFTS GET ALL.

Dead falls the cause if once the hand be mute; But let that speak, the client gets the suit.

309. THE END.

If well thou hast begun, go on fore-right; _It is the end that crowns us, not the fight_.

310. UPON A CHILD THAT DIED.

Here she lies, a pretty bud, Lately made of flesh and blood: Who as soon fell fast asleep As her little eyes did peep. Give her strewings, but not stir The earth that lightly covers her.

312. CONTENT, NOT CATES.

'Tis not the food, but the content That makes the table's merriment. Where trouble serves the board, we eat The platters there as soon as meat. A little pipkin with a bit Of mutton or of veal in it, Set on my table, trouble-free, More than a feast contenteth

me.

313. THE ENTERTAINMENT; OR, PORCH-VERSE, AT THE MARRIAGE OF MR. HENRY NORTHLY AND THE MOST WITTY MRS. LETTICE YARD.

Welcome! but yet no entrance, till we bless First you, then you, and both for white success. Profane no porch, young man and maid, for fear Ye wrong the Threshold-god that keeps peace here: Please him, and then all good-luck will betide You, the brisk bridegroom, you, the dainty bride. Do all things sweetly, and in comely wise; Put on your garlands first, then sacrifice: That done, when both of you have seemly fed, We'll call on Night, to bring ye both to bed: Where, being laid, all fair signs looking on, Fish-like, increase then to a million; And millions of spring-times may ye have, Which spent, one death bring to ye both one grave.

314. THE GOOD-NIGHT OR BLESSING.

Blessings in abundance come To the bride and to her groom; May the bed and this short night Know the fulness of delight! Pleasures many here attend ye, And, ere long, a boy Love send ye Curled and comely, and so trim, Maids, in time, may ravish him. Thus a dew of graces fall On ye both; good-night to all.

316. TO DAFFODILS.

Fair daffodils, we weep to see You haste away so soon; As yet the early-rising sun Has not attain'd his noon. Stay, stay, Until the hasting day Has run But to the evensong; And, having prayed together, we Will go with you along.

We have short time to stay, as you, We have as short a spring; As quick a growth to meet decay, As you, or anything. We die, As your hours do, and dry Away, Like to the summer's rain; Or as the pearls of morning's dew, Ne'er to be found again.

318. UPON A LADY THAT DIED IN CHILD-BED, AND LEFT A DAUGHTER BEHIND HER.

As gilliflowers do but stay To blow, and seed, and so away; So you, sweet lady, sweet as May, The garden's glory, lived a while To lend the world your scent and smile. But when your own fair print was set Once in a virgin flosculet, Sweet as yourself, and newly blown, To give that life, resigned your own: But so as still the mother's power Lives in the pretty lady-flower.

319. A NEW-YEAR'S GIFT SENT TO SIR SIMON STEWARD.

No news of navies burnt at seas; No noise of late-spawn'd tittyries; No closet plot, or open vent, That frights men with a parliament; No new device or late-found trick To read by the stars the kingdom's sick; No gin to catch the state, or wring The freeborn nostril of the king, We send to you; but here a jolly Verse, crown'd with ivy and with holly, That tells of winter's tales and mirth, That milkmaids make about the hearth, Of Christmas sports, the wassail-bowl, That['s] tost up, after fox-i'-th'-hole; Of blind-man-buff, and of the care That young men have to shoe the mare; Of Twelfth-tide cakes, of peas and beans, Wherewith you make those merry scenes, Whenas ye choose your king and queen, And cry out: _Hey, for our town green_; Of ash-heaps, in the which ye use Husbands and wives by streaks to choose; Of crackling

laurel, which fore-sounds A plenteous harvest to your grounds: Of these and such-like things for shift, We send instead of New-Year's gift. Read then, and when your faces shine With buxom meat and cap'ring wine, Remember us in cups full crown'd, And let our city-health go round, Quite through the young maids and the men, To the ninth number, if not ten; Until the fired chesnuts leap For joy to see the fruits ye reap From the plump chalice and the cup, That tempts till it be tossed up; Then as ye sit about your embers, Call not to mind those fled Decembers, But think on these that are t' appear As daughters to the instant year: Sit crown'd with rosebuds, and carouse Till Liber Pater twirls the house About your ears; and lay upon The year your cares that's fled and gone. And let the russet swains the plough And harrow hang up, resting now; And to the bagpipe all address, Till sleep takes place of weariness. And thus, throughout, with Christmas plays Frolic the full twelve holidays.

Tittyries, _i.e._, the Tityre-tues; see Note. _Fox-i'-th'-hole_, a game of hopping. _To shoe the mare_, or, shoe the wild mare, a Christmas game. _Buxom_, tender. _Liber Pater_, Father Bacchus.

320. MATINS; OR, MORNING PRAYER.

When with the virgin morning thou dost rise, Crossing thyself, come thus to sacrifice; First wash thy heart in innocence, then bring Pure hands, pure habits, pure, pure everything. Next to the altar humbly kneel, and thence Give up thy soul in clouds of frankincense. Thy golden censers, fill'd with odours sweet, Shall make thy actions with their ends to meet.

321. EVENSONG.

Begin with Jove; then is the work half done, And runs most smoothly when 'tis well begun. Jove's is the first and last: the morn's his due, The midst is thine; but Jove's the evening too; As sure a matins does to him belong, So sure he lays claim to the evensong.

322. THE BRACELET TO JULIA.

Why I tie about thy wrist, Julia, this my silken twist; For what other reason is't, But to show thee how, in part, Thou my pretty captive art? But thy bondslave is my heart; 'Tis but silk that bindeth thee, Knap the thread and thou art free: But 'tis otherwise with me; I am bound, and fast bound, so That from thee I cannot go; If I could, I would not so.

323. THE CHRISTIAN MILITANT.

A man prepar'd against all ills to come, That dares to dead the fire of martyrdom; That sleeps at home, and sailing there at ease, Fears not the fierce sedition of the seas; That's counter-proof against the farm's mishaps, Undreadful too of courtly thunderclaps; That wears one face, like heaven, and never shows A change when fortune either comes or goes; That keeps his own strong guard in the despite Of what can hurt by day or harm by night; That takes and re-delivers every stroke Of chance (as made up all of rock and oak); That sighs at others' death, smiles at his own Most dire and horrid crucifixion. Who for true glory suffers thus, we grant Him to be here our Christian militant.

324. A SHORT HYMN TO LAR.

Though I cannot give thee fires Glittering to my free desires; These accept, and I'll be free, Offering poppy unto thee.

325. ANOTHER TO NEPTUNE.

Mighty Neptune, may it please Thee, the rector of the seas, That my barque may safely run Through thy watery region; And a tunny-fish shall be Offered up with thanks to thee.

327. HIS EMBALMING TO JULIA.

For my embalming, Julia, do but this; Give thou my lips but their supremest kiss, Or else transfuse thy breath into the chest Where my small relics must for ever rest; That breath the balm, the myrrh, the nard shall be, To give an incorruption unto me.

328. GOLD BEFORE GOODNESS.

How rich a man is all desire to know; But none inquires if good he be or no.

329. THE KISS. A DIALOGUE.

1. Among thy fancies tell me this, What is the thing we call a kiss? 2. I shall resolve ye what it is.

It is a creature born and bred Between the lips (all cherry-red), By love and warm desires fed. _Chor._ And makes more soft the bridal bed.

2. It is an active flame that flies, First, to the babies of the eyes; And charms them there with lullabies. _Chor._ And stills the bride, too, when she cries.

2. Then to the chin, the cheek, the ear, It frisks and flies, now here, now there, 'Tis now far off, and then 'tis near. _Chor._ And here and there and everywhere.

1. Has it a speaking virtue? 2. Yes. 1. How speaks it, say? 2. Do you but this; Part your joined lips, then speaks your kiss _Chor._ And this love's sweetest language is.

1. Has it a body? 2. Aye, and wings With thousand rare encolourings; And, as it flies, it gently sings, _Chor._ Love honey yields, but never stings.

330. THE ADMONITION.

Seest thou those diamonds which she wears In that rich carcanet; Or those, on her dishevell'd hairs, Fair pearls in order set? Believe, young man, all those were tears By wretched wooers sent, In mournful hyacinths and rue, That figure discontent; Which when not warmed by her view, By cold neglect, each one Congeal'd to pearl and stone; Which precious spoils upon her She wears as trophies of her honour. Ah then, consider, what all this implies: She that will wear thy tears would wear thine eyes.

Carcanet, necklace.

331. TO HIS HONOURED KINSMAN, SIR WILLIAM SOAME. EPIG.

I can but name thee, and methinks I call All that have been, or are canonical For love and bounty to come near, and see Their many virtues volum'd up in thee; In thee,

brave man! whose incorrupted fame Casts forth a light like to a virgin flame; And as it shines it throws a scent about, As when a rainbow in perfumes goes out. So vanish hence, but leave a name as sweet As benjamin and storax when they meet.

Benjamin, gum benzoin. _Storax_ or _Styrax_, another resinous gum.

332. ON HIMSELF.

Ask me why I do not sing To the tension of the string As I did not long ago, When my numbers full did flow? Grief, ay, me! hath struck my lute And my tongue, at one time, mute.

333. TO LAR.

No more shall I, since I am driven hence, Devote to thee my grains of frankincense; No more shall I from mantle-trees hang down, To honour thee, my little parsley crown; No more shall I (I fear me) to thee bring My chives of garlic for an offering; No more shall I from henceforth hear a choir Of merry crickets by my country fire. Go where I will, thou lucky Lar stay here, Warm by a glitt'ring chimney all the year.

Chives, shreds.

334. THE DEPARTURE OF THE GOOD DEMON.

What can I do in poetry Now the good spirit's gone from me? Why, nothing now but lonely sit And over-read what I have writ.

335. CLEMENCY.

For punishment in war it will suffice If the chief author of the faction dies; Let but few smart, but strike a fear through all; Where the fault springs there let the judgment fall.

336. HIS AGE, DEDICATED TO HIS PECULIAR FRIEND, M. JOHN WICKES, UNDER THE NAME OF POSTHUMUS.

Ah Posthumus! our years hence fly, And leave no sound; nor piety, Or prayers, or vow Can keep the wrinkle from the brow; But we must on, As fate does lead or draw us; none, None, Posthumus, could ere decline The doom of cruel Proserpine.

The pleasing wife, the house, the ground, Must all be left, no one plant found To follow thee, Save only the curs'd cypress tree; A merry mind Looks forward, scorns what's left behind; Let's live, my Wickes, then, while we may, And here enjoy our holiday.

W'ave seen the past best times, and these Will ne'er return; we see the seas And moons to wane But they fill up their ebbs again; But vanish'd man, Like to a lily lost, ne'er can, Ne'er can repullulate, or bring His days to see a second spring.

But on we must, and thither tend, Where Anchus and rich Tullus blend Their sacred seed: Thus has infernal Jove decreed; We must be made, Ere long a song, ere long a shade. Why then, since life to us is short, Let's make it full up by our sport.

Crown we our heads with roses then, And 'noint with Tyrian balm; for when We two are dead, The world with us is buried. Then live we free As is the air, and let us

be Our own fair wind, and mark each one Day with the white and lucky stone.

We are not poor, although we have No roofs of cedar, nor our brave Baiæ, nor keep Account of such a flock of sheep; Nor bullocks fed To lard the shambles: barbels bred To kiss our hands; nor do we wish For Pollio's lampreys in our dish.

If we can meet and so confer Both by a shining salt-cellar, And have our roof, Although not arch'd, yet weather-proof, And ceiling free From that cheap candle bawdery; We'll eat our bean with that full mirth As we were lords of all the earth.

Well then, on what seas we are toss'd, Our comfort is, we can't be lost. Let the winds drive Our barque, yet she will keep alive Amidst the deeps. 'Tis constancy, my Wickes, which keeps The pinnace up; which, though she errs I' th' seas, she saves her passengers.

Say, we must part (sweet mercy bless Us both i' th' sea, camp, wilderness), Can we so far Stray to become less circular Than we are now? No, no, that self-same heart, that vow Which made us one, shall ne'er undo, Or ravel so to make us two.

Live in thy peace; as for myself, When I am bruised on the shelf Of time, and show My locks behung with frost and snow; When with the rheum, The cough, the ptisick, I consume Unto an almost nothing; then The ages fled I'll call again,

And with a tear compare these last Lame and bad times with those are past; While Baucis by, My old lean wife, shall kiss it dry. And so we'll sit By th' fire, foretelling snow and sleet, And weather by our aches, grown Now old enough to be our own

True calendars, as puss's ear Washed o'er's, to tell what change is near: Then to assuage The gripings of the chine by age, I'll call my young Iülus to sing such a song I made upon my Julia's breast; And of her blush at such a feast.

Then shall he read that flower of mine, Enclos'd within a crystal shrine; A primrose next; A piece, then, of a higher text, For to beget In me a more transcendent heat Than that insinuating fire, Which crept into each aged sire,

When the fair Helen, from her eyes, Shot forth her loving sorceries; At which I'll rear Mine aged limbs above my chair, And, hearing it, Flutter and crow as in a fit Of fresh concupiscence, and cry: _No lust there's like to poetry_.

Thus, frantic-crazy man, God wot, I'll call to mind things half-forgot, And oft between Repeat the times that I have seen! Thus ripe with tears, And twisting my Iülus' hairs, Doting, I'll weep and say, in truth, Baucis, these were my sins of youth.

Then next I'll cause my hopeful lad, If a wild apple can be had, To crown the hearth, Lar thus conspiring with our mirth; Then to infuse Our browner ale into the cruse, Which sweetly spic'd, we'll first carouse Unto the Genius of the house.

Then the next health to friends of mine, Loving the brave Burgundian wine, High sons of pith, Whose fortunes I have frolicked with; Such as could well Bear up the magic bough and spell; And dancing 'bout the mystic thyrse, Give up the just applause to verse:

To those, and then again to thee, We'll drink, my Wickes, until we be Plump as the cherry, Though not so fresh, yet full as merry As the cricket, The untam'd heifer, or the pricket, Until our tongues shall tell our ears We're younger by a score of years.

Thus, till we see the fire less shine From th' embers than the kitling's eyne, We'll still sit up, Sphering about the wassail-cup To all those times Which gave me honour for my rhymes. The coal once spent, we'll then to bed, Far more than night-bewearied.

Posthumus, the name is taken from Horace, Ode ii. 14, from which the beginning of this lyric is translated. _Repullulate_, be born again. _Anchus and rich Tullus._ Herrick is again translating from Horace (Ode iv. 7, 14). _Baiæ_, the favourite sea-side resort of the Romans in the time of Horace. _Pollio_, Vedius Pollio, who fed his lampreys with human flesh. _Ob_., B.C. 15. _Bawdery_, dirt (with no moral meaning). _Circular_, self-sufficing, the "in se ipso totus teres atque rotundus" of Horace. Sat. ii. 7, 86. _Iülus_, the son of Æneas. _Pith_, marrow. _Thyrse_, bacchic staff. _Pricket_, a buck in his second year.

337. A SHORT HYMN TO VENUS.

Goddess, I do love a girl, Ruby-lipp'd and tooth'd with pearl; If so be I may but prove Lucky in this maid I love, I will promise there shall be Myrtles offer'd up to thee.

338. TO A GENTLEWOMAN ON JUST DEALING.

True to yourself and sheets, you'll have me swear; You shall, if righteous dealing I find there. Do not you fall through frailty; I'll be sure To keep my bond still free from forfeiture.

339. THE HAND AND TONGUE.

Two parts of us successively command: The tongue in peace; but then in war the hand.

340. UPON A DELAYING LADY.

Come, come away, Or let me go; Must I here stay Because y'are slow, And will continue so? Troth, lady, no.

I scorn to be A slave to state: And, since I'm free, I will not wait Henceforth at such a rate For needy fate.

If you desire My spark should glow, The peeping fire You must blow, Or I shall quickly grow To frost or snow.

341. TO THE LADY MARY VILLARS, GOVERNESS TO THE PRINCESS HENRIETTA.

When I of Villars do but hear the name, It calls to mind that mighty Buckingham, Who was your brave exalted uncle here, Binding the wheel of fortune to his sphere, Who spurned at envy, and could bring with ease An end to all his stately purposes. For his love then, whose sacred relics show Their resurrection and their growth in

you; And for my sake, who ever did prefer You above all those sweets of Westminster; Permit my book to have a free access To kiss your hand, most dainty governess.

342. UPON HIS JULIA.

Will ye hear what I can say Briefly of my Julia? Black and rolling is her eye, Double-chinn'd and forehead high; Lips she has all ruby red, Cheeks like cream enclareted; And a nose that is the grace And proscenium of her face. So that we may guess by these The other parts will richly please.

343. TO FLOWERS.

In time of life I graced ye with my verse; Do now your flowery honours to my hearse. You shall not languish, trust me; virgins here Weeping shall make ye flourish all the year.

344. TO MY ILL READER.

Thou say'st my lines are hard, And I the truth will tell-- They are both hard and marr'd If thou not read'st them well.

345. THE POWER IN THE PEOPLE.

Let kings command and do the best they may, The saucy subjects still will bear the sway.

346. A HYMN TO VENUS AND CUPID.

Sea-born goddess, let me be By thy son thus grac'd and thee; That whene'er I woo, I find Virgins coy but not unkind. Let me when I kiss a maid Taste her lips so overlaid With love's syrup, that I may, In your temple when I pray, Kiss the altar and confess There's in love no bitterness.

347. ON JULIA'S PICTURE.

How am I ravish'd! when I do but see The painter's art in thy sciography? If so, how much more shall I dote thereon When once he gives it incarnation?

Sciography, the profile or section of a building.

348. HER BED.

See'st thou that cloud as silver clear, Plump, soft, and swelling everywhere? 'Tis Julia's bed, and she sleeps there.

349. HER LEGS.

Fain would I kiss my Julia's dainty leg, Which is as white and hairless as an egg.

350. UPON HER ALMS.

See how the poor do waiting stand For the expansion of thy hand. A wafer dol'd by thee will swell Thousands to feed by miracle.

351. REWARDS.

Still to our gains our chief respect is had; Reward it is that makes us good or bad.

352. NOTHING NEW.

Nothing is new; we walk where others went; There's no vice now but has his precedent.

353. THE RAINBOW.

Look how the rainbow doth appear But in one only hemisphere; So likewise after our decease No more is seen the arch of peace. That cov'nant's here, the under-bow, That nothing shoots but war and woe.

354. THE MEADOW-VERSE; OR, ANNIVERSARY TO MISTRESS BRIDGET LOWMAN.

Come with the spring-time forth, fair maid, and be This year again the meadow's deity. Yet ere ye enter give us leave to set Upon your head this flowery coronet; To make this neat distinction from the rest, You are the prime and princess of the feast; To which with silver feet lead you the way, While sweet-breath nymphs attend on you this day. This is your hour, and best you may command, Since you are lady of this fairy land. Full mirth wait on you, and such mirth as shall Cherish the cheek but make none blush at all.

Meadow-verse, to be recited at a rustic feast.

355. THE PARTING VERSE, THE FEAST THERE ENDED.

Loth to depart, but yet at last each one Back must now go to's habitation; Not knowing thus much when we once do sever, Whether or no that we shall meet here ever. As for myself, since time a thousand cares And griefs hath filed upon my silver hairs, 'Tis to be doubted whether I next year Or no shall give ye a re-meeting here. If die I must, then my last vow shall be, You'll with a tear or two remember me. Your sometime poet; but if fates do give Me longer date and more fresh springs to live, Oft as your field shall her old age renew, Herrick shall make the meadow-verse for you.

356. UPON JUDITH. EPIG.

Judith has cast her old skin and got new, And walks fresh varnish'd to the public view; Foul Judith was and foul she will be known For all this fair transfiguration.

359. TO THE RIGHT HONOURABLE PHILIP, EARL OF PEMBROKE AND MONTGOMERY.

How dull and dead are books that cannot show A prince of Pembroke, and that Pembroke you! You who are high born, and a lord no less Free by your fate than fortune's mightiness, Who hug our poems, honour'd sir, and then The paper gild and laureate the pen. Nor suffer you the poets to sit cold, But warm their wits and turn their lines to gold. Others there be who righteously will swear Those smooth-paced numbers amble everywhere, And these brave measures go a stately trot; Love those, like these, regard, reward them not. But you, my lord, are one whose hand along Goes with your mouth or does outrun your tongue; Paying before you praise, and, cockering wit, Give both the gold and garland unto it.

Cockering, pampering.

360. AN HYMN TO JUNO.

Stately goddess, do thou please, Who are chief at marriages, But to dress the bridal bed When my love and I shall wed; And a peacock proud shall be Offered up by us to thee.

362. UPON SAPPHO SWEETLY PLAYING AND SWEETLY SINGING.

When thou dost play and sweetly sing-- Whether it be the voice or string Or both of them that do agree Thus to entrance and ravish me-- This, this I know, I'm oft struck mute, And die away upon thy lute.

364. CHOP-CHERRY.

Thou gav'st me leave to kiss, Thou gav'st me leave to woo; Thou mad'st me think, by this And that, thou lov'dst me too.

But I shall ne'er forget How, for to make thee merry, Thou mad'st me chop, but yet Another snapp'd the cherry.

Chop-cherry, another name of cherry-bob.

365. TO THE MOST LEARNED, WISE, AND ARCH-ANTIQUARY, M. JOHN SELDEN.

I, who have favour'd many, come to be Grac'd now, at last, or glorified by thee, Lo! I, the lyric prophet, who have set On many a head the delphic coronet, Come unto thee for laurel, having spent My wreaths on those who little gave or lent. Give me the daphne, that the world may know it, Whom they neglected thou hast crown'd a poet. A city here of heroes I have made Upon the rock whose firm foundation laid, Shall never shrink; where, making thine abode, Live thou a Selden, that's a demi-god.

Daphne, _i.e._, the laurel

366. UPON HIMSELF.

Thou shalt not all die; for, while love's fire shines Upon his altar, men shall read thy lines, And learn'd musicians shall, to honour Herrick's Fame and his name, both set and sing his lyrics.

367. UPON WRINKLES.

Wrinkles no more are or no less Than beauty turned to sourness.

370. PRAY AND PROSPER.

First offer incense, then thy field and meads Shall smile and smell the better by thy beads. The spangling dew, dredg'd o'er the grass, shall be Turn'd all to mell and manna there for thee. Butter of amber, cream, and wine, and oil Shall run, as rivers, all throughout thy soil. Would'st thou to sincere silver turn thy mould? Pray once, twice pray, and turn thy ground to gold.

Beads, prayers. _Mell_, honey. _Sincere silver_, pure silver.

371. HIS LACHRYMÆ; OR, MIRTH TURNED TO MOURNING.

Call me no more, As heretofore, The music of a feast; Since now, alas! The mirth that was In me is dead or ceas'd.

Before I went, To banishment, Into the loathed west, I could rehearse A lyric verse, And speak it with the best.

But time, ay me! Has laid, I see, My organ fast asleep, And turn'd my voice Into the noise Of those that sit and weep.

375. TO THE MOST FAIR AND LOVELY MISTRESS ANNE SOAME, NOW LADY ABDIE.

So smell those odours that do rise From out the wealthy spiceries; So smells the flower of blooming clove, Or roses smother'd in the stove; So smells the air of spiced wine, Or essences of jessamine; So smells the breath about the hives When well the work of honey thrives, And all the busy factors come Laden with wax and honey home; So smell those neat and woven bowers All over-arch'd with orange flowers, And almond blossoms that do mix To make rich these aromatics; So smell those bracelets and those bands Of amber chaf'd between the hands, When thus enkindled they transpire A noble perfume from the fire; The wine of cherries, and to these The cooling breath of respasses; The smell of morning's milk and cream, Butter of cowslips mix'd with them; Of roasted warden or bak'd pear, These are not to be reckon'd here, Whenas the meanest part of her, Smells like the maiden pomander. Thus sweet she smells, or what can be More lik'd by her or lov'd by me.

Factors, workers. _Respasses_, raspberries. _Pomander_, ball of scent.

376. UPON HIS KINSWOMAN, MISTRESS ELIZABETH HERRICK.

Sweet virgin, that I do not set The pillars up of weeping jet Or mournful marble, let thy shade Not wrathful seem, or fright the maid Who hither at her wonted hours Shall come to strew thy earth with flowers. No; know, bless'd maid, when there's not one Remainder left of brass or stone, Thy living epitaph shall be, Though lost in them, yet found in me; Dear, in thy bed of roses then, Till this world shall dissolve as men, Sleep while we hide thee from the light, Drawing thy curtains round: Good-night.

377. A PANEGYRIC TO SIR LEWIS PEMBERTON.

Till I shall come again let this suffice, I send my salt, my sacrifice To thee, thy lady, younglings, and as far As to thy Genius and thy Lar; To the worn threshold, porch, hall, parlour, kitchen, The fat-fed smoking temple, which in The wholesome savour of thy mighty chines Invites to supper him who dines, Where laden spits, warp'd with large ribs of beef, Not represent but give relief To the lank stranger and the sour swain, Where both may feed and come again; For no black-bearded vigil from thy door Beats with a button'd-staff the poor; But from thy warm love-hatching gates each may Take friendly morsels and there stay To sun his thin-clad members if he likes, For thou no porter keep'st who strikes. No comer to thy roof his guest-rite wants, Or staying there is scourg'd with taunts Of some rough groom, who, yirkt with corns, says: "Sir, Y'ave dipped too long i' th' vinegar; And with our broth, and bread, and bits, sir friend, Y'ave fared well: pray make an end; Two days y'ave larded here; a third, ye know, Makes guests and fish smell strong; pray go You to some other

chimney, and there take Essay of other giblets; make Merry at another's hearth--y'are here Welcome as thunder to our beer; Manners know distance, and a man unrude Would soon recoil and not intrude His stomach to a second meal". No, no! Thy house well fed and taught can show No such crabb'd vizard: thou hast learnt thy train With heart and hand to entertain, And by the armsful, with a breast unhid, As the old race of mankind did, When either's heart and either's hand did strive To be the nearer relative. Thou dost redeem those times, and what was lost Of ancient honesty may boast It keeps a growth in thee, and so will run A course in thy fame's pledge, thy son. Thus, like a Roman tribune, thou thy gate Early sets ope to feast and late; Keeping no currish waiter to affright With blasting eye the appetite, Which fain would waste upon thy cates, but that The trencher-creature marketh what Best and more suppling piece he cuts, and by Some private pinch tells danger's nigh A hand too desp'rate, or a knife that bites Skin-deep into the pork, or lights Upon some part of kid, as if mistook, When checked by the butler's look. No, no; thy bread, thy wine, thy jocund beer Is not reserved for Trebius here, But all who at thy table seated are Find equal freedom, equal fare; And thou, like to that hospitable god, Jove, joy'st when guests make their abode To eat thy bullock's thighs, thy veals, thy fat Wethers, and never grudged at. The _pheasant_, _partridge_, _gotwit_, _reeve_, _ruff_, _rail_, The _cock_, the _curlew_ and the _quail_, These and thy choicest viands do extend Their taste unto the lower end Of thy glad table: not a dish more known To thee than unto anyone. But as thy meat so thy _immortal wine_ Makes the smirk face of each to shine And spring fresh rosebuds, while the salt, the wit, Flows from the wine and graces it; While reverence, waiting at the bashful board, Honours my lady and my lord. No scurril jest; no open scene is laid Here for to make the face afraid; But temperate mirth dealt forth, and so discreet- ly that it makes the meat more sweet; And adds perfumes unto the wine, which thou Dost rather pour forth than allow By cruse and measure; thus devoting wine As the Canary Isles were thine; But with that wisdom and that method, as No one that's there his guilty glass Drinks of distemper, or has cause to cry Repentance to his liberty. No, thou knowest order, ethics, and has read All economics, know'st to lead A house-dance neatly, and canst truly show How far a figure ought to go, Forward or backward, sideward, and what pace Can give, and what retract a grace; What gesture, courtship, comeliness agrees With those thy primitive decrees, To give subsistence to thy house, and proof What Genii support thy roof, Goodness and Greatness; not the oaken piles; _For these and marbles have their whiles To last, but not their ever_; virtue's hand It is which builds 'gainst fate to stand. Such is thy house, whose firm foundation's trust Is more in thee than in her dust Or depth; these last may yield and yearly shrink When what is strongly built, no chink Or yawning rupture can the same devour, But fix'd it stands, by her own power And well-laid bottom, on the iron and rock Which tries and counter-stands the shock And ram of time, and by vexation grows The stronger; _virtue dies when foes Are wanting to her exercise, but great And large she spreads by dust and sweat_. Safe stand thy walls and thee, and so both will, Since neither's height was rais'd by th' ill Of others; since no stud, no stone, no piece Was rear'd up by the poor man's fleece; No widow's tenement was rack'd to gild Or fret thy ceiling or to build A sweating-closet to anoint the silk- soft skin, or bathe in asses' milk; No orphan's pittance left him serv'd to set The pillars up of lasting jet, For which their cries might beat against thine ears, Or in

the damp jet read their tears. No plank from hallowed altar does appeal To yond' Star-Chamber, or does seal A curse to thee or thine; but all things even Make for thy peace and pace to heaven. Go on directly so, as just men may A thousand times more swear than say: This is that princely Pemberton who can Teach man to keep a god in man; And when wise poets shall search out to see Good men, they find them all in thee.

Vigil, watchman. _Button'd-staff_, staff with a knob at its end. _Yirkt_, scourged. _Redeem_, buy back. _Suppling_, tender. _Trebius_, friend of the epicure Lucullus; cp. Juv. v. 19.

378. TO HIS VALENTINE ON ST. VALENTINE'S DAY.

Oft have I heard both youths and virgins say Birds choose their mates, and couple too this day; But by their flight I never can divine When I shall couple with my valentine.

382. UPON M. BEN. JONSON. EPIG.

After the rare arch-poet, Jonson, died, The sock grew loathsome, and the buskin's pride, Together with the stage's glory, stood Each like a poor and pitied widowhood. The cirque profan'd was, and all postures rack'd; For men did strut, and stride, and stare, not act. Then temper flew from words, and men did squeak, Look red, and blow, and bluster, but not speak; No holy rage or frantic fires did stir Or flash about the spacious theatre. No clap of hands, or shout, or praise's proof Did crack the play-house sides, or cleave her roof. Artless the scene was, and that monstrous sin Of deep and arrant ignorance came in: Such ignorance as theirs was who once hiss'd At thy unequall'd play, the _Alchemist_; Oh, fie upon 'em! Lastly, too, all wit In utter darkness did, and still will sit, Sleeping the luckless age out, till that she Her resurrection has again with thee.

383. ANOTHER.

Thou had'st the wreath before, now take the tree, That henceforth none be laurel-crown'd but thee.

384. TO HIS NEPHEW, TO BE PROSPEROUS IN HIS ART OF PAINTING.

On, as thou hast begun, brave youth, and get The palm from Urbin, Titian, Tintoret, Brugel and Coxu, and the works outdo Of Holbein and that mighty Rubens too. So draw and paint as none may do the like, No, not the glory of the world, Vandyke.

Urbin, Raphael. _Brugel_, Jan Breughel, Dutch landscape painter (1569-1625), or his father or brother. _Coxu_, Michael van Coxcie, Flemish painter (1497-1592).

386. A VOW TO MARS.

Store of courage to me grant, Now I'm turn'd a combatant; Help me, so that I my shield, Fighting, lose not in the field. That's the greatest shame of all That in warfare can befall. Do but this, and there shall be Offer'd up a wolf to thee.

387. TO HIS MAID, PREW.

These summer-birds did with thy master stay The times of warmth, but then they flew away, Leaving their poet, being now grown old, Expos'd to all the coming winter's cold. But thou, kind Prew, did'st with my fates abide As well the winter's as the summer's tide; For which thy love, live with thy master here, Not one, but all the seasons of the year.

388. A CANTICLE TO APOLLO.

Play, Phœbus, on thy lute; And we will all sit mute, By listening to thy lyre, That sets all ears on fire.

Hark, hark, the god does play! And as he leads the way Through heaven the very spheres, As men, turn all to ears.

389. A JUST MAN.

A just man's like a rock that turns the wrath Of all the raging waves into a froth.

390. UPON A HOARSE SINGER.

Sing me to death; for till thy voice be clear, 'Twill never please the palate of mine ear.

391. HOW PANSIES OR HEART'S-EASE CAME FIRST.

Frolic virgins once these were, Over-loving, living here; Being here their ends denied, Ran for sweethearts mad, and died. Love, in pity of their tears, And their loss in blooming years, For their restless here-spent hours, Gave them heart's-ease turn'd to flowers.

392. TO HIS PECULIAR FRIEND, SIR EDWARD FISH, KNIGHT BARONET.

Since, for thy full deserts, with all the rest Of these chaste spirits that are here possest Of life eternal, time has made thee one For growth in this my rich plantation, Live here; but know 'twas virtue, and not chance, That gave thee this so high inheritance. Keep it for ever, grounded with the good, Who hold fast here an endless livelihood.

393. LAR'S PORTION AND THE POET'S PART.

At my homely country-seat I have there a little wheat, Which I work to meal, and make Therewithal a holy cake: Part of which I give to Lar, Part is my peculiar.

Peculiar, his own property.

394. UPON MAN.

Man is compos'd here of a twofold part: The first of nature, and the next of art: Art presupposes nature; nature she Prepares the way for man's docility.

395. LIBERTY.

Those ills that mortal men endure So long, are capable of cure, As they of freedom may be sure; But, that denied, a grief, though small, Shakes the whole roof, or ruins all.

396. LOTS TO BE LIKED.

Learn this of me, where'er thy lot doth fall, Short lot or not, to be content with all.

397. GRIEFS.

Jove may afford us thousands of reliefs, Since man expos'd is to a world of griefs.

399. THE DREAM.

By dream I saw one of the three Sisters of fate appear to me; Close to my bedside she did stand, Showing me there a firebrand; She told me too, as that did spend, So drew my life unto an end. Three quarters were consum'd of it; Only remained a little bit, Which will be burnt up by-and-by; Then, Julia, weep, for I must die.

402. CLOTHES DO BUT CHEAT AND COZEN US.

Away with silks, away with lawn, I'll have no scenes or curtains drawn; Give me my mistress as she is, Dress'd in her nak'd simplicities; For as my heart e'en so mine eye Is won with flesh, not drapery.

403. TO DIANEME.

Show me thy feet; show me thy legs, thy thighs; Show me those fleshy principalities; Show me that hill where smiling love doth sit. Having a living fountain under it; Show me thy waist, then let me therewithal, By the assention of thy lawn, see all.

404. UPON ELECTRA.

When out of bed my love doth spring, 'Tis but as day a-kindling; But when she's up and fully dress'd, 'Tis then broad day throughout the east.

405. TO HIS BOOK.

Have I not blest thee? Then go forth, nor fear Or spice, or fish, or fire, or close-stools here. But with thy fair fates leading thee, go on With thy most white predestination. Nor think these ages that do hoarsely sing The farting tanner and familiar king, The dancing friar, tatter'd in the bush; Those monstrous lies of little Robin Rush, Tom Chipperfeild, and pretty lisping Ned, That doted on a maid of gingerbread; The flying pilchard and the frisking dace, With all the rabble of Tim Trundell's race (Bred from the dunghills and adulterous rhymes), Shall live, and thou not superlast all times. No, no; thy stars have destin'd thee to see The whole world die and turn to dust with thee. _He's greedy of his life who will not fall Whenas a public ruin bears down all._

The farting tanner, etc., see Note.

406. OF LOVE.

I do not love, nor can it be Love will in vain spend shafts on me; I did this godhead once defy, Since which I freeze, but cannot fry. Yet out, alas! the death's the same, Kill'd by a frost or by a flame.

407. UPON HIMSELF.

I dislik'd but even now; Now I love I know not how. Was I idle, and that while Was I fir'd with a smile? I'll to work, or pray; and then I shall quite dislike again.

408. ANOTHER.

Love he that will, it best likes me To have my neck from love's yoke free.

412. THE MAD MAID'S SONG.

Good-morrow to the day so fair, Good-morning, sir, to you; Good-morrow to mine own torn hair, Bedabbled with the dew.

Good-morning to this primrose too, Good-morrow to each maid That will with flowers the tomb bestrew Wherein my love is laid.

Ah! woe is me, woe, woe is me, Alack and well-a-day! For pity, sir, find out that bee Which bore my love away.

I'll seek him in your bonnet brave, I'll seek him in your eyes; Nay, now I think th'ave made his grave I' th' bed of strawberries.

I'll seek him there; I know ere this The cold, cold earth doth shake him; But I will go or send a kiss By you, sir, to awake him.

Pray, hurt him not, though he be dead, He knows well who do love him, And who with green turfs rear his head, And who do rudely move him.

He's soft and tender (pray take heed); With bands of cowslips bind him, And bring him home; but 'tis decreed That I shall never find him.

413. TO SPRINGS AND FOUNTAINS.

I heard ye could cool heat, and came With hope you would allay the same; Thrice I have wash'd but feel no cold, Nor find that true which was foretold. Methinks, like mine, your pulses beat And labour with unequal heat; Cure, cure yourselves, for I descry Ye boil with love as well as I.

414. UPON JULIA'S UNLACING HERSELF.

Tell if thou canst, and truly, whence doth come This camphor, storax, spikenard, galbanum; These musks, these ambers, and those other smells, Sweet as the vestry of the oracles. I'll tell thee: while my Julia did unlace Her silken bodice but a breathing space, The passive air such odour then assum'd, As when to Jove great Juno goes perfum'd, Whose pure immortal body doth transmit A scent that fills both heaven and earth with it.

415. TO BACCHUS, A CANTICLE.

Whither dost thou whorry me, Bacchus, being full of thee? This way, that way, that way, this, Here and there a fresh love is. That doth like me, this doth please, Thus a thousand mistresses I have now; yet I alone, Having all, enjoy not one.

Whorry, carry rapidly.

416. THE LAWN.

Would I see lawn, clear as the heaven, and thin? It should be only in my Julia's skin, Which so betrays her blood as we discover The blush of cherries when a lawn's cast over.

417. THE FRANKINCENSE.

When my off'ring next I make, Be thy hand the hallowed cake, And thy breast the altar whence Love may smell the frankincense.

420. TO SYCAMORES.

I'm sick of love, O let me lie Under your shades to sleep or die! Either is welcome, so I have Or here my bed, or here my grave. Why do you sigh, and sob, and keep Time with the tears that I do weep? Say, have ye sense, or do you prove What crucifixions are in love? I know ye do, and that's the why You sigh for love as well as I.

421. A PASTORAL SUNG TO THE KING: MONTANO, SILVIO, AND MIRTILLO, SHEPHERDS.

Mon. Bad are the times. _Sil._ And worse than they are we. _Mon._ Troth, bad are both; worse fruit and ill the tree: The feast of shepherds fail. _Sil._ None crowns the cup Of wassail now or sets the quintell up; And he who us'd to lead the country-round, Youthful Mirtillo, here he comes grief-drown'd. _Ambo._ Let's cheer him up. _Sil._ Behold him weeping-ripe. _Mir._ Ah! Amaryllis, farewell mirth and pipe; Since thou art gone, no more I mean to play To these smooth lawns my mirthful roundelay. Dear Amaryllis! _Mon._ Hark! _Sil._ Mark! _Mir._ This earth grew sweet Where, Amaryllis, thou didst set thy feet. _Ambo._ Poor pitied youth! _Mir._ And here the breath of kine And sheep grew more sweet by that breath of thine. This flock of wool and this rich lock of hair, This ball of cowslips, these she gave me here. _Sil._ Words sweet as love itself. Montano, hark! _Mir._ This way she came, and this way too she went; How each thing smells divinely redolent! Like to a field of beans when newly blown, Or like a meadow being lately mown. _Mon._ A sweet-sad passion---- _Mir._ In dewy mornings when she came this way Sweet bents would bow to give my love the day; And when at night she folded had her sheep, Daisies would shut, and, closing, sigh and weep. Besides (ay me!) since she went hence to dwell, The voices' daughter ne'er spake syllable. But she is gone. _Sil._ Mirtillo, tell us whither. _Mir._ Where she and I shall never meet together. _Mon._ Forfend it Pan, and, Pales, do thou please To give an end. _Mir._ To what? _Sil._ Such griefs as these. _Mir._ Never, O never! Still I may endure The wound I suffer, never find a cure. _Mon._ Love for thy sake will bring her to these hills And dales again. _Mir._ No, I will languish still; And all the while my part shall be to weep, And with my sighs, call home my bleating sheep: And in the rind of every comely tree I'll carve thy name, and in that name kiss thee. _Mon._ Set with the sun thy woes. _Sil._ The day grows old, And time it is our full-fed flocks to fold. _Chor._ The shades grow great, but greater grows our sorrow; But let's go steep Our eyes in sleep, And meet to weep To-morrow.

Quintell, quintain or tilting board. _Bents_, grasses. _Pales_, the goddess of sheepfolds.

422. THE POET LOVES A MISTRESS, BUT NOT TO MARRY.

I do not love to wed, Though I do like to woo; And for a maidenhead I'll beg and buy it too.

I'll praise and I'll approve Those maids that never vary; And fervently I'll love, But yet I would not marry.

I'll hug, I'll kiss, I'll play, And, cock-like, hens I'll tread, And sport it any way But in the bridal bed.

For why? that man is poor Who hath but one of many, But crown'd he is with store That, single, may have any.

Why then, say, what is he, To freedom so unknown, Who, having two or three, Will be content with one?

425. THE WILLOW GARLAND.

A willow garland thou did'st send Perfum'd, last day, to me, Which did but only this portend-- I was forsook by thee.

Since so it is, I'll tell thee what, To-morrow thou shalt see Me wear the willow; after that, To die upon the tree.

As beasts unto the altars go With garlands dress'd, so I Will, with my willow-wreath, also Come forth and sweetly die.

427. A HYMN TO SIR CLIPSEBY CREW.

'Twas not love's dart, Or any blow Of want, or foe, Did wound my heart With an eternal smart;

But only you, My sometimes known Companion, My dearest Crew, That me unkindly slew.

May your fault die, And have no name In books of fame; Or let it lie Forgotten now, as I.

We parted are And now no more, As heretofore, By jocund Lar Shall be familiar.

But though we sever, My Crew shall see That I will be Here faithless never, But love my Clipseby ever.

430. EMPIRES.

Empires of kings are now, and ever were, As Sallust saith, coincident to fear.

431. FELICITY QUICK OF FLIGHT.

Every time seems short to be That's measured by felicity; But one half-hour that's made up here With grief, seems longer than a year.

436. THE CROWD AND COMPANY.

In holy meetings there a man may be One of the crowd, not of the company.

438. POLICY IN PRINCES.

That princes may possess a surer seat, 'Tis fit they make no one with them too great.

440. UPON THE NIPPLES OF JULIA'S BREAST.

Have ye beheld (with much delight) A red rose peeping through a white? Or else a cherry, double grac'd, Within a lily centre plac'd? Or ever mark'd the pretty beam A strawberry shows half-drown'd in cream? Or seen rich rubies blushing through A pure smooth pearl and orient too? So like to this, nay all the rest, Is each neat niplet of her breast.

441. TO DAISIES, NOT TO SHUT SO SOON.

Shut not so soon; the dull-ey'd night Has not as yet begun To make a seizure on the light, Or to seal up the sun.

No marigolds yet closed are, No shadows great appear; Nor doth the early shepherd's star Shine like a spangle here.

Stay but till my Julia close Her life-begetting eye, And let the whole world then dispose Itself to live or die.

442. TO THE LITTLE SPINNERS.

Ye pretty housewives, would ye know The work that I would put ye to? This, this it should be: for to spin A lawn for me, so fine and thin As it might serve me for my skin. For cruel Love has me so whipp'd That of my skin I all am stripp'd: And shall despair that any art Can ease the rawness or the smart, Unless you skin again each part. Which mercy if you will but do, I call all maids to witness to What here I promise: that no broom Shall now or ever after come To wrong a spinner or her loom.

Spinners, spiders.

443. OBERON'S PALACE.

After the feast, my Shapcot, see The fairy court I give to thee; Where we'll present our Oberon, led Half-tipsy to the fairy bed, Where Mab he finds, who there doth lie, Not without mickle majesty. Which done, and thence remov'd the light, We'll wish both them and thee good-night.

Full as a bee with thyme, and red As cherry harvest, now high fed For lust and action, on he'll go To lie with Mab, though all say no. Lust has no ears; he's sharp as thorn, And fretful, carries hay in's horn, And lightning in his eyes; and flings Among the elves, if moved, the stings Of peltish wasps; well know his guard-- _Kings, though they're hated, will be fear'd_. Wine lead[s] him on. Thus to a grove, Sometimes devoted unto love, Tinselled with twilight, he and they, Led by the shine of snails, a way Beat with their num'rous feet, which, by Many a neat perplexity, Many a turn and many a cross- Track they redeem a bank of moss, Spongy and swelling, and far more Soft than the finest Lemster ore, Mildly disparkling like those fires Which break from the enjewell'd tyres Of curious brides; or like those mites Of candi'd dew in moony nights. Upon this convex all the flowers Nature begets by th' sun and showers, Are to a wild digestion brought, As if love's sampler here was wrought: Or Citherea's ceston,

which All with temptation doth bewitch. Sweet airs move here, and more divine Made by the breath of great-eyed kine, Who, as they low, impearl with milk The four-leaved grass or moss like silk. The breath of monkeys met to mix With musk-flies are th' aromatics Which 'cense this arch; and here and there And farther off, and everywhere Throughout that brave mosaic yard, Those picks or diamonds in the card With peeps of hearts, of club, and spade Are here most neatly inter-laid Many a counter, many a die, Half-rotten and without an eye Lies hereabouts; and, for to pave The excellency of this cave, Squirrels' and children's teeth late shed Are neatly here enchequered With brownest toadstones, and the gum That shines upon the bluer plum. The nails fallen off by whitflaws: art's Wise hand enchasing here those warts Which we to others, from ourselves, Sell, and brought hither by the elves. The tempting mole, stolen from the neck Of the shy virgin, seems to deck The holy entrance, where within The room is hung with the blue skin Of shifted snake: enfriez'd throughout With eyes of peacocks' trains and trout- Flies' curious wings; and these among Those silver pence that cut the tongue Of the red infant, neatly hung. The glow-worm's eyes; the shining scales Of silv'ry fish; wheat straws, the snail's Soft candle light; the kitling's eyne; Corrupted wood; serve here for shine. No glaring light of bold-fac'd day, Or other over-radiant ray, Ransacks this room; but what weak beams Can make reflected from these gems And multiply; such is the light, But ever doubtful day or night. By this quaint taper light he winds His errors up; and now he finds His moon-tann'd Mab, as somewhat sick, And (love knows) tender as a chick. Upon six plump dandillions, high- Rear'd, lies her elvish majesty: Whose woolly bubbles seem'd to drown Her Mabship in obedient down. For either sheet was spread the caul That doth the infant's face enthral, When it is born (by some enstyl'd The lucky omen of the child), And next to these two blankets o'er- Cast of the finest gossamore. And then a rug of carded wool, Which, sponge-like drinking in the dull Light of the moon, seemed to comply, Cloud-like, the dainty deity. Thus soft she lies: and overhead A spinner's circle is bespread With cob-web curtains, from the roof So neatly sunk as that no proof Of any tackling can declare What gives it hanging in the air. The fringe about this are those threads Broke at the loss of maidenheads: And, all behung with these, pure pearls, Dropp'd from the eyes of ravish'd girls Or writhing brides; when (panting) they Give unto love the straiter way. For music now, he has the cries Of feigned-lost virginities; The which the elves make to excite A more unconquered appetite. The king's undrest; and now upon The gnat's watchword the elves are gone. And now the bed, and Mab possess'd Of this great little kingly guest; We'll nobly think, what's to be done, He'll do no doubt; _this flax is spun_.

Mickle, much. _Carries hay in's horn_ (fœnum habet in cornu), is dangerous. _Peltish_, angry. _Redeem_, gain. _Lemster ore_, Leominster wool. _Tyres_, head-dresses. _Picks_, diamonds on playing-cards were so called from their points. _Peeps_, pips. _Whitflaws_, whitlows. _Corrupted_, _i.e._, phosphorescent. _Winds his errors up_, brings his wanderings to an end. _Dandillions_, dandelions. _Comply_, embrace. _Spinner_, spider. _Proof_, sign.

444. TO HIS PECULIAR FRIEND, MR. THOMAS SHAPCOTT, LAWYER.

I've paid thee what I promis'd; that's not all; Besides I give thee here a verse that shall (When hence thy circummortal part is gone), Arch-like, hold up thy name's inscription. Brave men can't die, whose candid actions are Writ in the poet's endless calendar: Whose vellum and whose volume is the sky, And the pure stars the praising poetry. Farewell

Circummortal, more than mortal. _Candid_, fair.

445. TO JULIA IN THE TEMPLE.

Besides us two, i' th' temple here's not one To make up now a congregation. Let's to the altar of perfumes then go, And say short prayers; and when we have done so, Then we shall see, how in a little space Saints will come in to fill each pew and place.

446. TO OENONE.

What conscience, say, is it in thee, When I a heart had one, To take away that heart from me, And to retain thy own?

For shame or pity now incline To play a loving part; Either to send me kindly thine, Or give me back my heart.

Covet not both; but if thou dost Resolve to part with neither, Why! yet to show that thou art just, Take me and mine together.

447. HIS WEAKNESS IN WOES.

I cannot suffer; and in this my part Of patience wants. _Grief breaks the stoutest heart._

448. FAME MAKES US FORWARD.

To print our poems, the propulsive cause Is fame--the breath of popular applause.

449. TO GROVES.

Ye silent shades, whose each tree here Some relique of a saint doth wear, Who, for some sweetheart's sake, did prove The fire and martyrdom of love: Here is the legend of those saints That died for love, and their complaints: Their wounded hearts and names we find Encarv'd upon the leaves and rind. Give way, give way to me, who come Scorch'd with the self-same martyrdom: And have deserv'd as much (love knows) As to be canonis'd 'mongst those Whose deeds and deaths here written are Within your greeny calendar: By all those virgins' fillets hung Upon your boughs, and requiems sung For saints and souls departed hence (Here honour'd still with frankincense); By all those tears that have been shed, As a drink-offering to the dead; By all those true love-knots that be With mottoes carv'd on every tree; By sweet Saint Phyllis pity me: By dear Saint Iphis, and the rest Of all those other saints now blest, Me, me, forsaken, here admit Among your myrtles to be writ: That my poor name may have the glory To live remembered in your story.

Phyllis, the Thracian princess who hanged herself for love of Demophoon. _Iphis_, a Cyprian youth who hanged himself for love of Anaxaretes.

450. AN EPITAPH UPON A VIRGIN.

Here a solemn fast we keep, While all beauty lies asleep Hush'd be all things--no noise here-- But the toning of a tear: Or a sigh of such as bring Cowslips for her covering.

451. TO THE RIGHT GRACIOUS PRINCE, LODOWICK, DUKE OF RICHMOND AND LENNOX.

Of all those three brave brothers fall'n i' th' war (Not without glory), noble sir, you are, Despite of all concussions, left the stem To shoot forth generations like to them. Which may be done, if, sir, you can beget Men in their substance, not in counterfeit, Such essences as those three brothers; known Eternal by their own production. Of whom, from fame's white trumpet, this I'll tell, Worthy their everlasting chronicle: Never since first Bellona us'd a shield, _Such three brave brothers fell in Mars his field_. These were those three Horatii Rome did boast, Rome's were these three Horatii we have lost. One Cœur-de-Lion had that age long since; This, three; which three, you make up four, brave prince.

452. TO JEALOUSY.

O jealousy, that art The canker of the heart; And mak'st all hell Where thou do'st dwell; For pity be No fury, or no firebrand to me.

Far from me I'll remove All thoughts of irksome love: And turn to snow, Or crystal grow, To keep still free, O! soul-tormenting jealousy, from thee.

453. TO LIVE FREELY.

Let's live in haste; use pleasures while we may; Could life return, 'twould never lose a day.

455. HIS ALMS.

Here, here I live, And somewhat give Of what I have To those who crave, Little or much, My alms is such; But if my deal Of oil and meal Shall fuller grow, More I'll bestow; Meantime be it E'en but a bit, Or else a crumb, The scrip hath some.

Deal, portion.

456. UPON HIMSELF.

Come, leave this loathed country life, and then Grow up to be a Roman citizen. Those mites of time, which yet remain unspent, Waste thou in that most civil government. Get their comportment and the gliding tongue Of those mild men thou art to live among; Then, being seated in that smoother sphere, Decree thy everlasting topic there; And to the farm-house ne'er return at all: Though granges do not love thee, cities shall.

457. TO ENJOY THE TIME.

While Fates permit us let's be merry, Pass all we must the fatal ferry; And this our life too whirls away With the rotation of the day.

458. UPON LOVE.

Love, I have broke Thy yoke, The neck is free; But when I'm next Love-vexed, Then shackle me.

'Tis better yet To fret The feet or hands, Than to enthral Or gall The neck with bands.

459. TO THE RIGHT HONOURABLE MILDMAY, EARL OF WESTMORELAND.

You are a lord, an earl, nay more, a man Who writes sweet numbers well as any can; If so, why then are not these verses hurled, Like Sybil's leaves, throughout the ample world? What is a jewel if it be not set Forth by a ring or some rich carcanet? But being so, then the beholders cry: See, see a gem as rare as Belus' eye. Then public praise does run upon the stone, For a most rich, a rare, a precious one. Expose your jewels then unto the view, That we may praise them, or themselves prize you. _Virtue concealed_, with Horace you'll confess, _Differs not much from drowsy slothfulness_.

Belus' eye, the eye onyx. "The stone called Belus' eie is white, and hath within it a black apple." (Holland's _Pliny_.)

460. THE PLUNDER.

I am of all bereft, Save but some few beans left, Whereof, at last, to make For me and mine a cake, Which eaten, they and I Will say our grace, and die.

461. LITTLENESS NO CAUSE OF LEANNESS.

One feeds on lard, and yet is lean, And I but feasting with a bean Grow fat and smooth. The reason is: Jove prospers my meat more than his.

464. THE JIMMALL RING OR TRUE-LOVE KNOT.

Thou sent'st to me a true love-knot, but I Returned a ring of jimmals to imply Thy love had one knot, mine a triple tie.

Jimmal or _gimmal_, double or triple ring.

465. THE PARTING VERSE OR CHARGE TO HIS SUPPOSED WIFE WHEN HE TRAVELLED.

Go hence, and with this parting kiss, Which joins two souls, remember this: Though thou be'st young, kind, soft, and fair And may'st draw thousands with a hair; Yet let these glib temptations be Furies to others, friends to me. Look upon all, and though on fire Thou set their hearts, let chaste desire Steer thee to me, and think, me gone, In having all, that thou hast none. Nor so immured would I have Thee live, as dead and in thy grave; But walk abroad, yet wisely well Stand for my coming, sentinel. And think, as thou do'st walk the street, Me or my shadow thou do'st meet. I know a thousand greedy eyes Will on thy feature tyrannise In my short absence, yet behold Them like some picture, or some mould Fashion'd like thee, which, though 't have ears And eyes, it neither sees or hears. Gifts will be sent, and letters, which Are the expressions of that itch, And salt, which frets thy suitors; fly Both, lest thou lose thy liberty; For, that once lost, thou't fall to one, Then prostrate to a million. But if they woo thee, do thou say, As that chaste Queen of Ithaca Did to her suitors, this web

done, (Undone as oft as done), I'm won; I will not urge thee, for I know, Though thou art young, thou canst say no, And no again, and so deny Those thy lust-burning incubi. Let them enstyle thee fairest fair, The pearl of princes, yet despair That so thou art, because thou must Believe love speaks it not, but lust; And this their flattery does commend Thee chiefly for their pleasure's end. I am not jealous of thy faith, Or will be, for the axiom saith: He that doth suspect does haste A gentle mind to be unchaste. No, live thee to thy self, and keep Thy thoughts as cold as is thy sleep, And let thy dreams be only fed With this, that I am in thy bed; And thou, then turning in that sphere, Waking shalt find me sleeping there. But yet if boundless lust must scale Thy fortress, and will needs prevail, And wildly force a passage in, Banish consent, and 'tis no sin Of thine; so Lucrece fell and the Chaste Syracusian Cyane. So Medullina fell; yet none Of these had imputation For the least trespass, 'cause the mind Here was not with the act combin'd. _The body sins not, 'tis the will That makes the action, good or ill._ And if thy fall should this way come, Triumph in such a martyrdom. I will not over-long enlarge To thee this my religious charge. Take this compression, so by this Means I shall know what other kiss Is mixed with mine, and truly know, Returning, if't be mine or no: Keep it till then; and now, my spouse, For my wished safety pay thy vows And prayers to Venus; if it please The great blue ruler of the seas, Not many full-faced moons shall wane, Lean-horn'd, before I come again As one triumphant, when I find In thee all faith of womankind. Nor would I have thee think that thou Had'st power thyself to keep this vow, But, having 'scaped temptation's shelf, Know virtue taught thee, not thyself.

Queen of Ithaca, Penelope. _Incubi_, adulterous spirits. _Cyane_, a nymph of Syracuse, ravished by her father whom (and herself) she slew. _Medullina_, a Roman virgin who endured a like fate. _Compression_, embrace.

466. TO HIS KINSMAN, SIR THOS. SOAME.

Seeing thee, Soame, I see a goodly man, And in that good a great patrician. Next to which two, among the city powers And thrones, thyself one of those senators; Not wearing purple only for the show, As many conscripts of the city do, But for true service, worthy of that gown, The golden chain, too, and the civic crown.

Conscripts, "patres conscripti," aldermen.

467. TO BLOSSOMS.

Fair pledges of a fruitful tree, Why do ye fall so fast? Your date is not so past But you may stay yet here a while, To blush and gently smile; And go at last.

What! were ye born to be An hour or half's delight, And so to bid good-night? 'Twas pity Nature brought ye forth Merely to show your worth, And lose you quite.

But you are lovely leaves, where we May read how soon things have Their end, though ne'er so brave: And after they have shown their pride Like you a while, they glide Into the grave.

468. MAN'S DYING-PLACE UNCERTAIN.

Man knows where first he ships himself, but he Never can tell where shall his landing be.

469. NOTHING FREE-COST.

Nothing comes free-cost here; Jove will not let His gifts go from him, if not bought with sweat.

470. FEW FORTUNATE.

Many we are, and yet but few possess Those fields of everlasting happiness.

471. TO PERENNA.

How long, Perenna, wilt thou see Me languish for the love of thee? Consent, and play a friendly part To save, when thou may'st kill a heart.

472. TO THE LADIES.

Trust me, ladies, I will do Nothing to distemper you; If I any fret or vex, Men they shall be, not your sex.

473. THE OLD WIVES' PRAYER.

Holy rood, come forth and shield Us i' th' city and the field: Safely guard us, now and aye, From the blast that burns by day; And those sounds that us affright In the dead of dampish night. Drive all hurtful fiends us fro, By the time the cocks first crow.

475. UPON HIS DEPARTURE HENCE.

Thus I Pass by, And die: As one Unknown And gone: I'm made A shade, And laid I' th' grave: There have My cave, Where tell I dwell. Farewell.

476. THE WASSAIL.

Give way, give way, ye gates, and win An easy blessing to your bin And basket, by our entering in.

May both with manchet stand replete; Your larders, too, so hung with meat, That though a thousand, thousand eat,

Yet, ere twelve moons shall whirl about Their silv'ry spheres, there's none may doubt But more's sent in than was served out.

Next, may your dairies prosper so As that your pans no ebb may know; But if they do, the more to flow,

Like to a solemn sober stream Bank'd all with lilies, and the cream Of sweetest cowslips filling them.

Then, may your plants be prest with fruit, Nor bee, or hive you have be mute; But sweetly sounding like a lute.

Next, may your duck and teeming hen Both to the cock's tread say Amen; And for their two eggs render ten.

Last, may your harrows, shears, and ploughs, Your stacks, your stocks, your sweetest mows, All prosper by our virgin vows.

Alas! we bless, but see none here That brings us either ale or beer; _In a dry house all things are near_.

Let's leave a longer time to wait, Where rust and cobwebs bind the gate, And all live here with needy fate.

Where chimneys do for ever weep For want of warmth, and stomachs keep, With noise, the servants' eyes from sleep.

It is in vain to sing, or stay Our free feet here; but we'll away: Yet to the Lares this we'll say:

The time will come when you'll be sad And reckon this for fortune bad, T'ave lost the good ye might have had.

Manchet, fine white bread. _Prest_, laden. _Near_, penurious. _Leave to wait_, cease waiting.

477. UPON A LADY FAIR BUT FRUITLESS.

Twice has Pudica been a bride, and led By holy Hymen to the nuptial bed. Two youths she's known thrice two, and twice three years; Yet not a lily from the bed appears: Nor will; for why, Pudica this may know, _Trees never bear unless they first do blow_.

478. HOW SPRINGS CAME FIRST.

These springs were maidens once that lov'd, But lost to that they most approv'd: My story tells by Love they were Turn'd to these springs which we see here; The pretty whimpering that they make, When of the banks their leave they take, Tells ye but this, they are the same, In nothing chang'd but in their name.

479. TO ROSEMARY AND BAYS.

My wooing's ended: now my wedding's near When gloves are giving, gilded be you there.

481. UPON A SCAR IN A VIRGIN'S FACE.

'Tis heresy in others: in your face That scar's no schism, but the sign of grace.

482. UPON HIS EYESIGHT FAILING HIM.

I begin to wane in sight; Shortly I shall bid good-night: Then no gazing more about, When the tapers once are out.

483. TO HIS WORTHY FRIEND, M. THOS. FALCONBIRGE.

Stand with thy graces forth, brave man, and rise High with thine own auspicious destinies: Nor leave the search, and proof, till thou canst find These, or those ends, to which thou wast design'd. Thy lucky genius and thy guiding star Have made thee prosperous in thy ways thus far: Nor will they leave thee till they both have shown Thee to the world a prime and public one. Then, when thou see'st thine age all turn'd

to gold, Remember what thy Herrick thee foretold, When at the holy threshold of thine house _He boded good luck to thy self and spouse_. Lastly, be mindful, when thou art grown great, _That towers high rear'd dread most the lightning's threat: Whenas the humble cottages not fear The cleaving bolt of Jove the thunderer_.

484. UPON JULIA'S HAIR FILL'D WITH DEW.

Dew sat on Julia's hair And spangled too, Like leaves that laden are With trembling dew: Or glitter'd to my sight, As when the beams Have their reflected light Danc'd by the streams.

485. ANOTHER ON HER.

How can I choose but love and follow her Whose shadow smells like milder pomander? How can I choose but kiss her, whence does come The storax, spikenard, myrrh, and laudanum?

Pomander, ball of scent.

486. LOSS FROM THE LEAST.

Great men by small means oft are overthrown; _He's lord of thy life who contemns his own_.

487. REWARD AND PUNISHMENTS.

All things are open to these two events, Or to rewards, or else to punishments.

488. SHAME NO STATIST.

Shame is a bad attendant to a state: _He rents his crown that fears the people's hate_.

489. TO SIR CLIPSEBY CREW.

Since to the country first I came I have lost my former flame: And, methinks, I not inherit, As I did, my ravish'd spirit. If I write a verse or two, 'Tis with very much ado; In regard I want that wine Which should conjure up a line. Yet, though now of Muse bereft, I have still the manners left For to thank you, noble sir, For those gifts you do confer Upon him who only can Be in prose a grateful man.

490. UPON HIMSELF.

I could never love indeed; Never see mine own heart bleed: Never crucify my life, Or for widow, maid, or wife.

I could never seek to please One or many mistresses: Never like their lips to swear Oil of roses still smelt there.

I could never break my sleep, Fold mine arms, sob, sigh, or weep: Never beg, or humbly woo With oaths and lies, as others do.

I could never walk alone; Put a shirt of sackcloth on: Never keep a fast, or pray For good luck in love that day.

But have hitherto liv'd free As the air that circles me: And kept credit with my heart, Neither broke i' th' whole, or part.

491. FRESH CHEESE AND CREAM.

Would ye have fresh cheese and cream? Julia's breast can give you them: And, if more, each nipple cries: To your cream here's strawberries.

492. AN ECLOGUE OR PASTORAL BETWEEN ENDYMION PORTER AND LYCIDAS HERRICK, SET AND SUNG.

End. Ah! Lycidas, come tell me why Thy whilom merry oat By thee doth so neglected lie, And never purls a note?

I prithee speak. _Lyc._ I will. _End._ Say on. _Lyc._ 'Tis thou, and only thou, That art the cause, Endymion. _End._ For love's sake, tell me how.

Lyc. In this regard: that thou do'st play Upon another plain, And for a rural roundelay Strik'st now a courtly strain.

Thou leav'st our hills, our dales, our bowers, Our finer fleeced sheep, Unkind to us, to spend thine hours Where shepherds should not keep.

I mean the court: Let Latmos be My lov'd Endymion's court. _End._ But I the courtly state would see. _Lyc._ Then see it in report.

What has the court to do with swains, Where Phyllis is not known? Nor does it mind the rustic strains Of us, or Corydon.

Break, if thou lov'st us, this delay. _End._ Dear Lycidas, e're long I vow, by Pan, to come away And pipe unto thy song.

Then Jessamine, with Florabell, And dainty Amaryllis, With handsome-handed Drosomell Shall prank thy hook with lilies.

Lyc. Then Tityrus, and Corydon, And Thyrsis, they shall follow With all the rest; while thou alone Shalt lead like young Apollo.

And till thou com'st, thy Lycidas, In every genial cup, Shall write in spice: Endymion 'twas That kept his piping up.

And, my most lucky swain, when I shall live to see Endymion's moon to fill up full, remember me: Meantime, let Lycidas have leave to pipe to thee.

Oat, oaten pipe. _Prank_, bedeck. _Drosomell_, honey dew.

493. TO A BED OF TULIPS.

Bright tulips, we do know You had your coming hither, And fading-time does show That ye must quickly wither.

Your sisterhoods may stay, And smile here for your hour; But die ye must away, Even as the meanest flower.

Come, virgins, then, and see Your frailties, and bemoan ye; For, lost like these, 'twill be As time had never known ye.

494. A CAUTION.

That love last long, let it thy first care be To find a wife that is most fit for thee. Be she too wealthy or too poor, be sure _Love in extremes can never long endure_.

495. TO THE WATER NYMPHS DRINKING AT THE FOUNTAIN.

Reach, with your whiter hands, to me Some crystal of the spring; And I about the cup shall see Fresh lilies flourishing.

Or else, sweet nymphs, do you but this, To th' glass your lips incline; And I shall see by that one kiss The water turn'd to wine.

496. TO HIS HONOURED KINSMAN, SIR RICHARD STONE.

To this white temple of my heroes here, Beset with stately figures everywhere Of such rare saintships, who did here consume Their lives in sweets, and left in death perfume, Come, thou brave man! And bring with thee a stone Unto thine own edification. High are these statues here, besides no less Strong than the heavens for everlastingness: Where build aloft; and, being fix'd by these, Set up thine own eternal images.

497. UPON A FLY.

A golden fly one show'd to me, Clos'd in a box of ivory, Where both seem'd proud: the fly to have His burial in an ivory grave; The ivory took state to hold A corpse as bright as burnish'd gold. One fate had both, both equal grace; The buried, and the burying-place. Not Virgil's gnat, to whom the spring All flowers sent to's burying; Not Martial's bee, which in a bead Of amber quick was buried; Nor that fine worm that does inter Herself i' th' silken sepulchre; Nor my rare Phil,[K] that lately was With lilies tomb'd up in a glass; More honour had than this same fly, Dead, and closed up in ivory.

Virgil's gnat, see 256. _Martial's bee_, see Note.

[K] _Sparrow._ (Note in the original edition.)

499. TO JULIA.

Julia, when thy Herrick dies, Close thou up thy poet's eyes: And his last breath, let it be Taken in by none but thee.

500. TO MISTRESS DOROTHY PARSONS.

If thou ask me, dear, wherefore I do write of thee no more, I must answer, sweet, thy part Less is here than in my heart.

502. HOW HE WOULD DRINK HIS WINE.

Fill me my wine in crystal; thus, and thus I see't in's _puris naturalibus_: Unmix'd. I love to have it smirk and shine; _'Tis sin I know, 'tis sin to throttle wine_. What madman's he, that when it sparkles so, Will cool his flames or quench his fires with snow?

503. HOW MARIGOLDS CAME YELLOW.

Jealous girls these sometimes were, While they liv'd or lasted here: Turn'd to flowers, still they be Yellow, mark'd for jealousy.

504. THE BROKEN CRYSTAL.

To fetch me wine my Lucia went, Bearing a crystal continent: But, making haste, it came to pass She brake in two the purer glass, Then smil'd, and sweetly chid her speed; So with a blush beshrew'd the deed.

Continent, holder.

505. PRECEPTS.

Good precepts we must firmly hold, By daily learning we wax old.

506. TO THE RIGHT HONOURABLE EDWARD, EARL OF DORSET.

If I dare write to you, my lord, who are Of your own self a public theatre, And, sitting, see the wiles, ways, walks of wit, And give a righteous judgment upon it, What need I care, though some dislike me should, If Dorset say what Herrick writes is good? We know y'are learn'd i' th' Muses, and no less In our state-sanctions, deep or bottomless. Whose smile can make a poet, and your glance Dash all bad poems out of countenance; So that an author needs no other bays For coronation than your only praise, And no one mischief greater than your frown To null his numbers, and to blast his crown. _Few live the life immortal. He ensures His fame's long life who strives to set up yours._

507. UPON HIMSELF.

Thou'rt hence removing (like a shepherd's tent), And walk thou must the way that others went: Fall thou must first, then rise to life with these, Mark'd in thy book for faithful witnesses.

508. HOPE WELL AND HAVE WELL: OR, FAIR AFTER FOUL WEATHER.

What though the heaven be lowering now, And look with a contracted brow? We shall discover, by-and-by, A repurgation of the sky; And when those clouds away are driven, Then will appear a cheerful heaven.

509. UPON LOVE.

I held Love's head while it did ache; But so it chanc'd to be, The cruel pain did his forsake, And forthwith came to me.

Ay me! how shall my grief be still'd? Or where else shall we find One like to me, who must be kill'd For being too-too kind?

510. TO HIS KINSWOMAN, MRS. PENELOPE WHEELER.

Next is your lot, fair, to be number'd one, Here, in my book's canonisation: Late you come in; but you a saint shall be, In chief, in this poetic liturgy.

511. ANOTHER UPON HER.

First, for your shape, the curious cannot show Any one part that's dissonant in you: And 'gainst your chaste behaviour there's no plea, Since you are known to be

Penelope. Thus fair and clean you are, although there be _A mighty strife 'twixt form and chastity_.

Form, beauty.

513. CROSS AND PILE.

Fair and foul days trip cross and pile; the fair Far less in number than our foul days are.

Trip cross and pile, come haphazard, like the heads and tails of coins.

514. TO THE LADY CREW, UPON THE DEATH OF HER CHILD.

Why, madam, will ye longer weep, Whenas your baby's lull'd asleep? And (pretty child) feels now no more Those pains it lately felt before. All now is silent; groans are fled: Your child lies still, yet is not dead; But rather like a flower hid here To spring again another year.

515. HIS WINDING-SHEET.

Come thou, who art the wine and wit Of all I've writ: The grace, the glory, and the best Piece of the rest. Thou art of what I did intend The all and end; And what was made, was made to meet Thee, thee, my sheet. Come then, and be to my chaste side Both bed and bride. We two, as reliques left, will have One rest, one grave. And, hugging close, we will not fear Lust entering here, Where all desires are dead or cold As is the mould; And all affections are forgot, Or trouble not. Here, here the slaves and pris'ners be From shackles free: And weeping widows long oppress'd Do here find rest. The wronged client ends his laws Here, and his cause. Here those long suits of chancery lie Quiet, or die: And all Star-Chamber bills do cease, Or hold their peace. Here needs no Court for our Request, Where all are best, All wise, all equal, and all just Alike i' th' dust. Nor need we here to fear the frown Of court or crown: _Where fortune bears no sway o'er things, There all are kings_. In this securer place we'll keep, As lull'd asleep; Or for a little time we'll lie As robes laid by; To be another day re-worn, Turn'd, but not torn: Or, like old testaments engrost, Lock'd up, not lost. And for a while lie here conceal'd, To be reveal'd Next at that great Platonick year, And then meet here.

Platonick year, the 36,000th year, in which all persons and things return to their original state.

516. TO MISTRESS MARY WILLAND.

One more by thee, love, and desert have sent, T' enspangle this expansive firmament. O flame of beauty! come, appear, appear A virgin taper, ever shining here.

517. CHANGE GIVES CONTENT.

What now we like anon we disapprove: _The new successor drives away old love_.

519. ON HIMSELF.

Born I was to meet with age, And to walk life's pilgrimage. Much I know of time is spent, Tell I can't what's resident. Howsoever, cares, adieu! I'll have nought to say to you: But I'll spend my coming hours Drinking wine and crown'd with flowers.

Resident, remaining.

520. FORTUNE FAVOURS.

Fortune did never favour one Fully, without exception; Though free she be, there's something yet Still wanting to her favourite.

521. TO PHYLLIS, TO LOVE AND LIVE WITH HIM.

Live, live with me, and thou shall see The pleasures I'll prepare for thee; What sweets the country can afford Shall bless thy bed and bless thy board. The soft, sweet moss shall be thy bed With crawling woodbine over-spread; By which the silver-shedding streams Shall gently melt thee into dreams. Thy clothing, next, shall be a gown Made of the fleece's purest down. The tongues of kids shall be thy meat, Their milk thy drink; and thou shalt eat The paste of filberts for thy bread, With cream of cowslips buttered; Thy feasting-tables shall be hills With daisies spread and daffodils, Where thou shalt sit, and red-breast by, For meat, shall give thee melody. I'll give thee chains and carcanets Of primroses and violets. A bag and bottle thou shalt have, That richly wrought, and this as brave; So that as either shall express The wearer's no mean shepherdess. At shearing-times, and yearly wakes, When Themilis his pastime makes, There thou shalt be; and be the wit, Nay, more, the feast, and grace of it. On holidays, when virgins meet To dance the heyes with nimble feet, Thou shall come forth, and then appear The queen of roses for that year; And having danced, 'bove all the best, Carry the garland from the rest. In wicker baskets maids shall bring To thee, my dearest shepherling, The blushing apple, bashful pear, And shame-fac'd plum, all simp'ring there. Walk in the groves, and thou shalt find The name of Phyllis in the rind Of every straight and smooth-skin tree; Where kissing that, I'll twice kiss thee. To thee a sheep-hook I will send, Be-prank'd with ribands to this end; This, this alluring hook might be Less for to catch a sheep than me. Thou shalt have possets, wassails fine, Not made of ale, but spiced wine, To make thy maids and self free mirth, All sitting near the glitt'ring hearth. Thou shalt have ribands, roses, rings, Gloves, garters, stockings, shoes, and strings Of winning colours, that shall move Others to lust, but me to love. These, nay, and more, thine own shall be If thou wilt love, and live with me.

Carcanets, necklaces. _Wakes_, village feasts on the dedication day of the church. _The heyes_, a winding, country dance. _Be-prank'd_, be-decked.

522. TO HIS KINSWOMAN, MISTRESS SUSANNA HERRICK.

When I consider, dearest, thou dost stay But here a-while, to languish and decay, Like to these garden-glories, which here be The flowery-sweet resemblances of thee; With grief of heart, methinks, I thus do cry: Would thou hadst ne'er been born, or might'st not die.

523. UPON MISTRESS SUSANNA SOUTHWELL, HER CHEEKS.

Rare are thy cheeks, Susanna, which do show Ripe cherries smiling, while that others blow.

524. UPON HER EYES.

Clear are her eyes, Like purest skies, Discovering from thence A baby there That turns each sphere, Like an Intelligence.

A baby, see Note to 38, "To his mistress objecting to him neither toying nor talking".

525. UPON HER FEET.

Her pretty feet Like snails did creep A little out, and then, As if they played at Bo-Peep, Did soon draw in again.

526. TO HIS HONOURED FRIEND, SIR JOHN MINCE.

For civil, clean, and circumcised wit, And for the comely carriage of it, Thou art the man, the only man best known, Mark'd for the true wit of a million: From whom we'll reckon. Wit came in but since The calculation of thy birth, brave Mince.

527. UPON HIS GREY HAIRS.

Fly me not, though I be grey: Lady, this I know you'll say; Better look the roses red When with white commingled. Black your hairs are, mine are white; This begets the more delight, When things meet most opposite: As in pictures we descry Venus standing Vulcan by.

528. ACCUSATION.

If accusation only can draw blood, None shall be guiltless, be he ne'er so good.

529. PRIDE ALLOWABLE IN POETS.

As thou deserv'st, be proud; then gladly let The Muse give thee the Delphic coronet.

530. A VOW TO MINERVA.

Goddess, I begin an art; Come thou in, with thy best part For to make the texture lie Each way smooth and civilly; And a broad-fac'd owl shall be Offer'd up with vows to thee.

Civilly, orderly. _Owl_, the bird sacred to Athene or Minerva.

534. TO ELECTRA.

'Tis evening, my sweet, And dark, let us meet; Long time w'ave here been a-toying, And never, as yet, That season could get Wherein t'ave had an enjoying.

For pity or shame, Then let not love's flame Be ever and ever a-spending; Since now to the port The path is but short, And yet our way has no ending.

Time flies away fast, Our hours do waste, The while we never remember How soon our life, here, Grows old with the year That dies with the next December.

535. DISCORD NOT DISADVANTAGEOUS.

Fortune no higher project can devise Than to sow discord 'mongst the enemies.

536. ILL GOVERNMENT.

Preposterous is that government, and rude, When kings obey the wilder multitude.

Preposterous, lit. hind-part before.

537. TO MARIGOLDS.

Give way, and be ye ravish'd by the sun, And hang the head whenas the act is done, Spread as he spreads, wax less as he does wane; And as he shuts, close up to maids again.

538. TO DIANEME.

Give me one kiss And no more: If so be this Makes you poor, To enrich you, I'll restore For that one two Thousand score.

539. TO JULIA, THE FLAMINICA DIALIS OR QUEEN-PRIEST.

Thou know'st, my Julia, that it is thy turn This morning's incense to prepare and burn. The chaplet and Inarculum[L] here be, With the white vestures, all attending thee. This day the queen-priest thou art made, t' appease Love for our very many trespasses. One chief transgression is, among the rest, Because with flowers her temple was not dressed; The next, because her altars did not shine With daily fires; the last, neglect of wine; For which her wrath is gone forth to consume Us all, unless preserved by thy perfume. Take then thy censer, put in fire, and thus, O pious priestess! make a peace for us. For our neglect Love did our death decree; That we escape. _Redemption comes by thee_.

[L] A twig of a pomegranate, which the queen-priest did use to wear on her head at sacrificing. (Note in the original edition.)

540. ANACREONTIC.

Born I was to be old, And for to die here: After that, in the mould Long for to lie here. But before that day comes Still I be bousing, For I know in the tombs There's no carousing.

541. MEAT WITHOUT MIRTH.

Eaten I have; and though I had good cheer, I did not sup, because no friends were there. Where mirth and friends are absent when we dine Or sup, there wants the incense and the wine.

542. LARGE BOUNDS DO BUT BURY US.

All things o'er-ruled are here by chance: The greatest man's inheritance, Where'er the lucky lot doth fall, Serves but for place of burial.

543. UPON URSLEY.

Ursley, she thinks those velvet patches grace The candid temples of her comely face; But he will say, whoe'er those circlets seeth, They be but signs of Ursley's hollow teeth.

544. AN ODE TO SIR CLIPSEBY CREW.

Here we securely live and eat The cream of meat, And keep eternal fires, By which we sit, and do divine As wine And rage inspires.

If full we charm, then call upon Anacreon To grace the frantic thyrse; And having drunk, we raise a shout Throughout To praise his verse.

Then cause we Horace to be read, Which sung, or said, A goblet to the brim Of lyric wine, both swell'd and crown'd, Around We quaff to him.

Thus, thus we live, and spend the hours In wine and flowers, And make the frolic year, The month, the week, the instant day To stay The longer here.

Come then, brave knight, and see the cell Wherein I dwell, And my enchantments too, Which love and noble freedom is; And this Shall fetter you.

Take horse, and come, or be so kind To send your mind, Though but in numbers few, And I shall think I have the heart, Or part Of Clipseby Crew.

Securely, free from care. _Thyrse_, a Bacchic staff. _Instant_, oncoming. _Numbers_, verses.

545. TO HIS WORTHY KINSMAN, MR. STEPHEN SOAME.

Nor is my number full till I inscribe Thee, sprightly Soame, one of my righteous tribe; A tribe of one lip, leaven, and of one Civil behaviour, and religion; A stock of saints, where ev'ry one doth wear A stole of white, and canonised here; Among which holies be thou ever known, Brave kinsman, mark'd out with the whiter stone Which seals thy glory, since I do prefer Thee here in my eternal calender.

546. TO HIS TOMB-MAKER.

Go I must; when I am gone, Write but this upon my stone: Chaste I lived, without a wife, That's the story of my life. Strewings need none, every flower Is in this word, bachelour.

547. GREAT SPIRITS SUPERVIVE.

Our mortal parts may wrapp'd in sear-cloths lie: _Great spirits never with their bodies die_.

548. NONE FREE FROM FAULT.

Out of the world he must, who once comes in. _No man exempted is from death, or sin._

549. UPON HIMSELF BEING BURIED.

Let me sleep this night away, Till the dawning of the day; Then at th' opening of mine eyes I, and all the world, shall rise.

550. PITY TO THE PROSTRATE.

'Tis worse than barbarous cruelty to show No part of pity on a conquered foe.

552. HIS CONTENT IN THE COUNTRY.

Here, here I live with what my board Can with the smallest cost afford. Though ne'er so mean the viands be, They well content my Prew and me. Or pea, or bean, or wort, or beet, Whatever comes, content makes sweet. Here we rejoice, because no rent We pay for our poor tenement, Wherein we rest, and never fear The landlord or the usurer. The quarter-day does ne'er affright Our peaceful slumbers in the night. We eat our own and batten more, Because we feed on no man's score; But pity those whose flanks grow great, Swell'd with the lard of others' meat. We bless our fortunes when we see Our own beloved privacy; And like our living, where we're known To very few, or else to none.

Prew, _i.e._, his servant, Prudence Baldwin.

553. THE CREDIT OF THE CONQUEROR.

He who commends the vanquished, speaks the power And glorifies the worthy conqueror.

554. ON HIMSELF.

Some parts may perish, die thou canst not all: The most of thee shall 'scape the funeral.

556. THE FAIRIES.

If ye will with Mab find grace, Set each platter in his place; Rake the fire up, and get Water in, ere sun be set. Wash your pails, and cleanse your dairies; Sluts are loathsome to the fairies; Sweep your house, who doth not so, Mab will pinch her by the toe.

557. TO HIS HONOURED FRIEND, M. JOHN WEARE, COUNCILLOR.

Did I or love, or could I others draw To the indulgence of the rugged law, The first foundation of that zeal should be By reading all her paragraphs in thee, Who dost so fitly with the laws unite, As if you two were one hermaphrodite. Nor courts[t] thou her because she's well attended With wealth, but for those ends she was intended: Which were,--and still her offices are known,-- _Law is to give to ev'ry one his own_; To shore the feeble up against the strong, To shield the stranger and the poor from wrong. This was the founder's grave and good intent: To keep the outcast in his tenement, To free the orphan from that wolf-like man, Who is his butcher more than guardian; To dry the widow's tears, and stop her swoons, By pouring balm and oil into her wounds. This was the old way; and 'tis yet thy course To keep those pious principles in force. Modest I will be; but one word I'll say, Like to a sound that's vanishing away, Sooner the inside of thy hand shall grow Hisped and hairy, ere thy palm shall know A postern-bribe took, or a forked fee, To fetter Justice, when she might be free. _Eggs I'll not shave_; but yet, brave man, if I Was destin'd forth to golden sovereignty, A prince I'd be, that I might thee prefer To be my counsel both

and chancellor.

Hisped (_hispidus_), rough with hairs. _Postern-bribe_, a back-door bribe. _Forked fee_, a fee from both sides in a case; cp. Ben Jonson's _Volpone_: "Give forked counsel, take provoking gold on either hand". _Eggs I'll not shave_, a proverb.

560. THE WATCH.

Man is a watch, wound up at first, but never Wound up again: once down, he's down for ever. The watch once down, all motions then do cease; And man's pulse stop'd, all passions sleep in peace.

561. LINES HAVE THEIR LININGS, AND BOOKS THEIR BUCKRAM.

As in our clothes, so likewise he who looks, Shall find much farcing buckram in our books.

Farcing, stuffing.

562. ART ABOVE NATURE: TO JULIA.

When I behold a forest spread With silken trees upon thy head, And when I see that other dress Of flowers set in comeliness; When I behold another grace In the ascent of curious lace, Which like a pinnacle doth show The top, and the top-gallant too. Then, when I see thy tresses bound Into an oval, square, or round, And knit in knots far more than I Can tell by tongue, or true-love tie; Next, when those lawny films I see Play with a wild civility, And all those airy silks to flow, Alluring me, and tempting so: I must confess mine eye and heart Dotes less on Nature than on Art.

Civility, order.

564. UPON HIS KINSWOMAN, MISTRESS BRIDGET HERRICK.

Sweet Bridget blush'd, and therewithal Fresh blossoms from her cheeks did fall. I thought at first 'twas but a dream, Till after I had handled them And smelt them, then they smelt to me As blossoms of the almond tree.

565. UPON LOVE.

I played with Love, as with the fire The wanton Satyr did; Nor did I know, or could descry What under there was hid.

That Satyr he but burnt his lips; But mine's the greater smart, For kissing Love's dissembling chips The fire scorch'd my heart.

The wanton Satyr, see Note.

566. UPON A COMELY AND CURIOUS MAID.

If men can say that beauty dies, Marbles will swear that here it lies. If, reader, then thou canst forbear In public loss to shed a tear, The dew of grief upon this stone Will tell thee pity thou hast none.

567. UPON THE LOSS OF HIS FINGER.

One of the five straight branches of my hand Is lop'd already, and the rest but stand Expecting when to fall, which soon will be; First dies the leaf, the bough next, next the tree.

568. UPON IRENE.

Angry if Irene be But a minute's life with me: Such a fire I espy Walking in and out her eye, As at once I freeze and fry.

569. UPON ELECTRA'S TEARS.

Upon her cheeks she wept, and from those showers Sprang up a sweet nativity of flowers.

NOTES.

NOTES.

2. _Whither, mad maiden_, etc. From Martial, I. iv. 11, 12:--

Aetherias, lascive, cupis volitare per auras: I, fuge; sed poteras tutior esse domi.

But for the Court. Cp. Martial, I. iv. 3, 4.

4. _While Brutus standeth by._ "Brutus and Cato are commonplaces of examples of severe virtue": Grosart. But Herrick is translating. This is from Martial, XI. xvi. 9, 10:--

Erubuit posuitque meum Lucretia librum, Sed coram Bruto; Brute, recede, leget.

8. _When he would have his verses read._ The thought throughout this poem is taken from Martial, X. xix., beginning:--

Nec doctum satis et parum severum, Sed non rusticulum nimis libellum Facundo mea Plinio, Thalia, I perfer:

where the address to Thalia perhaps explains Herrick's "do not _thou_ rehearse". The important lines are:--

Sed ne tempore non tuo disertam Pulses ebria januam, videto. ... ... Seras tutior ibis ad lucernas. Hæc hora est tua, cum furit Lyæus, Cum regnat rosa, cum madent capilli: Tunc me vel rigidi legant Catones.

When laurel spirts i' th' fire. Burning bay leaves was a Christmas observance. Herrick sings:--

"Of crackling laurel, which foresounds A plenteous harvest to your grounds":

where compare Tibull. II. v. 81-84. It was also used by maids as a love omen.

Thyrse ... sacred Orgies. Herrick's glosses show that the passage he had in mind was Catullus, lxiv. 256-269:--

Harum pars tecta quatiebant cuspide thyrsos ... ... Pars obscura cavis celebrabant orgia cistis, Orgia, quæ frustra cupiunt audire profani.

10. _No man at one time can be wise and love._ Amare et sapere vix deo conceditur. (Publius Syrus.) The quotation is found in both Burton and Montaigne.

12. _Who fears to ask_, etc. From Seneca, _Hippol._ 594-95. Qui timide rogat ... docet negare.

15. _Goddess Isis ... with her scent._ Cp. Plutarch, _De Iside et Osiride_, 15.

17. _He acts the crime._ Seneca: Nil interest faveas sceleri an illud facias.

18. _Two things odious._ From Ecclus. xxv. 2.

31. _A Sister ... about I'll lead._ "Have we not power to lead about a sister, a wife?" 1 Cor. ix. 5.

35. _Mercy and Truth live with thee._ 2 Sam. xv. 20.

38. _To please those babies in your eyes._ The phrase "babies [_i.e._, dolls] in the eyes" is probably only a translation of its metaphor, involved in the use of the Latin _pupilla_ (a little girl), or "pupil," for the central spot of the eye. The metaphor doubtless arose from the small reflections of the inlooker, which appear in the eyes of the person gazed at; but we meet with it both intensified, as in the phrase "to look babies in the eyes" (= to peer amorously), and with its origin disregarded, as in Herrick, where the "babies" are the pupils, and have an existence independent of any inlooker.

Small griefs find tongue. Seneca, _Hippol._ 608:

Curæ leves loquuntur, ingentes stupent.

Full casks. So G. Herbert, _Jacula Prudentum_ (1640): Empty vessels sound most.

48. _Thus woe succeeds a woe as wave a wave._ Horace, Ep. II. ii. 176: Velut unda supervenit unda. Κύματα κακῶν and κακῶν τρικυμία are common phrases in Greek tragedy.

49. _Cherry-pit._ Printed in the 1654 edition of _Witts Recreations_, where it appears as:--

"_Nicholas_ and _Nell_ did lately sit Playing for sport at cherry-pit; They both did throw, and, having thrown, He got the pit and she the stone".

51. _Ennobled numbers._ This poem is often quoted to prove that Herrick's country incumbency was good for his verse; but if the reference be only to his sacred poems or _Noble Numbers_ these would rather prove the opposite.

52. _O earth, earth, earth, hear thou my voice._ Jerem. xxii. 29: O earth, earth, earth, hear the word of the Lord.

56. _Love give me more such nights as these._ A reminiscence of Marlowe's version of Ovid, _Amor_. I. v. 26: "Jove send me more such afternoons as this".

72. _Upon his Sister-in-law, Mistress Elizabeth Herrick_, wife to his brother Thomas (see _infra_, 106).

74. _Love makes me write what shame forbids to speak._ Ovid, _Phædra to Hippol._: Dicere quæ puduit scribere jussit amor.

Give me a kiss. Herrick is here imitating the well-known lines of Catullus to Lesbia (_Carm._ v.):--

Da mi basia mille, deinde centum, Dein mille altera, dein secunda centum, Deinde usque altera mille, deinde centum, Dein, cum millia multa fecerimus, Conturbabimus illa, ne sciamus, etc.

77. _To the King, upon his coming with his army into the west._ Essex had marched into the west in June, 1644, relieved Lyme, and captured royal fortresses in Dorset and Devon. Charles followed him into "the drooping west," and, in September, the Parliamentary infantry were forced to surrender, while Essex himself escaped by sea. Herrick's "white omens" were thus fulfilled.

79. _To the King and Queen upon their unhappy distances._ Henrietta Maria escaped abroad with the crown jewels in 1642, returned the next year and rejoined Charles in the west in 1644, whence she escaped again to France. This poem has been supposed to refer to domestic dissensions; but the "ball of strife" is surely the Civil War in general, and the reference to the parting of 1644.

81. _The Cheat of Cupid._ Herrick is here translating "Anacreon," 31 [3]:--

Μεσονυκτίοις ποθ' ὥραις στρέφεθ' ἡνίκ' Ἄρκτος ἤδη κατὰ χεῖρα τὴν Βοώτου, μερόπων δὲ φῦλα πάντα κέαται κόπῳ δαμέντα, 5 τότ' Ἔρως ἐπισταθείς μευ θυρέων ἔκοπτ' ὀχῆας. τίς, ἔφην, θύρας ἀράσσει; κατά μευ σχίζεις ὀνείρους. ὁ δ' Ἔρως, ἄνοιγε, φησίν· 10 βρέφος εἰμί, μὴ φόβησαι· βρέχομαι δὲ κἀσέληνον κατὰ νύκτα πεπλάνημαι. ἐλέησα ταῦτ' ἀκούσας, ἀνὰ δ' εὐθὺ λύχνον ἅψας 15 ἀνέῳξα, καὶ βρέφος μέν ἐσορῶ φέροντα τόξον πτέρυγάς τε καὶ φαρέτρην. παρὰ δ' ἱστίην καθῖσα, παλάμαις τε χεῖρας αὐτοῦ 20 ἀνέθαλπον, ἐκ δὲ χαίτης ἀπέθλιβον ὑγρὸν ὕδωρ. ὁ δ', ἐπεὶ κρύος μεθῆκεν, φέρε, φησί, πειράσωμεν τόδε τόξον, εἴ τι μοι νῦν 25 βλάβεται βραχεῖσα νευρή. τανύει δὲ καί με τύπτει μέσον ἦπαρ, ὥσπερ οἶστρος· ἀνὰ δ' ἄλλεται καχάζων, ξένε δ', εἶπε, συγχάρηθι· 30 κέρας ἀβλαβὲς μὲν ἡμῖν, σὺ δὲ καρδίην πονήσεις.

Some of his phrases, however, prove that he was occasionally more indebted to the Latin version of Stephanus than to the original.

82. _That for seven lusters I did never come._ The fall of Herrick's father from a window, fifteen months after the poet's birth, was imputed at the time to suicide; and it has been reasonably conjectured that some mystery may have attached to the place of his burial. If "seven lusters" can be taken literally for thirty-five years, this poem was written in 1627.

83. _Delight in Disorder._ Cp. Ben Jonson's "Still to be neat, still to be drest," in its turn imitated from one of the _Basia_ of Johannes Bonefonius.

85. _Upon Love._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1654. The only variant is "To tell me" for "To signifie" in the third line.

86. _To Dean Bourn._ "We found many persons in the village who could repeat some of his lines, and none who were not acquainted with his 'Farewell to Dean Bourn,' which they said he uttered as he crossed the brook upon being ejected by Cromwell from the vicarage, to which he had been presented by Charles the First. But they added, with an air of innocent triumph, 'he did see it again,' as was the fact after the restoration." Barron Field in _Quarterly Review_, August, 1810. Herrick was ejected in 1648.

A rocky generation! a people currish. Cp. Burton, II. iii. 2: a rude ... uncivil, wild, currish generation.

91. _That man loves not who is not zealous too._ Augustine, _Adv. Adimant._ 13: Qui non zelat, non amat.

92. _The Bag of the Bee._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1654, and in Henry Bold's _Wit a-sporting in a Pleasant Grove of new Fancies_, 1657. Set to music by Henry Lawes.

93. _Luxurious love by wealth is nourished._ Ovid, _Remed. Amor._ 746: Divitiis alitur luxuriosus amor.

95. _Homer himself._ Indignor quandoque bonus dormitat Homerus. Horace, _De Art. Poet._ 359.

100. _To bread and water none is poor._ Seneca, _Excerpt._ ii. 887: Panem et aquam Natura desiderat; nemo ad haec pauper est.

Nature with little is content. Seneca, _Ep._ xvi.: Exiguum Natura desiderat. _Ep._ lx.: parvo Natura dimittitur.

106. _A Country Life: To his brother, M. Tho. Herrick._ "Thomas, baptized May 12, 1588, was placed by his uncle and guardian, Sir William Heyrick, with Mr. Massam, a merchant in London; but in 1610 he appears to have returned into the country and to have settled in a small farm. It is supposed that this Thomas was the father of Thomas Heyrick, who in 1668 resided at Market Harborough and issued a trader's token there, and grandfather to the Thomas who was curate of Harborough and published some sermons and poems." Hill's _Market Harborough_, p. 122.

A MS. version of this poem is contained in Ashmole 38, from which Dr. Grosart gives a full collation on pp. cli.-cliii. of his Memorial Introduction. The MS. appears to follow an unrevised version of the poem, and contains a few couplets which Herrick afterwards thought fit to omit. The most important passage comes after line 92: "Virtue had, and mov'd her sphere".

"Nor know thy happy and unenvied state Owes more to virtue than to fate, Or fortune too; for what the first secures, That as herself, or heaven, endures. The two last fail, and by experience make Known, not they give again, they take."

Thrice and above blest. Felices ter et amplius, Hor. I. _Od._ xiii. 7.

My soul's half: Animæ dimidium meæ, Hor. I. _Od._ iii. 8. The poem is full of such reminiscences: "With holy meal and spirting (MS. crackling) salt" is the "Farre pio et

saliente mica" of III. _Od._ xxiii. 20; "Untaught to suffer poverty" the "Indocilis pauperiem pati" of I. _Od._ i. 18; "A heart thrice wall'd" comes from I. _Od._ iii. 9: Illi robur et æs triplex, etc. Similar instances might be multiplied. Note, too, the use of "Lar" and "Genius".

Jove for our labour all things sells us. Epicharm. apud Xenoph. _Memor._ II. i. 20, τῶν πόνων Πωλοῦσιν ἡμῖν πάντα τἀγαθ' οἱ θεοί. Quoted by Montaigne, II. xx.

Wisely true to thine own self. Possibly a Shakespearian reminiscence of the "to thine own self be true" in the speech of Polonius to Laertes, Hamlet, I. iii. 78.

A wise man every way lies square. Cp. Arist. _Eth._ I. x. 11, ὡς ἀληθῶς ἀγαθὸς καὶ τετράγωνος ἄνευ ψόγου.

For seldom use commends the pleasure. Voluptates commendat rarior usus. Juvenal, _Sat._ xi. ad fin.

Nor fear or wish your dying day. Summum nec metuas diem, nec optes. Mart. X. xlvii. 13.

112. _To the Earl of Westmoreland._ Mildmay Fane succeeded his father, Thomas Fane, the first earl, in March, 1628. At the outbreak of the Civil War he sided with the king, but after a short imprisonment made his submission to the Parliament, and was relieved of the sequestration of his estates. He subsequently printed privately a volume of poems, called _Otia Sacra_, which has been re-edited by Dr. Grosart.

117. _To the Patron of Poets, M. End. Porter._ Five of Herrick's poems are addressed to Endymion Porter, who seems to have been looked to as a patron by all the singers of his day. According to the inscription on a medal of him executed by Varin in 1635, he was then forty-eight, so that he was born in 1587, coming into the world at Aston-under-Hill in Gloucestershire. He went with Charles on his trip to Spain, and after his accession became groom of his bedchamber, was active in the king's service during the Civil War, and died in 1649. He was a collector of works of art both for himself and for the king, and encouraged Rob. Dover's Cotswold games by presenting him with a suit of the king's clothes. À Wood tells us this, and mentions also that he was a friend of Donne, that Gervase Warmsely dedicated his _Virescit Vulnere Virtus_ to him in 1628, and that in conjunction with the Earl of St. Alban's he also received the dedication of Davenant's _Madagascar_.

Let there be patrons, etc. Burton, I. ii. 3, § 15. 'Tis an old saying: "Sint Mæcenates, non deerunt, Flacce, Marones" (Mart. VIII. lvi. 5).

Fabius, Cotta, and Lentulus are examples of Roman patrons of poetry, themselves distinguished. Cp. Juvenal, vii. 94.

119. _His tapers thus put out._ So Ovid, _Am._ iii. 9:--

Ecce puer Veneris fert eversamque pharetram Et fractos arcus, et sine luce facem.

121. _Four things make us happy here._ From

Ὑγιαίνειν μὲν ἄριστον ἀνδρὶ θνατῷ· δεύτερον δὲ φυὰν καλὸν γενέσθαι· τὸ τρίτον δὲ πλουτεῖν αδόλως· καὶ τὸ τέταρτον, ἡβᾶν μετὰ τῶν φίλων. (Bergk, _Anth. Lyr._,

Scol. 8.)

123. _The Tear sent to her from Staines._ This is printed in _Witts Recreations_ with no other variation than in the title, which there runs: "A Teare sent his Mistresse". Dr. Grosart notes that Staines was at the time a royal residence.

128. _His Farewell to Sack._ A manuscript version of this poem at the British Museum omits many lines (7, 8, 11-22, 29-36), and contains few important variants. "Of the yet chaste and undefiled bride" is a poor anticipation of line 6, and "To raise the holy madness" for "To rouse the sacred madness" is also weak. For the line and a half:--

"Prithee not smile Or smile more inly, lest thy looks beguile,"

we have the very inferior passage:--

"I prithee draw in Thy gazing fires, lest at their sight the sin Of fierce idolatry shoot into me, and I turn apostate to the strict command Of nature; bid me now farewell, or smile More ugly, lest thy tempting looks beguile".

This MS. version is followed in the first published text in _Witts Recreations_, 1645.

130. _Upon Mrs. Eliz. Wheeler._ "The lady complimented in this poem was probably a relation by marriage. Herrick's first cousin, Martha, the seventh daughter of his uncle Robert, married Mr. John Wheeler." Nott.

132. _Fold now thine arms._ A sign of grief. Cp. "His arms in this sad knot". _Tempest._

134. _Mr. J. Warr._ This John Warr is probably the same as the "honoured friend, Mr. John Weare, Councellour," of a later poem. Dr. Grosart quotes an "Epitaph upon his honoured friend, Master Warre," by Randolph. Nothing is known of him, but I find in the Oxford Register that a John Warr matriculated at Exeter College, 16th May, 1619, and proceeded M.A. in 1624. He may possibly be Herrick's friend.

137. _Dowry with a wife._ Cp. Ovid, _Ars Am._ ii. 155: Dos est uxoria lites.

139. _The Wounded Cupid._ This is taken from Anacreon, 33 [40]:--

Ἔρως ποτ' ἐν ῥόδοισιν κοιμωμένην μέλιτταν οὐκ εἶδεν, ἀλλ' ἐτοώθη τὸν δάκτυλον· παταχθείς τὰς χεῖρας ὠλόλυξεν· δραμὼν δὲ καὶ πετασθεις πρὸς τὴν καλὴν Κυθήρην ὄλωλα, μᾶτερ, εἶπεν, ὄλωλα κἀποθνήσκω· ὄφις μ' ἔτυψε μικρός πτερωτός, ὃν καλοῦσιν μέλιτταν οἱ γεωργοί. ἁ δ' εἶπεν· εἰ τὸ κέντρον πονεῖ τὸ τᾶς μελίττας, πόσον δοκεῖς πονοῦσιν, Ἔρως, ὅσους σὺ βάλλεις;

142. _A Virgin's face she had._ Herrick is imitating a charming passage from the first Æneid (ll. 315-320), in which Æneas is confronted by Venus:--

Virginis os habitumque gerens et virginis arma, Spartanae vel qualis equos Threissa fatigat Harpalyce volucremque fuga praevertitur Eurum. Namque umeris de more habilem suspenderat arcum Venatrix, dederatque comam diffundere ventis, Nuda genu nodoque sinus collecta fluentis.

With a wand of myrtle, etc. Cp. Anacreon, 7 [29]:--

Ὑακινθίνῃ με ῥάβδῳ χαλέπως, Ἔρως ῥαπίζων ... εἶπε· Σὺ γὰρ οὐ δύνῃ φιλῆσαι.

146. _Upon the Bishop of Lincoln's Imprisonment._ John Williams (1582-1650), Bishop of Lincoln, 1621; Lord Keeper of the Privy Seal, 1621-1625; suspended and imprisoned, 1637-1640, on a frivolous charge of having betrayed the king's secrets; Archbishop of York, 1641. Save from this poem and the _Carol_ printed in the Appendix we know nothing of his relations with Herrick. He had probably stood in the way of the poet's obtaining holy orders or preferment. When Herrick was appointed to the cure of Dean Prior in 1629, Williams had already lost favour at the Court.

147. _Cynthius pluck ye by the ear._ Cp. Virg. _Ecl._ vi. 3: Cynthius aurem Vellit et admonuit; and Milton's _Lycidas_, 77: "Phœbus replied and touched my trembling ears".

The lazy man the most doth love. Cp. Ovid, _Remed. Amor._ 144: Cedit amor rebus: res age, tutus eris. Nott. But Ovid could also write: Qui nolet fieri desidiosus amet (1 _Am._ ix. 46).

149. _Sir Thomas Southwell_, of Hangleton, Sussex, knighted 1615, died before December 16, 1642.

Those tapers five. Mentioned by Plutarch, _Qu. Rom._ 2. For their significance see Ben Jonson's _Masque of Hymen_.

O'er the threshold force her in. The custom of lifting the bride over the threshold, probably to avert an ill-omened stumble, has prevailed among the most diverse races. For the anointing of the doorposts Brand quotes Langley's translation of Polydore Vergil: "The bryde anoynted the poostes of the doores with swynes' grease, because she thought by that meanes to dryve awaye all misfortune, whereof she had her name in Latin 'Uxor ab unguendo'".

To gather nuts. A Roman marriage custom mentioned in Catullus, _Carm._ lxi. 124-127, the _In Nuptias Juliæ et Manlii_, which Herrick keeps in mind all through this ode.

With all lucky birds to side. Bona cum bona nubit alite virgo. Cat. _Carm._ lxi. 18.

But when ye both can say Come. The wish in this case appears to have been fulfilled, as Lady Southwell administered to her husband's estate, Dec. 16, 1642, and her own estate was administered on the thirtieth of the following January.

Two ripe shocks of corn. Cp. Job v. 26.

153. _His wish._ From Hor. _Epist._ I. xviii. 111, 112:--

Sed satis est orare Jovem quæ donat et aufert; Det vitam, det opes; æquum mî animum ipse parabo:

where Herrick seems to have read _qui_ for _quæ_.

157. _No Herbs have power to cure Love._ Ovid, _Met._ i. 523; id. _Her._ v. 149: Nullis amor est medicabilis herbis. For the 'only one sovereign salve' cp. Seneca,

Hippol. 1189: Mors amoris una sedamen.

159. _The Cruel Maid._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, with no other variant than the mistaken omission of "how" in l. 7. I do not think that it has been yet pointed out that the whole poem is a close imitation of Theocritus, xxiii. 19-47:--

Ἄγριε παῖ καὶ στυγνέ, κ.τ.λ.

Possibly Herrick meant to translate the whole poem, which would explain his initial _And_. But cp. Ben Jonson's _Engl. Gram._ ch. viii.: "'And' in the beginning of a sentence serveth instead of an admiration".

164. _To a Gentlewoman objecting to him his gray hairs._ Mr. Hazlitt quotes an early MS. copy headed: "An old man to his younge Mrs.". The variants, as he observes, are mostly for the worse. The poem may have been suggested to Herrick by Anacreon, 6 [11]:--

Λέγουσιν αἱ γυναῖκες, Ἀνακρέων, γέρων εἶ· λαβὼν ἔσοπτρον ἄθρει κόμας μὲν οὐκέτ' οὔσας κ.τ.λ.

168. _Jos. Lo. Bishop of Exeter._ Joseph Hall, 1574-1656, author of the satires.

169. _The Countess of Carlisle._ Lucy, the second wife of James, first Earl of Carlisle, the Lady Carlisle of Browning's _Strafford_.

170. _I fear no earthly powers._ Probably suggested by Anacreon [36], beginning: τί με τοὺς νόμους διδάσκεις; Cp. also 7 [15]: Οὔ μοι μέλει τὰ Γύγεω.

172. _A Ring presented to Julia._ Printed without variation in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, under the title: "With a O to Julia".

174. _Still thou reply'st: The Dead._ Cp. Martial, VIII. lxix. 1, 2:--

Miraris veteres, Vacerra, solos Nec laudas nisi mortuos poetas.

178. _Corinna's going a-Maying._ Herrick's poem is a charming expansion of Chaucer's theme: "For May wol have no slogardye a night". The account of May-day customs in Brand (vol. i. pp. 212-234) is unusually full, and all Herrick's allusions can be illustrated from it. Dr. Nott compares the last stanza to Catullus, _Carm._ v.; but parallels from the classic poets could be multiplied indefinitely.

The God unshorn of l. 2 is from Hor. I. _Od_. xxi. 2: Intonsum pueri dicite Cynthium.

181. _A dialogue between Horace and Lydia._ Hor. III. _Od._ ix.

Ramsey. Organist of Trinity College, Cambridge, 1628-1634. Some of his music still exists in MS.

185. _An Ode to Master Endymion Porter, upon his brother's death._ Endymion Porter is said to have had an only brother, Giles, who died in the king's service at Oxford, _i.e._, between 1642 and 1646, and it has been taken for granted that this ode refers to his death. The supposition is possibly right, but if so, the ode, despite its beauty, is so gratingly and extraordinarily selfish that we may wonder if the dead brother is not the William Herrick of the next poem. The first verse is, of course, a

soliloquy of Herrick's, not, as Dr. Grosart suggests, addressed to him by Porter. Dr. Nott again parallels Catullus, _Carm_. v.

186. _To his dying brother, Master William Herrick._ According to Dr. Grosart and Mr. Hazlitt the poet had an elder brother, William, baptized at St. Vedast's, Foster Lane, Nov. 24, 1585 (he must have been born some months earlier, if this date be right, for his sister Martha was baptized in the following January), and alive in 1629, when he acted as one of the executors of his mother's will. But, it is said, there was also another brother named William, born in 1593, after his father's death, "at Harry Campion's house at Hampton". I have not been able to find the authority for this last statement, which, as it asserts the co-existence of two brothers, of the same name, is certainly surprising. According to Dr. Grosart, it is the younger William who "died young" and was addressed in this poem, but I must own to feeling some doubt in the matter.

193. _The Lily in a Crystal._ The poem may be taken as an expansion of Martial, VIII. lxviii. 5-8:--

Condita perspicuâ vivit vindemia gemmâ Et tegitur felix, nec tamen uva latet: Femineum lucet sic per bombycina corpus, Calculus in nitidâ sic numeratur aquâ.

197. _The Welcome to Sack._ Two MSS. at the British Museum (Harl. 6931 and Add. 19,268) contain copies of this important poem. These copies differ considerably from the printed version, are proved by small variations to be independent of each other, and at the same time agree in all important points. We may conclude, therefore, that they represent an earlier version of the poem, subsequently revised by Herrick before the issue of _Hesperides_. In the subjoined copy, in which the two MSS. are corrected from each other, italics show the variations, asterisks mark lines omitted in _Hesperides_, and a dagger the absence of lines subsequently added.

"So _swift_ streams meet, so springs with gladder smiles Meet after long divorcement _made by_ isles: When love (the child of likeness) urgeth on Their crystal _waters_ to an union. So meet stol'n kisses when the moonie _night_ Calls forth fierce lovers to their wisht _delight_: So kings and queens meet, when desire convinces All thoughts, _save those that tend to_ getting princes. As I meet thee, Soul of my life and fame! Eternal Lamp of Love, whose radiant flame Out-_darts_ the heaven's Osiris; and thy _gems Darken_ the splendour of his mid-day beams. Welcome, O welcome, my illustrious spouse! Welcome as are the ends unto my vows: _Nay_, far more welcome than the happy soil The sea-scourged merchant, after all his toil, Salutes with tears of joy, when fires _display_ The _smoking_ chimneys of his Ithaca. Where hast thou been so long from my embraces, Poor pitied exile? Tell me, did thy Graces Fly discontented hence, and for a time _Choose rather for_ to bless _some_ other clime? †*_Oh, then, not longer let my sweet defer *Her buxom smiles from me, her worshipper!_ Why _have those amber_ looks, the which have been Time-past so fragrant, sickly now _call'd_ in Like a dull twilight? Tell me, *_hath my soul *Prophaned in speech or done an act that is foul *Against thy purer essence?_ _For that_ fault I'll expiate with sulphur, hair and salt: And with the crystal humour of the spring Purge hence the guilt, and kill _the_ quarrelling. _Wilt_ thou not smile, _nor_ tell me what's amiss?

Have I been cold to hug thee, too remiss, Too temperate in embracing? Tell me, has desire To-thee-ward died in the embers, and no fire Left in _the_ raked-up _ashes_, as a mark To testify the glowing of a spark? †_I must_ confess I left thee, and appeal 'Twas done by me more to _increase_ my zeal, And double my affection[†]; as do those Whose love grows more inflamed by being _froze_. But to forsake thee, [†] could there _ever_ be A thought of such-like possibility? When _all the world may know that vines_ shall lack Grapes, before Herrick _leave_ Canary sack. *_Sack is my life, my leaven, salt to all *My dearest dainties, nay, 'tis the principal *Fire unto all my functions, gives me blood, *An active spirit, full marrow, and, what is good,_ _Sack makes_ me _sprightful, airy_ to be borne, Like Iphyclus, upon the tops of corn. _Sack makes_ me nimble, as the wingèd hours, To dance and caper _o'er the tops_ of flowers, And ride the sunbeams. Can there be a thing Under the _cope of heaven_ that can bring More _joy_ unto my _soul_, or can present My Genius with a fuller blandishment? Illustrious Idol! _Can_ the Egyptians seek Help from the garlick, onion and the leek, And pay no vows to thee, who _art the_ best God, and far more _transcending_ than the rest? Had Cassius, that weak water-drinker, known Thee in _the_ Vine, or had but tasted one Small chalice of thy _nectar, he, even_ he As the wise Cato had approved of thee. Had not Jove's son, the _rash_ Tyrinthian swain (Invited to the Thesbian banquet), ta'ne Full goblets of thy [†] blood; his *_lustful_ sprite _Had not_ kept heat for fifty maids that night. †As Queens meet Queens, _so let sack come to_ me _Or_ as Cleopatra _unto_ Anthonie, When her high _visage_ did at once present To the Triumvir love and wonderment. Swell up my _feeble sinews_, let my blood †Fill each part full of fire,* _let all my good_ _Parts be encouraged_, active to do What thy commanding soul shall put _me_ to, And till I turn apostate to thy love, Which here I vow to serve, _never_ remove Thy _blessing_ from me; but Apollo's curse Blast _all mine_ actions; or, a thing that's worse, When these circumstants _have the fate_ to see The time _when_ I prevaricate from thee, Call me the Son of Beer, and then confine Me to the tap, the toast, the turf; let wine Ne'er shine upon me; _let_ my _verses_ all _Haste_ to a sudden death and funeral: And last, _dear Spouse, when I thee_ disavow, _May ne'er_ prophetic Daphne crown my brow."

Certainly this manuscript version is in every way inferior to that printed in the _Hesperides_, and Herrick must be reckoned among the poets who are able to revise their own work.

The smoky chimneys of his Ithaca. Ovid, I. _de Ponto_, ix. 265:--

Non dubia est Ithaci prudentia sed tamen optat Fumum de patriis posse videre focis.

Upon the tops of corn. Virgil (_Æn._ vii. 808-9) uses the same comparison of Camilla: Illa vel intactae segetis per summa volaret Gramina, nec teneras cursu laesisset aristas.

Could the Egyptians seek Help from the garlick, onion and the leek. Cp. Numbers xi. 5, and Juv., xi. 9-11.

Cassius, that weak water-drinker. Not, as Dr. Grosart queries: "Cassius Iatrosophista, or Cassius Felix?" but C. Cassius Longinus, the murderer of Cæsar. Cp.

Montaigne, II. 2, and Seneca, _Ep._ 83: "Cassius totâ vitâ aquam bibit" there quoted.

201. _To trust to good verses._ Carminibus confide bonis. Ovid, _Am._ III. ix. 39.

The Golden Pomp is come. Aurea pompa venit, Ovid, _Am._ III. ii. 44. "Now reigns the rose" (nunc regnat rosa) is a common phrase in Martial and elsewhere. For the "Arabian dew," cp. Ovid, _Sappho to Phaon_, 98: Arabo noster rore capillus olet.

A text ... Behold Tibullus lies. Jacet ecce Tibullus: Vix manet e tanto parva quod urna capit. Ovid, _Am._ III. ix. 39.

203. _Lips Tongueless._ Dr. Nott parallels Catullus, _Carm._ lii. (lv.):--

Si linguam clauso tenes in ore, Fructus projicies amoris omnes: Verbosa gaudet Venus loquela.

208. _Gather ye rosebuds while ye may._ Set to music by William Lawes in Playford's second book of "Ayres," 1652. Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1654, with the variants: "Gather _your_ Rosebuds" in l. 1; l. 4, _may_ for _will_; l. 6, _he is getting_ for _he's a-getting_; l. 8, _nearer to his setting_ for _nearer he's to setting_. The opening lines are from Ausonius, ccclxi. 49, 50 (quoted by Burton, _Anat. Mel._ III. 2, 5 § 5):--

Collige, virgo, rosas, dum flos novus, et nova pubes, Et memor esto aevum sic properare tuum:

cp. also l. 43:--

Quam longa una dies, ætas tam longa rosarum.

209. _Has not whence to sink at all._ Seneca, _Ep._ xx.: Redige te ad parva ex quibus cadere non possis. Cp. Alain Delisle: Qui decumbit humi non habet unde cadat.

211. _His poetry his pillar._ A variation upon the Horatian theme:--

"Exegi monumentum aere perennius Regalique situ pyramidum altius". (III. _Od._ xxx.)

212. _What though the sea be calm._ Almost literally translated from Seneca, _Ep._ iv.: Noli huic tranquillitati confidere: momento mare evertitur: eodem die ubi luserunt navigia sorbentur.

213. _At noon of day was seen a silver star._ "King Charles the First went to St. Paul's Church the 30th day of May, 1630, to give praise for the birth of his son, attended with all his Peers and a most royal Train, where a bright star appeared at High Noon in the sight of all." (_Stella Meridiana_, 1661.)

213. _And all most sweet, yet all less sweet than he._ It is characteristic of Herrick that in his _Noble Numbers_ ("The New-Year's Gift") he repeats this line, applying it to Christ.

The swiftest grace is best. Ὠκεῖαι χάριτες γλυκερώτεραι. Anth. Pal. x. 30.

214. _Know thy when._ So in _The Star-song_ Herrick sings: "Thou canst clear All doubts and manifest the where".

219. _Lord Bernard Stewart_, fourth son of Esme, third Duke of Lennox, and himself created Earl of Lichfield by Charles I. He commanded the king's troop of guards, and was killed at the battle of Rowton Heath, outside Chester, Sept. 24, 1645.

Clarendon (_History of the Rebellion_, ix. 19) thus records his death and character: "Here fell many gentlemen and officers of name, with the brave Earl of Litchfield, who was the third brother of that illustrious family that sacrificed his life in this quarrel. He was a very faultless young man, of a most gentle, courteous, and affable nature, and of a spirit and courage invincible; whose loss all men lamented, and the king bore it with extraordinary grief."

Trentall. Properly a set of thirty masses for the repose of a dead man's soul. Here and elsewhere Herrick uses the word as an equivalent for dirge, but Sidney distinguished them: "Let dirige be sung and trentalls rightly read. For love is dead," etc. "Hence, hence profane," is the Latin, _procul o procul este profani_ of Virg. _Æn._ vi. 258, where "profane" is only equivalent to uninitiated.

223. _The Fairy Temple._ For a brief note on Herrick's fairy poems, see Appendix. On the dedication to Mr. John Merrifield, Counsellor-at-Law, Dr. Grosart remarks: "Nothing seems to be now known of Merrifield. It is just possible that--as throughout the poem--the name was an invented one, 'Merry Field'." But the records of the Inner Temple show that the Merrifields were a legal family from Woolmiston, near Crewkerne, Somersetshire. John (son of Richard) Merrifield, the father, was admitted to the Inner Temple in 1581, and John, the son, in 1611. This latter must be Herrick's Counsellor. He rose to be a Master of the Bench in 1638 and Sergeant-at-Law in 1660. He died October, 1666, aged 75, at Crewkerne. On the other hand, it can hardly be doubted that Dr. Grosart is right in regarding the names of the fairy saints as quite imaginary. He nevertheless suggests SS. Titus, Neot, Idus, Ida, Fridian or Fridolin, Trypho, Felan and Felix as the possible prototypes of "Saint _Tit_, Saint _Nit_, Saint _Is_," etc. It should be noted that "Tit and Nit" occur with "Wap and Win" and other obviously made-up names, in Drayton's _Nymphidia_.

229. _Upon Cupid._ Taken from Anacreon, 5 [59].

Στέφος πλέκων ποθ' εὗρον ἐν τοῖς ῥόδοις Ἔρωτα· καὶ τῶν πτερῶν κατασχών ἐβάπτισ' εἰς τὸν οἶνον· λαβὼν δ' ἔπινον αὐτόν, καὶ νῦν ἔσω μελῶν μου πτεροῖσι γαργαλίζει.

234. _Care will make a face._ Ovid, _Ar. Am._ iii. 105: Cura dabit faciem, facies neglecta peribit.

235. _Upon Himself._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1654, under the title: _On an old Batchelor_, and with the variants, _married_ for _wedded_, l. 3, _one_ for _a_ in l. 4, and _Rather than mend me, blind me quite_ in l. 6.

238. _To the Rose._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1654, with the variants _peevish_ for _flowing_ in l. 4, _say, if she frets, that I have bonds_ in l. 6, _that can tame although not kill_ in l. 10, and _now_ for _thus_ in l. 11. The opening couplet is

from Martial, VII. lxxxix.:--

I, felix rosa, mollibusque sertis Nostri cinge comas Apollinaris.

241. _Upon a painted Gentlewoman._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, under the title, _On a painted madame_.

250. _Mildmay, Earl of Westmoreland._ See Note to 112. According to the date of the earl's succession, this poem must have been written after 1628.

253. _He that will not love_, etc. Ovid, _Rem. Am._ 15, 16:--

Si quis male fert indignae regna puellae, Ne pereat nostrae sentiat artis opem.

How she is her own least part. _Ib._ 344: Pars minima est ipsa puella sui, quoted by Bacon, Burton, Lyly, and Montaigne.

Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1654, with the variants, '_freezing_ colds and _fiery_ heats,' and 'and how she is _in every_ part'.

256. _Had Lesbia_, etc. See Catullus, _Carm_. iii.

260. _How violets came blue._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1654, as _How the violets came blue_. The first two lines read:--

"The violets, as poets tell, With Venus wrangling went".

Other variants are _did_ for _sho'd_ in l. 3; _Girl_ for _Girls_; _you_ for _ye_; _do_ for _dare_.

264. _That verse_, etc. Herrick repeats this assurance in a different context in the second of his _Noble Numbers_, _His Prayer for Absolution_.

269. _The Gods to Kings the judgment give to sway._ From Tacitus, _Ann._ vi. 8 (M. Terentius to Tiberius): Tibi summum rerum judicium dii dedere; nobis obsequi gloria relicta est.

270. _He that may sin, sins least._ Ovid, _Amor._ III. iv. 9, 10:--

Cui peccare licet, peccat minus: ipsa potestas Semina nequitiae languidiora facit.

271. _Upon a maid that died the day she was married._ Cp. Meleager, Anth. Pal. vii. 182:

Οὐ γάμον ἀλλ' Ἀίδαν ἐπινυμφίδιον Κλεαρίστα δέξατο παρθενίας ἄμματα λυομένα· Ἄρτι γὰρ ἐσπέριοι νύμφας ἐπὶ δικλίσιν ἄχευν λωτοί, καὶ θαλάμων ἐπλαταγεῦντο θύραι· Ἠῷοι δ' ὀλολυγμὸν ἀνέκραγον, ἐκ δ' Ὑμέναιος σιγαθεὶς γοερὸν φθέγμα μεθαρμόσατο, Αἱ δ' αὐταὶ καὶ φέγγος ἐδᾳδούχουν παρὰ παστῷ πεῦκαι καὶ φθιμένᾳ νέρθεν ἔφαινον ὁδόν.

278. _To his Household Gods._ Obviously written at the time of his ejection from his living.

283. _A Nuptial Song on Sir Clipseby Crew._ Of this Epithalamium (written in 1625 for the marriage of Sir Clipseby Crew, knighted by James I. at Theobald's in 1620, with Jane, daughter of Sir John Pulteney), two manuscript versions, substantially

agreeing, are preserved at the British Museum (Harl. MS. 6917, and Add. 25, 303). Seven verses are transcribed in these manuscripts which Herrick afterwards saw fit to omit, and almost every verse contains variants of importance. It is impossible to convey the effect of the earlier version by a mere collation, and I therefore transcribe it in full, despite its length. As before, variants and additions are printed in italics. The numbers in brackets are those of the later version, as given in _Hesperides_. The marginal readings are variants of Add. 25, 303, from the Harleian manuscript.

1 [1].

"What's that we see from far? the spring of Day Bloom'd from the East, or fair _enamell'd_ May Blown out of April; or some new Star fill'd with glory to our view, Reaching at Heaven, To add a nobler Planet to the seven? Say or do we not descry Some Goddess in a Cloud of Tiffany To move, or rather the Emerg_ing_ Venus from the sea?

2 [2].

"'Tis she! 'tis she! or else some more Divine Enlightened substance; mark how from the shrine Of holy Saints she paces on _Throwing about_ Vermilion And Amber: spice-ing the chafte-air with fumes of Paradise. Then come on, come on, and yield A savour like unto a blessed field, When the bedabbled morn Washes the golden ears of corn.

3.

"_Lead on fair paranymphs, the while her eyes, Guilty of somewhat, ripe the strawberries And cherries in her cheeks, there's cream Already spilt, her rays must gleam Gently thereon, And so beget lust and temptation To surfeit and to hunger. Help on her pace; and, though she lag, yet stir Her homewards; well she knows Her heart's at home, howe'er she goes._

4 [3].

"See where she comes; and smell how all the street Breathes Vine-yards and Pomegranates: O how sweet, As a fir'd Altar, is each stone _Spirting forth_ pounded Cinnamon. The Phœnix nest, Built up of odours, burneth in her breast. Who _would not then_ consume His soul to _ashes_ in that rich perfume? [ash-heaps Bestroking Fate the while He burns to embers on the Pile.

5 [4].

"Hymen, O Hymen! tread the sacred _round_ [ground Shew thy white feet, and head with Marjoram crowned: Mount up thy flames, and let thy Torch Display _thy_ Bridegroom in the porch In his desires More towering, more _besparkling_ than thy fires: [disparkling Shew her how his eyes do turn And roll about, and in their motions burn Their balls to cinders: haste Or, _like a firebrand_, he will waste.

6.

"_See how he waves his hand, and through his eyes Shoots forth his jealous soul, for to surprise And ravish you his Bride, do you Not now perceive the soul of C[lipseby] C[rew], Your mayden knight, With kisses to inspire You with his just and holy ire._

7 [5].

"_If so, glide through the ranks of Virgins_, pass The Showers of Roses, lucky four-leaved grass: The while the cloud of younglings sing, And drown _you_ with a flowery spring: While some repeat Your praise, and bless you, sprinkling you with Wheat, While that others do divine, 'Blest is the Bride on whom the Sun doth shine'; And thousands gladly wish You multiply as _do the_ fish.

8.

"_Why then go forward, sweet Auspicious Bride, And come upon your Bridegroom like a Tide Bearing down Time before you; hye Swell, mix, and loose your souls; imply Like streams which flow Encurled together, and no difference show In their [most] silver waters; run Into your selves like wool together spun. Or blend so as the sight Of two makes one Hermaphrodite._

9 [6].

"And, beauteous Bride, we do confess _you_ are wise _On drawing_ forth _those_ bashful jealousies [doling In love's name, do so; and a price Set on yourself by being nice. But yet take heed What now you seem be not the same indeed, And turn Apostat_a_: Love will Part of the way be met, or sit stone still; On them, and though _y'are slow In going_ yet, howsoever go.

10.

"_How long, soft Bride, shall your dear C[lipseby] make Love to your welcome with the mystic cake, How long, oh pardon, shall the house And the smooth Handmaids pay their vows With oil and wine For your approach, yet see their Altars pine? How long shall the page to please You stand for to surrender up the keys Of the glad house? Come, come, Or Lar will freeze to death at home._

11.

"_Welcome at last unto the Threshold, Time Throned in a saffron evening, seems to chime All in, kiss and so enter. If A prayer must be said, be brief, The easy Gods For such neglect have only myrtle rods To stroke, not strike; fear you Not more, mild Nymph, than they would have you do; But dread that you do more offend In that you do begin than end._

12 [7].

"And now y'are entered, see the coddled cook Runs from his Torrid Zone to pry and look And bless his dainty mistress; see _How_ th' aged point out: 'This is she Who now must sway _Us_ (_and God_ shield her) with her yea and nay,' And the smirk Butler

thinks it Sin in _his_ nap'ry not t' express his wit; Each striving to devise Some gin wherewith to catch _her_ eyes.

13.

"_What though your laden Altar now has won The credit from the table of the Sun For earth and sea; this cost On you is altogether lost Because you feed Not on the flesh of beasts, but on the seed Of contemplation: your, Your eyes are they, wherewith you draw the pure Elixir to the mind Which sees the body fed, yet pined._

14 [14].

"If _you must needs_ for ceremonie's sake Bless a sack posset, Luck go with _you_, take The night charm quickly; you have spells And magic for to end, and Hells To pass, but such And of such torture as no _God_ would grutch To live therein for ever: fry, _Aye_ and consume, and grow again to die, And live, and in that case Love the _damnation_ of _that_ place. [the

15 [8].

"To Bed, to Bed, _sweet_ Turtles now, and write This the shortest day,† this the longest night _And_ yet too short for you; 'tis we Who count this night as long as three, Lying alone _Hearing_ the clock _go_ Ten, Eleven, Twelve, One: Quickly, quickly then prepare. And let the young men and the Bridemaids share Your garters, and their joints Encircle with the Bridegroom's points.

16 [9].

"By the Bride's eyes, and by the teeming life Of her green hopes, we charge you that no strife, _Further_ than _virtue lends_, gets place Among _you catching at_ her Lace. Oh, do not fall Foul in these noble pastimes, lest you call Discord in, and so divide The _gentle_ Bridegroom and the _fragrous_ Bride, Which Love forefend: but spoken Be't to your praise: 'No peace was broken'.

17[10].

"Strip her of spring-time, tender whimpering maids, Now Autumn's come, when all _those_ flowery aids Of her delays must end, dispose That Lady-smock, that pansy and that Rose Neatly apart; But for prick-madam, and for gentle-heart, And soft maiden-blush, the Bride Makes holy these, all others lay aside: Then strip her, or unto her Let him come who dares undo her.

18 [11].

"And to enchant _you_ more, _view_ everywhere [ye About the roof a Syren in a sphere, As we think, singing to the din Of many a warbling cherubin: _List, oh list!_ how _Even heaven gives up his soul between you_ now, [ye _Mark how_ thousand Cupids fly To light their Tapers at the Bride's bright eye; To bed, or her they'll tire, Were she an element of fire.

19 [12].

"And to your more bewitching, see the proud Plump bed bear up, and _rising_ like a cloud, Tempting _thee, too, too_ modest; can You see it brussle like a swan And you be cold To meet it, when it woos and seems to fold The arms to hug _you_? throw, throw Yourselves into _that main, in the full_ flow Of _the_ white pride, and drown The _stars_ with you in floods of down.

20 [13].

"_You see 'tis_ ready, and the maze of love Looks for the treaders; everywhere is wove Wit and new mystery, read and Put in practice, to understand And know each wile, Each Hieroglyphic of a kiss or smile; And do it _in_ the full, reach High in your own conceipts, and _rather_ teach Nature and Art one more _Sport_ than they ever knew before.

21.

To the Maidens:]

"_And now y' have wept enough, depart; yon stars [the Begin to pink, as weary that the wars Know so long Treaties; beat the Drum Aloft, and like two armies, come And guild the field, Fight bravely for the flame of mankind, yield Not to this, or that assault, For that would prove more Heresy than fault In combatants to fly 'Fore this or that hath got the victory._

22 [15].

"But since it must be done, despatch and sew Up in a sheet your Bride, and what if so It be with _rib of Rock and_ Brass, _Yea_ tower her up, as Danae was, [ye Think you that this, Or Hell itself, a powerful Bulwark is? I tell _you_ no; but like a [ye Bold bolt of thunder he will make his way, And rend the cloud, and throw The sheet about, like flakes of snow.

23 [16].

"All now is hushed in silence: Midwife-moon With all her Owl-ey'd issue begs a boon Which you must grant; that's entrance with Which extract, all we † call pith And quintessence Of Planetary bodies; so commence, All fair constellations Looking upon _you_ that _the_ Nations Springing from to such Fires May blaze the virtue of their Sires."

--R. HERRICK.

The variants in this version are not very important; one of the most noteworthy, _round_ for _ground_, in stanza 5 [4], was overlooked by Dr. Grosart in his collation. Of the seven stanzas subsequently omitted several are of great beauty. There are few happier images in Herrick than that of _Time throned in a saffron evening_ in stanza 11. It is only when the earlier version is read as a whole that Herrick's taste in omitting is vindicated. Each stanza is good in itself, but in the MSS. the poem drags from excessive length, and the reduction of its twenty-three stanzas to sixteen greatly improves it.

286. _Ever full of pensive fear._ Ovid, _Heroid._ i. 12: Res est solliciti plena timoris amor.

287. _Reverence to riches._ Perhaps from Tacit. _Ann._ ii. 33: Neque in familia et argento quæque ad usum parantur nimium aliquid aut modicum, nisi ex fortuna possidentis.

288. _Who forms a godhead._ From Martial, VIII. xxiv. 5:--

Qui fingit sacros auro vel marmore vultus Non facit ille deos: qui rogat, ille facit.

290. _The eyes be first that conquered are._ From Tacitus, _Germ._ 43: Primi in omnibus proeliis oculi vincuntur.

293. _Oberon's Feast._ For a note on Herrick's Fairy Poems and on the _Description of the King and Queene of the Fayries_ (1635), in which part of this poem was first printed, see Appendix. Add. MS. 22, 603, at the British Museum, and Ashmole MS. 38, at the Bodleian, contain early versions of the poem substantially agreeing. I transcribe the Museum copy:--

"A little mushroom table spread After _the dance_, they set on bread, A _yellow corn of hecky_ wheat With some small _sandy_ grit to eat His choice bits; with _which_ in a trice They make a feast less great than nice. But all _the_ while his eye _was_ served We _dare_ not think his ear was sterved: But that there was in place to stir His _fire_ the _pittering_ Grasshopper; The merry Cricket, puling Fly, The piping Gnat for minstralcy. _The Humming Dor, the dying Swan, And each a choice Musician._ And now we must imagine first, The Elves present to quench his thirst A pure seed-pearl of infant dew, Brought and _beswetted_ in a blue And pregnant violet; which done, His kitling eyes begin to run Quite through the table, where he spies The horns of papery Butterflies: Of which he eats, _but with_ a little _Neat cool allay_ of Cuckoo's spittle; A little Fuz-ball pudding stands By, yet not blessed by his hands-- That was too coarse, but _he not spares To feed upon the candid hairs Of a dried canker, with a_ sagg And well _bestuffed_ Bee's sweet bag: _Stroking_ his pallet with some store Of Emme_t_ eggs. What would he more, But Beards of Mice, _an Ewt's_ stew'd thigh, _A pickled maggot and a dry Hipp, with a_ Red cap worm, that's shut Within the concave of a Nut Brown as his tooth, _and with the fat And well-boiled inchpin of a Bat. A bloated Earwig with the Pith Of sugared rush aglads him with; But most of all the Glow-worm's fire. As most betickling his desire To know his Queen, mixt with the far- Fetcht binding-jelly of a star. The silk-worm's seed_, a little moth _Lately_ fattened in a piece of cloth; Withered cherries; Mandrake's ears; Mole's eyes; to these the slain stag's tears; The unctuous dewlaps of a Snail; The broke heart of a Nightingale O'er-come in music; with a wine Ne'er ravished from the flattering Vine, But gently pressed from the soft side Of the most sweet and dainty Bride, Brought in a _daisy chalice_, which He fully quaffs _off_ to bewitch His blood _too high_. This done, commended Grace by his Priest, the feast is ended."

The Shapcott to whom this _Oberon's Feast_ and _Oberon's Palace_ are dedicated is Herrick's "peculiar friend, Master Thomas Shapcott, Lawyer," of a later poem. Dr. Grosart again suggests that it may have been a character-name, but, as in the case of John Merrifield, the owner was a West country-man and a member of the Inner

Temple, where he was admitted in 1632 as the "son and heir of Thomas Shapcott," of Exeter.

298. _That man lives twice._ From Martial, X. xxiii. 7:--

Ampliat aetatis spatium sibi vir bonus: hoc est Vivere bis vita posse priore frui.

301. _Master Edward Norgate, Clerk of the Signet of his Majesty:_--

Son to Robert Norgate, D.D., Master of Bene't College, Cambridge. He was employed by the Earl of Arundel to purchase pictures, and on one occasion found himself at Marseilles without remittances, and had to tramp through France on foot. According to the Calendars of State Papers in 1625, it was ordered that, "forasmuch as his Majesty's letters to the Grand Signior, the King of Persia, the Emperor of Russia, the Great Mogul, and other remote Princes, had been written, limned, and garnished with gold and colours by scriveners abroad, thenceforth they should be so written, limned, and garnished by Edward Norgate, Clerk of the Signet in reversion". Six years later this order was renewed, the "Kings of Bantam, Macassar, Barbary, Siam, Achine, Fez, and Sus" being added to the previous list, and Norgate being now designated as a Clerk of the Signet Extraordinary. In the same year, having previously been Bluemantle Pursuivant, he was promoted to be Windsor Herald, in which capacity he received numerous fees during the next few years, and was excused ship money. He still, however, retained his clerkship, for he writes in 1639: "The poor Office of Arms is fain to blazon the Council books and Signet". The phrase occurs in a series of nineteen letters of extraordinary interest, which Norgate wrote from the North, chiefly to his friend, Robert Reade, secretary to Windebank, on the course of affairs. In Sept., 1641, "Ned Norgate" was ordered personally to attend the king. "It is his Majesty's pleasure that the master should wait and not the men, and _that_ they shall find." Henceforth I find no certain reference to him; according to Fuller he died at the Herald's Office in 1649. It would be interesting if we could be sure that this Edward Norgate is the same as the one who in 1611 was appointed Tuner of his Majesty's "virginals, organs, and other instruments," and in 1637 received a grant of £140 for the repair of the organ at Hampton Court. Herrick's love of music makes us expect to find a similar trait in his friends.

313. _The Entertainment, or Porch Verse._ The words _Ye wrong the threshold-god_ and the allusion to the porch in the Clipsby Crew Epithalamium (stanza 4) show that there is no reference here (as Brand thinks, ii. 135) to the old custom of reading part of the marriage service at the church door or porch (cp. Chaucer: "Husbands at churchë door she had had five"). The porch of the house is meant, and the allusions are to the ceremonies at the threshold (cp. the Southwell Epithalamium). Dr. Grosart quotes from the Dean Prior register the entry of the marriage of Henry Northleigh, gentleman, and Mistress Lettice Yard on September 5, 1639, by licence from the Archbishop of Canterbury.

319. _No noise of late-spawned Tittyries._ In the Camden Society's edition of the _Diary of Walter Yonge_, p. 70 (kindly shown me by the Rev. J. H. Ward), we have a contemporary account of the Club known as the Tityre Tues, which took its name from the first words of Virgil's first _Eclogue_. "The beginning of December, 1623,

there was a great number in London, haunting taverns and other debauched places, who swore themselves in a brotherhood and named themselves _Tityre Tues_. The oath they gave in this manner: he that was to be sworn did put his dagger into a pottle of wine, and held his hand upon the pommel thereof, and then was to make oath that he would aid and assist all other of his fellowship and not disclose their council. There were divers knights, some young noblemen and gentlemen of this brotherhood, and they were to know one the other by a black bugle which they wore, and their followers to be known by a blue ribbond. There are discovered of them about 80 or 100 persons, and have been examined by the Privy Council, but nothing discovered of any intent they had. It is said that the king hath given commandment that they shall be re-examined." In Mennis's _Musarum Deliciæ_ the brotherhood is celebrated in a poem headed "The Tytre Tues; or, a Mocke Song. To the tune of Chive Chase. By Mr. George Chambers." The second verse runs:--

"They call themselves the Tytere-tues, And wore a blue rib-bin; And when a-drie would not refuse To drink. O fearful sin!

"The council, which is thought most wise, Did sit so long upon it, That they grew weary and did rise, And could make nothing on it."

According to a letter of Chamberlain to Carleton, indexed among the _State Papers_, the Tityres were a secret society first formed in Lord Vaux's regiment in the Low Countries, and their "prince" was called Ottoman. Another entry shows that the "Bugle" mentioned by Yonge was the badge of a society originally distinct from the Tityres, which afterwards joined with it. The date of Herrick's poem is thus fixed as December, 1623/4, and this is confirmed by another sentence in the same passage in _Yonge's Diary_, in which he says: "The Jesuits and Papists do wonderfully swarm in the city, and rumours lately have been given out for firing the Navy and House of Munition, on which are set a double guard". The Parliament to which Herrick alludes was actually summoned in January, 1624, to meet on February 12. Sir Simeon Steward, to whom the poem is addressed, was of the family of the Stewards of Stantney, in the Isle of Ely. He was knighted with his father, Mark Steward, in 1603, and afterwards became a fellow-commoner of Trinity Hall, Cambridge. He was at different times Sheriff and Deputy-Lieutenant for Cambridgeshire, and while serving in the latter capacity got into some trouble for unlawful exactions. In 1627 he wrote a poem on the _King of the Fairies Clothes_ in the same vein as Herrick's fairy pieces.

321. _Then is the work half done._ As Dr. Grosart suggests, Herrick may have had in mind the "Dimidium facti qui cœpit habet" of Horace, I. _Epist._ ii. 40. But here the emphasis is on beginning _well_, there on _beginning_.

Begin with Jove is doubtless from the "Ab Jove principium, Musæ," of Virg. _Ecl._ iii. 60.

323. _Fears not the fierce sedition of the seas._ A reminiscence of Horace, III. _Od._ i. 25-32.

328. _Gold before goodness._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, as _A Foolish Querie_. The sentiment is from Seneca, _Ep._ cxv.: An dives, omnes quærimus; nemo, an bonus. Cp. Juvenal, III. 140 sqq.; Plaut. _Menæchm._ IV. ii. 6.

331. _To his honoured kinsman, Sir William Soame._ The second son of Sir Stephen Soame, Lord Mayor of London in 1598. Herrick's father and Sir Stephen married sisters.

As benjamin and storax when they meet. Instances of the use of "Benjamin" for gum benzoin will be found in the Dictionaries. Dr. Grosart's gloss, "_Benjamin_, the favourite youngest son of the Patriarch," is unfortunate.

336. _His Age: dedicated to ... M. John Wickes under the name of Posthumus._ There is an important version of this poem in Egerton MS., 2725, where it is entitled _Mr. Herrick's Old Age to Mr. Weekes_. I do not think it has been collated before. Stanzas i.-vi. contain few variants; ii. 6 reads: "Dislikes to care for what's behind"; iii. 6: "Like a lost maidenhead," for "Like to a lily lost"; v. 8: "With the best and whitest stone"; vi. 1: "We'll not be poor". After this we have two stanzas omitted in 1648:--

"We have no vineyards which do bear Their lustful clusters all the year, Nor odoriferous Orchards, like to Alcinous; Nor gall the seas Our witty appetites to please With mullet, turbot, gilt-head bought At a high rate and further brought.

"Nor can we glory of a great And stuffed magazine of wheat; We have no bath Of oil, but only rich in faith O'er which the hand Of fortune can have no command, But what she gives not, she not takes, But of her own a spoil she makes."

Stanza vii., l. 2, has "close" for "both"; l. 3 "see" for "have"; l. 6, "open" for "that cheap"; l. 7, "full" for "same". Stanzas x.-xvii. have so many variants that I am obliged to transcribe them in full, though they show Herrick not at his best, and the poem is not one to linger over:--

10.

"Live in thy peace; as for myself, When I am bruisèd on the shelf Of Time, and _read Eternal daylight o'er my head:_ When with the rheum, _With_ cough _and_ ptisick, I consume _Into an heap of cinders:_ then The Ages fled I'll call again,

11.

"And with a tear compare these last _And cold times unto_ those are past, While Baucis by _With her lean lips_ shall kiss _them dry Then will we_ sit By the fire, foretelling snow and sleet And weather by our aches, grown †Old enough to be our own

12.

"True Calendar [ ] _Is for to know_ what change is near, Then to assuage The gripings _in_ the chine by age, I'll call my young Iülus to sing such a song I made upon my _mistress'_ breast; _Or such a_ blush at such a feast.

13.

"Then shall he read _my Lily fine Entomb'd_ within a crystal shrine: _My_ Primrose next: A piece then of a higher text; For to beget In me a more transcendent heat Than that insinuating fire Which crept into each _reverend_ Sire,

14.

"When the _high_ Helen _her fair cheeks Showed to the army of the Greeks;_ At which I'll _rise_ (_Blind though as midnight in my eyes_), And hearing it, Flutter and crow, _and_, in a fit Of _young_ concupiscence, and _feel New flames within the aged steal_.

15.

"Thus frantic, crazy man (God wot), I'll call to mind _the times_ forgot And oft between _Sigh out_ the Times that _we_ have seen! _And shed a tear_, And twisting my Iülus _hair_, Doting, I'll weep and say (in truth) Baucis, these were _the_ sins of youth.

16.

"Then _will I_ cause my hopeful Lad (If a wild Apple can be had) To crown the Hearth (Lar thus conspiring with our mirth); _Next_ to infuse Our _better beer_ into the cruse: Which, neatly spiced, we'll first carouse Unto the _Vesta_ of the house.

17.

"Then the next health to friends of mine _In oysters, and_ Burgundian wine, _Hind, Goderiske, Smith, And Nansagge_, sons of _clune[M] and_ pith, Such _who know_ well _To board_ the magic _bowl_, and _spill All mighty blood, and can do more Than Jove and Chaos them before_."

[M] Clune = "clunis," a haunch.

This John Wickes or Weekes is spoken of by Anthony à Wood as a "jocular person" and a popular preacher. He enters Wood's _Fasti_ by right of his co-optation as a D.D. in 1643, while the court was at Oxford; his education had been at Cambridge. He was a prebendary of Bristol and Dean of St. Burian in Cornwall, and suffered some persecution as a royalist. Herrick later on, when himself shedless and cottageless, addresses another poem to him as his "peculiar friend,"

To whose glad threshold and free door I may, a poet, come, though poor.

A friend suggests that Hind may have been John Hind, an Anacreontic poet and friend of Greene, and has found references to a Thomas Goodricke of St. John's Coll., Camb., author of two poems on the accession of James I., and a Martin Nansogge, B.A. of Trinity Hall, 1614, afterwards vicar of Cornwood, Devon. Smith is certainly James Smith, who, with Sir John Mennis, edited the _Musarum Deliciæ_, in which the first poem is addressed "to Parson Weekes: an invitation to London," and contains a

reference to--

"That old sack Young Herrick took to entertain The Muses in a sprightly vein".

The early part of this poem contains, along with the name Posthumus, many Horatian reminiscences: cp. especially II. _Od._ xiv. 1-8, and IV. _Od._ vii. 14. It may be noted that in the imitation of the latter passage in stanza iv. the MS. copy at the Museum corrects the misplacement of the epithet, reading:--

"But we must on and thither tend Where Tullus and rich Ancus blend," etc.,

for "Where Ancus and rich Tullus".

Again the variant, "_Open_ candle baudery," in verse 7, is an additional argument against Dr. Grosart's explanation: "Obscene words and figures made with candle-smoke," the allusion being merely to the blackened ceilings produced by cheap candles without a shade.

337. _A Short Hymn to Venus._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, as _A vow to Cupid_, with variants: l. 1, _Cupid_ for _Goddess_; l. 2, _like_ for _with_; l. 3, _that I may_ for _I may but_; l. 5, _do_ for _will_.

340. _Upon a delaying lady._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, as _A Check to her delay_.

341. _The Lady Mary Villars_, niece of the first Duke of Buckingham, married successively Charles, son of Philip, Earl of Pembroke, Esme Stuart, Duke of Richmond and Lennox, and Thomas Howard. Died 1685.

355. _Hath filed upon my silver hairs._ Cp. Ben Jonson, _The King's Entertainment_:--

"What all the minutes, hours, weeks, months, and years That hang in file upon these silver hairs Could not produce," etc.

359. _Philip, Earl of Pembroke and Montgomery._ Philip Herbert (born 1584, died 1650), despite his foul mouth, ill temper, and devotion to sport ("He would make an excellent chancellor to the mews were Oxford turned into a kennel of hounds," wrote the author of _Mercurius Menippeus_ when Pembroke succeeded Laud as chancellor), was also a patron of literature. He was one of the "incomparable pair of brethren" to whom the Shakespeare folio of 1623 was dedicated, and he was a good friend to Massinger. His fondness for scribbling in the margins of books may, or may not, be considered as further evidence of a respect for literature.

366. _Thou shall not all die._ Horace's "non omnis moriar".

367. _Upon Wrinkles._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, under the title _To a Stale Lady_. The first line there reads:--

"Thy wrinkles are no more nor less".

375. _Anne Soame, now Lady Abdie_, eldest daughter of Sir Thomas Soame, and second wife of Sir Thomas Abdy, Bart., of Felix Hall, Essex. Herrick's poem is modelled on Mart. III. lxv.

376. _Upon his Kinswoman, Mistress Elizabeth Herrick_, daughter of the poet's brother Nicholas.

377. _A Panegyric to Sir Lewis Pemberton_ of Rushden, in Northamptonshire, sheriff of the county in 1622; married Alice, daughter of Tho. Bowles. Died 1641. With this poem cp. Ben Jonson's _Epig._ ci.

But great and large she spreads by dust and sweat. Dr. Grosart very appositely quotes Montaigne: "For it seemeth that the verie name of vertue presupposeth difficultie and inferreth resistance, and cannot well exercise it selfe without an enemie" (Florio's tr., p. 233). But I think the two passages have a common origin in some version of Hesiod's τῆς ἀρετῆς ἱδρῶτα θεοὶ προπάροιθεν ἔθηκαν, which is twice quoted by Plato.

382. _After the rare arch-poet, Jonson, died._ Perhaps suggested by the Epitaph of Plautus on himself, _ap._ Gell. i. 24:--

Postquam est mortem aptus Plautus, comoedia luget; Scena deserta, dein risus, ludu' jocusque, Et numeri innumeri simul omnes collacrumarunt.

384. _To his nephew, to be prosperous in painting._ This artistic nephew may have been a Wingfield, son of Mercy Herrick, who married John Wingfield, of Brantham, Suffolk; or one of three sons of Nicholas Herrick and Susanna Salter, or Thomas, or some unknown son of Thomas Herrick. There is no record of any painter Herrick's achievements.

392. _Sir Edward Fish, Knight Baronet_, of Chertsey, in Surrey. Died 1658.

405. _Nor fear or spice or fish._ Herrick is remembering Persius, i. 43: Nec scombros metuentia carmina, nec thus. To form the paper jacket or _tunica_ which wrapt the mackerel in Roman cookery seems to have been the ultimate employment of many poems. Cp. Mart. III. l. 9; IV. lxxxvii. 8; and Catullus, XCV. 8.

The farting Tanner and familiar King. The ballad here alluded to is that of _King Edward IV. and the tanner of Tamworth_, printed in Prof. Child's collection. "The dancing friar tattered in the bush" of the next line is one of the heroes of the old ballad of _The Fryar and the Boye_, printed by Wynkyn de Worde, and included in the Appendix to Furnivall and Hales' edition of the Percy folio. The boy was the possessor of a "magic flute," and, having got the friar into a bush, made him dance there.

"Jack, as he piped, laughed among, The Friar with briars was vilely stung, He hopped wondrous high. At last the Friar held up his hand And said: I can no longer stand, Oh! I shall dancing die."

"Those monstrous lies of little Robin Rush" is explained by Dr. Grosart as an allusion to "The Historie of Friar Rush, how he came to a House of Religion to seek a Service, and being entertained by the Prior was made First Cook, being full of pleasant Mirth and Delight for young people". Of "Tom Chipperfield and pretty lisping Ned" I can find nothing. "The flying Pilchard and the frisking Dace" probably belong to the fish monsters alluded to in the _Tempest_. In "Tim Trundell" Herrick seems for the sake of alliteration to have taken a liberty with the Christian name of a

well-known ballad publisher.

He's greedy of his life. From Seneca, _Thyestes_, 884-85:--

Vitæ est avidus quisquis non vult Mundo secum pereunte mori.

407. _Upon Himself._ 408. _Another._ Both printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, the second under the title of _Love and Liberty_. This last is taken from Corn. Gall. _Eleg._ i. 6, quoted by Montaigne, iii. 5:--

Et mihi dulce magis resoluto vivere collo.

412. _The Mad Maid's Song._ A manuscript version of this song is contained in Harleian MS. 6917, fol. 48, ver. 80. The chief variants are: st. i. l. 2, _morrow_ for _morning_; l. 4, _all dabbled_ for _bedabbled_; st. ii. l. 1, _cowslip_ for _primrose_; l. 3, _tears_ for _flowers_; l. 4, _was_ for _is_; st. v. l. 1, _hope_ for _know_; st. vii. l. 2, _balsam_ for _cowslips_.

415. _Whither dost thou whorry me._ Quo me, Bacche, rapis tui Plenum? Hor. III. _Od._ xxv. 1.

430. _As Sallust saith_, _i.e._, the pseudo-Sallust in the _Epist. ad Cai. Cæs. de Repub. Ordinanda_.

431. _Every time seems short._ Epigr. in Farnabii, _Florileg._ [a. 1629]:--

Τοῖσι μὲν εὖ πράττουσιν ἅπας ὁ βίος βραχύς ἐστιν· Τοῖς δὲ κακῶς, μία νὺξ ἄπλετός ἐστι χρόνος.

443. _Oberon's Palace.--After the feast (my Shapcott) see._ See 223, 293, from which it is a pity that this poem should have been divorced. Of the _Palace_ there are as many as three MS. versions, viz., Add. 22, 603 (p. 59), and Add. 25, 303 (p. 157), at the British Museum, both of which I have collated, and Ashmole MS. 38, which I only know through my predecessors. The three MSS. appear to agree very harmoniously, and they unite in increasing our knowledge of Herrick by a passage of twenty-seven lines, following on the words "And here and there and farther off," and in lieu of the next four and a half lines in _Hesperides_. They read as follows:--

"Some sort of pear, Apple or plum, is neatly laid (As if it was a tribute paid) By the round urchin; some mixt wheat The which the ant did taste, not eat; Deaf nuts, soft Jews'-ears, and some thin Chippings, the mice filched from the bin Of the gray farmer, and to these The scraps of lentils, chitted peas, Dried honeycombs, brown acorn cups, Out of the which he sometimes sups His herby broth, and there close by Are pucker'd bullace, cankers (?), dry Kernels, and withered haws; the rest Are trinkets fal'n from the kite's nest, As butter'd bread, the which the wild Bird snatched away from the crying child, Blue pins, tags, fesenes, beads and things Of higher price, as half-jet rings, Ribbons and then some silken shreaks The virgins lost at barley-breaks. Many a purse-string, many a thread Of gold and silver therein spread, _Many a counter, many a die, Half rotten and without an eye, Lies here about_, and, as we guess, Some bits of thimbles seem to dress The brave cheap work; _and for to pave The excellency of this cave, Squirrels and children's teeth late shed_, Serve here, both which _enchequered_ With castors' doucets, which poor they Bite off

themselves to 'scape away: Brown _toadstones_, ferrets' eyes, _the gum That shines_," etc.

The italicised words in the last few lines appear in _Hesperides_; all the rest are new. Other variants are: "The grass of Lemster ore soberly sparkling" for "the finest Lemster ore mildly disparkling"; "girdle" for "ceston"; "The eyes of all doth strait bewitch" for "All with temptation doth bewitch"; "choicely hung" for "neatly hung"; "silver roach" for "silvery fish"; "cave" for "room"; "get reflection" for "make reflected"; "Candlemas" for "taper-light"; "moon-tane" for "moon-tanned," etc., etc.

Kings though they're hated. The "Oderint dum metuant" of the _Atreus_ of Accius, quoted by Cicero and Seneca.

446. _To Oenone._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, under the title: "The Farewell to Love and to his Mistress," and with the unlucky misprint "court" for "covet" (also "for" for "but") in the stanza iii. l. i.

447. _Grief breaks the stoutest heart._ Frangit fortia corda dolor. Tibull. III. ii. 6.

451. _To the right gracious Prince, Lodowick, Duke of Richmond and Lennox._ There appears to me to be a blunder here which Dr. Grosart and Mr. Hazlitt do not elucidate, by recording the birth of Lodowick, first Duke of Richmond, in 1574, his succession to the Lennox title in 1583, creation as Duke of Richmond in May, 1623, and death in the following February. For this first duke was no "stem" left "of all those three brave brothers fallen in the war," and the allusion here is undoubtedly to his nephews--George, Lord d'Aubigny, who fell at Edgehill; Lord John Stewart, who fell at Alresford; and Lord Bernard Stewart (Earl of Lichfield), who fell at Rowton Heath. In elucidation of Herrick's Dirge (219) over the last of these three brothers, I have already quoted Clarendon's remark, that he was "the third brother of that illustrious family that sacrificed his life in this quarrel," and it cannot be doubted that Herrick is here alluding to the same fact. The poem must therefore have been written after 1645, _i.e._, more than twenty years after the death of Duke Lodowick. But the duke then living was James, who succeeded his father Esme in 1624, was recreated Duke of Richmond in 1641, and did not die till 1655. It is true that there was a brother named Lodovic, but he was an abbot in France and never succeeded to the title. Herrick, therefore, seems to have blundered in the Christian name.

453. _Let's live in haste._ From Martial, VII. xlvii. 11, 12:--

Vive velut rapto: fugitivaque gaudia carpe: Perdiderit nullum vita reversa diem.

457. _While Fates permit._ From Seneca, _Herc. Fur._ 177:--

Dum Fata sinunt, Vivite laeti: properat cursu Vita citato, volucrique die Rota praecipitis vertitur anni.

459. _With Horace_ (IV. _Od._ ix. 29):--

Paulùm sepultae distat inertiae Celata virtus.

465. _The parting Verse or charge to his Supposed Wife when he travelled._ MS. variants of this poem are found at the British Museum in Add. 22, 603, and in

Ashmole MS. 38. Their title, "Mr. Herrick's charge to his wife," led Mr. Payne Collier to rashly identify with the poet a certain Robert Herrick married at St. Clement Danes, 1632, to a Jane Gibbons. The variants are numerous, but not very important. In l. 4 we have "draw wooers" for "draw thousands"; ll. 11-16 are transposed to after l. 28; and "Are the expressions of that itch" is written "As emblems will express that itch"; ll. 27, 28 appear as:--

"For that once lost thou _needst must fall To one, then prostitute to all:_

And we then have the transposed passage:--

Nor so immurèd would I have Thee live, as dead, _or_ in thy grave; But walk abroad, yet wisely well _Keep 'gainst_ my coming sentinel. And think _each man thou seest doth doom Thy thoughts to say, I back am come._

Farther on we have the rather pretty variant:--

"Let them _call thee wondrous fair, Crown of women_, yet despair".

Eight lines lower "virtuous" is read for "gentle," and the omission of some small words throws some light on a change in Herrick's metrical views as he grew older. The words omitted are bracketed:--

"[And] Let thy dreams be only fed With this, that I am in thy bed. And [thou] then turning in that sphere, Waking findst [shall find] me sleeping there. But [yet] if boundless lust must scale Thy fortress and _must_ needs prevail _'Gainst thee and_ force a passage in," etc.

Other variants are: "Creates the action" for "That makes the action"; "Glory" for "Triumph"; "my last signet" for "this compression"; "turn again in my full triumph" for "come again, As one triumphant," and "the height of womankind" for "all faith of womankind".

The body sins not, 'tis the will, etc. A maxim of law Latin: Actus non facit reum nisi mens sit rea.

466. _To his Kinsman, Sir Thos. Soame_, son of Sir Stephen Soame, Lord Mayor of London, 1589, and of Anne Stone, Herrick's aunt. Sir Thomas was Sheriff of London, 1635, M.P. for the City, 1640, and died Jan., 1670. See Cussan's _Hertfortshire_. (_Hundred of Edwinstree_, p. 100.)

470. _Few Fortunate._ A variant on the text (Matt. xx. 16): "Many be called but few chosen".

479. _To Rosemary and Bays._ The use of rosemary and bays at weddings forms a section in Brand's chapter on marriage customs (ii. 119). For the gilding he quotes from a wedding sermon preached in 1607 by Roger Hacket: "Smell sweet, O ye flowers, in your native sweetness: be not gilded with the idle art of man". The use of gloves at weddings forms the subject of another section in Brand (ii. 125). He quotes Ben Jonson's _Silent Woman_; "We see no ensigns of a wedding here, no character of a bridal; where be our scarves and our gloves?"

483. _To his worthy friend, M. Thomas Falconbrige._ As Herrick hints at his friend's destiny for a public career, it seemed worth while to hunt through the Calendar of State Papers for a chance reference to this Falconbridge, who so far has evaded editors. He is apparently the Mr. Thomas Falconbridge who appears in various papers between 1640 and 1644, as passing accounts, and in the latter year was "Receiver-General at Westminster".

Towers reared high, etc. Cp. Horace, _Od._ II. x. 9-12.

Saepius ventis agitatur ingens Pinus, et celsae graviore casu Decidunt turres, feriuntque summos Fulgura montes.

486. _He's lord of thy life_, etc. Seneca, _Epist. Mor._ iv.: Quisquis vitam suam contempsit tuae dominus est. Quoted by Montaigne, I. xxiii.

488. _Shame is a bad attendant to a state._ From Seneca, _Hippol._ 431: Malus est minister regii imperii pudor.

He rents his crown that fears the people's hate. Also from Seneca, _Oedipus_, 701: Odia qui nimium timet regnare nescit.

496. _To his honoured kinsman, Sir Richard Stone_, son of John Stone, sergeant-at-law, the brother of Julian Stone, Herrick's mother. He died in 1660.

To this white temple of my heroes. Ben Jonson's admirers were proud to call themselves "sealed of the tribe of Ben," and Herrick, a devout Jonsonite, seems to have imitated the idea so far as to plan sometimes, as here, a Temple, sometimes a Book (see _infra_, 510), sometimes a City (365), a Plantation (392), a Calendar (545), a College (983), of his own favourite friends, to whom his poetry was to give immortality. The earliest direct reference to this plan is in his address to John Selden, the antiquary (365), in which he writes:--

"A city here of heroes I have made Upon the rock whose firm foundation laid Shall never shrink; where, making thine abode, Live thou a Selden, that's a demi-god".

It is noteworthy that the poems which contain the clearest reference to this Temple (or its variants) are mostly addressed to kinsfolk, _e.g._, this to Sir Richard Stone, to Mrs. Penelope Wheeler, to Mr. Stephen Soame, and to Susanna and Thomas Herrick. Other recipients of the honour are Sir Edward Fish and Dr. Alabaster, Jack Crofts, Master J. Jincks, etc.

497. _All flowers sent_, etc. See Virgil's--or the Virgilian--_Culex_, ll. 397-410.

Martial's bee. See _Epig._ IV. xxxii.

De ape electro inclusa. Et latet et lucet Phaethontide condita gutta, Ut videatur apis nectare clausa suo. Dignum tantorum pretium tulit illa laborum. Credibile est ipsam sic voluisse mori.

500. _To Mistress Dorothy Parsons._ This "saint" from Herrick's Temple may certainly be identified with the second of the three children (William, Dorothy, and Thomasine) of Mr. John Parsons, organist and master of the choristers at Westminster Abbey, where he was buried in 1623. Herrick addresses another poem

to her sister Thomasine:--

"Grow up in beauty, as thou dost begin, And be of all admired, Thomasine".

502. _'Tis sin to throttle wine._ Martial, I. xix. 5: Scelus est jugulare Falernum.

506. _Edward, Earl of Dorset_, Knight of the Garter, grandson of Thomas Sackville, author of _Gorboduc_. He succeeded his brother, Richard Sackville, the third earl, in 1624, and died in 1652. Clarendon describes a duel which he fought with Lord Bruce in Flanders.

Of your own self a public theatre. Cp. Burton (Democ. to Reader) "Ipse mihi theatrum".

510. _To his Kinswoman, Mrs. Penelope Wheeler._ See Note on 130.

511. _A mighty strife 'twixt form and chastity._ Lis est cum formâ magna pudicitiæ. Quoted from Ovid by Burton, who translates: "Beauty and honesty have ever been at odds".

514. _To the Lady Crew, upon the death of her child._ This must be the child buried in Westminster Abbey, according to the entry in the register "1637/8, Feb. 6. Sir Clipsy Crewe's daughter, in the North aisle of the monuments." Colonel Chester annotates: "She was a younger daughter, and was born at Crewe, 27th July, 1631. She died on the 4th of February, and must have been an independent heiress, as her father administered to her estate on the 24th May following."

515. _Here needs no Court for our Request._ An allusion to the Court of Requests, established in the time of Richard II. as a lesser Court of Equity for the hearing of "all poor men's suits". It was abolished in 1641, at the same time as the Star Chamber.

517. _The new successor drives away old love._ From Ovid, _Rem. Am._ 462: Successore novo vincitur omnis amor.

519. _Born I was to meet with age._ Cp. 540. From Anacreon, 38 [24]:--

Ἐπείδη βρότος ἐτέχθην, Βιότου τρίβον ὀδεύειν, Χρόνον ἔγνων ὃν παρῆλθον, Ὃν δ' ἔχω δραμεῖν οὐκ οἶδα· Μέθετέ με, φρονίιδες· Μηδέν μοι καὶ ὑμῖν ἔστω. Πρὶν ἐμὲ φθάσῃ τὸ τέρμα, Παίξω, γελάσω, χορεύσω, Μετὰ τοῦ καλοῦ Λυαίου.

520. _Fortune did never favour one._ From Dionys. Halicarn. as quoted by Burton, II. iii. 1, § 1.

521. _To Phillis to love and live with him._ A variant on Marlowe's theme: "Come live with me and be my love". Donne's _The Bait_ (printed in Grosart's edition, vol. ii. p. 206) is another.

522. _To his Kinswoman, Mistress Susanna Herrick_, wife of his elder brother Nicholas.

523. _Susanna Southwell._ Probably a daughter of Sir Thomas Southwell, for whom Herrick wrote the Epithalamium (No. 149).

525. _Her pretty feet_, etc. Cp. Suckling's "Ballad upon a Wedding":--

"Her feet beneath her petticoat, Like little mice stole in and out, As if they feared the light".

526. _To his Honoured Friend, Sir John Mynts._ John Mennis, a Vice-Admiral of the fleet and knighted in 1641, refused to join in the desertion of the fleet to the Parliament. After the Restoration he was made Governor of Dover and Chief Comptroller of the Navy. He was one of the editors of the collection called _Musarum Deliciæ_ (1656), in the first poem of which there is an allusion to--

"That old sack Young Herrick took to entertain The Muses in a sprightly vein".

527. _Fly me not_, etc. From Anacreon, 49 [34]:--

Μή με φύγῃς, ὁρῶσα Τὰν πολιὰν ἔθειραν· ... Ὥρα κἀν στεφάνοισιν Ὅπως πρέπει τὰ λευκὰ Ῥόδοις κρίν' ἐμπλακέντα.

529. _As thou deserv'st be proud._ Cp. Hor. III. _Od._ xxx. 14:--

Sume superbiam Quaesitam meritis et mihi Delphica Lauro cinge volens, Melpomene, comam.

534. _To Electra._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, where it is entitled _To Julia_.

536. _Ill Government.... When kings obey_, etc. From Seneca, _Octav._ 581:--

Male imperatur, cum regit vulgus duces.

545. _To his Worthy Kinsman, Mr. Stephen Soame_ (the son or, less probably, the brother of Sir Thomas Soame): _One of my righteous tribe_. Cp. Note to 496.

547. _Great spirits never with their bodies die._ Tacit. _Agric._ 46:--"Si quis piorum manibus locus, si, ut sapientibus placet, non cum corpore extinguuntur magnae animae".

554. _Die thou canst not all._ Hor. IV. _Od._ xxx. 6,7.

556. _The Fairies._ Cp. the old ballad of _Robin Goodfellow_:--

"When house or hearth doth sluttish lie, I pinch the maids both black and blue";

and Ben Jonson's _Entertainment at Althorpe_, etc.

557. _M. John Weare, Councellour._ Probably the same as "the much-lamented Mr. J. Warr" of 134.

Law is to give to every one his own. Cicero, _De Fin._ v.: Animi affectio suum cuique tribuens Justitia dicitur.

564. _His Kinswoman, Bridget Herrick_, eldest daughter of his brother Nicholas.

565. _The Wanton Satyr._ See Sir E. Dyer's _The Shepherd's Conceit of Prometheus_:--

"Prometheus, when first from heaven high He brought down fire, ere then on earth not seen, Fond of delight, a Satyr standing by Gave it a kiss, as it like sweet had been. ... ... The difference is--the Satyr's lips, my heart, He for a time, I evermore, have

smart."

So _Euphues_: "Satirus not knowing what fire was would needs embrace it and was burnt;" and Sir John Davies, _False and True Knowledge_.

Transcriber's Endnotes

Numeration Errors in the Hesperides:

Errors in the numbering system, despite the corrections mentioned in the NOTE TO SECOND EDITION, still exist in the text. A clear example is shown by _569. UPON ELECTRA'S TEARS_ ending Vol. I, whilst Vol. II begins with _569. A HYMN TO THE GRACES_. When the poems within the APPENDIX OF EPIGRAMS are considered, more errors in the numeration system become apparent.

Without an obvious solution to a discrepancy the numbers remain as originally printed, however the following alterations have been made to ensure any details in the NOTES section apply to the relevant poem.

Page 204. OBERON'S PALACE. "444" changed to _443_. "443. OBERON'S PALACE."

Page 221. FEW FORTUNATE. "472" changed to _470_. "470. FEW FORTUNATE."

Page 223. THE WASSAIL. "478" changed to _476_. "476. THE WASSAIL."

Page 317. Note to 496. "512" changed to _510_. "... sometimes a Book (see infra, 510) ..."

Page 321. Note to 545. "498" changed to _496_. "... Cp. Note to 496...."

Page 322. Note to 564. "562" changed to _564_. "564. _His Kinswoman, Bridget Herrick_, eldest ..."

Page 322. Note to 565. "563" changed to _565_. "565. _The Wanton Satyr._ See Sir E. Dyer's ..."

Typographical Errors:

Page 83. 178. CORINNA'S GOING.... "pries" corrected to _priest_. "And chose their priest, ere we can cast off sloth:"

Page 137. 275. CROSSES. "goods" corrected to _good_. "Though good things answer many good intents,"

Page 316. Note to 479. " owers" corrected to _flowers_. "Smell sweet, O ye flowers, in your native sweetness:"

Unresolved Errors:

The following errors remain as printed:

In 405. TO HIS BOOK., _Chipperfeild_, has been retained as it is unclear whether this is a misprint, or intentional.

In 101. BARLEY-BREAK; OR, LAST IN HELL. No corresponding note can be found for _Barley-break, a country game resembling prisoners' base_.

ABERDEEN UNIVERSITY PRESS.

ROBERT HERRICK

THE HESPERIDES & NOBLE NUMBERS: EDITED BY ALFRED POLLARD WITH A PREFACE BY A. C. SWINBURNE

VOL. II.

REVISED EDITION

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HESPERIDES.

569. A HYMN TO THE GRACES.

When I love (as some have told, Love I shall when I am old), O ye Graces! make me fit For the welcoming of it. Clean my rooms, as temples be, T' entertain that deity. Give me words wherewith to woo, Suppling and successful too; Winning postures, and, withal, Manners each way musical: Sweetness to allay my sour And unsmooth behaviour. For I know you have the skill Vines to prune, though not to kill, And of any wood ye see, You can make a Mercury.

Suppling, softening. _Mercury_, god of eloquence and inventor of the lyre.

570. TO SILVIA.

No more, my Silvia, do I mean to pray For those good days that ne'er will come away. I want belief; O gentle Silvia, be The patient saint, and send up vows for me.

573. THE POET HATH LOST HIS PIPE.

I cannot pipe as I was wont to do, Broke is my reed, hoarse is my singing, too; My wearied oat I'll hang upon the tree, And give it to the sylvan deity.

574. TRUE FRIENDSHIP.

Wilt thou my true friend be? Then love not mine, but me.

575. THE APPARITION OF HIS MISTRESS CALLING HIM TO ELYSIUM.

Desunt nonnulla ----

Come then, and like two doves with silv'ry wings, Let our souls fly to th' shades where ever springs Sit smiling in the meads; where balm and oil, Roses and cassia crown the untill'd soil. Where no disease reigns, or infection comes To blast the air, but ambergris and gums This, that, and ev'ry thicket doth transpire, More sweet than storax from the hallowed fire, Where ev'ry tree a wealthy issue bears Of fragrant apples, blushing plums, or pears; And all the shrubs, with sparkling spangles, shew Like morning sunshine tinselling the dew. Here in green meadows sits eternal May,

Purfling the margents, while perpetual day So double gilds the air, as that no night Can ever rust th' enamel of the light. Here, naked younglings, handsome striplings, run Their goals for virgins' kisses; which when done, Then unto dancing forth the learned round Commixed they meet, with endless roses crown'd. And here we'll sit on primrose-banks, and see Love's chorus led by Cupid; and we'll be Two loving followers, too, unto the grove Where poets sing the stories of our love. There thou shalt hear divine Musæus sing Of Hero and Leander; then I'll bring Thee to the stand, where honour'd Homer reads His Odysseys and his high Iliads; About whose throne the crowd of poets throng To hear the incantation of his tongue: To Linus, then to Pindar; and that done, I'll bring thee, Herrick, to Anacreon, Quaffing his full-crown'd bowls of burning wine, And in his raptures speaking lines of thine, Like to his subject; and as his frantic Looks show him truly Bacchanalian-like Besmear'd with grapes, welcome he shall thee thither, Where both may rage, both drink and dance together. Then stately Virgil, witty Ovid, by Whom fair Corinna sits, and doth comply With ivory wrists his laureate head, and steeps His eye in dew of kisses while he sleeps; Then soft Catullus, sharp-fang'd Martial, And towering Lucan, Horace, Juvenal, And snaky Persius, these, and those, whom rage (Dropt for the jars of heaven) fill'd t' engage All times unto their frenzies,--thou shalt there Behold them in a spacious theatre. Among which glories, crowned with sacred bays And flatt'ring ivy, two recite their plays--Beaumont and Fletcher, swans to whom all ears Listen, while they, like syrens in their spheres, Sing their Evadne; and still more for thee There yet remains to know than thou can'st see By glim'ring of a fancy. Do but come, And there I'll show thee that capacious room In which thy father Jonson now is plac'd, As in a globe of radiant fire, and grac'd To be in that orb crown'd, that doth include Those prophets of the former magnitude, And he one chief; but hark, I hear the cock (The bellman of the night) proclaim the clock Of late struck one, and now I see the prime Of day break from the pregnant east: 'tis time I vanish; more I had to say, But night determines here, away.

Purfling, trimming, embroidering. _Round_, rustic dance. _Comply_, encircle. _Their Evadne_, the sister of Melantius in their play "The Maid's Tragedy".

576. LIFE IS THE BODY'S LIGHT.

Life is the body's light, which once declining, Those crimson clouds i' th' cheek and lips leave shining. Those counter-changed tabbies in the air (The sun once set) all of one colour are. So, when Death comes, fresh tinctures lose their place, And dismal darkness then doth smutch the face.

Tabbies, shot silks.

579. LOVE LIGHTLY PLEASED.

Let fair or foul my mistress be, Or low, or tall, she pleaseth me; Or let her walk, or stand, or sit, The posture hers, I'm pleas'd with it; Or let her tongue be still, or stir, Graceful is every thing from her; Or let her grant, or else deny, _My love will fit each history_.

580. THE PRIMROSE.

Ask me why I send you here This sweet Infanta of the year? Ask me why I send to you This primrose, thus bepearl'd with dew? I will whisper to your ears: The sweets of love are mix'd with tears.

Ask me why this flower does show So yellow-green, and sickly too? Ask me why the stalk is weak And bending (yet it doth not break)? I will answer: These discover What fainting hopes are in a lover.

581. THE TITHE. TO THE BRIDE.

If nine times you your bridegroom kiss, The tenth you know the parson's is. Pay then your tithe, and doing thus, Prove in your bride-bed numerous. If children you have ten, Sir John Won't for his tenth part ask you one.

Sir John, the parson.

582. A FROLIC.

Bring me my rosebuds, drawer, come; So, while I thus sit crown'd, I'll drink the aged Cæcubum, Until the roof turn round.

Drawer, waiter. _Cæcubum_, Cæcuban, an old Roman wine.

583. CHANGE COMMON TO ALL.

All things subjected are to fate; Whom this morn sees most fortunate, The evening sees in poor estate.

584. TO JULIA.

The saints'-bell calls, and, Julia, I must read The proper lessons for the saints now dead: To grace which service, Julia, there shall be One holy collect said or sung for thee. Dead when thou art, dear Julia, thou shalt have A trentall sung by virgins o'er thy grave: Meantime we two will sing the dirge of these, Who dead, deserve our best remembrances.

Trentall, a service for the dead.

585. NO LUCK IN LOVE.

I do love I know not what, Sometimes this and sometimes that; All conditions I aim at.

But, as luckless, I have yet Many shrewd disasters met To gain her whom I would get.

Therefore now I'll love no more As I've doted heretofore: He who must be, shall be poor.

586. IN THE DARK NONE DAINTY.

Night hides our thefts, all faults then pardon'd be; All are alike fair when no spots we see. Lais and Lucrece in the night-time are Pleasing alike, alike both singular: Joan and my lady have at that time one, One and the self-same priz'd complexion: Then please alike the pewter and the plate, The chosen ruby, and the reprobate.

Lais and Lucrece, opposite types of incontinence and purity. Cp. 665, 885.

587. A CHARM, OR AN ALLAY FOR LOVE.

If so be a toad be laid In a sheep's-skin newly flay'd, And that tied to man, 'twill sever Him and his affections ever.

590. TO HIS BROTHER-IN-LAW, MASTER JOHN WINGFIELD.

For being comely, consonant, and free To most of men, but most of all to me; For so decreeing that thy clothes' expense Keeps still within a just circumference; Then for contriving so to load thy board As that the messes ne'er o'erlade the lord; Next for ordaining that thy words not swell To any one unsober syllable: These I could praise thee for beyond another, Wert thou a Winstfield only, not a brother.

Consonant, harmonious.

591. THE HEADACHE.

My head doth ache, O Sappho! take Thy fillet, And bind the pain, Or bring some bane To kill it.

But less that part Than my poor heart Now is sick; One kiss from thee Will counsel be And physic.

592. ON HIMSELF.

Live by thy muse thou shalt, when others die Leaving no fame to long posterity: When monarchies trans-shifted are, and gone, Here shall endure thy vast dominion.

593. UPON A MAID.

Hence a blessed soul is fled, Leaving here the body dead; Which since here they can't combine, For the saint we'll keep the shrine.

596. UPON THE TROUBLESOME TIMES.

O times most bad, Without the scope Of hope Of better to be had!

Where shall I go, Or whither run To shun This public overthrow?

No places are, This I am sure, Secure In this our wasting war.

Some storms we've past, Yet we must all Down fall, And perish at the last.

597. CRUELTY BASE IN COMMANDERS.

Nothing can be more loathsome than to see Power conjoin'd with Nature's cruelty.

599. UPON LUCIA.

I ask'd my Lucia but a kiss, And she with scorn denied me this; Say then, how ill should I have sped, Had I then ask'd her maidenhead?

600. LITTLE AND LOUD.

Little you are, for woman's sake be proud; For my sake next, though little, be not loud.

601. SHIPWRECK.

He who has suffered shipwreck fears to sail Upon the seas, though with a gentle gale.

602. PAINS WITHOUT PROFIT.

A long life's-day I've taken pains For very little, or no gains; The evening's come, here now I'll stop, And work no more, but shut up shop.

603. TO HIS BOOK.

Be bold, my book, nor be abash'd, or fear The cutting thumb-nail or the brow severe; But by the Muses swear all here is good If but well read, or, ill read, understood.

604. HIS PRAYER TO BEN JONSON.

When I a verse shall make, Know I have pray'd thee, For old religion's sake, Saint Ben, to aid me.

Make the way smooth for me, When I, thy Herrick, Honouring thee, on my knee Offer my lyric.

Candles I'll give to thee, And a new altar, And thou, Saint Ben, shall be Writ in my Psalter.

605. POVERTY AND RICHES.

Give Want her welcome if she comes; we find Riches to be but burdens to the mind.

606. AGAIN.

Who with a little cannot be content, Endures an everlasting punishment.

607. THE COVETOUS STILL CAPTIVES.

Let's live with that small pittance that we have; _Who covets more, is evermore a slave_.

608. LAWS.

When laws full power have to sway, we see Little or no part there of tyranny.

609. OF LOVE.

I'll get me hence, Because no fence Or fort that I can make here, But love by charms, Or else by arms Will storm, or starving take here.

611. TO HIS MUSE.

Go woo young Charles no more to look Than but to read this in my book: How Herrick begs, if that he can- Not like the muse, to love the man, Who by the shepherds sung, long since, The star-led birth of Charles the Prince.

Long since, _i.e._, in the "Pastoral upon the Birth of Prince Charles" (213), where see Note.

612. THE BAD SEASON MAKES THE POET SAD.

Dull to myself, and almost dead to these My many fresh and fragrant mistresses; Lost to all music now, since everything Puts on the semblance here of sorrowing. Sick is the land to the heart, and doth endure More dangerous faintings by her desp'rate cure. But if that golden age would come again, And Charles here rule, as he before did reign; If smooth and unperplexed the seasons were, As when the sweet Maria lived here: I should delight to have my curls half drown'd In Tyrian dews, and head with roses crown'd; And once more yet, ere I am laid out dead, _Knock at a star with my exalted head_.

Knock at a star (sublimi feriam sidera vertice). Horace Ode, i. 1.

613. TO VULCAN.

Thy sooty godhead I desire Still to be ready with thy fire; That should my book despised be, Acceptance it might find of thee.

614. LIKE PATTERN, LIKE PEOPLE.

This is the height of justice: that to do Thyself which thou put'st other men unto. As great men lead, the meaner follow on, Or to the good, or evil action.

615. PURPOSES.

No wrath of men or rage of seas Can shake a just man's purposes: No threats of tyrants or the grim Visage of them can alter him; But what he doth at first intend, That he holds firmly to the end.

616. TO THE MAIDS TO WALK ABROAD.

Come, sit we under yonder tree, Where merry as the maids we'll be; And as on primroses we sit, We'll venture, if we can, at wit: If not, at draw-gloves we will play; So spend some minutes of the day: Or else spin out the thread of sands, Playing at Questions and Commands: Or tell what strange tricks love can do, By quickly making one of two. Thus we will sit and talk, but tell No cruel truths of Philomel, Or Phyllis, whom hard fate forc'd on To kill herself for Demophon. But fables we'll relate: how Jove Put on all shapes to get a love; As now a satyr, then a swan; A bull but then, and now a man. Next we will act how young men woo, And sigh, and kiss as lovers do; And talk of brides, and who shall make That wedding-smock, this bridal cake, That dress, this sprig, that leaf, this vine, That smooth and silken columbine. This done, we'll draw lots who shall buy And gild the bays and rosemary; What posies for our wedding rings; What gloves we'll give and ribandings: And smiling at ourselves, decree, Who then the joining priest shall be. What short, sweet prayers shall be said; And how the posset shall be made With cream of lilies, not of kine, And maiden's-blush, for spiced wine. Thus, having talked, we'll next commend A kiss to each, and so we'll end.

Draw-gloves, talking on the fingers. _Philomela_, daughter of Pandion, changed into a nightingale. _Phyllis_, the S. Phyllis of a former lyric (To Groves). _Gild the bays_, see Note to 479.

617. HIS OWN EPITAPH.

As wearied pilgrims, once possest Of long'd-for lodging, go to rest, So I, now having rid my way, Fix here my button'd staff and stay. Youth, I confess, hath me misled; But age hath brought me right to bed.

Button'd, knobbed.

618. A NUPTIAL VERSE TO MISTRESS ELIZABETH LEE, NOW LADY TRACY.

Spring with the lark, most comely bride, and meet Your eager bridegroom with auspicious feet. The morn's far spent, and the immortal sun Corals his cheek to see those rites not done. Fie, lovely maid! indeed you are too slow, When to the temple Love should run, not go. Dispatch your dressing then, and quickly wed; Then feast, and coy't a little, then to bed. This day is Love's day, and this busy night Is yours, in which you challenged are to fight With such an arm'd, but such an easy foe, As will, if you yield, lie down conquer'd too. The field is pitch'd, but such must be your wars, As that your kisses must outvie the stars. Fall down together vanquished both, and lie Drown'd in the blood of rubies there, not die.

Corals, reddens.

619. THE NIGHT-PIECE, TO JULIA.

Her eyes the glow-worm lend thee, The shooting stars attend thee; And the elves also, Whose little eyes glow Like the sparks of fire, befriend thee.

No Will-o'-th'-Wisp mislight thee, Nor snake or slow-worm bite thee; But on, on thy way Not making a stay, Since ghost there's none to affright thee.

Let not the dark thee cumber: What though the moon does slumber? The stars of the night Will lend thee their light Like tapers clear without number.

Then, Julia, let me woo thee, Thus, thus to come unto me; And when I shall meet Thy silv'ry feet My soul I'll pour into thee.

620. TO SIR CLIPSEBY CREW.

Give me wine, and give me meat, To create in me a heat, That my pulses high may beat.

Cold and hunger never yet Could a noble verse beget; But your bowls with sack replete.

Give me these, my knight, and try In a minute's space how I Can run mad and prophesy.

Then, if any piece prove new And rare, I'll say, my dearest Crew, It was full inspired by you.

621. GOOD LUCK NOT LASTING.

If well the dice run, let's applaud the cast: _The happy fortune will not always last_.

622. A KISS.

What is a kiss? Why this, as some approve: The sure, sweet cement, glue, and lime of love.

623. GLORY.

I make no haste to have my numbers read: _Seldom comes glory till a man be dead_.

624. POETS.

Wantons we are, and though our words be such, Our lives do differ from our lines by much.

625. NO DESPITE TO THE DEAD.

Reproach we may the living, not the dead: _'Tis cowardice to bite the buried_.

626. TO HIS VERSES.

What will ye, my poor orphans, do When I must leave the world and you? Who'll give ye then a sheltering shed, Or credit ye when I am dead? Who'll let ye by their fire sit, Although ye have a stock of wit Already coin'd to pay for it? I cannot tell, unless there be Some race of old humanity Left, of the large heart and long hand, Alive, as noble Westmorland, Or gallant Newark, which brave two May fost'ring fathers be to you. If not, expect to be no less Ill us'd, than babes left fatherless.

Westmorland, _Newark_, see Notes.

627. HIS CHARGE TO JULIA AT HIS DEATH.

Dearest of thousands, now the time draws near That with my lines my life must full-stop here. Cut off thy hairs, and let thy tears be shed Over my turf when I am buried. Then for effusions, let none wanting be, Or other rites that do belong to me; As love shall help thee, when thou dost go hence Unto thy everlasting residence.

Effusions, the "due drink-offerings" of the lyric "To his lovely mistresses" (634).

628. UPON LOVE.

In a dream, Love bade me go To the galleys there to row; In the vision I ask'd why? Love as briefly did reply, 'Twas better there to toil, than prove The turmoils they endure that love. I awoke, and then I knew What Love said was too-too true; Henceforth therefore I will be, As from love, from trouble free. _None pities him that's in the snare, And, warned before, would not beware._

629. THE COBBLERS' CATCH.

Come sit we by the fire's side, And roundly drink we here; Till that we see our cheeks ale-dy'd And noses tann'd with beer.

633. CONNUBII FLORES, OR THE WELL-WISHES AT WEDDINGS.

Chorus Sacerdotum. From the temple to your home May a thousand blessings come! And a sweet concurring stream Of all joys to join with them.

Chorus Juvenum. Happy Day, Make no long stay Here In thy sphere; But give thy place to Night, That she, As thee, May be Partaker of this sight. And since it was thy care To see the younglings wed, 'Tis fit that Night the pair Should see safe brought to bed.

Chorus Senum. Go to your banquet then, but use delight, So as to rise still with an appetite. Love is a thing most nice, and must be fed To such a height, but never surfeited. What is beyond the mean is ever ill: _'Tis best to feed Love, but not overfill_; Go then discreetly to the bed of pleasure, And this remember, _virtue keeps the measure_.

Chorus Virginum. Lucky signs we have descri'd To encourage on the bride, And to these we have espi'd, Not a kissing Cupid flies Here about, but has his eyes To imply your love is wise.

Chorus Pastorum. Here we present a fleece To make a piece Of cloth; Nor, fair, must you be both Your finger to apply To housewifery. Then, then begin To spin: And, sweetling, mark you, what a web will come Into your chests, drawn by your painful thumb.

Chorus Matronarum. Set you to your wheel, and wax Rich by the ductile wool and flax. Yarn is an income, and the housewives' thread The larder fills with meat, the bin with bread.

Chorus Senum. Let wealth come in by comely thrift And not by any sordid shift; 'Tis haste Makes waste: Extremes have still their fault: _The softest fire makes the sweetest malt: Who grips too hard the dry and slippery sand Holds none at all, or little in his hand._

Chorus Virginum. Goddess of pleasure, youth and peace, Give them the blessing of increase: And thou, Lucina, that dost hear The vows of those that children bear: Whenas her April hour draws near, Be thou then propitious there.

Chorus Juvenum. Far hence be all speech that may anger move: _Sweet words must nourish soft and gentle love_.

Chorus Omnium. Live in the love of doves, and having told The raven's years, go hence more ripe than old.

Nice, dainty. _Painful_, painstaking; for the passage cp. Catull. _Nupt. Pel. et Thet._ 311-314.

634. TO HIS LOVELY MISTRESSES.

One night i' th' year, my dearest beauties, come And bring those due drink-offerings to my tomb. When thence ye see my reverend ghost to rise, And there to lick th' effused sacrifice: Though paleness be the livery that I wear, Look ye not wan or colourless for fear. Trust me, I will not hurt ye, or once show The least grim look, or cast a frown on you: Nor shall the tapers when I'm there burn blue. This I may do, perhaps, as I glide by, Cast on my girls a glance and loving eye, Or fold mine arms and sigh, because I've lost The world so soon, and in it you the most. Than these, no fears more on your fancies fall, Though then I smile and speak no words at

all.

Fold mine arms, cp. "crossing his arms in this sad knot" (_Tempest_).

635. UPON LOVE.

A crystal vial Cupid brought, Which had a juice in it; Of which who drank, he said no thought Of love he should admit.

I, greedy of the prize, did drink, And emptied soon the glass; Which burnt me so, that I do think The fire of hell it was.

Give me my earthen cups again, The crystal I contemn; Which, though enchas'd with pearls, contain A deadly draught in them.

And thou, O Cupid! come not to My threshold, since I see, For all I have, or else can do, Thou still wilt cozen me.

638. THE BEGGAR TO MAB, THE FAIRY QUEEN.

Please your Grace, from out your store, Give an alms to one that's poor, That your mickle may have more. Black I'm grown for want of meat Give me then an ant to eat, Or the cleft ear of a mouse Over-sour'd in drink of souce; Or, sweet lady, reach to me The abdomen of a bee; Or commend a cricket's hip, Or his huckson, to my scrip. Give for bread a little bit Of a pea that 'gins to chit, And my full thanks take for it. Flour of fuzz-balls, that's too good For a man in needihood; But the meal of milldust can Well content a craving man. Any orts the elves refuse Well will serve the beggar's use. But if this may seem too much For an alms, then give me such Little bits that nestle there In the prisoner's panier. So a blessing light upon You and mighty Oberon: That your plenty last till when I return your alms again.

Mickle, much. _Souce_, salt-pickle. _Huckson_, huckle-bone. _Chit_, sprout. _Orts_, scraps of food. _Prisoner's panier_, the basket which poor prisoners used to hang out of the gaol windows for alms in money or kind.

639. AN END DECREED.

Let's be jocund while we may, All things have an ending day; And when once the work is done, _Fates revolve no flax they've spun_.

Revolve, _i.e._, bring back.

640. UPON A CHILD.

Here a pretty baby lies Sung asleep with lullabies; Pray be silent, and not stir Th' easy earth that covers her.

641. PAINTING SOMETIMES PERMITTED.

If Nature do deny Colours, let Art supply.

642. FAREWELL FROST, OR WELCOME THE SPRING.

Fled are the frosts, and now the fields appear Re-cloth'd in fresh and verdant diaper. Thaw'd are the snows, and now the lusty spring Gives to each mead a neat enamelling. The palms put forth their gems, and every tree Now swaggers in her

leafy gallantry. The while the Daulian minstrel sweetly sings, With warbling notes, her Terean sufferings. What gentle winds perspire! As if here Never had been the northern plunderer To strip the trees and fields, to their distress, Leaving them to a pitied nakedness. And look how when a frantic storm doth tear A stubborn oak, or holm, long growing there, But lull'd to calmness, then succeeds a breeze That scarcely stirs the nodding leaves of trees: So when this war, which tempest-like doth spoil Our salt, our corn, our honey, wine and oil, Falls to a temper, and doth mildly cast His inconsiderate frenzy off, at last, The gentle dove may, when these turmoils cease, Bring in her bill, once more, the branch of peace.

Gems, buds. _Daulian minstrel_, the nightingale Philomela. _Terean sufferings_, _i.e._, at the hands of Tereus.

643. THE HAG.

The hag is astride This night for to ride, The devil and she together; Through thick and through thin, Now out and then in, Though ne'er so foul be the weather.

A thorn or a burr She takes for a spur, With a lash of a bramble she rides now; Through brakes and through briars, O'er ditches and mires, She follows the spirit that guides now.

No beast for his food Dare now range the wood, But hush'd in his lair he lies lurking; While mischiefs, by these, On land and on seas, At noon of night are a-working.

The storm will arise And trouble the skies; This night, and more for the wonder, The ghost from the tomb Affrighted shall come, Call'd out by the clap of the thunder.

644. UPON AN OLD MAN: A RESIDENTIARY.

Tread, sirs, as lightly as ye can Upon the grave of this old man. Twice forty, bating but one year And thrice three weeks, he lived here. Whom gentle fate translated hence To a more happy residence. Yet, reader, let me tell thee this, Which from his ghost a promise is, If here ye will some few tears shed, He'll never haunt ye now he's dead.

Residentiary, old inhabitant.

645. UPON TEARS.

Tears, though they're here below the sinner's brine, Above they are the angels' spiced wine.

646. PHYSICIANS.

Physicians fight not against men; but these Combat for men by conquering the disease.

647. THE PRIMITIÆ TO PARENTS.

Our household-gods our parents be; And manners good require that we The first fruits give to them, who gave Us hands to get what here we have.

649. UPON LUCY. EPIG.

Sound teeth has Lucy, pure as pearl, and small, With mellow lips, and luscious therewithal.

651. TO SILVIA.

I am holy while I stand Circum-crost by thy pure hand; But when that is gone, again I, as others, am profane.

Circum-crost, marked round with a cross.

652. TO HIS CLOSET-GODS.

When I go hence, ye Closet-Gods, I fear Never again to have ingression here Where I have had whatever thing could be Pleasant and precious to my muse and me. Besides rare sweets, I had a book which none Could read the intext but myself alone. About the cover of this book there went A curious-comely clean compartlement, And, in the midst, to grace it more, was set A blushing, pretty, peeping rubelet. But now 'tis closed; and being shut and seal'd, Be it, O be it, never more reveal'd! Keep here still, Closet-Gods, 'fore whom I've set Oblations oft of sweetest marmelet.

Ingression, entrance. _Intext_, contents.

653. A BACCHANALIAN VERSE.

Fill me a mighty bowl Up to the brim, That I may drink Unto my Jonson's soul.

Crown it again, again; And thrice repeat That happy heat, To drink to thee, my Ben.

Well I can quaff, I see, To th' number five Or nine; but thrive In frenzy ne'er like thee.

To the number five or nine, see Note.

654. LONG-LOOKED-FOR COMES AT LAST.

Though long it be, years may repay the debt; _None loseth that which he in time may get_.

655. TO YOUTH.

Drink wine, and live here blitheful, while ye may: _The morrow's life too late is; live to-day_.

656. NEVER TOO LATE TO DIE.

No man comes late unto that place from whence Never man yet had a regredience.

Regredience, return.

657. A HYMN TO THE MUSES.

O you the virgins nine! That do our souls incline To noble discipline! Nod to this vow of mine. Come, then, and now inspire My viol and my lyre With your eternal fire, And make me one entire Composer in your choir. Then I'll your altars strew With roses sweet and new; And ever live a true Acknowledger of you.

658. ON HIMSELF.

I'll sing no more, nor will I longer write Of that sweet lady, or that gallant knight. I'll sing no more of frosts, snows, dews and showers; No more of groves, meads, springs and wreaths of flowers. I'll write no more, nor will I tell or sing Of Cupid and his witty cozening: I'll sing no more of death, or shall the grave No more my dirges and my trentalls have.

Trentalls, service for the dead.

660. TO MOMUS.

Who read'st this book that I have writ, And can'st not mend but carp at it; By all the Muses! thou shalt be Anathema to it and me.

661. AMBITION.

In ways to greatness, think on this, _That slippery all ambition is_.

662. THE COUNTRY LIFE, TO THE HONOURED M. END. PORTER, GROOM OF THE BEDCHAMBER TO HIS MAJESTY.

Sweet country life, to such unknown Whose lives are others', not their own! But serving courts and cities, be Less happy, less enjoying thee. Thou never plough'st the ocean's foam To seek and bring rough pepper home; Nor to the Eastern Ind dost rove To bring from thence the scorched clove; Nor, with the loss of thy lov'd rest, Bring'st home the ingot from the West. No, thy ambition's masterpiece Flies no thought higher than a fleece; Or how to pay thy hinds, and clear All scores, and so to end the year: But walk'st about thine own dear bounds, Not envying others larger grounds: For well thou know'st _'tis not th' extent Of land makes life, but sweet content_. When now the cock (the ploughman's horn) Calls forth the lily-wristed morn, Then to thy corn-fields thou dost go, Which though well soil'd, yet thou dost know That the best compost for the lands Is the wise master's feet and hands. There at the plough thou find'st thy team With a hind whistling there to them; And cheer'st them up by singing how The kingdom's portion is the plough. This done, then to th' enamelled meads Thou go'st, and as thy foot there treads, Thou see'st a present God-like power Imprinted in each herb and flower; And smell'st the breath of great-ey'd kine, Sweet as the blossoms of the vine. Here thou behold'st thy large sleek neat Unto the dew-laps up in meat; And, as thou look'st, the wanton steer, The heifer, cow, and ox draw near To make a pleasing pastime there. These seen, thou go'st to view thy flocks Of sheep, safe from the wolf and fox, And find'st their bellies there as full Of short sweet grass as backs with wool, And leav'st them, as they feed and fill, A shepherd piping on a hill. For sports, for pageantry and plays Thou hast thy eves and holidays; On which the young men and maids meet To exercise their dancing feet; Tripping the comely country round, With daffodils and daisies crown'd. Thy wakes, thy quintels here thou hast, Thy May-poles, too, with garlands grac'd; Thy morris dance, thy Whitsun ale, Thy shearing feast which never fail; Thy harvest-home, thy wassail bowl, That's toss'd up after fox i' th' hole; Thy mummeries, thy Twelfth-tide kings And queens, thy Christmas revellings, Thy nut-brown mirth, thy russet wit, And no man pays too dear for it. To these, thou hast thy times to go And trace the hare i' th'

treacherous snow; Thy witty wiles to draw, and get The lark into the trammel net; Thou hast thy cockrood and thy glade To take the precious pheasant made; Thy lime-twigs, snares and pit-falls then To catch the pilfering birds, not men. O happy life! if that their good The husbandmen but understood! Who all the day themselves do please, And younglings, with such sports as these, And lying down have nought t' affright Sweet sleep, that makes more short the night. _Cætera desunt ----_

Soil'd, manured. _Compost_, preparation. _Fox i' th' hole_, a hopping game in which boys beat each other with gloves. _Cockrood_, a run for snaring woodcocks. _Glade_, an opening in the wood across which nets were hung to catch game. (Willoughby, _Ornithologie_, i. 3.)

663. TO ELECTRA.

I dare not ask a kiss, I dare not beg a smile, Lest having that, or this, I might grow proud the while.

No, no, the utmost share Of my desire shall be Only to kiss that air That lately kissed thee.

664. TO HIS WORTHY FRIEND, M. ARTHUR BARTLY.

When after many lusters thou shalt be Wrapt up in sear-cloth with thine ancestry; When of thy ragg'd escutcheons shall be seen So little left, as if they ne'er had been; Thou shalt thy name have, and thy fame's best trust, Here with the generation of my Just.

Luster, a period of five years.

665. WHAT KIND OF MISTRESS HE WOULD HAVE.

Be the mistress of my choice Clean in manners, clear in voice; Be she witty more than wise, Pure enough, though not precise; Be she showing in her dress Like a civil wilderness; That the curious may detect Order in a sweet neglect; Be she rolling in her eye, Tempting all the passers-by; And each ringlet of her hair An enchantment, or a snare For to catch the lookers-on; But herself held fast by none. Let her Lucrece all day be, Thais in the night to me. Be she such as neither will _Famish me, nor overfill_.

667. THE ROSEMARY BRANCH.

Grow for two ends, it matters not at all, Be 't for my bridal or my burial.

669. UPON CRAB. EPIG.

Crab faces gowns with sundry furs; 'tis known He keeps the fox fur for to face his own.

670. A PARANÆTICALL, OR ADVISIVE VERSE, TO HIS FRIEND, M. JOHN WICKS.

Is this a life, to break thy sleep, To rise as soon as day doth peep? To tire thy patient ox or ass By noon, and let thy good days pass, Not knowing this, that Jove decrees Some mirth t' adulce man's miseries? No; 'tis a life to have thine oil Without extortion from thy soil; Thy faithful fields to yield thee grain, Although with some, yet little, pain; To have thy mind, and nuptial bed, With fears and cares uncumbered; A

pleasing wife, that by thy side Lies softly panting like a bride. This is to live, and to endear Those minutes Time has lent us here. Then, while fates suffer, live thou free As is that air that circles thee, And crown thy temples too, and let Thy servant, not thy own self, sweat, To strut thy barns with sheafs of wheat. Time steals away like to a stream, And we glide hence away with them. _No sound recalls the hours once fled, Or roses, being withered_; Nor us, my friend, when we are lost, Like to a dew or melted frost. Then live we mirthful while we should, And turn the iron age to gold. Let's feast, and frolic, sing, and play, And thus less last than live our day. _Whose life with care is overcast, That man's not said to live, but last; Nor is't a life, seven years to tell, But for to live that half seven well;_ And that we'll do, as men who know, Some few sands spent, we hence must go, Both to be blended in the urn From whence there's never a return.

Adulce, sweeten. _Strut_, swell.

671. ONCE SEEN AND NO MORE.

Thousands each day pass by, which we, Once past and gone, no more shall see.

672. LOVE.

This axiom I have often heard, _Kings ought to be more lov'd than fear'd_.

673. TO M. DENHAM ON HIS PROSPECTIVE POEM.

Or look'd I back unto the times hence flown To praise those Muses and dislike our own-- Or did I walk those Pæan-gardens through, To kick the flowers and scorn their odours too-- I might, and justly, be reputed here One nicely mad or peevishly severe. But by Apollo! as I worship wit, Where I have cause to burn perfumes to it; So, I confess, 'tis somewhat to do well In our high art, although we can't excel Like thee, or dare the buskins to unloose Of thy brave, bold, and sweet Maronian muse. But since I'm call'd, rare Denham, to be gone, Take from thy Herrick this conclusion: 'Tis dignity in others, if they be Crown'd poets, yet live princes under thee; The while their wreaths and purple robes do shine Less by their own gems than those beams of thine.

Pæan-gardens, gardens sacred to Apollo. _Nicely_, fastidiously.

674. A HYMN TO THE LARES.

It was, and still my care is, To worship ye, the Lares, With crowns of greenest parsley And garlic chives, not scarcely; For favours here to warm me, And not by fire to harm me; For gladding so my hearth here With inoffensive mirth here; That while the wassail bowl here With North-down ale doth troul here, No syllable doth fall here To mar the mirth at all here. For which, O chimney-keepers! (I dare not call ye sweepers) So long as I am able To keep a country table, Great be my fare, or small cheer, I'll eat and drink up all here.

Troul, pass round.

675. DENIAL IN WOMEN NO DISHEARTENING TO MEN.

Women, although they ne'er so goodly make it, Their fashion is, but to say no, to take it.

676. ADVERSITY.

Love is maintain'd by wealth; when all is spent, _Adversity then breeds the discontent_.

677. TO FORTUNE.

Tumble me down, and I will sit Upon my ruins, smiling yet; Tear me to tatters, yet I'll be Patient in my necessity. Laugh at my scraps of clothes, and shun Me, as a fear'd infection; Yet, scare-crow-like, I'll walk as one Neglecting thy derision.

678. TO ANTHEA.

Come, Anthea, know thou this, _Love at no time idle is_; Let's be doing, though we play But at push-pin half the day; Chains of sweet bents let us make Captive one, or both, to take: In which bondage we will lie, Souls transfusing thus, and die.

Push-pin, a childish game in which one player placed a pin and the other pushed it. _Bents_, grasses.

679. CRUELTIES.

Nero commanded; but withdrew his eyes From the beholding death and cruelties.

680. PERSEVERANCE.

Hast thou begun an act? ne'er then give o'er: _No man despairs to do what's done before_.

681. UPON HIS VERSES.

What offspring other men have got, The how, where, when, I question not. These are the children I have left, Adopted some, none got by theft; But all are touch'd, like lawful plate, And no verse illegitimate.

Touch'd, tested.

682. DISTANCE BETTERS DIGNITIES.

Kings must not oft be seen by public eyes: _State at a distance adds to dignities_.

683. HEALTH.

Health is no other, as the learned hold, But a just measure both of heat and cold.

684. TO DIANEME. A CEREMONY IN GLOUCESTER.

I'll to thee a simnel bring, 'Gainst thou go'st a-mothering: So that when she blesseth thee, Half that blessing thou'lt give me.

Simnel, a cake, originally made of fine flour, eaten at Mid-Lent. _A-mothering_, visiting relations in Mid-Lent, but see Note.

685. TO THE KING.

Give way, give way! now, now my Charles shines here A public light, in this immensive sphere; Some stars were fix'd before, but these are dim Compar'd, in this my ample orb, to him. Draw in your feeble fires, while that he Appears but in his meaner majesty. Where, if such glory flashes from his name, Which is his shade, who can abide his flame! _Princes, and such like public lights as these, Must not be look'd on but at distances: For, if we gaze on these brave lamps too near, Our eyes they'll blind, or if not blind, they'll blear._

Immensive, immeasurable.

686. THE FUNERAL RITES OF THE ROSE.

The rose was sick, and smiling died; And, being to be sanctified, About the bed there sighing stood The sweet and flowery sisterhood. Some hung the head, while some did bring, To wash her, water from the spring. Some laid her forth, while others wept, But all a solemn fast there kept. The holy sisters, some among, The sacred dirge and trentall sung. But ah! what sweets smelt everywhere, As heaven had spent all perfumes there. At last, when prayers for the dead And rites were all accomplished, They, weeping, spread a lawny loom And clos'd her up, as in a tomb.

Trentall, a service for the dead.

687. THE RAINBOW, OR CURIOUS COVENANT.

Mine eyes, like clouds, were drizzling rain; And as they thus did entertain The gentle beams from Julia's sight To mine eyes levell'd opposite, O thing admir'd! there did appear A curious rainbow smiling there; Which was the covenant that she No more would drown mine eyes or me.

688. THE LAST STROKE STRIKES SURE.

Though by well warding many blows we've pass'd, _That stroke most fear'd is which is struck the last_.

689. FORTUNE.

Fortune's a blind profuser of her own, Too much she gives to some, enough to none.

690. STOOL-BALL.

At stool-ball, Lucia, let us play For sugar-cakes and wine: Or for a tansy let us pay, The loss, or thine, or mine.

If thou, my dear, a winner be At trundling of the ball, The wager thou shall have, and me, And my misfortunes all.

But if, my sweetest, I shall get, Then I desire but this: That likewise I may pay the bet And have for all a kiss.

Stool-ball, a game of ball played by girls. _Tansy_, a cake made of eggs, cream, and herbs.

691. TO SAPPHO.

Let us now take time and play, Love, and live here while we may; Drink rich wine, and make good cheer, While we have our being here; For once dead and laid i' th' grave, No return from thence we have.

692. ON POET PRAT. EPIG.

Prat he writes satires, but herein's the fault, In no one satire there's a mite of salt.

693. UPON TUCK. EPIG.

At post and pair, or slam, Tom Tuck would play This Christmas, but his want wherewith says nay.

Post and pair, or slam, old games of cards. Ben Jonson calls the former a "thrifty and right worshipful game".

694. BITING OF BEGGARS.

Who, railing, drives the lazar from his door, Instead of alms, sets dogs upon the poor.

695. THE MAY-POLE.

The May-pole is up! Now give me the cup, I'll drink to the garlands around it; But first unto those Whose hands did compose The glory of flowers that crown'd it.

A health to my girls, Whose husbands may earls Or lords be, granting my wishes, And when that ye wed To the bridal bed, Then multiply all like to fishes.

696. MEN MIND NO STATE IN SICKNESS.

That flow of gallants which approach To kiss thy hand from out the coach; That fleet of lackeys which do run Before thy swift postillion; Those strong-hoof'd mules which we behold Rein'd in with purple, pearl, and gold, And shod with silver, prove to be The drawers of the axletree. Thy wife, thy children, and the state Of Persian looms and antique plate; All these, and more, shall then afford No joy to thee, their sickly lord.

697. ADVERSITY.

Adversity hurts none, but only such Whom whitest fortune dandled has too much.

698. WANT.

Need is no vice at all, though here it be With men a loathed inconveniency.

699. GRIEF.

Sorrows divided amongst many, less Discruciate a man in deep distress.

Discruciate, torture.

700. LOVE PALPABLE.

I press'd my Julia's lips, and in the kiss Her soul and love were palpable in this.

701. NO ACTION HARD TO AFFECTION.

Nothing hard or harsh can prove Unto those that truly love.

702. MEAN THINGS OVERCOME MIGHTY.

By the weak'st means things mighty are o'erthrown. _He's lord of thy life who contemns his own_.

705. THE BRACELET OF PEARL: TO SILVIA.

I brake thy bracelet 'gainst my will, And, wretched, I did see Thee discomposed then, and still Art discontent with me.

One gem was lost, and I will get A richer pearl for thee, Than ever, dearest Silvia, yet Was drunk to Antony.

Or, for revenge, I'll tell thee what Thou for the breach shall do; First crack the strings, and after that Cleave thou my heart in two.

706. HOW ROSES CAME RED.

'Tis said, as Cupid danc'd among The gods he down the nectar flung, Which on the white rose being shed Made it for ever after red.

707. KINGS.

Men are not born kings, but are men renown'd; Chose first, confirm'd next, and at last are crown'd.

708. FIRST WORK, AND THEN WAGES.

Preposterous is that order, when we run To ask our wages ere our work be done.

Preposterous, lit. hind part before.

709. TEARS AND LAUGHTER.

Knew'st thou one month would take thy life away, Thou'dst weep; but laugh, should it not last a day.

710. GLORY.

Glory no other thing is, Tully says, Than a man's frequent fame spoke out with praise.

711. POSSESSIONS.

Those possessions short-liv'd are, Into the which we come by war.

713. HIS RETURN TO LONDON.

From the dull confines of the drooping West To see the day spring from the pregnant East, Ravish'd in spirit I come, nay, more, I fly To thee, bless'd place of my nativity! Thus, thus with hallowed foot I touch the ground, With thousand blessings by thy fortune crown'd. O fruitful Genius! that bestowest here An everlasting plenty, year by year. O place! O people! Manners! fram'd to please All nations, customs, kindreds, languages! I am a free-born Roman; suffer, then, That I amongst you live a citizen. London my home is: though by hard fate sent Into a long and irksome

banishment; Yet since call'd back; henceforward let me be, O native country, repossess'd by thee! For, rather than I'll to the West return, I'll beg of thee first here to have mine urn. Weak I am grown, and must in short time fall; Give thou my sacred relics burial.

714. NOT EVERY DAY FIT FOR VERSE.

'Tis not ev'ry day that I Fitted am to prophesy; No; but when the spirit fills The fantastic pannicles Full of fire, then I write As the godhead doth indite. Thus enrag'd, my lines are hurled, Like the Sybil's, through the world. Look how next the holy fire Either slakes, or doth retire; So the fancy cools, till when That brave spirit comes again.

Fantastic pannicles, brain cells of the imagination. _Sybil's_, the oracles of the Cumæan Sybil were written on leaves, which the wind blew about her cave.--Virg. Æn. iv.

715. POVERTY THE GREATEST PACK.

To mortal men great loads allotted be, _But of all packs, no pack like poverty_.

716. A BUCOLIC, OR DISCOURSE OF NEATHERDS.

1. Come, blitheful neatherds, let us lay A wager who the best shall play, Of thee or I, the roundelay That fits the business of the day.

Chor. And Lalage the judge shall be, To give the prize to thee, or me.

2. Content, begin, and I will bet A heifer smooth, and black as jet, In every part alike complete, And wanton as a kid as yet.

Chor. And Lalage, with cow-like eyes, Shall be disposeress of the prize.

1. Against thy heifer, I will here Lay to thy stake a lusty steer With gilded horns, and burnish'd clear.

Chor. Why, then, begin, and let us hear The soft, the sweet, the mellow note That gently purls from either's oat.

2. The stakes are laid: let's now apply Each one to make his melody.

Lal. The equal umpire shall be I, Who'll hear, and so judge righteously.

Chor. Much time is spent in prate; begin, And sooner play, the sooner win.

[_1 Neatherd plays_

2. That's sweetly touch'd, I must confess, Thou art a man of worthiness; But hark how I can now express My love unto my neatherdess. [_He sings_

Chor. A sugar'd note! and sound as sweet As kine when they at milking meet.

1. Now for to win thy heifer fair, I'll strike thee such a nimble air That thou shalt say thyself 'tis rare, And title me without compare.

Chor. Lay by a while your pipes, and rest, Since both have here deserved best.

2. To get thy steerling, once again I'll play thee such another strain That thou shalt swear my pipe does reign Over thine oat as sovereign. [_He sings_

Chor. And Lalage shall tell by this, Whose now the prize and wager is.

1. Give me the prize. 2. The day is mine. 1. Not so; my pipe has silenc'd thine: And hadst thou wager'd twenty kine, They were mine own. _Lal._ In love combine.

Chor. And lay ye down your pipes together, As weary, not o'ercome by either.

And lay ye _down your pipes_. The original edition reads _And lay_ we _down_ our _pipes_.

717. TRUE SAFETY.

'Tis not the walls or purple that defends A prince from foes, but 'tis his fort of friends.

718. A PROGNOSTIC.

As many laws and lawyers do express Nought but a kingdom's ill-affectedness; Even so, those streets and houses do but show Store of diseases where physicians flow.

719. UPON JULIA'S SWEAT.

Would ye oil of blossoms get? Take it from my Julia's sweat: Oil of lilies and of spike? From her moisture take the like. Let her breathe, or let her blow, All rich spices thence will flow.

Spike, lavender.

720. PROOF TO NO PURPOSE.

You see this gentle stream that glides, Shov'd on by quick-succeeding tides; Try if this sober stream you can Follow to th' wilder ocean; And see if there it keeps unspent In that congesting element. Next, from that world of waters, then By pores and caverns back again Induct that inadult'rate same Stream to the spring from whence it came. This with a wonder when ye do, As easy, and else easier too, Then may ye recollect the grains Of my particular remains, After a thousand lusters hurl'd By ruffling winds about the world.

721. FAME.

'Tis still observ'd that fame ne'er sings The order, but the sum of things.

722. BY USE COMES EASINESS.

Oft bend the bow, and thou with ease shalt do What others can't with all their strength put to.

723. TO THE GENIUS OF HIS HOUSE.

Command the roof, great Genius, and from thence Into this house pour down thy influence, That through each room a golden pipe may run Of living water by thy benison. Fulfill the larders, and with strengthening bread Be evermore these bins

replenished. Next, like a bishop consecrate my ground, That lucky fairies here may dance their round; And after that, lay down some silver pence The master's charge and care to recompense. Charm then the chambers, make the beds for ease, More than for peevish, pining sicknesses. Fix the foundation fast, and let the roof Grow old with time but yet keep weather-proof.

724. HIS GRANGE, OR PRIVATE WEALTH.

Though clock, To tell how night draws hence, I've none, A cock I have to sing how day draws on. I have A maid, my Prew, by good luck sent To save That little Fates me gave or lent. A hen I keep, which creeking day by day, Tells when She goes her long white egg to lay. A goose I have, which with a jealous ear Lets loose Her tongue to tell that danger's near. A lamb I keep, tame, with my morsels fed, Whose dam An orphan left him, lately dead. A cat I keep that plays about my house, Grown fat With eating many a miching mouse. To these A Tracy[A] I do keep whereby I please The more my rural privacy; Which are But toys to give my heart some ease; Where care None is, slight things do lightly please.

My Prew, Prudence Baldwin. _Creeking_, clucking. _Miching_, skulking.

[A] His spaniel. (Note in the original edition.)

725. GOOD PRECEPTS OR COUNSEL.

In all thy need be thou possess'd Still with a well-prepared breast; Nor let the shackles make thee sad; Thou canst but have what others had. And this for comfort thou must know Times that are ill won't still be so. Clouds will not ever pour down rain; _A sullen day will clear again_. First peals of thunder we must hear, Then lutes and harps shall stroke the ear.

726. MONEY MAKES THE MIRTH.

When all birds else do of their music fail, Money's the still sweet-singing nightingale.

727. UP TAILS ALL.

Begin with a kiss, Go on too with this; And thus, thus, thus let us smother Our lips for awhile, But let's not beguile Our hope of one for the other.

This play, be assur'd, Long enough has endur'd, Since more and more is exacted; For Love he doth call For his _uptails all_; And that's the part to be acted.

Uptails all, the refrain of a song beginning "Fly Merry News": see Note.

729. UPON LUCIA DABBLED IN THE DEW.

My Lucia in the dew did go, And prettily bedabbled so, Her clothes held up, she showed withal Her decent legs, clean, long, and small. I follow'd after to descry Part of the nak'd sincerity; But still the envious scene between Denied the mask I would have seen.

Decent, in the Latin sense, comely; _sincerity_, purity. _Scene_, a curtain or "drop-scene". _Mask_, a play.

730. CHARON AND PHILOMEL; A DIALOGUE SUNG.

_Ph._ Charon! O gentle Charon! let me woo thee By tears and pity now to come unto me. _Ch._ What voice so sweet and charming do I hear? Say what thou art. _Ph._ I prithee first draw near. _Ch._ A sound I hear, but nothing yet can see; Speak, where thou art. _Ph._ O Charon pity me! I am a bird, and though no name I tell, My warbling note will say I'm Philomel. _Ch._ What's that to me? I waft nor fish or fowls, Nor beasts, fond thing, but only human souls. _Ph._ Alas for me! _Ch._ Shame on thy witching note That made me thus hoist sail and bring my boat: But I'll return; what mischief brought thee hither? _Ph._ A deal of love and much, much grief together. _Ch._ What's thy request? _Ph._ That since she's now beneath Who fed my life, I'll follow her in death. _Ch._ And is that all? I'm gone. _Ph._ By love I pray thee. _Ch._ Talk not of love; all pray, but few souls pay me. _Ph._ I'll give thee vows and tears. _Ch._ Can tears pay scores For mending sails, for patching boat and oars? _Ph._ I'll beg a penny, or I'll sing so long Till thou shalt say I've paid thee with a song. _Ch._ Why then begin; and all the while we make Our slothful passage o'er the Stygian Lake, Thou and I'll sing to make these dull shades merry, Who else with tears would doubtless drown my ferry.

Fond, foolish. _She's now beneath_, her mother Zeuxippe?

733. A TERNARY OF LITTLES, UPON A PIPKIN OF JELLY SENT TO A LADY.

A little saint best fits a little shrine, A little prop best fits a little vine: As my small cruse best fits my little wine.

A little seed best fits a little soil, A little trade best fits a little toil: As my small jar best fits my little oil.

A little bin best fits a little bread, A little garland fits a little head: As my small stuff best fits my little shed.

A little hearth best fits a little fire, A little chapel fits a little choir: As my small bell best fits my little spire.

A little stream best fits a little boat, A little lead best fits a little float: As my small pipe best fits my little note.

A little meat best fits a little belly, As sweetly, lady, give me leave to tell ye, This little pipkin fits this little jelly.

734. UPON THE ROSES IN JULIA'S BOSOM.

Thrice happy roses, so much grac'd to have Within the bosom of my love your grave. Die when ye will, your sepulchre is known, Your grave her bosom is, the lawn the stone.

735. MAIDS' NAYS ARE NOTHING.

Maids' nays are nothing, they are shy But to desire what they deny.

736. THE SMELL OF THE SACRIFICE.

The gods require the thighs Of beeves for sacrifice; Which roasted, we the steam Must sacrifice to them, Who though they do not eat, Yet love the smell of meat.

737. LOVERS: HOW THEY COME AND PART.

A gyges' ring they bear about them still, To be, and not seen when and where they will. They tread on clouds, and though they sometimes fall, They fall like dew, but make no noise at all. So silently they one to th' other come, As colours steal into the pear or plum, And air-like, leave no pression to be seen Where'er they met or parting place has been.

Gyges' ring, which made the wearer invisible.

738. TO WOMEN, TO HIDE THEIR TEETH IF THEY BE ROTTEN OR RUSTY.

Close keep your lips, if that you mean To be accounted inside clean: For if you cleave them we shall see There in your teeth much leprosy.

739. IN PRAISE OF WOMEN.

O Jupiter, should I speak ill Of woman-kind, first die I will; Since that I know, 'mong all the rest Of creatures, woman is the best.

740. THE APRON OF FLOWERS.

To gather flowers Sappha went, And homeward she did bring Within her lawny continent The treasure of the spring.

She smiling blush'd, and blushing smil'd, And sweetly blushing thus, She look'd as she'd been got with child By young Favonius.

Her apron gave, as she did pass, An odour more divine, More pleasing, too, than ever was The lap of Proserpine.

Continent, anything that holds, here the bosom of her dress.

741. THE CANDOUR OF JULIA'S TEETH.

White as Zenobia's teeth, the which the girls Of Rome did wear for their most precious pearls.

Zenobia, Queen of Palmyra, conquered by the Romans, A.D. 273.

742. UPON HER WEEPING.

She wept upon her cheeks, and weeping so, She seem'd to quench love's fire that there did glow.

743. ANOTHER UPON HER WEEPING.

She by the river sat, and sitting there, She wept, and made it deeper by a tear.

744. DELAY.

Break off delay, since we but read of one That ever prospered by cunctation.

Cunctation, delay: the word is suggested by the name of Fabius Cunctator, the conqueror of the Carthaginians, addressed by Virg. (Æn. vi. 846) as "Unus qui nobis

cunctando restituis rem".

745. TO SIR JOHN BERKLEY, GOVERNOR OF EXETER.

Stand forth, brave man, since fate has made thee here The Hector over aged Exeter, Who for a long, sad time has weeping stood Like a poor lady lost in widowhood, But fears not now to see her safety sold, As other towns and cities were, for gold By those ignoble births which shame the stem That gave progermination unto them: Whose restless ghosts shall hear their children sing, "Our sires betrayed their country and their king". True, if this city seven times rounded was With rock, and seven times circumflank'd with brass, Yet if thou wert not, Berkley, loyal proof, The senators, down tumbling with the roof, Would into prais'd, but pitied, ruins fall, Leaving no show where stood the capitol. But thou art just and itchless, and dost please Thy Genius with two strengthening buttresses, Faith and affection, which will never slip To weaken this thy great dictatorship.

Progermination, budding out. _Itchless_, _i.e._, with no itch for bribes.

746. TO ELECTRA. LOVE LOOKS FOR LOVE.

Love love begets, then never be Unsoft to him who's smooth to thee. Tigers and bears, I've heard some say, For proffer'd love will love repay: None are so harsh, but if they find Softness in others, will be kind; Affection will affection move, Then you must like because I love.

747. REGRESSION SPOILS RESOLUTION.

Hast thou attempted greatness? then go on: Back-turning slackens resolution.

748. CONTENTION.

Discreet and prudent we that discord call That either profits, or not hurts at all.

749. CONSULTATION.

Consult ere thou begin'st; that done, go on With all wise speed for execution.

Consult, take counsel. The word and the epigram are suggested by Sallust's "Nam et, prius quam incipias, consulto, et ubi consulueris, mature facto opus est," Cat. i.

750. LOVE DISLIKES NOTHING.

Whatsoever thing I see, Rich or poor although it be; 'Tis a mistress unto me.

Be my girl or fair or brown, Does she smile or does she frown, Still I write a sweetheart down.

Be she rough or smooth of skin; When I touch I then begin For to let affection in.

Be she bald, or does she wear Locks incurl'd of other hair, I shall find enchantment there.

Be she whole, or be she rent, So my fancy be content, She's to me most excellent.

Be she fat, or be she lean, Be she sluttish, be she clean, I'm a man for ev'ry scene.

751. OUR OWN SINS UNSEEN.

Other men's sins we ever bear in mind; _None sees the fardell of his faults behind_.

Fardell, bundle.

752. NO PAINS, NO GAINS.

If little labour, little are our gains: Man's fortunes are according to his pains.

754. VIRTUE BEST UNITED.

By so much, virtue is the less, By how much, near to singleness.

755. THE EYE.

A wanton and lascivious eye Betrays the heart's adultery.

756. TO PRINCE CHARLES UPON HIS COMING TO EXETER.

What fate decreed, time now has made us see, A renovation of the west by thee. That preternatural fever, which did threat Death to our country, now hath lost his heat, And, calms succeeding, we perceive no more Th' unequal pulse to beat, as heretofore. Something there yet remains for thee to do; Then reach those ends that thou wast destin'd to. Go on with Sylla's fortune; let thy fate Make thee like him, this, that way fortunate: Apollo's image side with thee to bless Thy war (discreetly made) with white success. Meantime thy prophets watch by watch shall pray, While young Charles fights, and fighting wins the day: That done, our smooth-paced poems all shall be Sung in the high doxology of thee. Then maids shall strew thee, and thy curls from them Receive with songs a flowery diadem.

Sylla's fortune, in allusion to Sylla's surname of _Felix_. _Doxology_, glorifying.

757. A SONG.

Burn, or drown me, choose ye whether, So I may but die together; Thus to slay me by degrees Is the height of cruelties. What needs twenty stabs, when one Strikes me dead as any stone? O show mercy then, and be Kind at once to murder me.

758. PRINCES AND FAVOURITES.

Princes and fav'rites are most dear, while they By giving and receiving hold the play; But the relation then of both grows poor, When these can ask, and kings can give no more.

759. EXAMPLES; OR, LIKE PRINCE, LIKE PEOPLE.

Examples lead us, and we likely see; Such as the prince is, will his people be.

760. POTENTATES.

Love and the Graces evermore do wait Upon the man that is a potentate.

761. THE WAKE.

Come, Anthea, let us two Go to feast, as others do. Tarts and custards, creams and cakes, Are the junkets still at wakes: Unto which the tribes resort, Where the

business is the sport. Morris-dancers thou shall see, Marian, too, in pageantry, And a mimic to devise Many grinning properties. Players there will be, and those Base in action as in clothes; Yet with strutting they will please The incurious villages. Near the dying of the day There will be a cudgel-play, Where a coxcomb will be broke Ere a good word can be spoke: But the anger ends all here, Drenched in ale, or drown'd in beer. Happy rustics! best content With the cheapest merriment, And possess no other fear Than to want the wake next year.

Marian, Maid Marian of the Robin Hood ballads. _Action_, _i.e._, dramatic action. _Incurious_, careless, easily pleased. _Coxcomb_, to cause blood to flow from the opponent's head was the test of victory.

762. THE PETER-PENNY.

Fresh strewings allow To my sepulchre now, To make my lodging the sweeter; A staff or a wand Put then in my hand, With a penny to pay S. Peter.

Who has not a cross Must sit with the loss, And no whit further must venture; Since the porter he Will paid have his fee, Or else not one there must enter.

Who at a dead lift Can't send for a gift A pig to the priest for a roaster, Shall hear his clerk say, By yea and by nay, _No penny, no paternoster_.

S. Peter, as the gate-ward of heaven. _Cross_, a coin.

763. TO DOCTOR ALABASTER.

Nor art thou less esteem'd that I have plac'd, Amongst mine honour'd, thee almost the last: In great processions many lead the way To him who is the triumph of the day, As these have done to thee who art the one, One only glory of a million: In whom the spirit of the gods does dwell, Firing thy soul, by which thou dost foretell When this or that vast dynasty must fall Down to a fillet more imperial; When this or that horn shall be broke, and when Others shall spring up in their place again; When times and seasons and all years must lie Drowned in the sea of wild eternity; When the black doomsday books, as yet unseal'd, Shall by the mighty angel be reveal'd; And when the trumpet which thou late hast found Shall call to judgment. Tell us when the sound Of this or that great April day shall be, And next the Gospel we will credit thee. Meantime like earth-worms we will crawl below, And wonder at those things that thou dost know.

For an account of Alabaster see Notes: the allusions here are to his apocalyptic writings. _Horn_, used as a symbol of prosperity. _The trumpet which thou late hast found_, _i.e._, Alabaster's "Spiraculum Tubarum seu Fons Spiritualium Expositionum," published 1633. _April day_, day of weeping, or perhaps rather of "opening" or revelation.

764. UPON HIS KINSWOMAN, MRS. M. S.

Here lies a virgin, and as sweet As e'er was wrapt in winding sheet. Her name if next you would have known, The marble speaks it, Mary Stone: Who dying in her blooming years, This stone for name's sake melts to tears. If, fragrant virgins, you'll but keep A fast, while jets and marbles weep, And praying, strew some roses on her,

You'll do my niece abundant honour.

765. FELICITY KNOWS NO FENCE.

Of both our fortunes good and bad we find Prosperity more searching of the mind: Felicity flies o'er the wall and fence, While misery keeps in with patience.

766. DEATH ENDS ALL WOE.

Time is the bound of things; where'er we go _Fate gives a meeting, Death's the end of woe_.

767. A CONJURATION TO ELECTRA.

By those soft tods of wool With which the air is full; By all those tinctures there, That paint the hemisphere; By dews and drizzling rain That swell the golden grain; By all those sweets that be I' th' flowery nunnery; By silent nights, and the Three forms of Hecate; By all aspects that bless The sober sorceress, While juice she strains, and pith To make her philters with; By time that hastens on Things to perfection; And by yourself, the best Conjurement of the rest: O my Electra! be In love with none, but me.

Tods of wool, literally, tod of wool=twenty-eight pounds, here used of the fleecy clouds. _Tinctures_, colours. _Three forms of Hecate_, the _Diva triformis_ of Hor. Od. iii. 22. Luna in heaven, Diana on earth, Persephone in the world below. _Aspects_, _i.e._, of the planets.

768. COURAGE COOLED.

I cannot love as I have lov'd before; For I'm grown old and, with mine age, grown poor. _Love must be fed by wealth_: this blood of mine Must needs wax cold, if wanting bread and wine.

769. THE SPELL.

Holy water come and bring; Cast in salt, for seasoning: Set the brush for sprinkling: Sacred spittle bring ye hither; Meal and it now mix together, And a little oil to either. Give the tapers here their light, Ring the saints'-bell, to affright Far from hence the evil sprite.

770. HIS WISH TO PRIVACY.

Give me a cell To dwell, Where no foot hath A path: There will I spend And end My wearied years In tears.

771. A GOOD HUSBAND.

A Master of a house, as I have read, Must be the first man up, and last in bed. With the sun rising he must walk his grounds; See this, view that, and all the other bounds: Shut every gate; mend every hedge that's torn, Either with old, or plant therein new thorn; Tread o'er his glebe, but with such care, that where He sets his foot, he leaves rich compost there.

772. A HYMN TO BACCHUS.

I sing thy praise, Iacchus, Who with thy thyrse dost thwack us: And yet thou so dost back us With boldness, that we fear No Brutus ent'ring here, Nor Cato the severe. What though the lictors threat us, We know they dare not beat us, So long as thou dost heat us. When we thy orgies sing, Each cobbler is a king, Nor dreads he any thing: And though he do not rave, Yet he'll the courage have To call my Lord Mayor knave; Besides, too, in a brave, Although he has no riches, But walks with dangling breeches And skirts that want their stitches, And shows his naked flitches, Yet he'll be thought or seen So good as George-a-Green; And calls his blouze, his queen; And speaks in language keen. O Bacchus! let us be From cares and troubles free; And thou shalt hear how we Will chant new hymns to thee.

Orgies, hymns to Bacchus. _Brave_, boast. _George-a-Green_, the legendary pinner of Wakefield, renowned for the use of the quarterstaff. _Blouze_, a fat wench.

773. UPON PUSS AND HER 'PRENTICE. EPIG.

Puss and her 'prentice both at drawgloves play; That done, they kiss, and so draw out the day: At night they draw to supper; then well fed, They draw their clothes off both, so draw to bed.

Drawgloves, the game of talking on the fingers.

774. BLAME THE REWARD OF PRINCES.

Among disasters that dissension brings, This not the least is, which belongs to kings: If wars go well, each for a part lays claim; If ill, then kings, not soldiers, bear the blame.

775. CLEMENCY IN KINGS.

Kings must not only cherish up the good, But must be niggards of the meanest blood.

776. ANGER.

Wrongs, if neglected, vanish in short time, But heard with anger, we confess the crime.

777. A PSALM OR HYMN TO THE GRACES.

Glory be to the Graces! That do in public places Drive thence whate'er encumbers The list'ning to my numbers.

Honour be to the Graces! Who do with sweet embraces, Show they are well contented With what I have invented.

Worship be to the Graces! Who do from sour faces, And lungs that would infect me, For evermore protect me.

778. A HYMN TO THE MUSES.

Honour to you who sit Near to the well of wit, And drink your fill of it.

Glory and worship be To you, sweet maids, thrice three, Who still inspire me,

And teach me how to sing Unto the lyric string My measures ravishing.

Then while I sing your praise, My priesthood crown with bays Green, to the end of days.

779. UPON JULIA'S CLOTHES.

Whenas in silks my Julia goes, Then, then, methinks, how sweetly flows The liquefaction of her clothes.

Next, when I cast mine eyes and see That brave vibration each way free; O how that glittering taketh me!

780. MODERATION.

In things a moderation keep: _Kings ought to shear, not skin their sheep_.

781. TO ANTHEA.

Let's call for Hymen, if agreed thou art; _Delays in love but crucify the heart_. Love's thorny tapers yet neglected lie: Speak thou the word, they'll kindle by-and-bye. The nimble hours woo us on to wed, And Genius waits to have us both to bed. Behold, for us the naked Graces stay With maunds of roses for to strew the way: Besides, the most religious prophet stands Ready to join, as well our hearts as hands. Juno yet smiles; but if she chance to chide, Ill luck 'twill bode to th' bridegroom and the bride. Tell me, Anthea, dost thou fondly dread The loss of that we call a maidenhead? Come, I'll instruct thee. Know, the vestal fire Is not by marriage quench'd, but flames the higher.

Maunds, baskets. _Fondly_, foolishly.

782. UPON PREW, HIS MAID.

In this little urn is laid Prudence Baldwin, once my maid: From whose happy spark here let Spring the purple violet.

783. THE INVITATION.

To sup with thee thou did'st me home invite; And mad'st a promise that mine appetite Should meet and tire on such lautitious meat, The like not Heliogabalus did eat: And richer wine would'st give to me, thy guest, Than Roman Sylla pour'd out at his feast. I came, 'tis true, and looked for fowl of price, The bastard phœnix, bird of paradise, And for no less than aromatic wine Of maiden's-blush, commix'd with jessamine. Clean was the hearth, the mantel larded jet; Which wanting Lar, and smoke, hung weeping wet; At last, i' th' noon of winter, did appear A ragg'd-soust-neat's-foot with sick vinegar: And in a burnished flagonet stood by, Beer small as comfort, dead as charity. At which amaz'd, and pondering on the food, How cold it was, and how it chill'd my blood; I curs'd the master, and I damn'd the souce, And swore I'd got the ague of the house. Well, when to eat thou dost me next desire, I'll bring a fever, since thou keep'st no fire.

Tire, feed on. _Lautitious_, sumptuous. _Maiden's-blush_, the pink-rose. _Larded jet_, _i.e._, blacked. _Soust_, pickled.

784. CEREMONIES FOR CHRISTMAS.

Come, bring with a noise, My merry, merry boys, The Christmas log to the firing; While my good dame, she Bids ye all be free, And drink to your hearts' desiring.

With the last year's brand Light the new block, and For good success in his spending On your psaltries play, That sweet luck may Come while the log is a-teending.

Drink now the strong beer, Cut the white loaf here; The while the meat is a-shredding For the rare mince-pie, And the plums stand by To fill the paste that's a-kneading.

Psaltries, a kind of guitar. _Teending_, kindling.

785. CHRISTMAS-EVE, ANOTHER CEREMONY.

Come guard this night the Christmas-pie, That the thief, though ne'er so sly, With his flesh-hooks, don't come nigh To catch it From him, who all alone sits there, Having his eyes still in his ear, And a deal of nightly fear, To watch it.

786. ANOTHER TO THE MAIDS.

Wash your hands, or else the fire Will not teend to your desire; Unwash'd hands, ye maidens, know, Dead the fire, though ye blow.

Teend, kindle.

787. ANOTHER.

Wassail the trees, that they may bear You many a plum and many a pear: For more or less fruits they will bring, As you do give them wassailing.

788. POWER AND PEACE.

'Tis never, or but seldom known, Power and peace to keep one throne.

789. TO HIS DEAR VALENTINE, MISTRESS MARGARET FALCONBRIDGE.

Now is your turn, my dearest, to be set A gem in this eternal coronet: 'Twas rich before, but since your name is down It sparkles now like Ariadne's crown. Blaze by this sphere for ever: or this do, Let me and it shine evermore by you.

790. TO OENONE.

Sweet Oenone, do but say Love thou dost, though love says nay. Speak me fair; for lovers be Gently kill'd by flattery.

791. VERSES.

Who will not honour noble numbers, when Verses out-live the bravest deeds of men?

792. HAPPINESS.

That happiness does still the longest thrive, Where joys and griefs have turns alternative.

793. THINGS OF CHOICE LONG A-COMING.

We pray 'gainst war, yet we enjoy no peace; _Desire deferr'd is that it may increase_.

794. POETRY PERPETUATES THE POET.

Here I myself might likewise die, And utterly forgotten lie, But that eternal poetry Repullulation gives me here Unto the thirtieth thousand year, When all now dead shall reappear.

Repullulation, rejuvenescence. _Thirtieth thousand year_, an allusion to the doctrine of the Platonic year.

797. KISSES.

Give me the food that satisfies a guest: Kisses are but dry banquets to a feast.

798. ORPHEUS.

Orpheus he went, as poets tell, To fetch Eurydice from hell; And had her; but it was upon This short but strict condition: Backward he should not look while he Led her through hell's obscurity: But ah! it happened, as he made His passage through that dreadful shade, Revolve he did his loving eye, For gentle fear or jealousy; And looking back, that look did sever Him and Eurydice for ever.

803. TO SAPPHO.

Sappho, I will choose to go Where the northern winds do blow Endless ice and endless snow: Rather than I once would see But a winter's face in thee, To benumb my hopes and me.

804. TO HIS FAITHFUL FRIEND, M. JOHN CROFTS, CUP-BEARER TO THE KING.

For all thy many courtesies to me, Nothing I have, my Crofts, to send to thee For the requital, save this only one Half of my just remuneration. For since I've travell'd all this realm throughout To seek and find some few immortals out To circumspangle this my spacious sphere, As lamps for everlasting shining here; And having fix'd thee in mine orb a star, Amongst the rest, both bright and singular, The present age will tell the world thou art, If not to th' whole, yet satisfi'd in part. As for the rest, being too great a sum Here to be paid, I'll pay't i' th' world to come.

805. THE BRIDE-CAKE.

This day, my Julia, thou must make For Mistress Bride the wedding-cake: Knead but the dough, and it will be To paste of almonds turn'd by thee: Or kiss it thou but once or twice, And for the bride-cake there'll be spice.

806. TO BE MERRY.

Let's now take our time While w'are in our prime, And old, old age is afar off: For the evil, evil days Will come on apace, Before we can be aware of.

807. BURIAL.

Man may want land to live in; but for all Nature finds out some place for burial.

808. LENITY.

'Tis the Chirurgeon's praise, and height of art, Not to cut off, but cure the vicious part.

809. PENITENCE.

Who after his transgression doth repent, Is half, or altogether innocent.

810. GRIEF.

Consider sorrows, how they are aright: _Grief, if't be great, 'tis short; if long, 'tis light_.

811. THE MAIDEN-BLUSH.

So look the mornings when the sun Paints them with fresh vermilion: So cherries blush, and Kathern pears, And apricots in youthful years: So corals look more lovely red, And rubies lately polished: So purest diaper doth shine, Stain'd by the beams of claret wine: As Julia looks when she doth dress Her either cheek with bashfulness.

Kathern pears, _i.e._, Catharine pears.

812. THE MEAN.

Imparity doth ever discord bring; The mean the music makes in everything.

813. HASTE HURTFUL.

Haste is unhappy; what we rashly do Is both unlucky, aye, and foolish, too. Where war with rashness is attempted, there The soldiers leave the field with equal fear.

814. PURGATORY.

Readers, we entreat ye pray For the soul of Lucia; That in little time she be From her purgatory free: In the interim she desires That your tears may cool her fires.

815. THE CLOUD.

Seest thou that cloud that rides in state, Part ruby-like, part candidate? It is no other than the bed Where Venus sleeps half-smothered.

Candidate, robed in white.

817. THE AMBER BEAD.

I saw a fly within a bead Of amber cleanly buried; The urn was little, but the room More rich than Cleopatra's tomb.

818. TO MY DEAREST SISTER, M. MERCY HERRICK.

Whene'er I go, or whatsoe'er befalls Me in mine age, or foreign funerals, This blessing I will leave thee, ere I go: Prosper thy basket and therein thy dough. Feed on the paste of filberts, or else knead And bake the flour of amber for thy bread. Balm may thy trees drop, and thy springs run oil, And everlasting harvest crown thy soil! These I but wish for; but thyself shall see The blessing fall in mellow times on thee.

819. THE TRANSFIGURATION.

Immortal clothing I put on So soon as, Julia, I am gone To mine eternal mansion. Thou, thou art here, to human sight Cloth'd all with incorrupted light; But yet how more admir'dly bright Wilt thou appear, when thou art set In thy refulgent thronelet, That shin'st thus in thy counterfeit!

820. SUFFER THAT THOU CANST NOT SHIFT.

Does fortune rend thee? Bear with thy hard fate: _Virtuous instructions ne'er are delicate_. Say, does she frown? still countermand her threats: _Virtue best loves those children that she beats_.

821. TO THE PASSENGER.

If I lie unburied, sir, These my relics pray inter: 'Tis religion's part to see Stones or turfs to cover me. One word more I had to say: But it skills not; go your way; He that wants a burial room _For a stone, has Heaven his tomb_.

Religion's, orig. ed. _religious_.

823. TO THE KING, UPON HIS TAKING OF LEICESTER.

This day is yours, great Charles! and in this war Your fate, and ours, alike victorious are. In her white stole now Victory does rest _Ensphered with palm on your triumphant crest_. Fortune is now your captive; other Kings _Hold but her hands; you hold both hands and wings_.

824. TO JULIA, IN HER DAWN, OR DAYBREAK.

By the next kindling of the day, My Julia, thou shalt see, Ere Ave-Mary thou canst say I'll come and visit thee.

Yet ere thou counsel'st with thy glass, Appear thou to mine eyes As smooth, and nak'd, as she that was The prime of paradise.

If blush thou must, then blush thou through A lawn, that thou mayst look As purest pearls, or pebbles do When peeping through a brook.

As lilies shrin'd in crystal, so Do thou to me appear; Or damask roses when they grow To sweet acquaintance there.

825. COUNSEL.

'Twas Cæsar's saying: _Kings no less conquerors are By their wise counsel, than they be by war._

826. BAD PRINCES PILL THE PEOPLE.

Like those infernal deities which eat The best of all the sacrificed meat; And leave their servants but the smoke and sweat: So many kings, and primates too there are, Who claim the fat and fleshy for their share And leave their subjects but the starved ware.

827. MOST WORDS, LESS WORKS.

In desp'rate cases all, or most, are known Commanders, few for execution.

828. TO DIANEME.

I could but see thee yesterday Stung by a fretful bee; And I the javelin suck'd away, And heal'd the wound in thee.

A thousand thorns and briars and stings, I have in my poor breast; Yet ne'er can see that salve which brings My passions any rest.

As love shall help me, I admire How thou canst sit, and smile To see me bleed, and not desire To staunch the blood the while.

If thou, compos'd of gentle mould, Art so unkind to me; What dismal stories will be told Of those that cruel be?

Admire, wonder.

830. HIS LOSS.

All has been plundered from me but my wit: Fortune herself can lay no claim to it.

831. DRAW AND DRINK.

Milk still your fountains and your springs: for why? The more th'are drawn, the less they will grow dry.

833. TO OENONE.

Thou say'st Love's dart Hath pricked thy heart; And thou dost languish too: If one poor prick Can make thee sick, Say, what would many do?

836. TO ELECTRA.

Shall I go to Love and tell, Thou art all turned icicle? Shall I say her altars be Disadorn'd and scorn'd by thee? O beware! in time submit; Love has yet no wrathful fit: If her patience turns to ire, Love is then consuming fire.

837. TO MISTRESS AMY POTTER.

Ay me! I love; give him your hand to kiss Who both your wooer and your poet is. Nature has precompos'd us both to love: Your part's to grant; my scene must be to move. Dear, can you like, and liking love your poet? If you say "Aye," blush-guiltiness will show it. Mine eyes must woo you, though I sigh the while: _True love is tongueless as a crocodile_. And you may find in love these different parts-- _Wooers have tongues of ice, but burning hearts_.

838. UPON A MAID.

Here she lies, in bed of spice, Fair as Eve in Paradise: For her beauty it was such Poets could not praise too much. Virgins, come, and in a ring Her supremest requiem sing; Then depart, but see ye tread Lightly, lightly, o'er the dead.

Supremest, last.

839. UPON LOVE.

Love is a circle, and an endless sphere; From good to good, revolving here and there.

840. BEAUTY.

Beauty's no other but a lovely grace Of lively colours flowing from the face.

841. UPON LOVE.

Some salve to every sore we may apply; Only for my wound there's no remedy. Yet if my Julia kiss me, there will be A sovereign balm found out to cure me.

844. TO HIS BOOK.

Make haste away, and let one be A friendly patron unto thee: Lest, rapt from hence, I see thee lie Torn for the use of pastery: Or see thy injur'd leaves serve well, To make loose gowns for mackerel: Or see the grocers in a trice, Make hoods of thee to serve out spice.

845. READINESS.

The readiness of doing doth express No other but the doer's willingness.

846. WRITING.

When words we want, Love teacheth to indite; And what we blush to speak, she bids us write.

847. SOCIETY.

Two things do make society to stand: The first commerce is, and the next command.

848. UPON A MAID.

Gone she is a long, long way, But she has decreed a day Back to come, and make no stay: So we keep, till her return, Here, her ashes, or her urn.

849. SATISFACTION FOR SUFFERINGS.

For all our works a recompense is sure: _'Tis sweet to think on what was hard t' endure_.

850. THE DELAYING BRIDE.

Why so slowly do you move To the centre of your love? On your niceness though we wait, Yet the hours say 'tis late: _Coyness takes us, to a measure; But o'eracted deads the pleasure._ Go to bed, and care not when Cheerful day shall spring again. One brave captain did command, By his word, the sun to stand: One short charm, if you but say, Will enforce the moon to stay, Till you warn her hence, away, T' have your blushes seen by day.

Niceness, delicacy.

851. TO M. HENRY LAWES, THE EXCELLENT COMPOSER OF HIS LYRICS.

Touch but thy lyre, my Harry, and I hear From thee some raptures of the rare Gotiere; Then if thy voice commingle with the string, I hear in thee rare Laniere to sing; Or curious Wilson: tell me, canst thou be Less than Apollo, that usurp'st such three? Three, unto whom the whole world give applause; Yet their three praises

praise but one; that's Lawes.

Gotiere, Wilson, see above, 111. _Laniere_, Nicholas Laniere (1590?-1670?), musician and painter, appointed Master of the King's Music in 1626.

852. AGE UNFIT FOR LOVE.

Maidens tell me I am old; Let me in my glass behold Whether smooth or not I be, Or if hair remains to me. Well, or be't or be't not so, This for certainty I know, Ill it fits old men to play, When that Death bids come away.

853. THE BEDMAN, OR GRAVEMAKER.

Thou hast made many houses for the dead; When my lot calls me to be buried, For love or pity, prithee let there be I' th' churchyard made one tenement for me.

854. TO ANTHEA.

Anthea, I am going hence With some small stock of innocence: But yet those blessed gates I see Withstanding entrance unto me. To pray for me do thou begin, The porter then will let me in.

855. NEED.

Who begs to die for fear of human need, Wisheth his body, not his soul, good speed.

856. TO JULIA.

I am zealless; prithee pray For my welfare, Julia, For I think the gods require Male perfumes, but female fire.

Male perfumes, perfumes of the best kind.

857. ON JULIA'S LIPS.

Sweet are my Julia's lips and clean, As if o'erwashed in Hippocrene.

858. TWILIGHT.

Twilight no other thing is, poets say, Than the last part of night and first of day.

859. TO HIS FRIEND, MR. J. JINCKS.

Love, love me now, because I place Thee here among my righteous race: The bastard slips may droop and die Wanting both root and earth; but thy Immortal self shall boldly trust To live for ever with my Just.

With my Just, cp. 664.

860. ON HIMSELF.

If that my fate has now fulfill'd my year, And so soon stopt my longer living here; What was't, ye gods, a dying man to save, But while he met with his paternal grave! Though while we living 'bout the world do roam, We love to rest in peaceful urns at home, Where we may snug, and close together lie By the dead bones of our dear ancestry.

861. KINGS AND TYRANTS.

'Twixt kings and tyrants there's this difference known: _Kings seek their subjects' good, tyrants their own_.

862. CROSSES.

Our crosses are no other than the rods, And our diseases, vultures of the gods: Each grief we feel, that likewise is a kite Sent forth by them, our flesh to eat, or bite.

863. UPON LOVE.

Love brought me to a silent grove And show'd me there a tree, Where some had hang'd themselves for love, And gave a twist to me.

The halter was of silk and gold, That he reach'd forth unto me; No otherwise than if he would By dainty things undo me.

He bade me then that necklace use; And told me, too, he maketh A glorious end by such a noose, His death for love that taketh.

'Twas but a dream; but had I been There really alone, My desp'rate fears in love had seen Mine execution.

864. NO DIFFERENCE I' TH' DARK.

Night makes no difference 'twixt the priest and clerk; Joan as my lady is as good i' th' dark.

865. THE BODY.

The body is the soul's poor house or home, Whose ribs the laths are, and whose flesh the loam.

866. TO SAPPHO.

Thou say'st thou lov'st me, Sappho; I say no; But would to Love I could believe 'twas so! Pardon my fears, sweet Sappho; I desire That thou be righteous found, and I the liar.

867. OUT OF TIME, OUT OF TUNE.

We blame, nay, we despise her pains That wets her garden when it rains: But when the drought has dried the knot, Then let her use the wat'ring-pot. We pray for showers, at our need, To drench, but not to drown our seed.

Knot, quaintly shaped flower-bed.

868. TO HIS BOOK.

Take mine advice, and go not near Those faces, sour as vinegar. For these, and nobler numbers can Ne'er please the supercilious man.

869. TO HIS HONOURED FRIEND, SIR THOMAS HEALE.

Stand by the magic of my powerful rhymes 'Gainst all the indignation of the times. Age shall not wrong thee; or one jot abate Of thy both great and everlasting fate.

While others perish, here's thy life decreed, Because begot of my immortal seed.

870. THE SACRIFICE, BY WAY OF DISCOURSE BETWIXT HIMSELF AND JULIA.

Herr. Come and let's in solemn wise Both address to sacrifice: Old religion first commands That we wash our hearts, and hands. Is the beast exempt from stain, Altar clean, no fire profane? Are the garlands, is the nard Ready here?

Jul. All well prepar'd, With the wine that must be shed, 'Twixt the horns, upon the head Of the holy beast we bring For our trespass-offering.

Herr. All is well; now next to these Put we on pure surplices; And with chaplets crown'd, we'll roast With perfumes the holocaust: And, while we the gods invoke, Read acceptance by the smoke.

871. TO APOLLO.

Thou mighty lord and master of the lyre, Unshorn Apollo, come and re-inspire My fingers so, the lyric-strings to move, That I may play and sing a hymn to Love.

872. ON LOVE.

Love is a kind of war: hence those who fear! No cowards must his royal ensigns bear.

873. ANOTHER.

Where love begins, there dead thy first desire: _A spark neglected makes a mighty fire_.

874. A HYMN TO CUPID.

Thou, thou that bear'st the sway, With whom the sea-nymphs play; And Venus, every way: When I embrace thy knee, And make short pray'rs to thee, In love then prosper me. This day I go to woo; Instruct me how to do This work thou put'st me to. From shame my face keep free; From scorn I beg of thee, Love, to deliver me: So shall I sing thy praise, And to thee altars raise, Unto the end of days.

875. TO ELECTRA.

Let not thy tombstone e'er be laid by me: Nor let my hearse be wept upon by thee: But let that instant when thou diest be known The minute of mine expiration. One knell be rung for both; and let one grave To hold us two an endless honour have.

876. HOW HIS SOUL CAME ENSNARED.

My soul would one day go and seek For roses, and in Julia's cheek A richesse of those sweets she found, As in another Rosamond. But gathering roses as she was, Not knowing what would come to pass, It chanc'd a ringlet of her hair Caught my poor soul, as in a snare: Which ever since has been in thrall; Yet freedom she enjoys withal.

Richesse, wealth.

877. FACTIONS.

The factions of the great ones call, To side with them, the commons all.

881. UPON JULIA'S HAIR BUNDLED UP IN A GOLDEN NET.

Tell me, what needs those rich deceits, These golden toils, and trammel nets, To take thine hairs when they are known Already tame, and all thine own? 'Tis I am wild, and more than hairs Deserve these meshes and those snares. Set free thy tresses, let them flow As airs do breathe or winds do blow: And let such curious net-works be Less set for them than spread for me.

883. THE SHOWER OF BLOSSOMS.

Love in a shower of blossoms came Down, and half drown'd me with the same: The blooms that fell were white and red; But with such sweets comminglèd, As whether--this I cannot tell-- My sight was pleas'd more, or my smell: But true it was, as I roll'd there, Without a thought of hurt or fear, Love turn'd himself into a bee, And with his javelin wounded me: From which mishap this use I make, _Where most sweets are, there lies a snake: Kisses and favours are sweet things; But those have thorns and these have stings._

885. A DEFENCE FOR WOMEN.

Naught are all women: I say no, Since for one bad, one good I know: For Clytemnestra most unkind, Loving Alcestis there we find: For one Medea that was bad, A good Penelope was had: For wanton Lais, then we have Chaste Lucrece, a wife as grave: And thus through womankind we see A good and bad. Sirs, credit me.

887. SLAVERY.

'Tis liberty to serve one lord; but he Who many serves, serves base servility.

888. CHARMS.

Bring the holy crust of bread, Lay it underneath the head; 'Tis a certain charm to keep Hags away, while children sleep.

889. ANOTHER.

Let the superstitious wife Near the child's heart lay a knife: Point be up, and haft be down (While she gossips in the town); This, 'mongst other mystic charms, Keeps the sleeping child from harms.

890. ANOTHER TO BRING IN THE WITCH.

To house the hag, you must do this: Commix with meal a little piss Of him bewitch'd; then forthwith make A little wafer or a cake; And this rawly bak'd will bring The old hag in. No surer thing.

891. ANOTHER CHARM FOR STABLES.

Hang up hooks and shears to scare Hence the hag that rides the mare, Till they be all over wet With the mire and the sweat: This observ'd, the manes shall be Of your horses all knot-free.

892. CEREMONIES FOR CANDLEMAS EVE.

Down with the rosemary and bays, Down with the mistletoe; Instead of holly, now up-raise The greener box, for show.

The holly hitherto did sway; Let box now domineer Until the dancing Easter day, Or Easter's eve appear.

Then youthful box which now hath grace Your houses to renew; Grown old, surrender must his place Unto the crisped yew.

When yew is out, then birch comes in, And many flowers beside; Both of a fresh and fragrant kin To honour Whitsuntide.

Green rushes, then, and sweetest bents, With cooler oaken boughs, Come in for comely ornaments To re-adorn the house. Thus times do shift; each thing his turn does hold: _New things succeed, as former things grow old_.

Bents, grasses.

893. THE CEREMONIES FOR CANDLEMAS DAY.

Kindle the Christmas brand, and then Till sunset let it burn; Which quench'd, then lay it up again Till Christmas next return. Part must be kept wherewith to teend The Christmas log next year, And where 'tis safely kept, the fiend Can do no mischief there.

894. UPON CANDLEMAS DAY.

End now the white loaf and the pie, And let all sports with Christmas die.

Teend, kindle.

897. TO BIANCA, TO BLESS HIM.

Would I woo, and would I win? Would I well my work begin? Would I evermore be crowned With the end that I propound? Would I frustrate or prevent All aspects malevolent? Thwart all wizards, and with these Dead all black contingencies: Place my words and all works else In most happy parallels? All will prosper, if so be I be kiss'd or bless'd by thee.

898. JULIA'S CHURCHING, OR PURIFICATION.

Put on thy holy filletings, and so To th' temple with the sober midwife go. Attended thus, in a most solemn wise, By those who serve the child-bed mysteries, Burn first thine incense; next, whenas thou see'st The candid stole thrown o'er the pious priest, With reverend curtsies come, and to him bring Thy free (and not decurted) offering. All rites well ended, with fair auspice come (As to the breaking of a bride-cake) home, Where ceremonious Hymen shall for thee Provide a second epithalamy. _She who keeps chastely to her husband's side Is not for one, but every night his bride; And stealing still with love and fear to bed, Brings him not one, but many a maidenhead._

Candid, white. _Decurted_, curtailed.

899. TO HIS BOOK.

Before the press scarce one could see A little-peeping-part of thee; But since thou'rt printed, thou dost call To show thy nakedness to all. My care for thee is now the less, Having resign'd thy shamefac'dness. Go with thy faults and fates; yet stay And take this sentence, then away: Whom one belov'd will not suffice, She'll run to all adulteries.

900. TEARS.

Tears most prevail; with tears, too, thou may'st move Rocks to relent, and coyest maids to love.

901. TO HIS FRIEND TO AVOID CONTENTION OF WORDS.

Words beget anger; anger brings forth blows; Blows make of dearest friends immortal foes. For which prevention, sociate, let there be Betwixt us two no more logomachy. Far better 'twere for either to be mute, Than for to murder friendship by dispute.

Logomachy, contention of words.

902. TRUTH.

Truth is best found out by the time and eyes; _Falsehood wins credit by uncertainties_.

904. THE EYES BEFORE THE EARS.

We credit most our sight; one eye doth please Our trust far more than ten ear-witnesses.

905. WANT.

Want is a softer wax, that takes thereon This, that, and every base impression.

906. TO A FRIEND.

Look in my book, and herein see Life endless signed to thee and me. We o'er the tombs and fates shall fly; While other generations die.

907. UPON M. WILLIAM LAWES, THE RARE MUSICIAN.

Should I not put on blacks, when each one here Comes with his cypress and devotes a tear? Should I not grieve, my Lawes, when every lute, Viol, and voice is by thy loss struck mute? Thy loss, brave man! whose numbers have been hurl'd, And no less prais'd than spread throughout the world. Some have thee call'd Amphion; some of us Nam'd thee Terpander, or sweet Orpheus: Some this, some that, but all in this agree, Music had both her birth and death with thee.

Blacks, mourning garments.

908. A SONG UPON SILVIA.

From me my Silvia ran away, And running therewithal A primrose bank did cross her way, And gave my love a fall.

But trust me now, I dare not say What I by chance did see; But such the drap'ry did betray That fully ravished me.

909. THE HONEYCOMB.

If thou hast found an honeycomb, Eat thou not all, but taste on some: For if thou eat'st it to excess, That sweetness turns to loathsomeness. Taste it to temper, then 'twill be Marrow and manna unto thee.

910. UPON BEN JONSON.

Here lies Jonson with the rest Of the poets: but the best. Reader, would'st thou more have known? Ask his story, not this stone. That will speak what this can't tell Of his glory. So farewell.

911. AN ODE FOR HIM.

Ah Ben! Say how, or when Shall we thy guests Meet at those lyric feasts Made at the Sun, The Dog, the Triple Tun? Where we such clusters had, As made us nobly wild, not mad; And yet each verse of thine Out-did the meat, out-did the frolic wine.

My Ben! Or come again, Or send to us Thy wit's great overplus; But teach us yet Wisely to husband it, Lest we that talent spend: And having once brought to an end That precious stock; the store Of such a wit the world should have no more.

The Sun, _etc._, famous taverns.

912. UPON A VIRGIN.

Spend, harmless shade, thy nightly hours Selecting here both herbs and flowers; Of which make garlands here and there To dress thy silent sepulchre. Nor do thou fear the want of these _In everlasting properties_, Since we fresh strewings will bring hither, Far faster than the first can wither.

913. BLAME.

In battles what disasters fall, The king he bears the blame of all.

914. A REQUEST TO THE GRACES.

Ponder my words, if so that any be Known guilty here of incivility: Let what is graceless, discompos'd, and rude, With sweetness, smoothness, softness, be endu'd. Teach it to blush, to curtsy, lisp, and show Demure, but yet full of temptation, too. _Numbers ne'er tickle, or but lightly please, Unless they have some wanton carriages._ This if ye do, each piece will here be good, And graceful made by your neat sisterhood.

915. UPON HIMSELF.

I lately fri'd, but now behold I freeze as fast, and shake for cold. And in good faith I'd thought it strange T' have found in me this sudden change; But that I understood by dreams These only were but Love's extremes; Who fires with hope the lover's heart, And starves with cold the self-same part.

916. MULTITUDE.

We trust not to the multitude in war, But to the stout, and those that skilful are.

917. FEAR.

Man must do well out of a good intent; Not for the servile fear of punishment.

918. TO M. KELLAM.

What! can my Kellam drink his sack In goblets to the brim, And see his Robin Herrick lack, Yet send no bowls to him?

For love or pity to his muse, That she may flow in verse, Contemn to recommend a cruse, But send to her a tierce.

919. HAPPINESS TO HOSPITALITY; OR, A HEARTY WISH TO GOOD HOUSEKEEPING.

First, may the hand of bounty bring Into the daily offering Of full provision such a store, Till that the cook cries: Bring no more. Upon your hogsheads never fall A drought of wine, ale, beer, at all; But, like full clouds, may they from thence Diffuse their mighty influence. Next, let the lord and lady here Enjoy a Christ'ning year by year; And this good blessing back them still, T' have boys, and girls too, as they will. Then from the porch may many a bride Unto the holy temple ride: And thence return, short prayers said, A wife most richly married. Last, may the bride and bridegroom be Untouch'd by cold sterility; But in their springing blood so play, As that in lusters few they may, By laughing too, and lying down, People a city or a town.

Wish, om. orig. ed. _Lusters_, quinquenniums.

920. CUNCTATION IN CORRECTION.

The lictors bundled up their rods; beside, Knit them with knots with much ado unti'd, That if, unknitting, men would yet repent, They might escape the lash of punishment.

921. PRESENT GOVERNMENT GRIEVOUS.

Men are suspicious, prone to discontent: Subjects still loathe the present government.

922. REST REFRESHES.

Lay by the good a while; a resting field Will, after ease, a richer harvest yield; Trees this year bear: next, they their wealth withhold: _Continual reaping makes a land wax old_.

923. REVENGE.

Man's disposition is for to requite An injury, before a benefit: Thanksgiving is a burden and a pain; Revenge is pleasing to us, as our gain.

924. THE FIRST MARS OR MAKES.

In all our high designments 'twill appear, _The first event breeds confidence or fear_.

925. BEGINNING DIFFICULT.

Hard are the two first stairs unto a crown: Which got, the third bids him a king come down.

926. FAITH FOUR-SQUARE.

Faith is a thing that's four-square; let it fall This way or that, it not declines at all.

927. THE PRESENT TIME BEST PLEASETH.

Praise they that will times past; I joy to see Myself now live: _this age best pleaseth me_.

928. CLOTHES ARE CONSPIRATORS.

Though from without no foes at all we fear, We shall be wounded by the clothes we wear.

929. CRUELTY.

'Tis but a dog-like madness in bad kings, For to delight in wounds and murderings: As some plants prosper best by cuts and blows, So kings by killing do increase their foes.

930. FAIR AFTER FOUL.

Tears quickly dry, griefs will in time decay: A clear will come after a cloudy day.

931. HUNGER.

Ask me what hunger is, and I'll reply, 'Tis but a fierce desire of hot and dry.

932. BAD WAGES FOR GOOD SERVICE.

In this misfortune kings do most excel, To hear the worst from men when they do well.

933. THE END.

Conquer we shall, but we must first contend; _'Tis not the fight that crowns us, but the end_.

934. THE BONDMAN.

Bind me but to thee with thine hair, And quickly I shall be Made by that fetter or that snare A bondman unto thee. Or if thou tak'st that bond away, Then bore me through the ear, And by the law I ought to stay For ever with thee here.

935. CHOOSE FOR THE BEST.

Give house-room to the best; _'tis never known Virtue and pleasure both to dwell in one_.

936. TO SILVIA.

Pardon my trespass, Silvia; I confess My kiss out-went the bounds of shamefastness: None is discreet at all times; no, _not Jove Himself, at one time, can

be wise and love_.

937. FAIR SHOWS DECEIVE.

Smooth was the sea, and seem'd to call Two pretty girls to play withal: Who paddling there, the sea soon frown'd, And on a sudden both were drown'd. What credit can we give to seas, Who, kissing, kill such saints as these?

938. HIS WISH.

Fat be my hind; unlearned be my wife; Peaceful my night; my day devoid of strife: To these a comely offspring I desire, Singing about my everlasting fire.

Hind, country servant.

939. UPON JULIA WASHING HERSELF IN THE RIVER.

How fierce was I, when I did see My Julia wash herself in thee! So lilies thorough crystal look: So purest pebbles in the brook: As in the river Julia did, Half with a lawn of water hid. Into thy streams myself I threw, And struggling there, I kiss'd thee too; And more had done, it is confess'd, Had not thy waves forbade the rest.

940. A MEAN IN OUR MEANS.

Though frankincense the deities require, _We must not give all to the hallowed fire_. Such be our gifts, and such be our expense, As for ourselves to leave some frankincense.

941. UPON CLUNN.

A roll of parchment Clunn about him bears, Charg'd with the arms of all his ancestors: And seems half ravish'd, when he looks upon That bar, this bend; that fess, this cheveron; This manch, that moon; this martlet, and that mound; This counterchange of pearl and diamond. What joy can Clunn have in that coat, or this, Whenas his own still out at elbows is?

942. UPON CUPID.

Love, like a beggar, came to me With hose and doublet torn: His shirt bedangling from his knee, With hat and shoes outworn.

He ask'd an alms; I gave him bread, And meat too, for his need: Of which, when he had fully fed, He wished me all good speed.

Away he went, but as he turn'd (In faith I know not how) He touch'd me so, as that I burn['d], And am tormented now.

Love's silent flames and fires obscure Then crept into my heart; And though I saw no bow, I'm sure His finger was the dart.

946. AN HYMN TO LOVE.

I will confess With cheerfulness, Love is a thing so likes me, That let her lay On me all day, I'll kiss the hand that strikes me.

I will not, I, Now blubb'ring, cry, It, ah! too late repents me, That I did fall To love at all, Since love so much contents me.

No, no, I'll be In fetters free: While others they sit wringing Their hands for pain, I'll entertain The wounds of love with singing.

With flowers and wine, And cakes divine, To strike me I will tempt thee: Which done; no more I'll come before Thee and thine altars empty.

947. TO HIS HONOURED AND MOST INGENIOUS FRIEND, MR. CHARLES COTTON.

For brave comportment, wit without offence, Words fully flowing, yet of influence: Thou art that man of men, the man alone, Worthy the public admiration: Who with thine own eyes read'st what we do write, And giv'st our numbers euphony and weight; Tell'st when a verse springs high, how understood To be, or not, born of the royal blood. What state above, what symmetry below, Lines have, or should have, thou the best can'st show. For which, my Charles, it is my pride to be Not so much known, as to be lov'd of thee. Long may I live so, and my wreath of bays Be less another's laurel than thy praise.

948. WOMEN USELESS.

What need we marry women, when Without their use we may have men, And such as will in short time be For murder fit, or mutiny? As Cadmus once a new way found, By throwing teeth into the ground; From which poor seed, and rudely sown, Sprung up a war-like nation: So let us iron, silver, gold, Brass, lead, or tin throw into th' mould; And we shall see in little space Rise up of men a fighting race. If this can be, say then, what need Have we of women or their seed?

949. LOVE IS A SYRUP.

Love is a syrup; and whoe'er we see Sick and surcharg'd with this satiety, Shall by this pleasing trespass quickly prove _There's loathsomeness e'en in the sweets of love_.

950. LEAVEN.

Love is a leaven; and a loving kiss The leaven of a loving sweetheart is.

951. REPLETION.

Physicians say repletion springs More from the sweet than sour things.

952. ON HIMSELF.

Weep for the dead, for they have lost this light: And weep for me, lost in an endless night. Or mourn, or make a marble verse for me, Who writ for many. Benedicite.

953. NO MAN WITHOUT MONEY.

No man such rare parts hath that he can swim, If favour or occasion help not him.

954. ON HIMSELF.

Lost to the world; lost to myself; alone Here now I rest under this marble stone: In depth of silence, heard and seen of none.

955. TO M. LEONARD WILLAN, HIS PECULIAR FRIEND.

I will be short, and having quickly hurl'd This line about, live thou throughout the world; Who art a man for all scenes; unto whom, What's hard to others, nothing's troublesome. Can'st write the comic, tragic strain, and fall From these to pen the pleasing pastoral: Who fli'st at all heights: prose and verse run'st through; Find'st here a fault, and mend'st the trespass too: For which I might extol thee, but speak less, Because thyself art coming to the press: And then should I in praising thee be slow, Posterity will pay thee what I owe.

956. TO HIS WORTHY FRIEND, M. JOHN HALL, STUDENT OF GRAY'S INN.

Tell me, young man, or did the Muses bring Thee less to taste than to drink up their spring, That none hereafter should be thought, or be A poet, or a poet-like but thee? What was thy birth, thy star that makes thee known, At twice ten years, a prime and public one? Tell us thy nation, kindred, or the whence Thou had'st and hast thy mighty influence, That makes thee lov'd, and of the men desir'd, And no less prais'd than of the maids admired. Put on thy laurel then; and in that trim Be thou Apollo or the type of him: Or let the unshorn god lend thee his lyre, And next to him be master of the choir.

957. TO JULIA.

Offer thy gift; but first the law commands Thee, Julia, first, to sanctify thy hands: Do that, my Julia, which the rites require, Then boldly give thine incense to the fire.

958. TO THE MOST COMELY AND PROPER M. ELIZABETH FINCH.

Handsome you are, and proper you will be Despite of all your infortunity: Live long and lovely, but yet grow no less In that your own prefixed comeliness: Spend on that stock: and when your life must fall, Leave others beauty to set up withal.

Proper, well-made.

960. TO HIS BOOK.

If hap it must, that I must see thee lie Absyrtus-like, all torn confusedly: With solemn tears, and with much grief of heart, I'll recollect thee, weeping, part by part; And having wash'd thee, close thee in a chest With spice; that done, I'll leave thee to thy rest.

Absyrtus-like, the brother of Medea, cut in pieces by her that his father might be delayed by gathering his limbs.

961. TO THE KING, UPON HIS WELCOME TO HAMPTON COURT. SET AND SUNG.

Welcome, great Cæsar, welcome now you are As dearest peace after destructive war: Welcome as slumbers, or as beds of ease After our long and peevish sicknesses. O pomp of glory! Welcome now, and come To repossess once more your long'd-for

home. A thousand altars smoke: a thousand thighs Of beeves here ready stand for sacrifice. Enter and prosper; while our eyes do wait For an ascendent throughly auspicate: Under which sign we may the former stone Lay of our safety's new foundation: That done, O Cæsar! live and be to us Our fate, our fortune, and our genius; To whose free knees we may our temples tie As to a still protecting deity: That should you stir, we and our altars too May, great Augustus, go along with you. _Chor._ Long live the King! and to accomplish this, We'll from our own add far more years to his.

Ascendent, the most influential position of a planet in astrology. _Auspicate_, propitious.

962. ULTIMUS HEROUM: OR, TO THE MOST LEARNED, AND TO THE RIGHT HONOURABLE, HENRY, MARQUIS OF DORCHESTER.

And as time past when Cato the severe Enter'd the circumspacious theatre, In reverence of his person everyone Stood as he had been turn'd from flesh to stone; E'en so my numbers will astonished be If but looked on; struck dead, if scann'd by thee.

963. TO HIS MUSE; ANOTHER TO THE SAME.

Tell that brave man, fain thou would'st have access To kiss his hands, but that for fearfulness; Or else because th'art like a modest bride, Ready to blush to death, should he but chide.

966. TO HIS LEARNED FRIEND, M. JO. HARMAR, PHYSICIAN TO THE COLLEGE OF WESTMINSTER.

When first I find those numbers thou dost write, To be most soft, terse, sweet, and perpolite: Next, when I see thee tow'ring in the sky, In an expansion no less large than high; Then, in that compass, sailing here and there, And with circumgyration everywhere; Following with love and active heat thy game, And then at last to truss the epigram; I must confess, distinction none I see Between Domitian's Martial then, and thee. But this I know, should Jupiter again Descend from heaven to reconverse with men; The Roman language full, and superfine, If Jove would speak, he would accept of thine.

Perpolite, well polished.

967. UPON HIS SPANIEL TRACY.

Now thou art dead, no eye shall ever see, For shape and service, spaniel like to thee. This shall my love do, give thy sad death one Tear, that deserves of me a million.

968. THE DELUGE.

Drowning, drowning, I espy Coming from my Julia's eye: 'Tis some solace in our smart, To have friends to bear a part: I have none; but must be sure Th' inundation to endure. Shall not times hereafter tell This for no mean miracle? When the waters by their fall Threaten'd ruin unto all, Yet the deluge here was known Of a world to drown but one.

971. STRENGTH TO SUPPORT SOVEREIGNTY.

Let kings and rulers learn this line from me: _Where power is weak, unsafe is majesty_.

973. CRUTCHES.

Thou see'st me, Lucia, this year droop; Three zodiacs filled more, I shall stoop; Let crutches then provided be To shore up my debility. Then, while thou laugh'st, I'll sighing cry, "A ruin, underpropp'd, am I". Don will I then my beadsman's gown, And when so feeble I am grown, As my weak shoulders cannot bear The burden of a grasshopper, Yet with the bench of aged sires, When I and they keep termly fires, With my weak voice I'll sing, or say, Some odes I made of Lucia: Then will I heave my wither'd hand To Jove the mighty, for to stand Thy faithful friend, and to pour down Upon thee many a benison.

Zodiacs, used as symbols of the astronomical year. _Beadsman's_, almshouseman's.

974. TO JULIA.

Holy waters hither bring For the sacred sprinkling: Baptise me and thee, and so Let us to the altar go, And, ere we our rites commence, Wash our hands in innocence. Then I'll be the Rex Sacrorum, Thou the Queen of Peace and Quorum.

Quorum, _i.e._, quorum of justices of the peace, sportively added for the rhyme's sake.

975. UPON CASE.

Case is a lawyer, that ne'er pleads alone, But when he hears the like confusion, As when the disagreeing Commons throw About their House, their clamorous Aye or No: Then Case, as loud as any serjeant there, Cries out: My lord, my lord, the case is clear. But when all's hush'd, Case, than a fish more mute, Bestirs his hand, but starves in hand the suit.

976. TO PERENNA.

I a dirge will pen to thee; Thou a trentall make for me: That the monks and friars together, Here may sing the rest of either: Next, I'm sure, the nuns will have Candlemas to grace the grave.

Trentall, services for the dead.

977. TO HIS SISTER-IN-LAW, M. SUSANNA HERRICK.

The person crowns the place; your lot doth fall Last, yet to be with these a principal. Howe'er it fortuned; know for truth, I meant You a fore-leader in this testament.

978. UPON THE LADY CREW.

This stone can tell the story of my life, What was my birth, to whom I was a wife: In teeming years, how soon my sun was set. Where now I rest, these may be known by jet. For other things, my many children be The best and truest chronicles of me.

979. ON TOMASIN PARSONS.

Grow up in beauty, as thou dost begin, And be of all admired, Tomasin.

980. CEREMONY UPON CANDLEMAS EVE.

Down with the rosemary, and so Down with the bays and mistletoe; Down with the holly, ivy, all, Wherewith ye dressed the Christmas Hall: That so the superstitious find No one least branch there left behind: For look, how many leaves there be Neglected, there (maids, trust to me) So many goblins you shall see.

981. SUSPICION MAKES SECURE.

He that will live of all cares dispossess'd, Must shun the bad, aye, and suspect the best.

983. TO HIS KINSMAN, M. THO. HERRICK, WHO DESIRED TO BE IN HIS BOOK.

Welcome to this my college, and though late Thou'st got a place here (standing candidate) It matters not, since thou art chosen one Here of my great and good foundation.

984. A BUCOLIC BETWIXT TWO: LACON AND THYRSIS.

Lacon. For a kiss or two, confess, What doth cause this pensiveness, Thou most lovely neat-herdess? Why so lonely on the hill? Why thy pipe by thee so still, That erewhile was heard so shrill? Tell me, do thy kine now fail To full fill the milking-pail? Say, what is't that thou dost ail?

Thyr. None of these; but out, alas! A mischance is come to pass, And I'll tell thee what it was: See, mine eyes are weeping-ripe.

Lacon. Tell, and I'll lay down my pipe.

Thyr. I have lost my lovely steer, That to me was far more dear Than these kine which I milk here: Broad of forehead, large of eye, Party-colour'd like a pie; Smooth in each limb as a die; Clear of hoof, and clear of horn: Sharply pointed as a thorn, With a neck by yoke unworn; From the which hung down by strings, Balls of cowslips, daisy rings, Interplac'd with ribbonings: Faultless every way for shape; Not a straw could him escape; Ever gamesome as an ape, But yet harmless as a sheep. Pardon, Lacon, if I weep; _Tears will spring where woes are deep_. Now, ay me! ay me! Last night Came a mad dog and did bite, Aye, and kill'd my dear delight.

Lacon. Alack, for grief!

Thyr. But I'll be brief. Hence I must, for time doth call Me, and my sad playmates all, To his ev'ning funeral. Live long, Lacon, so adieu!

Lacon. Mournful maid, farewell to you; _Earth afford ye flowers to strew_.

Pie, _i.e._, a magpie.

985. UPON SAPPHO.

Look upon Sappho's lip, and you will swear There is a love-like leaven rising there.

988. A BACCHANALIAN VERSE.

Drink up Your cup, But not spill wine; For if you Do, 'Tis an ill sign;

That we Foresee You are cloy'd here, If so, no Ho, But avoid here.

989. CARE A GOOD KEEPER.

Care keeps the conquest; 'tis no less renown To keep a city than to win a town.

990. RULES FOR OUR REACH.

Men must have bounds how far to walk; for we Are made far worse by lawless liberty.

991. TO BIANCA.

Ah, Bianca! now I see It is noon and past with me: In a while it will strike one; Then, Bianca, I am gone. Some effusions let me have Offer'd on my holy grave; Then, Bianca, let me rest With my face towards the East.

992. TO THE HANDSOME MISTRESS GRACE POTTER.

As is your name, so is your comely face Touch'd everywhere with such diffused grace, As that in all that admirable round There is not one least solecism found; And as that part, so every portion else Keeps line for line with beauty's parallels.

993. ANACREONTIC.

I must Not trust Here to any; Bereav'd, Deceiv'd By so many: As one Undone By my losses; Comply Will I With my crosses; Yet still I will Not be grieving, Since thence And hence Comes relieving. But this Sweet is In our mourning; Times bad And sad Are a-turning: And he Whom we See dejected, Next day We may See erected.

994. MORE MODEST, MORE MANLY.

'Tis still observ'd those men most valiant are, That are most modest ere they come to war.

995. NOT TO COVET MUCH WHERE LITTLE IS THE CHARGE.

Why should we covet much, whenas we know W'ave more to bear our charge than way to go?

996. ANACREONTIC VERSE.

Brisk methinks I am, and fine When I drink my cap'ring wine: Then to love I do incline, When I drink my wanton wine: And I wish all maidens mine, When I drink my sprightly wine: Well I sup and well I dine, When I drink my frolic wine; But I languish, lower, and pine, When I want my fragrant wine.

998. PATIENCE IN PRINCES.

Kings must not use the axe for each offence: Princes cure some faults by their patience.

999. FEAR GETS FORCE.

Despair takes heart, when there's no hope to speed: The coward then takes arms and does the deed.

1000. PARCEL-GILT POETRY.

Let's strive to be the best; the gods, we know it, Pillars and men, hate an indifferent poet.

1001. UPON LOVE, BY WAY OF QUESTION AND ANSWER.

I bring ye love: _Quest._ What will love do? _Ans._ Like and dislike ye. I bring ye love: _Quest._ What will love do? _Ans._ Stroke ye to strike ye. I bring ye love: _Quest._ What will love do? _Ans._ Love will befool ye. I bring ye love: _Quest._ What will love do? Ans. Heat ye to cool ye. I bring ye love: _Quest._ What will love do? _Ans._ Love gifts will send ye. I bring ye love: _Quest._ What will love do? _Ans._ Stock ye to spend ye. I bring ye love: _Quest._ What will love do? _Ans._ Love will fulfil ye. I bring ye love: _Quest._ What will love do? _Ans._ Kiss ye to kill ye.

1002. TO THE LORD HOPTON, ON HIS FIGHT IN CORNWALL.

Go on, brave Hopton, to effectuate that Which we, and times to come, shall wonder at. Lift up thy sword; next, suffer it to fall, And by that one blow set an end to all.

1003. HIS GRANGE.

How well contented in this private grange Spend I my life, that's subject unto change: Under whose roof with moss-work wrought, there I Kiss my brown wife and black posterity.

Grange, a farmstead.

1004. LEPROSY IN HOUSES.

When to a house I come, and see The Genius wasteful, more than free: The servants thumbless, yet to eat With lawless tooth the flour of wheat: The sons to suck the milk of kine, More than the teats of discipline: The daughters wild and loose in dress, Their cheeks unstained with shamefac'dness: The husband drunk, the wife to be A bawd to incivility; I must confess, I there descry, A house spread through with leprosy.

Thumbless, lazy: cp. painful thumb, _supra_.

1005. GOOD MANNERS AT MEAT.

This rule of manners I will teach my guests: To come with their own bellies unto feasts; Not to eat equal portions, but to rise Farced with the food that may themselves suffice.

Farced, stuffed.

1006. ANTHEA'S RETRACTATION.

Anthea laugh'd, and fearing lest excess Might stretch the cords of civil comeliness, She with a dainty blush rebuk'd her face, And call'd each line back to his rule and space.

1007. COMFORTS IN CROSSES.

Be not dismayed though crosses cast thee down; Thy fall is but the rising to a crown.

1008. SEEK AND FIND.

Attempt the end, and never stand to doubt; Nothing's so hard but search will find it out.

1009. REST.

On with thy work, though thou be'st hardly press'd: _Labour is held up by the hope of rest_.

1010. LEPROSY IN CLOTHES.

When flowing garments I behold Inspir'd with purple, pearl and gold, I think no other, but I see In them a glorious leprosy That does infect and make the rent More mortal in the vestiment. _As flowery vestures do descry The wearer's rich immodesty: So plain and simple clothes do show Where virtue walks, not those that flow._

1012. GREAT MALADIES, LONG MEDICINES.

To an old sore a long cure must go on: Great faults require great satisfaction.

1013. HIS ANSWER TO A FRIEND.

You ask me what I do, and how I live? And, noble friend, this answer I must give: Drooping, I draw on to the vaults of death, O'er which you'll walk, when I am laid beneath.

1014. THE BEGGAR.

Shall I a daily beggar be, For love's sake asking alms of thee? Still shall I crave, and never get A hope of my desired bit? Ah, cruel maids! I'll go my way, Whereas, perchance, my fortunes may Find out a threshold or a door That may far sooner speed the poor: Where thrice we knock, and none will hear, Cold comfort still I'm sure lives there.

1015. BASTARDS.

Our bastard children are but like to plate Made by the coiners--illegitimate.

1016. HIS CHANGE.

My many cares and much distress Has made me like a wilderness; Or, discompos'd, I'm like a rude And all confused multitude: Out of my comely manners worn, And, as in means, in mind all torn.

1017. THE VISION.

Methought I saw, as I did dream in bed, A crawling vine about Anacreon's head. Flushed was his face; his hairs with oil did shine; And, as he spake, his mouth ran o'er with wine. Tippled he was, and tippling lisped withal; And lisping reeled, and reeling like to fall. A young enchantress close by him did stand, Tapping his plump thighs

with a myrtle wand: She smil'd; he kiss'd; and kissing, cull'd her too, And being cup-shot, more he could not do. For which, methought, in pretty anger she Snatched off his crown, and gave the wreath to me; Since when, methinks, my brains about do swim, And I am wild and wanton like to him.

Cull'd, embraced. _Cup-shot_, drunk.

1018. A VOW TO VENUS.

Happily I had a sight Of my dearest dear last night; Make her this day smile on me, And I'll roses give to thee.

1019. ON HIS BOOK.

The bound, almost, now of my book I see, But yet no end of these therein, or me: Here we begin new life, while thousands quite Are lost, and theirs, in everlasting night.

1020. A SONNET OF PERILLA.

Then did I live when I did see Perilla smile on none but me. But, ah! by stars malignant crossed, The life I got I quickly lost; But yet a way there doth remain For me embalm'd to live again, And that's to love me; in which state I'll live as one regenerate.

1021. BAD MAY BE BETTER.

Man may at first transgress, but next do well: _Vice doth in some but lodge a while, not dwell_.

1022. POSTING TO PRINTING.

Let others to the printing press run fast; Since after death comes glory, I'll not haste.

1023. RAPINE BRINGS RUIN.

What's got by justice is established sure: _No kingdoms got by rapine long endure_.

1024. COMFORT TO A YOUTH THAT HAD LOST HIS LOVE.

What needs complaints, When she a place Has with the race Of saints? In endless mirth, She thinks not on What's said or done In earth. She sees no tears, Or any tone Of thy deep groan She hears: Nor does she mind, Or think on't now, That ever thou Wast kind; But chang'd above, She likes not there. As she did here, Thy love. Forbear, therefore, And lull asleep Thy woes, and weep No more.

1026. SAINT DISTAFF'S DAY, OR THE MORROW AFTER TWELFTH DAY.

Partly work and partly play Ye must on S. Distaff's day: From the plough soon free your team, Then come home and fodder them. If the maids a-spinning go, Burn the flax and fire the tow; Scorch their plackets, but beware That ye singe no maidenhair. Bring in pails of water, then, Let the maids bewash the men. Give S. Distaff all the right, Then bid Christmas sport good-night; And next morrow everyone To his own

vocation.

Plackets, petticoats.

1027. SUFFERANCE.

In the hope of ease to come, Let's endure one martyrdom.

1028. HIS TEARS TO THAMESIS.

I send, I send here my supremest kiss To thee, my silver-footed Thamesis. No more shall I reiterate thy Strand, Whereon so many stately structures stand: Nor in the summer's sweeter evenings go To bathe in thee, as thousand others do; No more shall I along thy crystal glide In barge with boughs and rushes beautifi'd, With soft-smooth virgins for our chaste disport, To Richmond, Kingston, and to Hampton Court. Never again shall I with finny oar Put from, or draw unto the faithful shore: And landing here, or safely landing there, Make way to my beloved Westminster, Or to the golden Cheapside, where the earth Of Julia Herrick gave to me my birth. May all clean nymphs and curious water-dames With swan-like state float up and down thy streams: No drought upon thy wanton waters fall To make them lean and languishing at all. No ruffling winds come hither to disease Thy pure and silver-wristed Naiades. Keep up your state, ye streams; and as ye spring, Never make sick your banks by surfeiting. Grow young with tides, and though I see ye never, Receive this vow, so fare ye well for ever.

Reiterate, retread.

1029. PARDONS.

Those ends in war the best contentment bring, _Whose peace is made up with a pardoning_.

1030. PEACE NOT PERMANENT.

Great cities seldom rest; if there be none T' invade from far, they'll find worse foes at home.

1031. TRUTH AND ERROR.

'Twixt truth and error there's this difference known; Error is fruitful, truth is only one.

1032. THINGS MORTAL STILL MUTABLE.

Things are uncertain, and the more we get, The more on icy pavements we are set.

1033. STUDIES TO BE SUPPORTED.

Studies themselves will languish and decay, When either price or praise is ta'en away.

1034. WIT PUNISHED, PROSPERS MOST.

Dread not the shackles: on with thine intent; _Good wits get more fame by their punishment_.

1035. TWELFTH NIGHT: OR, KING AND QUEEN.

Now, now the mirth comes With the cake full of plums, Where bean's the king of the sport here; Beside we must know, The pea also Must revel, as queen, in the court here.

Begin then to choose, This night as ye use, Who shall for the present delight here, Be a king by the lot, And who shall not Be Twelfth-day queen for the night here.

Which known, let us make Joy-sops with the cake; And let not a man then be seen here, Who unurg'd will not drink To the base from the brink A health to the king and the queen here.

Next crown the bowl full With gentle lamb's wool: Add sugar, nutmeg, and ginger, With store of ale too; And thus ye must do To make the wassail a swinger.

Give then to the king And queen wassailing: And though with ale ye be whet here, Yet part ye from hence, As free from offence As when ye innocent met here.

1036. HIS DESIRE.

Give me a man that is not dull When all the world with rifts is full; But unamaz'd dares clearly sing, Whenas the roof's a-tottering: And, though it falls, continues still Tickling the cittern with his quill.

Cittern, a kind of lute; _quill_, the plectrum for striking it.

1037. CAUTION IN COUNSEL.

Know when to speak; for many times it brings Danger to give the best advice to kings.

1038. MODERATION.

Let moderation on thy passions wait; Who loves too much, too much the lov'd will hate.

1039. ADVICE THE BEST ACTOR.

Still take advice; though counsels, when they fly At random, sometimes hit most happily.

1040. CONFORMITY IS COMELY.

Conformity gives comeliness to things: And equal shares exclude all murmurings.

1041. LAWS.

Who violates the customs, hurts the health, Not of one man, but all the commonwealth.

1042. THE MEAN.

'Tis much among the filthy to be clean; _Our heat of youth can hardly keep the mean_.

1043. LIKE LOVES HIS LIKE.

Like will to like, each creature loves his kind; Chaste words proceed still from a bashful mind.

1044. HIS HOPE OR SHEET ANCHOR.

Among these tempests great and manifold My ship has here one only anchor-hold; That is my hope, which if that slip, I'm one Wildered in this vast wat'ry region.

1045. COMFORT IN CALAMITY.

'Tis no discomfort in the world to fall, When the great crack not crushes one, but all.

1046. TWILIGHT.

The twilight is no other thing, we say, Than night now gone, and yet not sprung the day.

1047. FALSE MOURNING.

He who wears blacks, and mourns not for the dead, Does but deride the party buried.

Blacks, mourning garments.

1048. THE WILL MAKES THE WORK; OR, CONSENT MAKES THE CURE.

No grief is grown so desperate, but the ill Is half way cured if the party will.

1049. DIET.

If wholesome diet can recure a man, What need of physic or physician?

1050. SMART.

Stripes, justly given, yerk us with their fall; But causeless whipping smarts the most of all.

1051. THE TINKER'S SONG.

Along, come along, Let's meet in a throng Here of tinkers; And quaff up a bowl As big as a cowl To beer drinkers. The pole of the hop Place in the aleshop To bethwack us, If ever we think So much as to drink Unto Bacchus. Who frolic will be For little cost, he Must not vary From beer-broth at all, So much as to call For Canary.

1052. HIS COMFORT.

The only comfort of my life Is, that I never yet had wife; Nor will hereafter; since I know Who weds, o'er-buys his weal with woe

1053. SINCERITY.

Wash clean the vessel, lest ye sour Whatever liquor in ye pour.

1054. TO ANTHEA.

Sick is Anthea, sickly is the spring, The primrose sick, and sickly everything; The while my dear Anthea does but droop, The tulips, lilies, daffodils do stoop: But when

again she's got her healthful hour, Each bending then will rise a proper flower.

1055. NOR BUYING OR SELLING.

Now, if you love me, tell me, For as I will not sell ye, So not one cross to buy thee I'll give, if thou deny me.

Cross, a coin.

1056. TO HIS PECULIAR FRIEND, M. JO. WICKS.

Since shed or cottage I have none, I sing the more, that thou hast one To whose glad threshold, and free door, I may a poet come, though poor, And eat with thee a savoury bit, Paying but common thanks for it. Yet should I chance, my Wicks, to see An over-leaven look in thee, To sour the bread, and turn the beer To an exalted vinegar: Or should'st thou prize me as a dish Of thrice-boiled worts, or third-day's fish; I'd rather hungry go and come, Than to thy house be burdensome; Yet, in my depth of grief, I'd be One that should drop his beads for thee.

Worts, cabbages. _Drop his beads_, _i.e._, pray.

1057. THE MORE MIGHTY, THE MORE MERCIFUL.

Who may do most, does least: the bravest will Show mercy there, where they have power to kill.

1058. AFTER AUTUMN, WINTER.

Die ere long, I'm sure, I shall; After leaves, the tree must fall.

1059. A GOOD DEATH.

For truth I may this sentence tell, _No man dies ill, that liveth well_.

1060. RECOMPENSE.

Who plants an olive, but to eat the oil? _Reward, we know, is the chief end of toil_.

1061. ON FORTUNE.

This is my comfort when she's most unkind: She can but spoil me of my means, not mind.

1062. TO SIR GEORGE PARRY, DOCTOR OF THE CIVIL LAW.

I have my laurel chaplet on my head If, 'mongst these many numbers to be read, But one by you be hugg'd and cherished.

Peruse my measures thoroughly, and where Your judgment finds a guilty poem, there Be you a judge; but not a judge severe.

The mean pass by, or over, none contemn; The good applaud; the peccant less condemn, Since absolution you can give to them.

Stand forth, brave man, here to the public sight; And in my book now claim a twofold right: The first as doctor, and the last as knight.

1063. CHARMS.

This I'll tell ye by the way: Maidens, when ye leavens lay, Cross your dough, and your dispatch Will be better for your batch.

1064. ANOTHER.

In the morning when ye rise, Wash your hands and cleanse your eyes. Next be sure ye have a care To disperse the water far; For as far as that doth light, So far keeps the evil sprite.

1065. ANOTHER.

If ye fear to be affrighted When ye are by chance benighted, In your pocket for a trust Carry nothing but a crust: For that holy piece of bread Charms the danger and the dread.

1067. GENTLENESS.

That prince must govern with a gentle hand Who will have love comply with his command.

1068. A DIALOGUE BETWEEN HIMSELF AND MISTRESS ELIZA WHEELER, UNDER THE NAME OF AMARYLLIS.

Her. My dearest love, since thou wilt go, And leave me here behind thee, For love or pity let me know The place where I may find thee.

Ama. In country meadows pearl'd with dew, And set about with lilies, There, filling maunds with cowslips, you May find your Amaryllis.

Her. What have the meads to do with thee, Or with thy youthful hours? Live thou at Court, where thou mayst be The queen of men, not flowers.

Let country wenches make 'em fine With posies, since 'tis fitter For thee with richest gems to shine, And like the stars to glitter.

Ama. You set too high a rate upon A shepherdess so homely. _Her._ Believe it, dearest, there's not one I' th' Court that's half so comely.

I prithee stay. _Ama._ I must away; Let's kiss first, then we'll sever. _Ambo._ And though we bid adieu to-day, We shall not part for ever.

Maunds, baskets.

1069. TO JULIA.

Help me, Julia, for to pray, Matins sing, or matins say: This, I know, the fiend will fly Far away, if thou be'st by. Bring the holy water hither, Let us wash and pray together; When our beads are thus united, Then the foe will fly affrighted.

Beads, prayers.

1070. TO ROSES IN JULIA'S BOSOM.

Roses, you can never die, Since the place wherein ye lie, Heat and moisture mix'd are so As to make ye ever grow.

1071. TO THE HONOURED MASTER ENDYMION PORTER.

When to thy porch I come and ravish'd see The state of poets there attending thee, Those bards and I, all in a chorus sing: We are thy prophets, Porter, thou our king.

1072. SPEAK IN SEASON.

When times are troubled, then forbear; but speak When a clear day out of a cloud does break.

1073. OBEDIENCE.

The power of princes rests in the consent Of only those who are obedient: Which if away, proud sceptres then will lie Low, and of thrones the ancient majesty.

1074. ANOTHER OF THE SAME.

No man so well a kingdom rules as he Who hath himself obeyed the sovereignty.

1075. OF LOVE.

1. Instruct me now what love will do. 2. 'Twill make a tongueless man to woo. 1. Inform me next, what love will do. 2. 'Twill strangely make a one of two. 1. Teach me besides, what love will do. 2. 'Twill quickly mar, and make ye too. 1. Tell me now last, what love will do. 2. 'Twill hurt and heal a heart pierc'd through.

1076. UPON TRAP.

Trap of a player turn'd a priest now is: Behold a sudden metamorphosis. If tithe-pigs fail, then will he shift the scene, And from a priest turn player once again.

1080. THE SCHOOL OR PEARL OF PUTNEY, THE MISTRESS OF ALL SINGULAR MANNERS, MISTRESS PORTMAN.

Whether I was myself, or else did see Out of myself that glorious hierarchy; Or whether those, in orders rare, or these Made up one state of sixty Venuses; Or whether fairies, syrens, nymphs they were, Or muses on their mountain sitting there; Or some enchanted place, I do not know, Or Sharon, where eternal roses grow. This I am sure: I ravished stood, as one Confus'd in utter admiration. Methought I saw them stir, and gently move, And look as all were capable of love; And in their motion smelt much like to flowers Inspir'd by th' sunbeams after dews and showers. There did I see the reverend rectress stand, Who with her eye's gleam, or a glance of hand, Those spirits raised; and with like precepts then, As with a magic, laid them all again. _A happy realm! When no compulsive law, Or fear of it, but love keeps all in awe._ Live you, great mistress of your arts, and be A nursing mother so to majesty, As those your ladies may in time be seen, For grace and carriage, everyone a queen. One birth their parents gave them; but their new, And better being, they receive from you. _Man's former birth is graceless; but the state Of life comes in, when he's regenerate._

1081. TO PERENNA.

Thou say'st I'm dull; if edgeless so I be, I'll whet my lips, and sharpen love on thee.

1082. ON HIMSELF.

Let me not live if I not love: Since I as yet did never prove Where pleasures met, at last do find All pleasures meet in womankind.

1083. ON LOVE.

That love 'twixt men does ever longest last Where war and peace the dice by turns do cast.

1084. ANOTHER ON LOVE.

Love's of itself too sweet; the best of all Is, when love's honey has a dash of gall.

1086. UPON CHUB.

When Chub brings in his harvest, still he cries, "Aha, my boys! here's meat for Christmas pies!" Soon after he for beer so scores his wheat, That at the tide he has not bread to eat.

1087. PLEASURES PERNICIOUS.

Where pleasures rule a kingdom, never there Is sober virtue seen to move her sphere.

1088. ON HIMSELF.

A wearied pilgrim, I have wandered here Twice five-and-twenty, bate me but one year; Long I have lasted in this world, 'tis true, But yet those years that I have lived, but few. Who by his grey hairs doth his lusters tell, Lives not those years, but he that lives them well. One man has reach'd his sixty years, but he Of all those threescore, has not liv'd half three. _He lives, who lives to virtue; men who cast Their ends for pleasure, do not live, but last._

Luster, five years.

1089. TO M. LAURENCE SWETNAHAM.

Read thou my lines, my Swetnaham; if there be A fault, 'tis hid if it be voic'd by thee. Thy mouth will make the sourest numbers please: How will it drop pure honey speaking these!

1090. HIS COVENANT; OR, PROTESTATION TO JULIA.

Why dost thou wound and break my heart, As if we should for ever part? Hast thou not heard an oath from me, After a day, or two, or three, I would come back and live with thee? Take, if thou dost distrust that vow, This second protestation now. Upon thy cheek that spangled tear, Which sits as dew of roses there, That tear shall scarce be dried before I'll kiss the threshold of thy door. Then weep not, sweet; but thus much know, I'm half return'd before I go.

1091. ON HIMSELF.

I will no longer kiss, I can no longer stay; The way of all flesh is That I must go this day. Since longer I can't live, My frolic youths, adieu; My lamp to you I'll give, And all my troubles too.

1092. TO THE MOST ACCOMPLISHED GENTLEMAN, M. MICHAEL OULSWORTH.

Nor think that thou in this my book art worst, Because not plac'd here with the midst, or first. Since fame that sides with these, or goes before Those, that must live with thee for evermore; That fame, and fame's rear'd pillar, thou shalt see In the next sheet, brave man, to follow thee. Fix on that column then, and never fall, Held up by Fame's eternal pedestal.

In the next sheet. See 1129.

1093. TO HIS GIRLS, WHO WOULD HAVE HIM SPORTFUL.

Alas! I can't, for tell me, how Can I be gamesome, aged now? Besides, ye see me daily grow Here, winter-like, to frost and snow; And I, ere long, my girls, shall see Ye quake for cold to look on me.

1094. TRUTH AND FALSEHOOD.

Truth by her own simplicity is known, Falsehood by varnish and vermilion.

1095. HIS LAST REQUEST TO JULIA.

I have been wanton and too bold, I fear, To chafe o'ermuch the virgin's cheek or ear. Beg for my pardon, Julia: _he doth win Grace with the gods who's sorry for his sin_. That done, my Julia, dearest Julia, come And go with me to choose my burial room: My fates are ended; when thy Herrick dies, Clasp thou his book, then close thou up his eyes.

1096. ON HIMSELF.

One ear tingles; some there be That are snarling now at me: Be they those that Homer bit, I will give them thanks for it.

1097. UPON KINGS.

Kings must be dauntless; subjects will contemn Those who want hearts and wear a diadem.

1098. TO HIS GIRLS.

Wanton wenches, do not bring For my hairs black colouring: For my locks, girls, let 'em be Grey or white, all's one to me.

1100. TO HIS BROTHER, NICHOLAS HERRICK.

What others have with cheapness seen and ease In varnish'd maps, by th' help of compasses, Or read in volumes and those books with all Their large narrations incanonical, Thou hast beheld those seas and countries far, And tell'st to us what once they were, and are. So that with bold truth thou can'st now relate This kingdom's fortune, and that empire's fate: Can'st talk to us of Sharon, where a spring Of roses have an endless flourishing; Of Sion, Sinai, Nebo, and with them Make known to us the new Jerusalem; The Mount of Olives, Calvary, and where Is, and hast seen, thy Saviour's sepulchre. So that the man that will but lay his ears As inapostate to the thing he hears, Shall by his hearing quickly come to see The truth of travels less in books than thee.

Large, exaggerated. _Incanonical_, untrustworthy.

1101. THE VOICE AND VIOL.

Rare is the voice itself: but when we sing To th' lute or viol, then 'tis ravishing.

1102. WAR.

If kings and kingdoms once distracted be, The sword of war must try the sovereignty

1103. A KING AND NO KING.

That prince who may do nothing but what's just, Rules but by leave, and takes his crown on trust.

1104. PLOTS NOT STILL PROSPEROUS.

All are not ill plots that do sometimes fail; Nor those false vows which ofttimes don't prevail.

1105. FLATTERY.

What is't that wastes a prince? example shows, 'Tis flattery spends a king, more than his foes.

1109. EXCESS.

Excess is sluttish: keep the mean; for why? Virtue's clean conclave is sobriety.

Conclave, guard.

1111. THE SOUL IS THE SALT.

The body's salt the soul is; which when gone, The flesh soon sucks in putrefaction.

1117. ABSTINENCE.

Against diseases here the strongest fence Is the defensive virtue, abstinence.

1118. NO DANGER TO MEN DESPERATE.

When fear admits no hope of safety, then Necessity makes dastards valiant men.

1119. SAUCE FOR SORROWS.

Although our suffering meet with no relief, _An equal mind is the best sauce for grief_.

1120. TO CUPID.

I have a leaden, thou a shaft of gold; Thou kill'st with heat, and I strike dead with cold. Let's try of us who shall the first expire; Or thou by frost, or I by quenchless fire: _Extremes are fatal where they once do strike, And bring to th' heart destruction both alike_.

1121. DISTRUST.

Whatever men for loyalty pretend, _'Tis wisdom's part to doubt a faithful friend_.

1123. THE MOUNT OF THE MUSES.

After thy labour take thine ease, Here with the sweet Pierides. But if so be that men will not Give thee the laurel crown for lot; Be yet assur'd, thou shall have one Not subject to corruption.

1124. ON HIMSELF.

I'll write no more of love; but now repent Of all those times that I in it have spent. I'll write no more of life; but wish 'twas ended, And that my dust was to the earth commended.

1125. TO HIS BOOK.

Go thou forth, my book, though late: Yet be timely fortunate. It may chance good luck may send Thee a kinsman, or a friend, That may harbour thee, when I With my fates neglected lie. If thou know'st not where to dwell, See, the fire's by: farewell.

1126. THE END OF HIS WORK.

Part of the work remains; one part is past: And here my ship rides, having anchor cast.

1127. TO CROWN IT.

My wearied bark, O let it now be crown'd! The haven reach'd to which I first was bound.

1128. ON HIMSELF.

The work is done: young men and maidens, set Upon my curls the myrtle coronet Washed with sweet ointments: thus at last I come To suffer in the Muses' martyrdom; But with this comfort, if my blood be shed, The Muses will wear blacks when I am dead.

Blacks, mourning garments.

1129. THE PILLAR OF FAME.

Fame's pillar here, at last, we set, Outduring marble, brass, or jet. Charm'd and enchanted so As to withstand the blow Of o v e r t h r o w; Nor shall the seas, Or o u t r a g e s Of storms o'erbear What we uprear. Tho' kingdoms fall, This pillar never shall Decline or waste at all; But stand for ever by his own Firm and well-fix'd foundation.

To his book's end this last line he'd have placed: _Jocund his muse was, but his life was chaste_.

HIS

NOBLE NUMBERS:

_OR_,

HIS PIOUS PIECES,

Wherein (amongst other things)

he sings the Birth of his CHRIST; and sighes for his _Saviours_ suffering on the _Crosse_.

HESIOD.

Ἴδμεν ψεύδεα πολλὰ λέγειν ἐτύμοισιν ὁμοῖα. Ἴδμεν δ', εὖτ' ἐθέλωμεν, ἀληθέα μυθήσασθαι.

[Illustration]

LONDON Printed for _John Williams_, and _Francis Eglesfield_. 1647.

HIS NOBLE NUMBERS:

OR,

HIS PIOUS PIECES.

1. HIS CONFESSION.

Look how our foul days do exceed our fair; And as our bad, more than our good works are, E'en so those lines, pen'd by my wanton wit, Treble the number of these good I've writ. Things precious are least numerous: men are prone To do ten bad for one good action.

2. HIS PRAYER FOR ABSOLUTION.

For those my unbaptised rhymes, Writ in my wild unhallowed times; For every sentence, clause, and word, That's not inlaid with Thee, my Lord, Forgive me, God, and blot each line Out of my book that is not Thine. But if, 'mongst all, thou find'st here one Worthy Thy benediction; That one of all the rest shall be The glory of my work and me.

3. TO FIND GOD.

Weigh me the fire; or canst thou find A way to measure out the wind; Distinguish all those floods that are Mix'd in that watery theatre; And taste thou them as saltless there As in their channel first they were. Tell me the people that do keep Within the kingdoms of the deep; Or fetch me back that cloud again Beshiver'd into seeds of rain; Tell me the motes, dust, sands, and spears Of corn, when summer shakes his ears; Show me that world of stars, and whence They noiseless spill their influence: This if thou canst, then show me Him That rides the glorious cherubim.

Keep, abide.

4. WHAT GOD IS.

God is above the sphere of our esteem, And is the best known, not defining Him.

5. UPON GOD.

God is not only said to be An Ens, but Supraentity.

6. MERCY AND LOVE.

God hath two wings which He doth ever move; The one is mercy, and the next is love: Under the first the sinners ever trust; And with the last He still directs the just.

7. GOD'S ANGER WITHOUT AFFECTION.

God when He's angry here with anyone, His wrath is free from perturbation; And when we think His looks are sour and grim, The alteration is in us, not Him.

8. GOD NOT TO BE COMPREHENDED.

'Tis hard to find God, but to comprehend Him, as He is, is labour without end.

9. GOD'S PART.

Prayers and praises are those spotless two Lambs, by the law, which God requires as due.

10. AFFLICTION.

God ne'er afflicts us more than our desert, Though He may seem to overact His part: Sometimes He strikes us more than flesh can bear; But yet still less than grace can suffer here.

11. THREE FATAL SISTERS.

Three fatal sisters wait upon each sin; First, fear and shame without, then guilt within.

12. SILENCE.

Suffer thy legs, but not thy tongue to walk: God, the Most Wise, is sparing of His talk.

13. MIRTH.

True mirth resides not in the smiling skin: The sweetest solace is to act no sin.

14. LOADING AND UNLOADING.

God loads and unloads, thus His work begins, To load with blessings and unload from sins.

15. GOD'S MERCY.

God's boundless mercy is, to sinful man, Like to the ever-wealthy ocean: Which though it sends forth thousand streams, 'tis ne'er Known, or else seen, to be the emptier; And though it takes all in, 'tis yet no more Full, and fill'd full, than when full fill'd before.

16. PRAYERS MUST HAVE POISE.

God, He rejects all prayers that are slight And want their poise: words ought to have their weight.

17. TO GOD: AN ANTHEM SUNG IN THE CHAPEL AT WHITEHALL BEFORE THE KING.

Verse. My God, I'm wounded by my sin, And sore without, and sick within. _Ver. Chor._ I come to Thee, in hope to find Salve for my body and my mind. _Verse._ In Gilead though no balm be found To ease this smart or cure this wound, _Ver. Chor._ Yet, Lord, I know there is with Thee All saving health, and help for me. _Verse._ Then reach Thou forth that hand of Thine, That pours in oil, as well as wine, _Ver. Chor._ And let it work, for I'll endure The utmost smart, so Thou wilt cure.

18. UPON GOD.

God is all fore-part; for, we never see Any part backward in the Deity.

19. CALLING AND CORRECTING.

God is not only merciful to call Men to repent, but when He strikes withal.

20. NO ESCAPING THE SCOURGING.

God scourgeth some severely, some He spares; But all in smart have less or greater shares.

21. THE ROD.

God's rod doth watch while men do sleep, and then The rod doth sleep, while vigilant are men.

22. GOD HAS A TWOFOLD PART.

God, when for sin He makes His children smart, His own He acts not, but another's part; But when by stripes He saves them, then 'tis known He comes to play the part that is His own.

23. GOD IS ONE.

God, as He is most holy known, So He is said to be most one.

24. PERSECUTIONS PROFITABLE.

Afflictions they most profitable are To the beholder and the sufferer: Bettering them both, but by a double strain, The first by patience, and the last by pain.

25. TO GOD.

Do with me, God, as Thou didst deal with John, Who writ that heavenly Revelation. Let me, like him, first cracks of thunder hear, Then let the harps enchantments stroke mine ear: Here give me thorns, there, in Thy kingdom, set Upon my head the golden coronet; There give me day; but here my dreadful night: My sackcloth here; but there my stole of white.

Stroke, text _strike_.

26. WHIPS.

God has His whips here to a twofold end: The bad to punish, and the good t' amend.

27. GOD'S PROVIDENCE.

If all transgressions here should have their pay, What need there then be of a reckoning day? If God should punish no sin here of men, His providence who would not question then?

28. TEMPTATION.

Those saints which God loves best, The devil tempts not least.

29. HIS EJACULATION TO GOD.

My God! look on me with Thine eye Of pity, not of scrutiny; For if Thou dost, Thou then shalt see Nothing but loathsome sores in me. O then, for mercy's sake, behold These my eruptions manifold, And heal me with Thy look or touch; But if Thou wilt not deign so much, Because I'm odious in Thy sight, Speak but the word, and cure me quite.

30. GOD'S GIFTS NOT SOON GRANTED.

God hears us when we pray, but yet defers His gifts, to exercise petitioners; And though a while He makes requesters stay, With princely hand He'll recompense delay.

31. PERSECUTIONS PURIFY.

God strikes His Church, but 'tis to this intent, To make, not mar her, by this punishment; So where He gives the bitter pills, be sure 'Tis not to poison, but to make thee pure.

32. PARDON.

God pardons those who do through frailty sin, But never those that persevere therein.

33. AN ODE OF THE BIRTH OF OUR SAVIOUR.

In numbers, and but these few, I sing Thy birth, O JESU! Thou pretty baby, born here, With sup'rabundant scorn here; Who for Thy princely port here, Hadst for Thy place Of birth a base Out-stable for Thy court here.

Instead of neat enclosures Of interwoven osiers, Instead of fragrant posies Of daffodils and roses, Thy cradle, Kingly Stranger, As Gospel tells, Was nothing else But here a homely manger.

But we with silks, not crewels, With sundry precious jewels, And lily-work will dress Thee; And as we dispossess Thee Of clouts, we'll make a chamber, Sweet babe, for Thee Of ivory, And plaister'd round with amber.

The Jews they did disdain Thee, But we will entertain Thee With glories to await here, Upon Thy princely state here; And more for love than pity, From year to year, We'll make Thee, here, A freeborn of our city.

Crewels, worsteds. _Clouts_, rags.

34. LIP-LABOUR.

In the old Scripture I have often read, The calf without meal ne'er was offered; To figure to us nothing more than this, Without the heart lip-labour nothing is.

35. THE HEART.

In prayer the lips ne'er act the winning part, Without the sweet concurrence of the heart.

36. EARRINGS.

Why wore th' Egyptians jewels in the ear? But for to teach us, all the grace is there, When we obey, by acting what we hear.

37. SIN SEEN.

When once the sin has fully acted been, Then is the horror of the trespass seen.

38. UPON TIME.

Time was upon The wing, to fly away; And I call'd on Him but awhile to stay; But he'd be gone, For ought that I could say.

He held out then A writing, as he went; And ask'd me, when False man would be content To pay again What God and Nature lent.

An hour-glass, In which were sands but few, As he did pass, He show'd, and told me, too, Mine end near was; And so away he flew.

39. HIS PETITION.

If war or want shall make me grow so poor, As for to beg my bread from door to door; Lord! let me never act that beggar's part, Who hath Thee in his mouth, not in his heart: He who asks alms in that so sacred Name, Without due reverence, plays the cheater's game.

40. TO GOD.

Thou hast promis'd, Lord, to be With me in my misery; Suffer me to be so bold As to speak, Lord, say and hold.

41. HIS LITANY TO THE HOLY SPIRIT.

In the hour of my distress, When temptations me oppress, And when I my sins confess, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When I lie within my bed, Sick in heart and sick in head, And with doubts discomforted, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the house doth sigh and weep, And the world is drown'd in sleep, Yet mine eyes the watch do keep, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the artless doctor sees No one hope, but of his fees, And his skill runs on the lees, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When his potion and his pill Has, or none, or little skill, Meet for nothing, but to kill; Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the passing bell doth toll, And the furies in a shoal Come to fright a parting soul, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the tapers now burn blue, And the comforters are few, And that number more than true, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the priest his last hath prayed, And I nod to what is said, 'Cause my speech is now decayed, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When, God knows, I'm toss'd about, Either with despair, or doubt; Yet before the glass be out, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the tempter me pursu'th With the sins of all my youth, And half damns me with untruth, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the flames and hellish cries Fright mine ears, and fright mine eyes, And all terrors me surprise, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the judgment is reveal'd, And that open'd which was seal'd, When to Thee I have appeal'd, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

42. THANKSGIVING.

Thanksgiving for a former, doth invite God to bestow a second benefit.

43. COCK-CROW.

Bellman of night, if I about shall go For to deny my Master, do thou crow. Thou stop'dst St. Peter in the midst of sin; Stay me, by crowing, ere I do begin: Better it is, premonish'd for to shun A sin, than fall to weeping when 'tis done.

44. ALL THINGS RUN WELL FOR THE RIGHTEOUS.

Adverse and prosperous fortunes both work on Here, for the righteous man's salvation; Be he oppos'd, or be he not withstood, All serve to th' augmentation of his good.

45. PAIN ENDS IN PLEASURE.

Afflictions bring us joy in times to come, When sins, by stripes, to us grow wearisome.

46. TO GOD.

I'll come, I'll creep, though Thou dost threat, Humbly unto Thy mercy-seat: When I am there, this then I'll do, Give Thee a dart, and dagger too; Next, when I have my faults confessed, Naked I'll show a sighing breast; Which if that can't Thy pity woo, Then let Thy justice do the rest And strike it through.

47. A THANKSGIVING TO GOD FOR HIS HOUSE.

Lord, Thou hast given me a cell Wherein to dwell; A little house, whose humble roof Is weather-proof; Under the spars of which I lie Both soft and dry; Where Thou my chamber for to ward Hast set a guard Of harmless thoughts, to watch and keep Me, while I sleep. Low is my porch, as is my fate, Both void of state; And yet the threshold of my door Is worn by th' poor, Who thither come, and freely get Good

words or meat; Like as my parlour, so my hall And kitchen's small; A little buttery, and therein A little bin Which keeps my little loaf of bread Unclipt, unflead. Some brittle sticks of thorn or briar Make me a fire, Close by whose living coal I sit, And glow like it. Lord, I confess, too, when I dine, The pulse is Thine, And all those other bits, that be There placed by Thee; The worts, the purslain, and the mess Of water-cress, Which of Thy kindness Thou hast sent; And my content Makes those, and my beloved beet, To be more sweet. 'Tis Thou that crown'st my glittering hearth With guiltless mirth; And giv'st me wassail bowls to drink, Spiced to the brink. Lord, 'tis Thy plenty-dropping hand, That soils my land; And giv'st me for my bushel sown, Twice ten for one. Thou mak'st my teeming hen to lay Her egg each day; Besides my healthful ewes to bear Me twins each year, The while the conduits of my kine Run cream for wine. All these, and better Thou dost send Me, to this end, That I should render, for my part, A thankful heart; Which, fired with incense, I resign, As wholly Thine; But the acceptance, that must be, My Christ, by Thee.

Unflead, lit. unflay'd. _Purslain_, an herb.

48. TO GOD.

Make, make me Thine, my gracious God, Or with Thy staff, or with Thy rod; And be the blow, too, what it will, Lord, I will kiss it, though it kill: Beat me, bruise me, rack me, rend me, Yet, in torments, I'll commend Thee; Examine me with fire, and prove me To the full, yet I will love Thee; Nor shall Thou give so deep a wound But I as patient will be found.

49. ANOTHER TO GOD.

Lord, do not beat me, Since I do sob and cry, And swoon away to die, Ere Thou dost threat me. Lord, do not scourge me, If I by lies and oaths Have soil'd myself or clothes, But rather purge me.

50. NONE TRULY HAPPY HERE.

Happy's that man to whom God gives A stock of goods, whereby he lives Near to the wishes of his heart: No man is blest through every part.

51. TO HIS EVER-LOVING GOD.

Can I not come to Thee, my God, for these So very many meeting hindrances, That slack my pace, but yet not make me stay? Who slowly goes, rids, in the end, his way. Clear Thou my paths, or shorten Thou my miles, Remove the bars, or lift me o'er the stiles; Since rough the way is, help me when I call, And take me up; or else prevent the fall. I ken my home, and it affords some ease To see far off the smoking villages. Fain would I rest, yet covet not to die For fear of future biting penury: No, no, my God, Thou know'st my wishes be To leave this life, not loving it, but Thee.

Rids way, gets over the ground.

52. ANOTHER.

Thou bid'st me come; I cannot come; for why? Thou dwell'st aloft, and I want wings to fly. To mount my soul, she must have pinions given; For 'tis no easy way from earth

to heaven.

53. TO DEATH.

Thou bid'st me come away, And I'll no longer stay Than for to shed some tears For faults of former years, And to repent some crimes Done in the present times: And next, to take a bit Of bread, and wine with it: To don my robes of love, Fit for the place above; To gird my loins about With charity throughout; And so to travel hence With feet of innocence: These done, I'll only cry God mercy, and so die.

54. NEUTRALITY LOATHSOME.

God will have all, or none; serve Him, or fall Down before Baal, Bel, or Belial: Either be hot or cold: God doth despise, Abhor, and spew out all neutralities.

55. WELCOME WHAT COMES.

Whatever comes, let's be content withal: Among God's blessings there is no one small.

56. TO HIS ANGRY GOD.

Through all the night Thou dost me fright, And hold'st mine eyes from sleeping; And day by day, My cup can say My wine is mix'd with weeping.

Thou dost my bread With ashes knead Each evening and each morrow; Mine eye and ear Do see and hear The coming in of sorrow.

Thy scourge of steel, Ah me! I feel Upon me beating ever: While my sick heart With dismal smart Is disacquainted never.

Long, long, I'm sure, This can't endure, But in short time 'twill please Thee, My gentle God, To burn the rod, Or strike so as to ease me.

57. PATIENCE: OR, COMFORTS IN CROSSES.

Abundant plagues I late have had, Yet none of these have made me sad: For why? My Saviour with the sense Of suff'ring gives me patience.

58. ETERNITY.

O years! and age! farewell: Behold, I go Where I do know Infinity to dwell.

And these mine eyes shall see All times, how they Are lost i' th' sea Of vast eternity.

Where never moon shall sway The stars; but she And night shall be Drown'd in one endless day.

59. TO HIS SAVIOUR, A CHILD: A PRESENT BY A CHILD.

Go, pretty child, and bear this flower Unto thy little Saviour; And tell Him, by that bud now blown, He is the Rose of Sharon known. When thou hast said so, stick it there Upon His bib or stomacher; And tell Him, for good handsel too, That thou hast brought a whistle new, Made of a clean strait oaten reed, To charm His cries at time of need. Tell Him, for coral, thou hast none, But if thou hadst, He should have one; But poor thou art, and known to be Even as moneyless as He. Lastly, if thou canst win

a kiss From those mellifluous lips of His; Then never take a second on, To spoil the first impression.

Handsel, earnest money.

60. THE NEW-YEAR'S GIFT.

Let others look for pearl and gold, Tissues, or tabbies manifold: One only lock of that sweet hay Whereon the blessed baby lay, Or one poor swaddling-clout, shall be The richest New-Year's gift to me.

Tabbies, shot silks.

61. TO GOD.

If anything delight me for to print My book, 'tis this: that Thou, my God, art in't.

62. GOD AND THE KING.

How am I bound to Two! God, who doth give The mind; the king, the means whereby I live.

63. GOD'S MIRTH: MAN'S MOURNING.

Where God is merry, there write down thy fears: What He with laughter speaks, hear thou with tears.

64. HONOURS ARE HINDRANCES.

Give me honours! what are these, But the pleasing hindrances? Stiles, and stops, and stays that come In the way 'twixt me and home; Clear the walk, and then shall I To my heaven less run than fly.

65. THE PARASCEVE, OR PREPARATION.

To a love-feast we both invited are: The figur'd damask, or pure diaper, Over the golden altar now is spread, With bread, and wine, and vessels furnished; The sacred towel and the holy ewer Are ready by, to make the guests all pure: Let's go, my Alma; yet, ere we receive, Fit, fit it is we have our parasceve. Who to that sweet bread unprepar'd doth come, Better be starv'd, than but to taste one crumb.

Parasceve, preparation.

66. TO GOD.

God gives not only corn for need, But likewise sup'rabundant seed; Bread for our service, bread for show, Meat for our meals, and fragments too: He gives not poorly, taking some Between the finger and the thumb; But for our glut and for our store, Fine flour press'd down, and running o'er.

67. A WILL TO BE WORKING.

Although we cannot turn the fervent fit Of sin, we must strive 'gainst the stream of it; And howsoe'er we have the conquest miss'd, 'Tis for our glory that we did resist.

68. CHRIST'S PART.

Christ, He requires still, wheresoe'er He comes To feed or lodge, to have the best of rooms: Give Him the choice; grant Him the nobler part Of all the house: the best of all's the heart.

69. RICHES AND POVERTY.

God could have made all rich, or all men poor; But why He did not, let me tell wherefore: Had all been rich, where then had patience been? Had all been poor, who had His bounty seen?

70. SOBRIETY IN SEARCH.

To seek of God more than we well can find, Argues a strong distemper of the mind.

71. ALMS.

Give, if thou canst, an alms; if not, afford, Instead of that, a sweet and gentle word: _God crowns our goodness wheresoe'er He sees, On our part, wanting all abilities_.

72. TO HIS CONSCIENCE.

Can I not sin, but thou wilt be My private protonotary? Can I not woo thee to pass by A short and sweet iniquity? I'll cast a mist and cloud upon My delicate transgression So utter dark as that no eye Shall see the hugg'd impiety; Gifts blind the wise, and bribes do please And wind all other witnesses; And wilt not thou with gold be ti'd To lay thy pen and ink aside? That in the mirk and tongueless night Wanton I may, and thou not write? It will not be. And, therefore, now, For times to come I'll make this vow, From aberrations to live free; So I'll not fear the Judge or thee.

Protonotary, once the title of the chief clerk in the Courts of Common Pleas and King's Bench.

73. TO HIS SAVIOUR.

Lord, I confess, that Thou alone art able To purify this my Augean stable: Be the seas water, and the land all soap, Yet if Thy blood not wash me, there's no hope.

74. TO GOD.

God is all sufferance here; here He doth show No arrow nockt, only a stringless bow: His arrows fly, and all His stones are hurl'd Against the wicked in another world.

Nockt, placed ready for shooting.

75. HIS DREAM.

I dreamt, last night, Thou didst transfuse Oil from Thy jar into my cruse; And pouring still Thy wealthy store, The vessel full did then run o'er; Methought I did Thy bounty chide To see the waste; but 'twas replied By Thee, dear God, God gives man seed Ofttimes for waste, as for his need. Then I could say that house is bare That has not bread and some to spare.

76. GOD'S BOUNTY.

God's bounty, that ebbs less and less As men do wane in thankfulness.

77. TO HIS SWEET SAVIOUR.

Night hath no wings to him that cannot sleep, And time seems then not for to fly, but creep; Slowly her chariot drives, as if that she Had broke her wheel, or crack'd her axletree. Just so it is with me, who, list'ning, pray The winds to blow the tedious night away, That I might see the cheerful, peeping day. Sick is my heart! O Saviour! do Thou please To make my bed soft in my sicknesses: Lighten my candle, so that I beneath Sleep not for ever in the vaults of death; Let me Thy voice betimes i' th' morning hear: Call, and I'll come; say Thou the when, and where. Draw me but first, and after Thee I'll run And make no one stop till my race be done.

78. HIS CREED.

I do believe that die I must, And be return'd from out my dust: I do believe that when I rise, Christ I shall see, with these same eyes: I do believe that I must come, With others, to the dreadful doom: I do believe the bad must go From thence, to everlasting woe: I do believe the good, and I, Shall live with Him eternally: I do believe I shall inherit Heaven, by Christ's mercies, not my merit. I do believe the One in Three, And Three in perfect unity: Lastly, that JESUS is a deed Of gift from God: and here's my creed.

79. TEMPTATIONS.

Temptations hurt not, though they have access: Satan o'ercomes none, but by willingness.

80. THE LAMP.

When a man's faith is frozen up, as dead; Then is the lamp and oil extinguished.

81. SORROWS.

Sorrows our portion are: ere hence we go, Crosses we must have; or, hereafter woe.

82. PENITENCY.

A man's transgressions God does then remit, When man He makes a penitent for it.

83. THE DIRGE OF JEPHTHAH'S DAUGHTER: SUNG BY THE VIRGINS.

O thou, the wonder of all days! O paragon, and pearl of praise! O virgin-martyr, ever blest Above the rest Of all the maiden train! We come, And bring fresh strewings to thy tomb.

Thus, thus, and thus we compass round Thy harmless and unhaunted ground; And as we sing thy dirge, we will The daffodil And other flowers lay upon The altar of our love, thy stone.

Thou wonder of all maids, liest here. Of daughters all the dearest dear; The eye of virgins; nay, the queen Of this smooth green, And all sweet meads; from whence we get The primrose and the violet.

Too soon, too dear did Jephthah buy, By thy sad loss, our liberty: His was the bond and cov'nant, yet Thou paid'st the debt: Lamented maid! he won the day, But for the conquest thou didst pay.

Thy father brought with him along The olive branch and victor's song: He slew the Ammonites, we know, But to thy woe; And in the purchase of our peace, The cure was worse than the disease.

For which obedient zeal of thine, We offer here, before thy shrine, Our sighs for storax, tears for wine; And to make fine And fresh thy hearse-cloth, we will, here, Four times bestrew thee ev'ry year.

Receive, for this thy praise, our tears: Receive this offering of our hairs: Receive these crystal vials fill'd With tears distill'd From teeming eyes; to these we bring, Each maid, her silver filleting,

To gild thy tomb; besides, these cauls, These laces, ribbons, and these falls, These veils, wherewith we use to hide The bashful bride, When we conduct her to her groom: And all we lay upon thy tomb.

No more, no more, since thou art dead, Shall we e'er bring coy brides to bed; No more, at yearly festivals We cowslip balls Or chains of columbines shall make For this or that occasion's sake.

No, no; our maiden pleasures be Wrapp'd in the winding-sheet with thee: 'Tis we are dead, though not i' th' grave: Or, if we have One seed of life left, 'tis to keep A Lent for thee, to fast and weep.

Sleep in thy peace, thy bed of spice, And make this place all paradise: May sweets grow here: and smoke from hence Fat frankincense: Let balm and cassia send their scent From out thy maiden-monument.

May no wolf howl, or screech-owl stir A wing about thy sepulchre! No boisterous winds, or storms, come hither To starve or wither Thy soft sweet earth! but, like a spring, Love keep it ever flourishing.

May all shy maids, at wonted hours, Come forth to strew thy tomb with flow'rs: May virgins, when they come to mourn, Male-incense burn Upon thine altar! then return, And leave thee sleeping in thy urn.

Cauls, nets for the hair. _Falls_, trimmings hanging loosely. _Male-incense_, incense in globular drops.

84. TO GOD: ON HIS SICKNESS.

What though my harp and viol be Both hung upon the willow tree? What though my bed be now my grave, And for my house I darkness have? What though my healthful days are fled, And I lie number'd with the dead? Yet I have hope, by Thy great power, To spring; though now a wither'd flower.

85. SINS LOATHED, AND YET LOVED.

Shame checks our first attempts; but then 'tis prov'd _Sins first dislik'd are after that belov'd_.

86. SIN.

Sin leads the way, but as it goes, it feels The following plague still treading on his heels.

87. UPON GOD.

God, when He takes my goods and chattels hence, Gives me a portion, giving patience: What is in God is God; if so it be He patience gives, He gives Himself to me.

88. FAITH.

What here we hope for, we shall once inherit; By faith we all walk here, not by the Spirit.

89. HUMILITY.

Humble we must be, if to heaven we go: High is the roof there; but the gate is low: Whene'er thou speak'st, look with a lowly eye: Grace is increased by humility.

90. TEARS.

Our present tears here, not our present laughter, Are but the handsels of our joys hereafter.

Handsels, earnest money, foretaste.

91. SIN AND STRIFE.

After true sorrow for our sins, our strife Must last with Satan to the end of life.

92. AN ODE, OR PSALM TO GOD.

Dear God, If Thy smart rod Here did not make me sorry, I should not be With Thine or Thee In Thy eternal glory.

But since Thou didst convince My sins by gently striking; Add still to those First stripes new blows, According to Thy liking.

Fear me, Or scourging tear me; That thus from vices driven, I may from hell Fly up to dwell With Thee and Thine in heaven.

93. GRACES FOR CHILDREN.

What God gives, and what we take, 'Tis a gift for Christ, His sake: Be the meal of beans and peas, God be thanked for those and these: Have we flesh, or have we fish, All are fragments from His dish. He His Church save, and the king; And our peace here, like a spring, Make it ever flourishing.

94. GOD TO BE FIRST SERVED.

Honour thy parents; but good manners call Thee to adore thy God the first of all.

95. ANOTHER GRACE FOR A CHILD.

Here a little child I stand Heaving up my either hand; Cold as paddocks though they be, Here I lift them up to Thee, For a benison to fall On our meat and on us all. Amen.

Paddocks, frogs.

96. A CHRISTMAS CAROL SUNG TO THE KING IN THE PRESENCE AT WHITEHALL.

Chor. What sweeter music can we bring, Than a carol for to sing The birth of this our heavenly King? Awake the voice! awake the string! Heart, ear, and eye, and everything Awake! the while the active finger Runs division with the singer.

FROM THE FLOURISH THEY CAME TO THE SONG.

1. Dark and dull night, fly hence away And give the honour to this day That sees December turn'd to May.

2. If we may ask the reason, say The why and wherefore all things here Seem like the spring-time of the year.

3. Why does the chilling winter's morn Smile like a field beset with corn? Or smell like to a mead new shorn, Thus, on the sudden?

4. Come and see The cause, why things thus fragrant be: 'Tis He is born, whose quick'ning birth Gives life and lustre, public mirth, To heaven and the under-earth.

Chor. We see Him come, and know Him ours, Who, with His sunshine and His showers, Turns all the patient ground to flowers.

1. The darling of the world is come, And fit it is we find a room To welcome Him. 2. The nobler part Of all the house here is the heart,

Chor. Which we will give Him; and bequeath This holly and this ivy wreath, To do Him honour; who's our King, And Lord of all this revelling.

The musical part was composed by M. Henry Lawes.

Division, a rapid passage of music sung in one breath or a single syllable.

97. THE NEW-YEAR'S GIFT: OR, CIRCUMCISION'S SONG. SUNG TO THE KING IN THE PRESENCE AT WHITEHALL.

1. Prepare for songs; He's come, He's come; And be it sin here to be dumb, And not with lutes to fill the room.

2. Cast holy water all about, And have a care no fire goes out, But 'cense the porch and place throughout.

3. The altars all on fire be; The storax fries; and ye may see How heart and hand do all agree To make things sweet. _Chor._ Yet all less sweet than He.

4. Bring Him along, most pious priest, And tell us then, whenas thou seest His gently-gliding, dove-like eyes, And hear'st His whimpering and His cries; How can'st

thou this Babe circumcise?

5. Ye must not be more pitiful than wise; For, now unless ye see Him bleed, Which makes the bapti'm, 'tis decreed The birth is fruitless. _Chor._ Then the work God speed.

1. Touch gently, gently touch; and here Spring tulips up through all the year; And from His sacred blood, here shed, May roses grow to crown His own dear head.

Chor. Back, back again; each thing is done With zeal alike, as 'twas begun; Now singing, homeward let us carry The Babe unto His mother Mary; And when we have the Child commended To her warm bosom, then our rites are ended. _Composed by M. Henry Lawes._

98. ANOTHER NEW-YEAR'S GIFT: OR, SONG FOR THE CIRCUMCISION.

1. Hence, hence profane, and none appear With anything unhallowed here; No jot of leaven must be found Conceal'd in this most holy ground.

2. What is corrupt, or sour'd with sin, Leave that without, then enter in;

Chor. But let no Christmas mirth begin Before ye purge and circumcise Your hearts, and hands, lips, ears, and eyes.

3. Then, like a perfum'd altar, see That all things sweet and clean may be: For here's a Babe that, like a bride, Will blush to death if ought be spi'd Ill-scenting, or unpurifi'd.

Chor. The room is 'cens'd: help, help t' invoke Heaven to come down, the while we choke The temple with a cloud of smoke.

4. Come then, and gently touch the birth Of Him, who's Lord of Heaven and Earth:

5. And softly handle Him; y'ad need, Because the pretty Babe does bleed. Poor pitied Child! who from Thy stall Bring'st, in Thy blood, a balm that shall Be the best New-Year's gift to all.

1. Let's bless the Babe: and, as we sing His praise, so let us bless the King.

Chor. Long may He live till He hath told His New-Years trebled to His old: And when that's done, to re-aspire A new-born Phœnix from His own chaste fire.

99. GOD'S PARDON.

When I shall sin, pardon my trespass here; For once in hell, none knows remission there.

100. SIN.

Sin once reached up to God's eternal sphere, And was committed, not remitted there.

101. EVIL.

Evil no nature hath; the loss of good Is that which gives to sin a livelihood.

102. THE STAR-SONG: A CAROL TO THE KING SUNG AT WHITEHALL.

The Flourish of Music; then followed the Song.

1. Tell us, thou clear and heavenly tongue, Where is the Babe but lately sprung? Lies he the lily-banks among?

2. Or say, if this new Birth of ours Sleeps, laid within some ark of flowers, Spangled with dew-light; thou canst clear All doubts, and manifest the where.

3. Declare to us, bright star, if we shall seek Him in the morning's blushing cheek, Or search the beds of spices through, To find him out.

Star. No, this ye need not do; But only come and see Him rest A Princely Babe in's mother's breast.

Chor. He's seen, He's seen! why then a round, Let's kiss the sweet and holy ground; And all rejoice that we have found _A King before conception crown'd_.

4. Come then, come then, and let us bring Unto our pretty Twelfth-tide King, Each one his several offering;

Chor. And when night comes, we'll give Him wassailing; And that His treble honours may be seen, We'll choose Him King, and make His mother Queen.

103. TO GOD.

With golden censers, and with incense, here Before Thy virgin-altar I appear, To pay Thee that I owe, since what I see In, or without, all, all belongs to Thee. Where shall I now begin to make, for one Least loan of Thine, half restitution? Alas! I cannot pay a jot; therefore I'll kiss the tally, and confess the score. Ten thousand talents lent me, Thou dost write; 'Tis true, my God, but I can't pay one mite.

Tally, the record of his score or debt.

104. TO HIS DEAR GOD.

I'll hope no more For things that will not come; And if they do, they prove but cumbersome. Wealth brings much woe; And, since it fortunes so, 'Tis better to be poor Than so t' abound As to be drown'd Or overwhelm'd with store.

Pale care, avaunt! I'll learn to be content With that small stock Thy bounty gave or lent. What may conduce To my most healthful use, Almighty God, me grant; But that, or this, That hurtful is, Deny Thy suppliant.

105. TO GOD: HIS GOOD WILL.

Gold I have none, but I present my need, O Thou, that crown'st the will, where wants the deed. Where rams are wanting, or large bullocks' thighs, There a poor lamb's a plenteous sacrifice. Take then his vows, who, if he had it, would Devote to Thee both incense, myrrh and gold Upon an altar rear'd by him, and crown'd Both with the ruby, pearl, and diamond.

106. ON HEAVEN.

Permit mine eyes to see Part, or the whole of Thee, O happy place! Where all have grace, And garlands shar'd, For their reward; Where each chaste soul In long white

stole, And palms in hand, Do ravish'd stand; So in a ring, The praises sing Of Three in One That fill the Throne; While harps and viols then To voices say, Amen.

107. THE SUM AND THE SATISFACTION.

Last night I drew up mine account, And found my debits to amount To such a height, as for to tell How I should pay 's impossible. Well, this I'll do: my mighty score Thy mercy-seat I'll lay before; But therewithal I'll bring the band Which, in full force, did daring stand Till my Redeemer, on the tree, Made void for millions, as for me. Then, if thou bidst me pay, or go Unto the prison, I'll say, no; Christ having paid, I nothing owe: For, this is sure, the debt is dead By law, the bond once cancelled.

Score, debt or reckoning. _Band_, bond. _Daring_, frightening.

108. GOOD MEN AFFLICTED MOST.

God makes not good men wantons, but doth bring Them to the field, and, there, to skirmishing. With trials those, with terrors these He proves, And hazards those most whom the most He loves; For Sceva, darts; for Cocles, dangers; thus He finds a fire for mighty Mutius; Death for stout Cato; and besides all these, A poison, too, He has for Socrates; Torments for high Attilius; and, with want, Brings in Fabricius for a combatant: But bastard-slips, and such as He dislikes, He never brings them once to th' push of pikes.

109. GOOD CHRISTIANS

Play their offensive and defensive parts, Till they be hid o'er with a wood of darts.

110. THE WILL THE CAUSE OF WOE.

When man is punish'd, he is plagued still, Not for the fault of nature, but of will.

111. TO HEAVEN.

Open thy gates To him, who weeping waits, And might come in, But that held back by sin. Let mercy be So kind to set me free, And I will straight Come in, or force the gate.

112. THE RECOMPENSE.

All I have lost that could be rapt from me; And fare it well: yet, Herrick, if so be Thy dearest Saviour renders thee but one Smile, that one smile's full restitution.

113. TO GOD.

Pardon me, God, once more I Thee entreat, That I have placed Thee in so mean a seat Where round about Thou seest but all things vain, Uncircumcis'd, unseason'd and profane. But as Heaven's public and immortal eye Looks on the filth, but is not soil'd thereby, So Thou, my God, may'st on this impure look, But take no tincture from my sinful book: Let but one beam of glory on it shine, And that will make me and my work divine.

114. TO GOD.

Lord, I am like to mistletoe, Which has no root, and cannot grow Or prosper but by that same tree It clings about; so I by Thee. What need I then to fear at all, So long as I about Thee crawl? But if that tree should fall and die, Tumble shall heav'n, and down will I.

115. HIS WISH TO GOD.

I would to God that mine old age might have Before my last, but here a living grave, Some one poor almshouse; there to lie, or stir Ghostlike, as in my meaner sepulchre; A little piggin and a pipkin by, To hold things fitting my necessity, Which rightly used, both in their time and place, Might me excite to fore and after-grace. Thy Cross, my Christ, fix'd 'fore mine eyes should be, Not to adore that, but to worship Thee. So, here the remnant of my days I'd spend, Reading Thy Bible, and my Book; so end.

Piggin, a small wooden vessel.

116. SATAN.

When we 'gainst Satan stoutly fight, the more He tears and tugs us than he did before; Neglecting once to cast a frown on those Whom ease makes his without the help of blows.

117. HELL.

Hell is no other but a soundless pit, Where no one beam of comfort peeps in it.

118. THE WAY.

When I a ship see on the seas, Cuff'd with those wat'ry savages, And therewithal behold it hath In all that way no beaten path, Then, with a wonder, I confess Thou art our way i' th' wilderness; And while we blunder in the dark, Thou art our candle there, or spark.

119. GREAT GRIEF, GREAT GLORY.

The less our sorrows here and suff'rings cease, The more our crowns of glory there increase.

120. HELL.

Hell is the place where whipping-cheer abounds, But no one jailer there to wash the wounds.

121. THE BELLMAN.

Along the dark and silent night, With my lantern and my light, And the tinkling of my bell, Thus I walk, and this I tell: Death and dreadfulness call on To the gen'ral session, To whose dismal bar we there All accounts must come to clear. Scores of sins w'ave made here many, Wip'd out few, God knows, if any. Rise, ye debtors, then, and fall To make payment while I call. Ponder this, when I am gone; By the clock 'tis almost one.

122. THE GOODNESS OF HIS GOD.

When winds and seas do rage And threaten to undo me, Thou dost, their wrath assuage If I but call unto Thee.

A mighty storm last night Did seek my soul to swallow, But by the peep of light A gentle calm did follow.

What need I then despair, Though ills stand round about me; Since mischiefs neither dare To bark or bite without Thee?

123. THE WIDOWS' TEARS: OR, DIRGE OF DORCAS.

Come pity us, all ye who see Our harps hung on the willow tree: Come pity us, ye passers-by Who see or hear poor widows cry: Come pity us; and bring your ears And eyes to pity widows' tears. _Chor._ And when you are come hither Then we will keep A fast, and weep Our eyes out altogether.

For Tabitha, who dead lies here, Clean washed, and laid out for the bier, O modest matrons, weep and wail! For now the corn and wine must fail: The basket and the bin of bread, Wherewith so many souls were fed, _Chor._ Stand empty here for ever: And ah! the poor At thy worn door Shall be relieved never.

Woe worth the time, woe worth the day That 'reaved us of thee, Tabitha! For we have lost with thee the meal, The bits, the morsels, and the deal Of gentle paste and yielding dough That thou on widows did'st bestow. _Chor._ All's gone, and death hath taken Away from us Our maundy; thus Thy widows stand forsaken.

Ah, Dorcas, Dorcas! now adieu We bid the cruse and pannier too: Ay, and the flesh, for and the fish Doled to us in that lordly dish. We take our leaves now of the loom From whence the housewives' cloth did come: _Chor._ The web affords now nothing; Thou being dead, The worsted thread Is cut, that made us clothing.

Farewell the flax and reaming wool With which thy house was plentiful; Farewell the coats, the garments, and The sheets, the rugs, made by thy hand; Farewell thy fire and thy light That ne'er went out by day or night: _Chor._ No, or thy zeal so speedy, That found a way By peep of day, To feed and cloth the needy.

But, ah, alas! the almond bough And olive branch is withered now. The wine press now is ta'en from us, The saffron and the calamus. The spice and spikenard hence is gone, The storax and the cinnamon. _Chor._ The carol of our gladness Has taken wing, And our late spring Of mirth is turned to sadness.

How wise wast thou in all thy ways! How worthy of respect and praise! How matron-like didst thou go dressed! How soberly above the rest Of those that prank it with their plumes, And jet it with their choice perfumes! _Chor._ Thy vestures were not flowing: Nor did the street Accuse thy feet Of mincing in their going.

And though thou here li'st dead, we see A deal of beauty yet in thee. How sweetly shows thy smiling face, Thy lips with all-diffused grace! Thy hands, though cold, yet spotless white, And comely as the chrysolite! _Chor._ Thy belly like a hill is, Or as a neat Clean heap of wheat, All set about with lilies.

Sleep with thy beauties here, while we Will show these garments made by thee; These were the coats, in these are read The monuments of Dorcas dead. These were thy acts, and thou shall have These hung as honours o'er thy grave; _Chor._ And after us, distressed, Should fame be dumb, Thy very tomb Would cry out, Thou art blessed.

Deal, portion. _Maundy_, the alms given on Thursday in Holy Week. _Reaming_, drawing out into threads. _Calamus_, a fragrant plant, the sweet flag. _Chrysolite_, the topaz.

124. TO GOD IN TIME OF PLUNDERING.

Rapine has yet took nought from me; But if it please my God I be Brought at the last to th' utmost bit, God make me thankful still for it. I have been grateful for my store: Let me say grace when there's no more.

125. TO HIS SAVIOUR. THE NEW-YEAR'S GIFT.

That little pretty bleeding part Of foreskin send to me: And I'll return a bleeding heart For New-Year's gift to Thee.

Rich is the gem that Thou did'st send, Mine's faulty too and small; But yet this gift Thou wilt commend Because I send Thee all.

126. DOOMSDAY.

Let not that day God's friends and servants scare; The bench is then their place, and not the bar.

127. THE POOR'S PORTION.

The sup'rabundance of my store, That is the portion of the poor: Wheat, barley, rye, or oats; what is't But He takes toll of? all the grist. Two raiments have I: Christ then makes This law; that He and I part stakes. Or have I two loaves, then I use The poor to cut, and I to choose.

128. THE WHITE ISLAND: OR, PLACE OF THE BLEST.

In this world, the isle of dreams, While we sit by sorrow's streams, Tears and terrors are our themes Reciting:

But when once from hence we fly, More and more approaching nigh Unto young Eternity Uniting:

In that whiter island, where Things are evermore sincere; Candour here, and lustre there Delighting:

There no monstrous fancies shall Out of hell an horror call, To create, or cause at all, Affrighting.

There in calm and cooling sleep We our eyes shall never steep; But eternal watch shall keep, Attending

Pleasures, such as shall pursue Me immortalised, and you; And fresh joys, as never to Have ending.

129. TO CHRIST.

I crawl, I creep; my Christ, I come To Thee for curing balsamum: Thou hast, nay more, Thou art the tree Affording salve of sovereignty. My mouth I'll lay unto Thy wound Bleeding, that no blood touch the ground: For, rather than one drop shall fall To waste, my JESU, I'll take all.

130. TO GOD.

God! to my little meal and oil Add but a bit of flesh to boil: And Thou my pipkinet shalt see, Give a wave-off'ring unto Thee.

131. FREE WELCOME.

God He refuseth no man, but makes way For all that now come or hereafter may.

132. GOD'S GRACE.

God's grace deserves here to be daily fed That, thus increased, it might be perfected.

133. COMING TO CHRIST.

To him who longs unto his Christ to go, Celerity even itself is slow.

134. CORRECTION.

God had but one Son free from sin; but none Of all His sons free from correction.

135. GOD'S BOUNTY.

God, as He's potent, so He's likewise known To give us more than hope can fix upon.

136. KNOWLEDGE.

Science in God is known to be A substance, not a quality.

137. SALUTATION.

Christ, I have read, did to His chaplains say, Sending them forth, Salute no man by th' way: Not that He taught His ministers to be Unsmooth or sour to all civility, But to instruct them to avoid all snares Of tardidation in the Lord's affairs. Manners are good; but till His errand ends, Salute we must nor strangers, kin, or friends.

Tardidation, sloth.

138. LASCIVIOUSNESS.

Lasciviousness is known to be The sister to saturity.

139. TEARS.

God from our eyes all tears hereafter wipes, And gives His children kisses then, not stripes.

140. GOD'S BLESSING.

In vain our labours are whatsoe'er they be, Unless God gives the benedicite.

141. GOD, AND LORD.

God is His name of nature; but that word Implies His power when He's called the Lord.

142. THE JUDGMENT-DAY.

God hides from man the reck'ning day, that he May fear it ever for uncertainty; That being ignorant of that one, he may Expect the coming of it every day.

143. ANGELS.

Angels are called gods; yet of them, none Are gods but by participation: As just men are entitled gods, yet none Are gods of them but by adoption.

144. LONG LIFE.

The longer thread of life we spin, The more occasion still to sin.

145. TEARS.

The tears of saints more sweet by far Than all the songs of sinners are.

146. MANNA.

That manna, which God on His people cast, Fitted itself to ev'ry feeder's taste.

147. REVERENCE.

True rev'rence is, as Cassiodore doth prove, The fear of God commix'd with cleanly love.

Cassiodore, Marcus Aurelius Cassiodorus, theologian and statesman 497-575?

148. MERCY.

Mercy, the wise Athenians held to be Not an affection, but a deity.

149. WAGES.

After this life, the wages shall Not shared alike be unto all.

150. TEMPTATION.

God tempteth no one, as St. Austin saith, For any ill, but for the proof of faith; Unto temptation God exposeth some, But none of purpose to be overcome.

151. GOD'S HANDS.

God's hands are round and smooth, that gifts may fall Freely from them and hold none back at all.

152. LABOUR.

Labour we must, and labour hard I' th' forum here, or vineyard.

153. MORA SPONSI, THE STAY OF THE BRIDEGROOM.

The time the bridegroom stays from hence Is but the time of penitence.

154. ROARING.

Roaring is nothing but a weeping part Forced from the mighty dolour of the heart.

155. THE EUCHARIST.

He that is hurt seeks help: sin is the wound; The salve for this i' th' Eucharist is found.

156. SIN SEVERELY PUNISHED.

God in His own day will be then severe To punish great sins, who small faults whipt here.

157. MONTES SCRIPTURARUM: THE MOUNTS OF THE SCRIPTURES.

The mountains of the Scriptures are, some say, Moses, and Jesus, called Joshua: The prophets, mountains of the Old are meant, Th' apostles, mounts of the New Testament.

158. PRAYER.

A prayer that is said alone Starves, having no companion. Great things ask for when thou dost pray, And those great are which ne'er decay. Pray not for silver, rust eats this; Ask not for gold, which metal is; Nor yet for houses, which are here But earth: _such vows ne'er reach God's ear_.

159. CHRIST'S SADNESS.

Christ was not sad, i' th' garden, for His own Passion, but for His sheep's dispersion.

160. GOD HEARS US.

God, who's in heaven, will hear from thence; If not to th' sound, yet to the sense.

161. GOD.

God, as the learned Damascene doth write, A sea of substance is, indefinite.

The learned Damascene, _i.e._, St. John of Damascus.

162. CLOUDS.

He that ascended in a cloud, shall come In clouds descending to the public doom.

163. COMFORTS IN CONTENTIONS.

The same who crowns the conqueror, will be A coadjutor in the agony.

164. HEAVEN.

Heaven is most fair; but fairer He That made that fairest canopy.

165. GOD.

In God there's nothing, but 'tis known to be Even God Himself, in perfect entity.

166. HIS POWER.

God can do all things, save but what are known For to imply a contradiction.

167. CHRIST'S WORDS ON THE CROSS: MY GOD, MY GOD.

Christ, when He hung the dreadful cross upon, Had, as it were, a dereliction In this regard, in those great terrors He Had no one beam from God's sweet majesty.

Dereliction, abandonment.

168. JEHOVAH.

Jehovah, as Boëtius saith, No number of the plural hath.

169. CONFUSION OF FACE.

God then confounds man's face when He not bears The vows of those who are petitioners.

170. ANOTHER.

The shame of man's face is no more Than prayers repell'd, says Cassiodore.

171. BEGGARS.

Jacob God's beggar was; and so we wait, Though ne'er so rich, all beggars at His gate.

172. GOOD AND BAD.

The bad among the good are here mix'd ever; The good without the bad are here plac'd never.

173. SIN.

Sin no existence; nature none it hath, Or good at all, as learned Aquinas saith.

174. MARTHA, MARTHA.

The repetition of the name made known No other than Christ's full affection.

175. YOUTH AND AGE.

God on our youth bestows but little ease; But on our age most sweet indulgences.

176. GOD'S POWER.

God is so potent, as His power can Draw out of bad a sovereign good to man.

177. PARADISE.

Paradise is, as from the learn'd I gather, _A choir of bless'd souls circling in the Father_.

178. OBSERVATION.

The Jews, when they built houses, I have read, One part thereof left still unfinished, To make them thereby mindful of their own City's most sad and dire destruction.

179. THE ASS.

God did forbid the Israelites to bring An ass unto Him for an offering, Only, by this dull creature, to express His detestation to all slothfulness.

180. OBSERVATION.

The Virgin Mother stood at distance, there, From her Son's cross, not shedding once a tear, Because the law forbad to sit and cry For those who did as malefactors die. So she, to keep her mighty woes in awe, Tortured her love not to transgress the law. Observe we may, how Mary Joses then, And th' other Mary, Mary Magdalen, Sat by the grave; and sadly sitting there, Shed for their Master many a bitter tear; But 'twas not till their dearest Lord was dead And then to weep they both were licensed.

181. TAPERS.

Those tapers which we set upon the grave In fun'ral pomp, but this importance have: That souls departed are not put out quite; But as they walked here in their vestures white, So live in heaven in everlasting light.

182. CHRIST'S BIRTH.

One birth our Saviour had; the like none yet Was, or will be a second like to it.

183. THE VIRGIN MARY.

To work a wonder, God would have her shown At once a bud and yet a rose full-blown.

184. ANOTHER.

As sunbeams pierce the glass, and streaming in, No crack or schism leave i' th' subtle skin: So the Divine Hand worked and brake no thread, But, in a mother, kept a maidenhead.

185. GOD.

God, in the holy tongue, they call The place that filleth all in all.

186. ANOTHER OF GOD.

God's said to leave this place, and for to come Nearer to that place than to other some, Of local motion, in no least respect, But only by impression of effect.

187. ANOTHER.

God is Jehovah call'd: which name of His Implies or Essence, or the He that Is.

188. GOD'S PRESENCE.

God's evident, and may be said to be Present with just men, to the verity; But with the wicked if He doth comply, 'Tis, as St. Bernard saith, but seemingly.

189. GOD'S DWELLING.

God's said to dwell there, wheresoever He Puts down some prints of His high Majesty; As when to man He comes, and there doth place His Holy Spirit, or doth plant His Grace.

190. THE VIRGIN MARY.

The Virgin Mary was, as I have read, The House of God, by Christ inhabited; Into the which He entered, but, the door Once shut, was never to be open'd more.

191. TO GOD.

God's undivided, One in Persons Three, And Three in inconfused unity. Original of Essence there is none, 'Twixt God the Father, Holy Ghost, and Son: And though the Father be the first of Three, 'Tis but by order, not by entity.

192. UPON WOMAN AND MARY.

So long, it seem'd, as Mary's faith was small, Christ did her woman, not her Mary call; But no more woman, being strong in faith, But Mary call'd then, as St. Ambrose saith.

193. NORTH AND SOUTH.

The Jews their beds and offices of ease, Placed north and south for these clean purposes; That man's uncomely froth might not molest God's ways and walks, which lie still east and west.

194. SABBATHS.

Sabbaths are threefold, as St. Austin says: The first of time, or Sabbath here of days; The second is a conscience trespass-free; The last the Sabbath of Eternity.

195. THE FAST, OR LENT.

Noah the first was, as tradition says, That did ordain the fast of forty days.

196. SIN.

There is no evil that we do commit, But hath th' extraction of some good from it: As when we sin, God, the great Chemist, thence Draws out th' elixir of true penitence.

197. GOD.

God is more here than in another place, Not by His essence, but commerce of grace.

198. THIS, AND THE NEXT WORLD.

God hath this world for many made, 'tis true: But He hath made the World to Come for few.

199. EASE.

God gives to none so absolute an ease As not to know or feel some grievances.

200. BEGINNINGS AND ENDINGS.

Paul, he began ill, but he ended well; Judas began well, but he foully fell: In godliness not the beginnings so Much as the ends are to be look'd unto.

201. TEMPORAL GOODS.

These temporal goods God, the most wise, commends To th' good and bad in common for two ends: First, that these goods none here may o'er-esteem Because the

wicked do partake of them; Next, that these ills none cowardly may shun, Being, oft here, the just man's portion.

202. HELL FIRE.

The fire of hell this strange condition hath, To burn, not shine, as learned Basil saith.

203. ABEL'S BLOOD.

Speak, did the blood of Abel cry To God for vengeance? Yes, say I, Ev'n as the sprinkled blood called on God for an expiation.

204. ANOTHER.

The blood of Abel was a thing Of such a rev'rend reckoning, As that the old world thought it fit Especially to swear by it.

205. A POSITION IN THE HEBREW DIVINITY.

One man repentant is of more esteem With God, than one that never sinned 'gainst Him.

206. PENITENCE.

The doctors, in the Talmud, say, That in this world one only day In true repentance spent will be More worth than heaven's eternity.

207. GOD'S PRESENCE.

God's present everywhere, but most of all Present by union hypostatical: God, He is there, where's nothing else, schools say, And nothing else is there where He's away.

Hypostatical, personal.

208. THE RESURRECTION POSSIBLE AND PROBABLE.

For each one body that i' th' earth is sown, There's an uprising but of one for one; But for each grain that in the ground is thrown, Threescore or fourscore spring up thence for one: So that the wonder is not half so great Of ours as is the rising of the wheat.

209. CHRIST'S SUFFERING.

Justly our dearest Saviour may abhor us, Who hath more suffered by us far, than for us.

210. SINNERS.

Sinners confounded are a twofold way, Either as when, the learned schoolmen say, Men's sins destroyed are when they repent, Or when, for sins, men suffer punishment.

211. TEMPTATIONS.

No man is tempted so but may o'ercome, If that he has a will to masterdom.

212. PITY AND PUNISHMENT.

God doth embrace the good with love; and gains The good by mercy, as the bad by pains.

213. GOD'S PRICE AND MAN'S PRICE.

God bought man here with His heart's blood expense; And man sold God here for base thirty pence.

214. CHRIST'S ACTION.

Christ never did so great a work but there His human nature did in part appear; Or ne'er so mean a piece but men might see Therein some beams of His Divinity: So that in all He did there did combine His human nature and His part divine.

215. PREDESTINATION.

Predestination is the cause alone Of many standing, but of fall to none.

216. ANOTHER.

Art thou not destin'd? then with haste go on To make thy fair predestination: If thou can'st change thy life, God then will please To change, or call back, His past sentences.

217. SIN.

Sin never slew a soul unless there went Along with it some tempting blandishment.

218. ANOTHER.

Sin is an act so free, that if we shall Say 'tis not free, 'tis then no sin at all.

219. ANOTHER.

Sin is the cause of death; and sin's alone The cause of God's predestination: And from God's prescience of man's sin doth flow Our destination to eternal woe.

220. PRESCIENCE.

God's prescience makes none sinful; but th' offence Of man's the chief cause of God's prescience.

221. CHRIST.

To all our wounds here, whatsoe'er they be, Christ is the one sufficient remedy.

222. CHRIST'S INCARNATION.

Christ took our nature on Him, not that He 'Bove all things loved it for the purity: No, but He dress'd Him with our human trim, Because our flesh stood most in need of Him.

223. HEAVEN.

Heaven is not given for our good works here; Yet it is given to the labourer.

224. GOD'S KEYS

God has four keys, which He reserves alone: The first of rain; the key of hell next known; With the third key He opes and shuts the womb; And with the fourth key he unlocks the tomb.

225. SIN.

There's no constraint to do amiss, Whereas but one enforcement is.

226. ALMS.

Give unto all, lest he, whom thou deni'st, May chance to be no other man but Christ.

227. HELL FIRE.

One only fire has hell; but yet it shall Not after one sort there excruciate all: But look, how each transgressor onward went Boldly in sin, shall feel more punishment.

228. TO KEEP A TRUE LENT.

Is this a fast, to keep The larder lean? And clean From fat of veals and sheep?

Is it to quit the dish Of flesh, yet still To fill The platter high with fish?

Is it to fast an hour, Or ragg'd to go, Or show A downcast look and sour?

No; 'tis a fast to dole Thy sheaf of wheat, And meat, Unto the hungry soul.

It is to fast from strife, From old debate And hate; To circumcise thy life.

To show a heart grief-rent; To starve thy sin, Not bin; And that's to keep thy Lent.

229. NO TIME IN ETERNITY.

By hours we all live here; in Heaven is known No spring of time, or time's succession.

230. HIS MEDITATION UPON DEATH.

Be those few hours, which I have yet to spend, Blest with the meditation of my end: Though they be few in number, I'm content: If otherwise, I stand indifferent. Nor makes it matter Nestor's years to tell, If man lives long and if he live not well. A multitude of days still heaped on, Seldom brings order, but confusion. Might I make choice, long life should be withstood; Nor would I care how short it were, if good: Which to effect, let ev'ry passing-bell Possess my thoughts, "Next comes my doleful knell": And when the night persuades me to my bed, I'll think I'm going to be buried. So shall the blankets which come over me Present those turfs which once must cover me: And with as firm behaviour I will meet The sheet I sleep in as my winding-sheet. When sleep shall bathe his body in mine eyes, I will believe that then my body dies: And if I chance to wake and rise thereon, I'll have in mind my resurrection, Which must produce me to that General Doom, To which the peasant, so the prince, must come, To hear the Judge give sentence on the throne, Without the least hope of affection. Tears, at that day, shall make but weak defence, When hell and horror

fright the conscience. Let me, though late, yet at the last, begin To shun the least temptation to a sin; Though to be tempted be no sin, until Man to th' alluring object gives his will. Such let my life assure me, when my breath Goes thieving from me, I am safe in death; Which is the height of comfort: when I fall, I rise triumphant in my funeral.

Affection, partiality.

231. CLOTHES FOR CONTINUANCE.

Those garments lasting evermore, Are works of mercy to the poor, Which neither tettar, time, or moth Shall fray that silk or fret this cloth.

Tettar, scab.

232. TO GOD.

Come to me, God; but do not come To me as to the General Doom In power; or come Thou in that state When Thou Thy laws did'st promulgate, Whenas the mountain quaked for dread, And sullen clouds bound up his head. No; lay Thy stately terrors by To talk with me familiarly; For if Thy thunder-claps I hear, I shall less swoon than die for fear. Speak Thou of love and I'll reply By way of Epithalamy, Or sing of mercy and I'll suit To it my viol and my lute; Thus let Thy lips but love distil, Then come, my God, and hap what will.

Mountain, orig. ed. _mountains_.

233. THE SOUL.

When once the soul has lost her way, O then how restless does she stray! And having not her God for light, How does she err in endless night!

234. THE JUDGMENT-DAY.

In doing justice God shall then be known, Who showing mercy here, few prized, or none.

235. SUFFERINGS.

We merit all we suffer, and by far More stripes than God lays on the sufferer.

236. PAIN AND PLEASURE.

God suffers not His saints and servants dear To have continual pain or pleasure here; But look how night succeeds the day, so He Gives them by turns their grief and jollity.

237. GOD'S PRESENCE.

God is all-present to whate'er we do, And as all-present, so all-filling too.

238. ANOTHER.

That there's a God we all do know, But what God is we cannot show.

239. THE POOR MAN'S PART.

Tell me, rich man, for what intent Thou load'st with gold thy vestiment? Whenas the poor cry out: To us Belongs all gold superfluous.

240. THE RIGHT HAND.

God has a right hand, but is quite bereft Of that which we do nominate the left.

241. THE STAFF AND ROD.

Two instruments belong unto our God: The one a staff is and the next a rod; That if the twig should chance too much to smart, The staff might come to play the friendly part.

242. GOD SPARING IN SCOURGING.

God still rewards us more than our desert; But when He strikes, He quarter-acts His part.

243. CONFESSION.

Confession twofold is, as Austin says, The first of sin is, and the next of praise. If ill it goes with thee, thy faults confess: If well, then chant God's praise with cheerfulness.

244. GOD'S DESCENT.

God is then said for to descend, when He Doth here on earth some thing of novity; As when in human nature He works more Than ever yet the like was done before.

245. NO COMING TO GOD WITHOUT CHRIST.

Good and great God! how should I fear To come to Thee if Christ not there! Could I but think He would not be Present to plead my cause for me, To hell I'd rather run than I Would see Thy face and He not by.

246. ANOTHER TO GOD.

Though Thou be'st all that active love Which heats those ravished souls above; And though all joys spring from the glance Of Thy most winning countenance; Yet sour and grim Thou'dst seem to me If through my Christ I saw not Thee.

247. THE RESURRECTION.

That Christ did die, the pagan saith; But that He rose, that's Christians' faith.

248. CO-HEIRS.

We are co-heirs with Christ; nor shall His own Heirship be less by our adoption. The number here of heirs shall from the state Of His great birthright nothing derogate.

249. THE NUMBER OF TWO.

God hates the dual number, being known The luckless number of division; And when He bless'd each sev'ral day whereon He did His curious operation, 'Tis never read there, as the fathers say, God bless'd His work done on the second day; Wherefore two prayers ought not to be said, Or by ourselves, or from the pulpit read.

250. HARDENING OF HEARTS.

God's said our hearts to harden then, Whenas His grace not supples men.

251. THE ROSE.

Before man's fall the rose was born, St. Ambrose says, without the thorn; But for man's fault then was the thorn Without the fragrant rose-bud born; But ne'er the rose without the thorn.

252. GOD'S TIME MUST END OUR TROUBLE.

God doth not promise here to man that He Will free him quickly from his misery; But in His own time, and when He thinks fit, Then He will give a happy end to it.

253. BAPTISM.

The strength of baptism that's within, It saves the soul by drowning sin.

254. GOLD AND FRANKINCENSE.

Gold serves for tribute to the king, The frankincense for God's off'ring.

255. TO GOD.

God, who me gives a will for to repent, Will add a power to keep me innocent; That I shall ne'er that trespass recommit When I have done true penance here for it.

256. THE CHEWING THE CUD.

When well we speak and nothing do that's good, We not divide the hoof, but chew the cud; But when good words by good works have their proof, We then both chew the cud and cleave the hoof.

257. CHRIST'S TWOFOLD COMING.

Thy former coming was to cure My soul's most desp'rate calenture; Thy second advent, that must be To heal my earth's infirmity.

Calenture, delirium caused by excessive heat.

258. TO GOD, HIS GIFT.

As my little pot doth boil, We will keep this level-coil, That a wave and I will bring To my God a heave-offering.

Level-coil, the old Christmas game of changing chairs; to "keep level-coil" means to change about.

259. GOD'S ANGER.

God can't be wrathful: but we may conclude Wrathful He may be by similitude: God's wrathful said to be, when He doth do That without wrath which wrath doth force us to.

260. GOD'S COMMANDS.

In God's commands ne'er ask the reason why; Let thy obedience be the best reply.

261. TO GOD.

If I have played the truant, or have here Failed in my part, oh! Thou that art my dear, My mild, my loving tutor, Lord and God! Correct my errors gently with Thy rod. I know that faults will many here be found, But where sin swells there let Thy grace abound.

262. TO GOD.

The work is done; now let my laurel be Given by none but by Thyself to me: That done, with honour Thou dost me create Thy poet, and Thy prophet Laureate.

263. GOOD FRIDAY: REX TRAGICUS; OR, CHRIST GOING TO HIS CROSS.

Put off Thy robe of purple, then go on To the sad place of execution: Thine hour is come, and the tormentor stands Ready to pierce Thy tender feet and hands. Long before this, the base, the dull, the rude, Th' inconstant and unpurged multitude Yawn for Thy coming; some ere this time cry, How He defers, how loath He is to die! Amongst this scum, the soldier with his spear And that sour fellow with his vinegar, His sponge, and stick, do ask why Thou dost stay; So do the scurf and bran too. Go Thy way, Thy way, Thou guiltless man, and satisfy By Thine approach each their beholding eye. Not as a thief shalt Thou ascend the mount, But like a person of some high account; The Cross shall be Thy stage, and Thou shalt there The spacious field have for Thy theatre. Thou art that Roscius and that marked-out man That must this day act the tragedian To wonder and affrightment: Thou art He Whom all the flux of nations comes to see, Not those poor thieves that act their parts with Thee; Those act without regard, when once a king And God, as Thou art, comes to suffering. No, no; this scene from Thee takes life, and sense, And soul, and spirit, plot and excellence. Why then, begin, great King! ascend Thy throne, And thence proceed to act Thy Passion To such an height, to such a period raised, As hell, and earth, and heav'n may stand amazed. God and good angels guide Thee; and so bless Thee in Thy several parts of bitterness, That those who see Thee nail'd unto the tree May, though they scorn Thee, praise and pity Thee. And we, Thy lovers, while we see Thee keep The laws of action, will both sigh and weep, And bring our spices to embalm Thee dead; That done, we'll see Thee sweetly buried.

Scurf and bran, the rabble.

264. HIS WORDS TO CHRIST GOING TO THE CROSS.

When Thou wast taken, Lord, I oft have read, All Thy disciples Thee forsook and fled. Let their example not a pattern be For me to fly, but now to follow Thee.

265. ANOTHER TO HIS SAVIOUR.

If Thou be'st taken, God forbid I fly from Thee, as others did: But if Thou wilt so honour me As to accept my company, I'll follow Thee, hap hap what shall, Both to the judge and judgment hall: And, if I see Thee posted there, To be all-flayed with whipping-cheer, I'll take my share; or else, my God, Thy stripes I'll kiss, or burn the rod.

266. HIS SAVIOUR'S WORDS GOING TO THE CROSS.

Have, have ye no regard, all ye Who pass this way, to pity Me, Who am a man of misery!

A man both bruis'd, and broke, and one Who suffers not here for Mine own, But for My friends' transgression!

Ah! Sion's daughters, do not fear The cross, the cords, the nails, the spear, The myrrh, the gall, the vinegar;

For Christ, your loving Saviour, hath Drunk up the wine of God's fierce wrath; Only there's left a little froth,

Less for to taste than for to show What bitter cups had been your due, Had He not drank them up for you.

267. HIS ANTHEM TO CHRIST ON THE CROSS.

When I behold Thee, almost slain, With one and all parts full of pain: When I Thy gentle heart do see Pierced through and dropping blood for me, I'll call, and cry out, thanks to Thee.

Vers. But yet it wounds my soul to think That for my sin Thou, Thou must drink, Even Thou alone, the bitter cup Of fury and of vengeance up.

Chor. Lord, I'll not see Thee to drink all The vinegar, the myrrh, the gall:

Vers. Chor. But I will sip a little wine; Which done, Lord, say: The rest is Mine.

268.

This crosstree here Doth Jesus bear, Who sweet'ned first The death accurs'd. Here all things ready are, make haste, make haste away; For long this work will be, and very short this day. Why then, go on to act: here's wonders to be done Before the last least sand of Thy ninth hour be run; Or ere dark clouds do dull or dead the mid-day's sun. Act when Thou wilt, Blood will be spilt; Pure balm, that shall Bring health to all. Why then, begin To pour first in Some drops of wine, Instead of brine, To search the wound So long unsound: And, when that's done, Let oil next run To cure the sore Sin made before. And O! dear Christ, E'en as Thou di'st, Look down, and see Us weep for Thee. And tho', love knows, Thy dreadful woes We cannot ease, Yet do Thou please, Who mercy art, T' accept each heart That gladly would Help if it could. Meanwhile let me, Beneath this tree, This honour have, To make my grave.

269. TO HIS SAVIOUR'S SEPULCHRE: HIS DEVOTION.

Hail, holy and all-honour'd tomb, By no ill haunted; here I come, With shoes put off, to tread thy room. I'll not profane by soil of sin Thy door as I do enter in; For I have washed both hand and heart, This, that, and every other part, So that I dare, with far less fear Than full affection, enter here. Thus, thus I come to kiss Thy stone With a warm lip and solemn one: And as I kiss I'll here and there Dress Thee with flow'ry diaper. How sweet this place is! as from hence Flowed all Panchaia's frankincense; Or rich Arabia did commix, Here, all her rare aromatics. Let me live ever here, and stir No one step from this sepulchre. Ravish'd I am! and down I lie Confused in this

brave ecstasy. Here let me rest; and let me have This for my heaven that was Thy grave: And, coveting no higher sphere, I'll my eternity spend here.

Panchaia, a fabulous spice island in the Erythrean Sea.

270. HIS OFFERING, WITH THE REST, AT THE SEPULCHRE.

To join with them who here confer Gifts to my Saviour's sepulchre, Devotion bids me hither bring Somewhat for my thank-offering. Lo! thus I bring a virgin flower, To dress my Maiden Saviour.

271. HIS COMING TO THE SEPULCHRE.

Hence they have borne my Lord; behold! the stone Is rolled away and my sweet Saviour's gone. Tell me, white angel, what is now become Of Him we lately sealed up in this tomb? Is He, from hence, gone to the shades beneath, To vanquish hell as here He conquered death? If so, I'll thither follow without fear, And live in hell if that my Christ stays there.

Of all the good things whatsoe'er we do, God is the ΑΡΧΗ, and the ΤΕΛΟΣ too.

POEMS

NOT INCLUDED IN _HESPERIDES_.

THE DESCRIPTION OF A WOMAN.

Whose head, befringed with bescattered tresses, Shows like Apollo's when the morn he dresses,[B] Or like Aurora when with pearl she sets Her long, dishevell'd, rose-crown'd trammelets: Her forehead smooth, full, polish'd, bright and high Bears in itself a graceful majesty, Under the which two crawling eyebrows twine Like to the tendrils of a flatt'ring vine, Under whose shade two starry sparkling eyes Are beautifi'd with fair fring'd canopies. Her comely nose, with uniformal grace, Like purest white, stands in the middle place, Parting the pair, as we may well suppose. Each cheek resembling still a damask rose, Which like a garden manifestly show How roses, lilies, and carnations grow, Which sweetly mixed both with white and red, Like rose leaves, white and red, seem[C] mingled. Then nature for a sweet allurement sets Two smelling, swelling, bashful cherrylets, The which with ruby redness being tipp'd, Do speak a virgin, merry, cherry-lipp'd. Over the which a neat, sweet skin is drawn, Which makes them show like roses under lawn: These be the ruby portals, and divine, Which ope themselves to show a holy shrine Whose breath is rich perfume, that to the sense Smells like the burn'd Sabean frankincense: In which the tongue, though but a member small, Stands guarded with a rosy-hilly wall; And her white teeth, which in the gums are set Like pearl and gold, make one rich cabinet. Next doth her chin with dimpled beauty strive For his white, plump, and smooth prerogative; At whose fair top, to please the sight, there grows The fairest[D] image of a blushing rose, Mov'd by the chin, whose motion causeth this, That both her lips do part, do meet, do kiss; Her ears, which like two labyrinths are plac'd On either side, with rich rare jewels grac'd, Moving a question whether that by them The gem is grac'd, or they grac'd by the gem. But the foundation of the architect Is the swan-staining, fair, rare, stately neck

Which with ambitious humbleness stands under, Bearing aloft this rich, round world of wonder. Her breast, a place for beauty's throne most fit, Bears up two globes where love and pleasure sit, Which, headed with two rich, round rubies, show Like wanton rosebuds growing out of snow; And in the milky valley that's between Sits Cupid, kissing of his mother queen, Fingering the paps that feel like sieved silk, And press'd a little they will weep pure milk. Then comes the belly, seated next below, Like a fair mountain in Riphean snow, Where Nature, in a whiteness without spot, Hath in the middle tied a Gordian knot. Now love invites me to survey her thighs, Swelling in likeness like two crystal skies, Which to the knees by Nature fastened on, Derive their ever well 'greed motion. Her legs with two clear calves, like silver tri'd, Kindly swell up with little pretty pride, Leaving a distance for the comely[E] small To beautify the leg and foot withal. Then lowly, yet most lovely stand the feet, Round, short and clear, like pounded spices sweet, And whatsoever thing they tread upon They make it scent like bruised cinnamon. The lovely shoulders now allure the eye To see two tablets of pure ivory From which two arms like branches seem to spread With tender rind[F] and silver coloured, With little hands and fingers long and small To grace a lute, a viol, virginal. In length each finger doth his next excel, Each richly headed with a pearly shell. Thus every part in contrariety Meet in the whole and make a harmony, As divers strings do singly disagree, But form'd by number make sweet melody.

[B] MS. blesses.

[C] MS. lye.

[D] MS. blessed.

[E] MS. beauteous.

[F] W.R. vein'd.

MR. HERRICK: HIS DAUGHTER'S DOWRY.

Ere I go hence and be no more Seen to the world, I'll give the score I owe unto a female child, And that is this, a verse enstyled My daughter's dowry; having which, I'll leave thee then completely rich. Instead of gold, pearl, rubies, bonds Long forfeit, pawned diamonds Or antique pledges, house or land, I give thee this that shall withstand The blow of ruin and of chance. These hurt not thine inheritance, For 'tis fee simple and no rent Thou fortune ow'st for tenement. However after times will praise, This portion, my prophetic bays, Cannot deliver up to th' rust, Yet I keep peaceful in my dust. As for thy birth and better seeds (Those which must grow to virtuous deeds), Thou didst derive from that old stem (Love and mercy cherish them), Which like a vestal virgin ply With holy fire lest that it die. Grow up with milder laws to know At what time to say aye or no; Let manners teach thee where to be More comely flowing, where less free. These bring thy husband, like to those Old coins and medals we expose To th' show, but never part with. Next, As in a more conspicuous text, Thy forehead, let therein be sign'd The maiden candour of thy mind; And under it two chaste-born spies To bar out bold adulteries, For through these optics fly the darts Of lust which set on fire our hearts. On either side of these quick ears There must be plac'd, for seasoned fears Which sweeten love, yet ne'er come nigh The

plague of wilder jealousy. Then let each cheek of thine entice His soul as to a bed of spice Where he may roll and lose his sense, As in a bed of frankincense. A lip enkindled with that coal With which love chafes and warms the soul, Bring to him next, and in it show Love's cherries from such fires grow And have their harvest, which must stand The gathering of the lip, not hand; Then unto these be it thy care To clothe thy words in gentle air, That smooth as oil, sweet, soft and clean As is the childish bloom of bean, They may fall down and stroke, as the Beams of the sun the peaceful sea. With hands as smooth as mercy's bring Him for his better cherishing, That when thou dost his neck ensnare, Or with thy wrist, or flattering hair, He may, a prisoner, there descry Bondage more loved than liberty. A nature so well formed, so wrought To calm and tempest, let be brought With thee, that should he but incline To roughness, clasp him like a vine, Or like as wool meets steel, give way Unto the passion, not to stay; Wrath, if resisted, over-boils, If not, it dies or else recoils. And lastly, see you bring to him Somewhat peculiar to each limb; And I charge thee to be known By n'other face but by thine own. Let it in love's name be kept sleek, Yet to be found when he shall seek It, and not instead of saint Give up his worth unto the paint; For, trust me, girl, she over-does Who by a double proxy woos. But lest I should forget his bed, Be sure thou bring a maidenhead. That is a margarite, which lost, Thou bring'st unto his bed a frost Or a cold poison, which his blood Benumbs like the forgetful flood. Now for some jewels to supply The want of earrings' bravery For public eyes; take only these Ne'er travelled for beyond the seas; They're nobly home-bred, yet have price Beyond the far-fet merchandise: Obedience, wise distrust, peace, shy Distance and sweet urbanity; Safe modesty, lov'd patience, fear Of offending, temperance, dear Constancy, bashfulness and all The virtues less or cardinal, Take with my blessing, and go forth Enjewelled with thy native worth. And now if there a man be found That looks for such prepared ground, Let him, but with indifferent skill, So good a soil bestock and till; He may ere long have such a wife Nourish in's breast a tree of life.

MR. ROBERT HERRICK: HIS FAREWELL UNTO POETRY.

I have beheld two lovers in a night Hatched o'er with moonshine from their stolen delight (When this to that, and that to this, had given A kiss to such a jewel of the heaven, Or while that each from other's breath did drink Health to the rose, the violet, or pink), Call'd on the sudden by the jealous mother, Some stricter mistress or suspicious other, Urging divorcement (worse than death to these) By the soon jingling of some sleepy keys, Part with a hasty kiss; and in that show How stay they would, yet forced they are to go. Even such are we, and in our parting do No otherwise than as those former two Natures like ours, we who have spent our time Both from the morning to the evening chime. Nay, till the bellman of the night had tolled Past noon of night, yet wear the hours not old Nor dulled with iron sleep, but have outworn The fresh and fairest nourish of the morn With flame and rapture; drinking to the odd Number of nine which makes us full with God, And in that mystic frenzy we have hurled, As with a tempest, nature through the world, And in a whirlwind twirl'd her home, aghast At that which in her ecstasy had past; Thus crowned with rosebuds, sack, thou mad'st me fly Like fire-drakes, yet didst me no harm thereby. O thou almighty nature, who didst give True heat wherewith humanity

doth live Beyond its stinted circle, giving food, White fame and resurrection to the good; Shoring them up 'bove ruin till the doom, The general April of the world doth come That makes all equal. Many thousands should, Were't not for thee, have crumbled into mould, And with their serecloths rotted, not to show Whether the world such spirits had or no, Whereas by thee those and a million since, Nor fate, nor envy, can their fames convince. Homer, Musæus, Ovid, Maro, more Of those godful prophets long before Held their eternal fires, and ours of late (Thy mercy helping) shall resist strong fate, Nor stoop to the centre, but survive as long As fame or rumour hath or trump or tongue; But unto me be only hoarse, since now (Heaven and my soul bear record of my vow) I my desires screw from thee, and direct Them and my thoughts to that sublim'd respect And conscience unto priesthood; 'tis not need (The scarecrow unto mankind) that doth breed Wiser conclusions in me, since I know I've more to bear my charge than way to go, Or had I not, I'd stop the spreading itch Of craving more, so in conceit be rich; But 'tis the God of Nature who intends And shapes my function for more glorious ends. Kiss, so depart, yet stay a while to see The lines of sorrow that lie drawn in me In speech, in picture; no otherwise than when, Judgment and death denounced 'gainst guilty men, Each takes a weeping farewell, racked in mind With joys before and pleasures left behind; Shaking the head, whilst each to each doth mourn, With thought they go whence they must ne'er return. So with like looks, as once the ministrel Cast, leading his Eurydice through hell, I strike thy love, and greedily pursue Thee with mine eyes or in or out of view. So looked the Grecian orator when sent From's native country into banishment, Throwing his eyeballs backward to survey The smoke of his beloved Attica; So Tully looked when from the breasts of Rome The sad soul went, not with his love, but doom, Shooting his eyedarts 'gainst it to surprise It, or to draw the city to his eyes. Such is my parting with thee, and to prove There was not varnish only in my love, But substance, lo! receive this pearly tear Frozen with grief and place it in thine ear. Then part in name of peace, and softly on With numerous feet to hoofy Helicon; And when thou art upon that forked hill Amongst the thrice three sacred virgins, fill A full-brimm'd bowl of fury and of rage, And quaff it to the prophets of our age; When drunk with rapture curse the blind and lame, Base ballad-mongers who usurp thy name And foul thy altar; charm some into frogs, Some to be rats, and others to be hogs; Into the loathsom'st shapes thou canst devise To make fools hate them, only by disguise; Thus with a kiss of warmth and love I part Not so, but that some relic in my heart Shall stand for ever, though I do address Chiefly myself to what I must profess. Know yet, rare soul, when my diviner muse Shall want a handmaid (as she oft will use), Be ready, thou for me, to wait upon her, Though as a servant, yet a maid of honour. The crown of duty is our duty: well Doing's the fruit of doing well. Farewell.

Shoring, copies _soaring_.

A CAROL PRESENTED TO DR. WILLIAMS, BISHOP OF LINCOLN AS A NEW-YEAR'S GIFT.

Fly hence, pale care, no more remember Past sorrows with the fled December, But let each pleasant cheek appear Smooth as the childhood of the year, And sing a carol here. 'Twas brave, 'twas brave, could we command the hand Of youth's swift watch to

stand As you have done your day; Then should we not decay. But all we wither, and our light Is spilt in everlasting night, Whenas your sight Shows like the heavens above the moon, Like an eternal noon That sees no setting sun.

Keep up those flames, and though you shroud Awhile your forehead in a cloud, Do it like the sun to write In the air a greater text of light; Welcome to all our vows, And since you pay To us this day So long desir'd, See we have fir'd Our holy spikenard, and there's none But brings his stick of cinnamon, His eager eye or smoother smile, And lays it gently on the pile, Which thus enkindled, we invoke Your name amidst the sacred smoke.

Chorus. Come then, great Lord. And see our altar burn With love of your return, And not a man here but consumes His soul to glad you in perfumes.

SONG. HIS MISTRESS TO HIM AT HIS FAREWELL.

You may vow I'll not forget To pay the debt Which to thy memory stands as due As faith can seal it you; Take then tribute of my tears, So long as I have fears To prompt me I shall ever Languish and look, but thy return see never. Oh then to lessen my despair Print thy lips into the air, So by this Means I may kiss thy kiss Whenas some kind Wind Shall hither waft it, and in lieu My lips shall send a 1000 back to you.

UPON PARTING.

Go hence away, and in thy parting know 'Tis not my voice but Heaven's that bids thee go; Spring hence thy faith, nor think it ill desert I find in thee that makes me thus to part. But voice of fame, and voice of Heaven have thundered We both were lost, if both of us not sundered. Fold now thine arms, and in thy last look rear One sigh of love, and cool it with a tear. Since part we must, let's kiss; that done, retire With as cold frost as erst we met with fire; With such white vows as fate can ne'er dissever, But truth knit fast; and so, farewell for ever.

UPON MASTER FLETCHER'S INCOMPARABLE PLAYS.

Apollo sings, his harp resounds: give room, For now behold the golden pomp is come, Thy pomp of plays which thousands come to see With admiration both of them and thee. O volume! worthy, leaf by leaf and cover, To be with juice of cedar wash'd all over; Here words with lines and lines with scenes consent To raise an act to full astonishment; Here melting numbers, words of power to move Young men to swoon and maids to die for love. _Love lies a-bleeding_ here, _Evadne_, there Swells with brave rage, yet comely everywhere; Here's _A mad lover_, there that high design Of _King and no King_, and the rare plot thine. So that whene'er we circumvolve our eyes, Such rich, such fresh, such sweet varieties Ravish our spirits, that entranc'd we see None writes love's passion in the world like thee.

THE NEW CHARON:

UPON THE DEATH OF HENRY, LORD HASTINGS.

The musical part being set by Mr. Henry Lawes.

THE SPEAKERS,

CHARON AND EUCOSMIA.

Euc. Charon, O Charon, draw thy boat to th' shore, And to thy many take in one soul more. _Cha._ Who calls? who calls? _Euc._ One overwhelm'd with ruth; Have pity either on my tears or youth, And take me in who am in deep distress; But first cast off thy wonted churlishness. _Cha._ I will be gentle as that air which yields A breath of balm along the Elysian fields. Speak, what art thou? _Euc_. One once that had a lover, Than which thyself ne'er wafted sweeter over. He was---- _Cha._ Say what? _Euc._ Ah me, my woes are deep. _Cha._ Prithee relate, while I give ear and weep. _Euc._ He was a Hastings; and that one name has In it all good that is, and ever was. He was my life, my love, my joy, but died Some hours before I should have been his bride. _Chorus._ Thus, thus the gods celestial still decree, For human joy contingent misery. _Euc._ The hallowed tapers all prepared were, And Hymen call'd to bless the rites. _Cha._ Stop there. _Euc._ Great are my woes. _Cha._ And great must that grief be That makes grim Charon thus to pity thee. But now come in. _Euc._ More let me yet relate. _Cha._ I cannot stay; more souls for waftage wait And I must hence. _Euc._ Yet let me thus much know, Departing hence, where good and bad souls go? _Cha._ Those souls which ne'er were drench'd in pleasure's stream, The fields of Pluto are reserv'd for them; Where, dress'd with garlands, there they walk the ground Whose blessed youth with endless flowers is crown'd. But such as have been drown'd in this wild sea, For those is kept the Gulf of Hecate, Where with their own contagion they are fed, And there do punish and are punished. This known, the rest of thy sad story tell When on the flood that nine times circles hell. _Chorus._ We sail along to visit mortals never; But there to live where love shall last for ever.

EPITAPH ON THE TOMB OF SIR EDWARD GILES AND HIS WIFE IN THE SOUTH AISLE OF DEAN PRIOR CHURCH, DEVON.

No trust to metals nor to marbles, when These have their fate and wear away as men; Times, titles, trophies may be lost and spent, But virtue rears the eternal monument. What more than these can tombs or tombstones pay? But here's the sunset of a tedious day: These two asleep are: I'll but be undress'd And so to bed: pray wish us all good rest.

NOTES.

NOTES.

569. _And of any wood ye see, You can make a Mercury._ Pythagoras allegorically said that Mercury's statue could not be made of every sort of wood: cp. Rabelais, iv. 62.

575. _The Apparition of his Mistress calling him to Elysium._ An earlier version of this poem was printed in the 1640 edition of Shakespeare's poems under the title, _His Mistris Shade_, having been licensed for separate publication at Stationers' Hall the previous year. The variants are numerous, and some of them important. l. 1, _of silver_ for _with silv'rie_; l. 3, on the Banks for _in the Meads_; l. 8, _Spikenard through_ for _Storax from_; l. 10 reads: "_Of mellow_ Apples, _ripened_ Plums _and_

Pears": l. 17, the order of "naked younglings, handsome striplings" is reversed; in place of l. 20 we have:--

"So soon as each his dangling locks hath crown'd With Rosie Chaplets, Lilies, Pansies red, Soft Saffron Circles to perfume the head";

l. 23, _to_ for _too unto_; l. 24, _their_ for _our_; ll. 29, 30:--

"Unto the Prince of Shades, whom once his Pen Entituled the Grecian Prince of Men";

l. 31, _thereupon_ for _and that done_; l. 36, _render him true_ for _show him truly_; l. 37, _will_ for _shall_; l. 38, "Where both may _laugh_, both drink, _both_ rage together"; l. 48, _Amphitheatre_ for _spacious theatre_; l. 49, _synod_ for _glories_, followed by:--

"crown'd with sacred Bays And flatt'ring _joy, we'll have to_ recite their plays, _Shakespeare and Beamond_, Swans to whom _the Spheres_ Listen while they _call back the former year[s] To teach the truth of scenes_, and more for thee, There yet remains, _brave soul_, than thou can'st see," etc.;

l. 56, _illustrious for capacious_; l. 57, _shall be_ for _now is_ [Jonson died 1637]; ll. 59-61:--

"To be of that high Hierarchy where none But brave souls take illumination Immediately from heaven; but hark the cock," etc.;

l. 62, _feel_ for _see_; l. 63, _through_ for _from_.

579. _My love will fit each history._ Cp. Ovid, _Amor._ II. iv. 44: Omnibus historiis se meus aptat amor.

580. _The sweets of love are mixed with tears._ Cp. Propert. I. xii. 16: Nonnihil adspersis gaudet Amor lacrimis.

583. _Whom this morn sees most fortunate_, etc. Seneca, _Thyest._ 613: Quem dies vidit veniens superbum Hunc dies vidit fugiens jacentem.

586. _Night hides our thefts_, etc. Ovid, _Ars Am._ i. 249:--

Nocte latent mendæ vitioque ignoscitur omni, Horaque formosam quamlibet illa facit.

590. _To his brother-in-law, Master John Wingfield._ Of Brantham, Suffolk, husband of the poet's sister, Mercy. See 818, and Sketch of Herrick's Life in vol. i.

599. _Upon Lucia._ Cp. "The Resolution" in _Speculum Amantis_, ed. A. H. Bullen.

604. _Old Religion._ Certainly not Roman Catholicism, though Jonson was a Catholic. Herrick uses the noun and its adjective rather curiously of the dead: cp. 82, "To the reverend shade of his religious Father," and 138, "When thou shalt laugh at my religious dust". There may be something of this use here, or we may refer to his ancient cult of Jonson. But the use of the phrase in 870 makes the exact shade of meaning difficult to fix.

605. _Riches to be but burdens to the mind._ Seneca _De Provid._ 6: Democritus divitias projecit, onus illas bonae mentis existimans.

607. _Who covets more is evermore a slave._ Hor. I. _Ep._ x. 41: Serviet aeternum qui parvo nesciet uti.

615. _No Wrath of Men._ Cp. Hor. _Od._ III. iii. 1-8.

616. _To the Maids to walk abroad._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, under the title: _Abroad with the Maids_.

618. _Mistress Elizabeth Lee, now Lady Tracy._ Elizabeth, daughter of Thomas, first Lord Leigh of Stoneleigh, in Warwickshire, married John, third Viscount Tracy. She survived her husband two years, and died in 1688.

624. _Poets._ _Wantons we are_, etc. From Ovid, _Trist._ ii. 353-4:--

Crede mihi, mores distant a carmine nostri: Vita verecunda est, Musa jocosa, mihi.

625. _'Tis cowardice to bite the buried._ Cp. Ben Jonson, _The Poetaster_, I. 1: "Envy the living, not the dead, doth bite"; perhaps from Ovid, _Am._ I. xv. 39: Pascitur in vivis livor; post fata quiescit.

626. _Noble Westmoreland._ See Note to 112.

Gallant Newark. Robert Pierrepoint was created Viscount Newark in 1627 and Earl of Kingston in the following year. But Herrick is perhaps addressing his son, Henry Pierrepoint, afterwards Marquis of Dorchester (see 962 and Note), who during the first Earl of Kingston's life would presumably have borne his second title.

633. _Sweet words must nourish soft and gentle love._ Ovid, _Ars Am._ ii. 152: Dulcibus est verbis mollis alendus amor.

639. _Fates revolve no flax they've spun._ Seneca, _Herc. Fur._ 1812: Duræ peragunt pensa sorores, Nec sua retro fila revolvunt.

642. _Palms ... gems._ A Latinism. Cp. Ovid, _Fasti_, i. 152: Et nova de gravido palmite gemma tumet.

645. _Upon Tears._ Cp. S. Bernard: Pœnitentium lacrimæ vinum angelorum.

649. _Upon Lucy._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, under the title, _On Betty_.

653. _To th' number five or nine._ Probably Herrick is mistaking the references in Greek and Latin poets to the mixing of their wine and water (_e.g._, Hor. _Od._ III. xix. 11-17) for the drinking of so many cups.

654. _Long-looked-for comes at last._ Cp. G. Herbert, preface to Sibbes' Funeral Sermon on Sir Thomas Crew (1638): "That ancient adage, 'Quod differtur non aufertur' for 'Long-looked-for comes at last'".

655. _The morrow's life too late is_, etc. Mart. I. xvi. 12: Sera nimis vita est crastina: vive hodie.

662. _O happy life_, etc. From Virg. _Georg._ ii. 458-9:--

O fortunatos nimium sua si bona norint Agricolas.

It is not uncharacteristic that these fervid praises of country life were left unfinished.

664. _Arthur Bartly._ Not yet identified.

665. _Let her Lucrece all day be._ From Martial XI. civ. 21, 22:--

Lucretia toto Sis licet usque die: Laida nocte volo.

Neither will Famish me, nor overfill. Mart. I. lviii. 4: Nec volo quod cruciat, nec volo quod satiat.

667. _Be't for my Bridal or my Burial._ Cp. Brand, vol. ii., and Coles' _Introduction to the Knowledge of Plants_: "Rosemary and bayes are used by the commons both at funerals and weddings".

672. _Kings ought to be more lov'd than fear'd._ Seneca, _Octavia_, 459: Decet timeri Cæsarem. At plus diligi.

673. _To Mr. Denham, on his prospective poem._ Sir John Denham published in 1642 his _Cooper's Hill_, a poem on the view over the Thames towards London, from a hill near Windsor.

675. _Their fashion is, but to say no_, etc. Cp. Montaigne's _Essais_, II. 3, p. 51; Florio's tr. p. 207: "Let it suffice that in doing it they say no and take it".

676. _Love is maintained by wealth._ Ovid, _Rem. Am._ 746: Divitiis alitur luxuriosus amor.

679. _Nero commanded, but withdrew his eyes._ Tacit. _Agric._ 45: Nero subtraxit oculos, jussitque scelera, non spectavit.

683. _But a just measure both of Heat and Cold._ This is a version of the medieval doctrine of the four humours. So Chaucer says of his Doctor of Physic:--

"He knew the cause of every maladye, Were it of hoot or cold, or moyste, or drye, And where engendered and of what humour".

684. _'Gainst thou go'st a-mothering._ The Epistle for Mid-Lent Sunday was from Galat. iv. 21, etc., and contained the words: "Jerusalem, quæ est Mater nostra". On that Sunday people made offerings at their Mother Church. After the Reformation the natural mother was substituted for the spiritual, and the day was set apart for visiting relations. Excellent simnel cakes (Low Lat., _siminellus_, fine flour) are still made in the North, where the current derivation of the word is from _Sim_ and _Nell_!

685. _To the King._ Probably written in 1645, when Charles was for a short time in the West.

689. _Too much she gives to some, enough to none._ Mart. XII. x.; Fortuna multis dat nimis, satis nulli.

696. _Men mind no state in sickness._ There is a general resemblance in this poem to the latter part of Hor. III. _Od._ i., but I have an uneasy sense that Herrick is

translating.

697. _Adversity._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650.

702. _Mean things overcome mighty._ Cp. 486 and Note.

706. _How roses came red._ Cp. Burton, _Anat. Mel._ III. ii. 3: "Constantine (_Agricult._ xi. 18) makes Cupid himself to be a great dancer: by the same token that he was capering among the gods, he flung down a bowl of nectar, which, distilling upon the white rose, ever since made it red".

709. _Tears and Laughter._ Bishop Jebb quotes a Latin couplet inscribed on an old inn at Four Crosses, Staffordshire:--

Fleres si scires unum tua tempora mensem: Rides, cum non sit forsitan una dies.

710. _Tully says._ Cic. _Tusc. Disp._ III. ii. 3: Gloria est frequens de aliquo, fama cum laude.

713. _His return to London._ Written at the same time as his _Farewell to Dean Bourn_, _i.e._, after his ejection in 1648, the year of the publication of the _Hesperides_.

715. _No pack like poverty._ Burton, _Anat. Mel._ iii. 3: Οὐδὲν πενίας βαρύτερόν ἐστι φόρτιον. "No burden, saith Menander, is so intolerable as poverty."

718. _As many laws_, etc. Tacit. _Ann._ iii. 27: Corruptissima in republica plurimæ leges.

723. _Lay down some silver pence._ Cp. Bishop Corbet's _The Faeryes Farewell_:--

"And though they sweep their hearths no less Than maids were wont to do, Yet who of late for cleanliness Finds sixpence in her shoe?"

725. _Times that are ill ... Clouds will not ever_, etc., two reminiscences of Horace, II. _Od._ x. 17, and ix.

727. _Up tails all._ This tune will be found in Chappell's _Popular Music of the Olden Time_, vol. i. p. 196. He notes that it was a favourite with Herrick, who wrote four other poems in the metre, viz.: _The Hag is Astride_, _The Maypole is up_, _The Peter-penny_, and _Twelfth Night: or, King and Queen_. The tune is found in Queen Elizabeth's Virginal Book, and in the _Dancing Master_ (1650-1690). It is alluded to by Ben Jonson, and was a favourite with the Cavaliers.

730. _Charon and Philomel._ This dialogue is found with some slight variations of text in Rawlinson's MS. poet. 65. fol. 32. The following variants may be noted: l. 5, _voice_ for _sound_; l. 7, _shade_ for _bird_; l. 11, _warbling_ for _watching_; l. 12, _hoist up_ for _thus hoist_; l. 13, _be gone_ for _return_; l. 18, _praise_ for _pray_; l. 19, _sighs_ for _vows_; l. 24, omit _slothful_. The dialogue is succeeded in the MS. by an old catch (probably written before Herrick was born):--

"A boat! a boat! haste to the ferry! For we go over to be merry, To laugh and quaff, and drink old sherry".

After the catch comes the following dialogue, written (it would seem) in imitation of Herrick's _Charon and Philomel_: the speakers' names are not marked:--

"Charon! O Charon! the wafter of all souls to bliss or bane! Who calls the ferryman of Hell? Come near and say who lives in bliss and who in pain. Those that die well eternal bliss shall follow. Those that die ill their own black deeds shall swallow. Shall thy black barge those guilty spirits row That kill themselves for love? Oh, no! oh, no! My cordage cracks when such foul sins draw near, No wind blows fair, nor I my boat can steer. What spirits pass and in Elysium reign? Those harmless souls that love and are beloved again. That soul that lives in love and fain would die to win, Shall he go free? Oh, no! it is too foul a sin. He must not come aboard, I dare not row, Storms of despair my boat will overblow. But when thy mistress (?) shall close up thine eyes then come aboard, Then come aboard and pass; till then be wise and sing."

"Then come aboard" from the penultimate line and "and sing" from the last should clearly be struck out.

739. _O Jupiter_, etc. Eubulus in Athenaeus, xiii. 559: Ὦ Ζεῦ πολυτίμητ', εἶτ' ἐγὼ κακῶς ποτε | ἐρῶ γυναῖκας; νὴ Δί' ἀπολοίμην ἄρα· | πάντων ἄριστον κτημάτων. Comp. 885.

743. _Another upon her Weeping._ Printed in Witts _Recreations_, 1650, under the title: _On Julia's Weeping_.

745. _To Sir John Berkeley, Governour of Exeter._ Youngest son of Sir Maurice Berkeley, of Bruton, in Somersetshire; knighted in Berwick in 1638; commander-in-chief of all the Royalist forces in Devonshire, 1643; captured Exeter Sept. 4 of that year, and held it till April 13, 1646. Created Baron Berkeley of Stratton, in Cornwall, 1658; died 1678.

749. _Consultation._ As noted in the text, this is from Sallust, _Cat._ i.

751. _None sees the fardell of his faults behind._ Cp. Catullus, xxii. 20, 21:--

Suus cuique attributus est error, Sed non videmus manticae quod in tergo est,

or, perhaps more probably from Seneca, _de Irá_, ii. 28: Aliena vitia in oculis habemus; à tergo nostra sunt.

755. _The Eye._ Æschyl. _Fragm._ in Plutarch, _Amat._ 21: Νέας γυναικὸς οὔ με μὴ λάθῃ φλέγων Ὀφθαλμὸς, ἥτις ἀνδρὸς ᾗ γεγευμένη.

756. _To Prince Charles upon his coming to Exeter._ In August, 1645.

761. _The Wake._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, under the title: _Alvar and Anthea_.

763. _To Doctor Alabaster._ William Alabaster, or Alablaster, born at Hadleigh, Suffolk (1567); educated at Westminster and Trinity College, Cambridge; a friend of Spencer; was converted to Roman Catholicism while chaplain to the Earl of Essex in Spain, 1596. In 1607 he began his series of apocalyptic writings by an _Apparatus in Revelationem Jesu Christi_. On visiting Rome he was imprisoned by the Inquisition, escaped, and returned to Protestantism. Besides his theological works, he published

(in 1637) a Lexicon Pentaglotton. Died April, 1640.

766. _Time is the bound of things_, etc. From Seneca, _Consol. ad Marc._ xix.: Excessit filius tuus terminos intra quos servitur ... mors omnium dolorum solutio est et finis.

771. _As I have read must be the first man up_, etc. Hor. I. _Ep._ vi. 48: Hoc primus repetas opus, hoc postremus omittas.

Rich compost. Cp. the same thought in 662.

772. _A Hymn to Bacchus._ Printed, with the misprint _Bacchus for Iacchus_ in l. 1, in _Witts Recreations_, 1650.

Brutus ... Cato. Cp. Note to 4 and 8.

774. _If wars go well_, etc. Tacitus, _Ann._ iii. 53: cùm rectè factorum sibi quisque gratiam trahant, unius [Principis scil.] invidiâ ab omnibus peccatur.

775. _Niggards of the meanest blood._ Seneca, _de Clem._ i. 1: Summa parsimonia etiam vilissimi sanguinis.

776. _Wrongs, if neglected_, etc. Tacit. _Ann._ iv. 34: [Probra] spreta exolescunt, si irascare agnita videntur.

780. _Kings ought to shear_, etc. A saying of Tiberius quoted by Suetonius: Boni pastoris est tondere oves, non deglubere. Herrick probably took it from Ben Jonson's _Discoveries_.

784-7. _Ceremonies for Christmas._ More will be found about the Yule-log in _Ceremonies for Candlemas Day_ (893); cp. also _The Wassail_ (476).

788. _Power and Peace._ From Tacitus, _Ann._ iv. 4: Quanquam arduum sit eodem loci potentiam et concordiam esse.

789. _Mistress Margaret Falconbridge._ A daughter, probably, of the Thomas Falconbridge of number 483.

797. _Kisses._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, with omission of me in l. 1.

804. _John Crofts, Cup-bearer to the King._ Third son of Sir John Crofts, of Saxham, Suffolk. We hear of him in the king's service as early as 1628, and two years later Lord Conway, in thanking Wm. Weld for some verses sent him, hopes "the lines are strong enough to bind Robert Maule and Jack Crofts from ever more using the phrase". So Jack was probably a bit of a poet himself. He may be the Mr. Crofts for assaulting whom George, Lord Digby, was imprisoned a month and more, in 1634.

807. _Man may want land to live in._ Tacitus, _Ann._ xiii. 56: Addidit [Boiocalus] Deësse nobis terra in quâ vivamus, in quâ moriamur non potest, quoted by Montaigne, II. 3.

809. _Who after his transgression doth repent._ Seneca, _Agam._ 243: Quem poenitet peccasse paene est innocens.

810. _Grief, if't be great 'tis short._ Seneca, quoted by Burton (II. iii. 1, § 1): "Si longa est, levis est; si gravis est, brevis est. If it be long, 'tis light; if grievous, it cannot last."

817. _The Amber Bead._ Cp. Martial's epigram quoted in Note to 497. The comparison to Cleopatra is from Mart. IV. xxxii.

818. _To my dearest sister, M. Mercy Herrick._ Not quite five years his senior. She married John Wingfield, of Brantham, Suffolk, to whom also Herrick addresses a poem.

820. _Suffer that thou canst not shift._ From Seneca; the title from _Ep._ cvii.: Optimum est pati quod emendare non possis, the epigram from _De Provid._ 4, as translated by Thomas Lodge, 1614, "Vertuous instructions are never delicate. Doth fortune beat and rend us? Let us suffer it"--whence Herrick reproduces the printer's error, _Vertuous_ for Vertues (Virtue's).

821. _For a stone has Heaven his tomb._ Cp. Sir T. Browne, _Relig. Med._ § 40: "Nor doe I altogether follow that rodomontado of Lucan (_Phars._ vii. 819): Coelo tegitur qui non habet urnam,

He that unburied lies wants not his hearse, For unto him a tomb's the universe".

823. _To the King upon his taking of Leicester._ May 31, 1645, a brief success before Naseby.

825. _'Twas Cæsar's saying._ Tiberius ap. Tacit. _Ann._ ii. 26: Se novies a divo Augusto in Germaniam missum plura consilio quam vi perfecisse.

830. _His Loss._ A reference to his ejection from Dean Prior.

837. _Mistress Amy Potter._ Daughter of Barnabas Potter, Bishop of Carlisle, Herrick's predecessor at Dean Prior.

839. _Love is a circle ... from good to good._ So Burton, III. i. 1, § 2: Circulus a bono in bonum.

844. TO HIS BOOK. _Make haste away._ Martial, III. ii. Ad Librum suum--Festina tibi vindicem parare, Ne nigram cito raptus in culinam Cordyllas madidâ tegas papyro, Vel thuris piperisque sis cucullus. _To make loose gowns for mackerel._ From Catullus, xcv. 1:--

At Volusi annales Paduam morientur ad ipsam, Et laxas scombris saepe dabunt tunicas.

846. _And what we blush to speak_, etc. Ovid, _Phaedra to Hipp._ 10: Dicere quae puduit scribere jussit amor.

849. _'Tis sweet to think_, etc. Seneca, _Herc. Fur._ 657-58: Quae fuit durum pati Meminisse dulce est.

851. _To Mr. Henry Lawes, the excellent composer of his lyrics._ Henry Lawes (1595-1662), the friend of Milton, admitted a Gentleman of the Chapel Royal, 1625. In the _Noble Numbers_ he is mentioned as the composer of Herrick's _Christmas

Carol_ and the first of his two _New-Year's Gifts_. Lawes also set to music Herrick's _Not to Love_, _To Mrs. Eliz. Wheeler_ (Among the Myrtles as I walked), _The Kiss_, _The Primrose_, _To a Gentlewoman objecting to him his Grey Hairs_, and doubtless others.

852. _Maidens tell me I am old._ From Anacreon:

Λέγουσιν αἱ γυναῖκες Ἀνακρέων γέρων εἶ κ.τ.λ.

With a significant variation--"Ill it fits"--for μᾶλλον πρέπει.

859. _Master J. Jincks._ Not identified.

861. _Kings seek their subjects' good, tyrants their own._ Aristot. _Politics_, iii. 7: καλεῖν εἰώθαμεν τῶν μὲν μοναρχιῶν τὴν πρὸς τὸ κοινὸν ἀποβλέπουσαν συμφέρον βασιλείαν ... ἡ τυραννίς ἐστι μοναρχία πρὸς τὸ συμφέρον τὸ τοῦ μοναρχοῦντος.

869. _Sir Thomas Heale._ Probably a son of the Sir Thomas Hele, of Fleet, Co. Devon, who died in 1624. This Sir Thomas was created a baronet in 1627, and according to Dr. Grosart was one of the Royalist commanders at the siege of Plymouth. He died 1670.

872. _Love is a kind of war._ Ovid, _Ars Am._ II. 233, 34:--

Militiae species amor est: discedite segnes! Non sunt haec timidis signa tuenda viris.

873. _A spark neglected_, etc. Ovid, _Rem. Am._ 732-34:--

E minimo maximus ignis erit. Sic nisi vitaris quicquid renovabit amorem, Flamma redardescet quae modo nulla fuit.

874. _An Hymn to Cupid._ From Anacreon:--

Ὤναξ, ᾧ δαμάλης Ἔρως καὶ Νύμφαι κυανώπιδες πορφυρέη τ' Ἀφροδίτη συμπαίζουσιν ... γουνοῦμαί σε, κ.τ.λ.

885. _Naught are all women._ Burton, III. ii. 5. § 5.

907. _Upon Mr. William Lawes, the rare musician._ Elder brother of the more famous Henry Lawes; appointed a Gentleman of the Chapel Royal, 1602, and also one of Charles I.'s musicians-in-ordinary. When the Civil War broke out he joined the king's army and was killed by a stray shot during the siege of Chester, 1645. He set Herrick's _Gather ye rosebuds_ to music.

914. _Numbers ne'er tickle_, etc. Martial, I. xxxvi.:--

Lex haec carminibus data est jocosis, Ne possint, nisi pruriant, juvare.

918. _M. Kellam._ As yet unidentified. Dr. Grosart suggests that he may have been one of Herrick's parishioners, and the name sounds as of the west country.

920. _Cunctation in correction._ Is Herrick translating? According to a relief at Rome the lictors' rods were bound together not only by a red thong twisted from top to bottom, but by six straps as well.

922. _Continual reaping makes a land wax old._ Ovid, _Ars Am._ iii. 82: Continua messe senescit ager.

923. _Revenge._ Tacitus, _Hist._ iv. 3: Tanto proclivius est injuriae quàm beneficio vicem exsolvere; quia gratia oneri, ultio in quaestu habetur.

927. _Praise they that will times past._ Ovid, _Ars Am._ iii. 121:--

Prisca juvent alios: ego me nunc denique natum Gratulor; haec aetas moribus apta meis.

928. _Clothes are conspirators._ I can suggest no better explanation of this oracular epigram than that the tailor's bill is an enemy of a slender purse.

929. _Cruelty_. Seneca _de Clem._ i. 24: Ferina ista rabies est, sanguine gaudere et vulneribus; (i. 8), Quemadmodum praecisae arbores plurimis ramis repullulant [H. uses repullulate, -tion, 336, 794], et multa satorum genera, ut densiora surgant, reciduntur; ita regia crudelitas auget inimicorum numerum tollendo. Ben Jonson, _Discoveries_ (_Clementia_): "The lopping of trees makes the boughs shoot out quicker; and the taking away of some kind of enemies increaseth the number".

931. _A fierce desire of hot and dry._ Cp. note on 683.

932. _To hear the worst_, etc. Antisthenes ap. _Diog. Laert._ VI. i. 4, § 3: Ἀκούσας ποτὲ ὅτι Πλάτων αὐτὸν κακῶς λέγει Βασιλικὸν ἔφη καλῶς ποιοῦντα κακῶς ἀκούειν, quoted by Burton, II. iii. 7.

934. _The Bondman._ Cp. Exodus xxi. 5, 6: "And if the servant shall plainly say: I love my master, my wife, and my children: I will not go out free: Then his master shall bring him unto the judges; he shall also bring him to the door, or unto the doorpost; and his master shall bore his ear through with an awl, and he shall serve him for ever".

936. _My kiss outwent the bonds of shamefastness._ Cp. Sidney's _Astrophel and Stella_, sonnet 82. For _not Jove himself_, etc., cp. 10, and note.

938. _His wish._ From Martial, II. xc. 7-10:--

Sit mihi verna satur: sit non doctissima conjux: Sit nox cum somno, sit sine lite dies, etc.

939. _Upon Julia washing herself in the river._ Imitated from Martial, IV. xxii.:--

Primos passa toros et adhuc placanda marito Merserat in nitidos se Cleopatra lacus, Dum fugit amplexus: sed prodidit unda latentem, Lucebat, totis cum tegeretur aquis. Condita sic puro numerantur lilia vitro, Sic prohibet tenuis gemma latere rosas, Insilui mersusque vadis luctantia carpsi Basia: perspicuae plus vetuistis aquae.

940. _Though frankincense_, etc. Ovid, _de Medic. Fac._ 83, 84:--

Quamvis thura deos irataque numina placent, Non tamen accensis omnia danda focis.

947. _To his honoured and most ingenious friend, Mr. Charles Cotton._ Dr. Grosart annotates: "The translator of Montaigne, and associate of Izaak Walton"; but as the

younger Cotton was only eighteen when _Hesperides_ was printed, it is perhaps more probable that the father is meant, though we may note that Herrick and the younger Cotton were joint-contributors in 1649 to the _Lacrymæ Musarum_, published in memory of Lord Hastings. For a tribute to the brilliant abilities of the elder Cotton, see Clarendon's _Life_ (i. 36; ed. 1827).

948. _Women Useless._ A variation on a theme as old as Euripides. Cp. _Medea_, 573-5:--

χρῆν γὰρ ἀλλοθέν ποθεν βροτοὺς παῖδας τεκνοῦσθαι, θῆλυ δ' οὐκ εἶναι γένος· χοὒτως ἂν οὐκ ἦν οὐδὲν ἀνθρώποις κακόν.

952. _Weep for the dead, for they have lost the light_, cp. Ecclus. xxii. 11.

955. _To M. Leonard Willan, his peculiar friend._ A wretched poet; author of "The Phrygian Fabulist; or the Fables of Æsop" (1650), "Astraea; or True Love's Mirror" (1651), etc.

956. _Mr. John Hall, Student of Gray's Inn._ Hall remained at Cambridge till 1647, and this poem, which addresses him as a "Student of Gray's Inn," must therefore have been written almost while _Hesperides_ was passing through the press. Hall's _Horæ Vacivæ, or Essays_, published in 1646, had at once given him high rank among the wits.

958. _To the most comely and proper M. Elizabeth Finch._ No certain identification has been proposed.

961. _To the King, upon his welcome to Hampton Court, set and sung._ The allusion can only be to the king's stay at Hampton Court in 1647. Good hope was then entertained of a peaceful settlement, and Herrick's ode, enthusiastic as it is, expresses little more than this.

For an ascendent, etc.: This and the next seven lines are taken from phrases on pp. 29-33 of the _Notes and Observations on some passages of Scripture_, by John Gregory (see note on N. N. 178). According to Gregory, "The Ascendent of a City is that sign which riseth in the Heavens at the laying of the first stone".

962. _Henry, Marquis of Dorchester._ Henry Pierrepoint, second Earl of Kingston, succeeded his father (Herrick's Newark) July 30, 1643, and was created Marquis of Dorchester, March, 1645. "He was a very studious nobleman and very learned, particularly in law and physics." (See Burke's _Extinct Peerages_, iii. 435.)

When Cato, the severe, entered the circumspacious theatre. The allusion is to the visit of Cato to the games of Flora, given by Messius. When his presence in the theatre was known, the dancing-women were not allowed to perform in their accustomed lack of costume, whereupon the moralist obligingly retired, amidst applause.

966. _M. Jo. Harmar, physician to the College of Westminster._ John Harmar, born at Churchdown, near Gloucester, about 1594, was educated at Winchester and Magdalen College, Oxford; was a master at Magdalen School, the Free School at St. Albans, and at Westminster, and Professor of Greek at Oxford under the

Commonwealth. He died 1670. Wood characterises him as a butt for the wits and a flatterer of great men, and notes that he was always called by the name of Doctor Harmar, though he took no higher degree than M.A. But in 1632 he supplicated for the degree of M.B., and Dr. Grosart's note--"Herrick, no doubt, playfully transmuted 'Doctor' into 'Physician'"--is misleading. He may have cared for the minds and bodies of the Westminster boys at one and the same time.

The Roman language.... If Jove would speak, etc. Cp. Ben Jonson's _Discoveries_: "that testimony given by L. Aelius Stilo upon Plautus who affirmed, "Musas si latine loqui voluissent Plautino sermone fuisse loquuturas". And Cicero [in Plutarch, § 24] "said of the Dialogues of Plato, that Jupiter, if it were his nature to use language, would speak like him".

967. _Upon his spaniel, Tracy._ Cp. _supra_, 724.

971. _Strength_, etc. Tacitus, _Ann._ xiii. 19: Nihil rerum mortalium tam instabile ac fluxum est, quàm fama potentiae, non suâ vi nixa.

975. _Case is a lawyer_, etc. Martial, I. xcviii. Ad Naevolum Causidicum. Cùm clamant omnes, loqueris tu, Naevole, tantùm.... Ecce, tacent omnes; Naevole, dic aliquid.

977. _To his sister-in-law, M. Susanna Herrick._ Cp. _supra_, 522. The subject is again the making up of the book of the poet's elect.

978. _Upon the Lady Crew._ Cp. Herrick's Epithalamium for her marriage with Sir Clipsby Crew, 283. She died 1639, and was buried in Westminster Abbey.

979. _On Tomasin Parsons._ Daughter of the organist of Westminster Abbey: cp. 500 and Note.

983. _To his kinsman, M. Thomas Herrick, who desired to be in his book._ Cp. 106 and Note.

989. _Care keeps the conquest._ Perhaps jotted down with reference to the Governorship of Exeter by Sir John Berkeley: see Note to 745.

992. _To the handsome Mistress Grace Potter._ Probably sister to the Mistress Amy Potter celebrated in 837, where see Note.

995. _We've more to bear our charge than way to go._ Seneca, Ep. 77: quantulumcunque haberem, tamen plus superesset viatici quam viae, quoted by Montaigne, II. xxviii.

1000. _The Gods, pillars, and men._ Horace's Mediocribus esse poetis Non homines, non di, non concessere columnae (_Ars Poet._ 373). Latin poets hung up their epigrams in public places.

1002. _To the Lord Hopton on his fight in Cornwall._ Sir Ralph Hopton won two brilliant victories for the Royalists, at Bradock Down and Stratton, January and May, 1643, and was created Baron Hopton in the following September. Originally a Parliamentarian, he was one of the king's ablest and most loyal servants.

1008. _Nothing's so hard but search will find it out._ Terence, _Haut._ IV. ii. 8: Nihil tam difficile est quin quaerendo investigari posset.

1009. _Labour is held up by the hope of rest._ Ps. Sallust, _Epist. ad C. Caes._: Sapientes laborem spe otii sustentant.

1022. _Posting to Printing._ Mart. V. x. 11, 12:--

Vos, tamen, o nostri, ne festinate, libelli: Si post fata venit gloria, non propero.

1023. _No kingdoms got by rapine long endure._ Seneca, _Troad._ 264: Violenta nemo imperia continuit dies.

1026. _Saint Distaff's Day._ "Saint Distaff is perhaps only a coinage of our poet's to designate the day when, the Christmas vacation being over, good housewives, with others, resumed their usual employment." (Nott.) The phrase is explained in dictionaries and handbooks, but no other use of it is quoted than this. Herrick's poem was pilfered by Henry Bold (a notorious plagiarist) in _Wit a-sporting in a pleasant Grove of New Fancies_, 1657.

1028. _My beloved Westminster._ As mentioned in the brief "Life" of Herrick prefixed to vol. i., all the references in this poem seem to refer to Herrick's courtier-days, between leaving Cambridge and going to Devonshire. He then, doubtless, resided in Westminster for the sake of proximity to Whitehall. It has been suggested, however, that the reference is to Westminster School, but we have no evidence that Herrick was educated there.

Golden Cheapside. My friend, Mr. Herbert Horne, in his admirably-chosen selection from the _Hesperides_, suggests that the allusion here is to the great gilt cross at the end of Wood Street. The suggestion is ingenious; but as Cheapside was the goldsmiths' quarter this would amply justify the epithet, which may indeed only refer to Cheapside as a money-winning street, as we might say Golden Lombard Street.

1032. _Things are uncertain._ Tiberius, in Tacitus, _Annal._ i. 72: Cuncta mortalium incerta; quantoque plus adeptus foret, tanto se magis in lubrico.

1034. _Good wits get more fame by their punishment._ Cp. Tacit. _Ann._ iv. 35, sub fin.: Punitis ingeniis gliscit auctoritas, etc., quoted by Bacon and Milton.

1035. _Twelfth Night: or King and Queen._ Herrick alludes to these "Twelfth-Tide Kings and Queens" in writing to Endymion Porter (662), and earlier still, in the "New-Year's Gift to Sir Simeon Steward" (319) he speaks--

"Of Twelfth-Tide cakes, of Peas and Beans, Wherewith ye make those merry scenes, Whenas ye choose your King and Queen".

Brand (i. 27) illustrates well from "Speeches to the Queen at Sudley" in Nichols' _Progresses of Queen Elizabeth_.

"_Melibœus._ Cut the cake: who hath the bean shall be king, and where the pea is, she shall be queen.

Nisa. I have the pea and must be queen.

Mel. I the bean, and king. I must command."

1045. _Comfort in Calamity._ An allusion to the ejection from their benefices which befel most of the loyal clergy at the same time as Herrick. It is perhaps worth noting that in the second volume of this edition, and in the last hundred poems printed in the first, wherever a date can be fixed it is always in the forties. Equally late poems occur, though much less frequently, among the first five hundred, but there the dated poems belong, for the most part, to the years 1623-1640. Now, in April 29, 1640, as stated in the brief "Life" prefixed to vol. i., there was entered at Stationers' Hall, "The severall poems written by Master Robert Herrick," a book which, as far as is known, never saw the light. It was probably, however, to this book that Herrick addressed the poem (405) beginning:--

"Have I not blest thee? Then go forth, nor fear Or spice, or fish, or fire, or close-stools here";

and we may fairly regard the first five hundred poems of _Hesperides_ as representing the intended collection of 1640, with a few additions, and the last six hundred as for the most part later, and I must add, inferior work. This is borne out by the absence of any manuscript versions of poems in the second half of the book. Herrick's verses would only be passed from hand to hand when he was living among the wits in London.

1046. _Twilight._ Ovid, _Amores_, I. v. 5, 6: Crepuscula ... ubi nox abiit, nec tamen orta dies.

1048. _Consent makes the cure._ Seneca, _Hippol._ 250: Pars sanitatis velle sanari fuit.

1050. _Causeless whipping._ Ovid, _Heroid._ v. 7, 8: Leniter ex merito quicquid patiare, ferendum est; Quae venit indignae poena, dolenda venit. Quoted by Montaigne, III. xiii.

1052. _His comfort._ Terence, _Adelph._ I. i. 18: Ego ... quod fortunatum isti putant, Uxorem nunquam habui.

1053. _Sincerity._ From Hor. _Ep._ I. ii. 54: Sincerum est nisi vas, quodcunque infundis acescit. Quoted by Montaigne, III. xiii.

1056. _To his peculiar friend, M. Jo. Wicks._ See 336 and Note. Written after Herrick's ejection. We know that the poet's uncle, Sir William Herrick, suffered greatly in estate during the Civil War, and it may have been the same with other friends and relatives. But there can be little doubt that the poet found abundant hospitality on his return to London.

1059. _A good Death._ August. _de Disciplin. Christ._ 13: Non potest malè mori, qui benè vixerit.

1061. _On Fortune._ Seneca, _Medea_, 176: Fortuna opes auferre non animum potest.

1062. _To Sir George Parry, Doctor of the Civil Law._ According to Dr. Grosart, Parry "was admitted to the College of Advocates, London, 3rd Nov., 1628; but almost nothing has been transmitted concerning him save that he married the daughter and heir of Sir Giles Sweet, Dean of Arches". I can hardly doubt that he must be identified with the Dr. George Parry, Chancellor to the Bishop of Exeter, who in 1630 was accused of excommunicating persons for the sake of fees, but was highly praised in 1635 and soon after appointed a Judge Marshal. If so, his wife was a widow when she came to him, as she is spoken of in 1638 as "Lady Dorothy Smith, wife of Sir Nicholas Smith, deceased". She brought him a rich dower, and her death greatly confused his affairs.

1067. _Gentleness._ Seneca, _Phoen._ 659: Qui vult amari, languidâ regnet manu. And Ben Jonson, _Panegyre_ (1603): "He knew that those who would with love command, Must with a tender yet a steadfast hand, Sustain the reins".

1068. _Mrs. Eliza Wheeler._ See 130 and Note.

1071. _To the Honoured Master Endymion Porter._ For Porter's patronage of poetry see 117 and Note.

1080. _The Mistress of all singular Manners, Mistress Portman._ Dr. Grosart notes that a Mrs. Mary Portman was buried at Putney Parish Church, June 27, 1671, and this was perhaps Herrick's schoolmistress, the "pearl of Putney".

1087. _Where pleasures rule a kingdom._ Cicero, _De Senect._ xii. 41: Neque omnino in voluptatis regno virtutem posse consistere. _He lives who lives to virtue._ Comp. Sallust, _Catil._ 2, s. fin.

1088. _Twice five-and-twenty (bate me but one year)._ As Herrick was born in 1591, this poem must have been written in 1640.

1089. _To M. Laurence Swetnaham._ Unless the various entries in the parish registers of St. Margaret's, Westminster, refer to different men, this Lawrence Swetnaham was the third son of Thomas Swettenham of Swettenham in Cheshire, married in 1602 to Mary Birtles. Lawrence himself had children as early as 1629, and ten years later was church-warden. He was buried in the Abbey, 1673.

1091. _My lamp to you I give._ Allusion to the Λαμπαδηφορία which Plato (_Legg._ 776B) uses to illustrate the succession of generations. So Lucretius (ii. 77): Et quasi cursores vitaï lampada tradunt.

1092. _Michael Oulsworth._ Michael Oulsworth, Oldsworth or Oldisworth, graduated M.A. from Magdalen College, Oxford, in 1614. According to Wood, "he was afterwards Fellow of his College, Secretary to Earl of Pembroke, elected a burgess to serve in several Parliaments for Sarum and Old Sarum, and though in the Grand Rebellion he was no Colonel, yet he was Governor of Old Pembroke, and Montgomery led him by the nose as he pleased, to serve both their turns". The partnership, however, was not eternal, for between 1648 and 1650 Oldisworth published at least eight virulent satires against his former master.

1094. _Truth--her own simplicity._ Seneca, _Ep._ 49: (Ut ille tragicus), Veritatis simplex oratio est.

1097. _Kings must be dauntless._ Seneca, _Thyest._ 388: Rex est qui metuit nihil.

1100. _To his brother, Nicholas Herrick._ Baptized April 22, 1589; a merchant trading to the Levant. He married Susanna Salter, to whom Herrick addresses two poems (522, 977).

1103. _A King and no King._ Seneca, _Thyest._ 214: Ubicunque tantùm honestè dominanti licet, Precario regnatur.

1118. _Necessity makes dastards valiant men._ Sallust, _Catil._ 58: Necessitudo ... timidos fortes facit.

1119. _Sauce for Sorrows._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650. _An equal mind._ Plautus, _Rudens_, II. iii. 71: Animus aequus optimum est aerumnae condimentum.

1126. _The End of his Work._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, under the title: _Of this Book._ From Ovid, _Ars Am._ i. 773, 774:--

Pars superest caepti, pars est exhausta laboris: Hic teneat nostras anchora jacta rates.

1127. _My wearied bark_, etc. Ovid, _Rem. Am._ 811, 812:--

fessae date serta carinæ: Contigimus portum, quo mihi cursus erat.

1128. _The work is done._ Ovid, _Ars Am._ ii. 733, 734:--

Finis adest operi: palmam date, grata juventus, Sertaque odoratae myrtea ferte comae.

1130. _His Muse._ Cp. Note on 624.

NOBLE NUMBERS.

3. _Weigh me the Fire._ _2 Esdras_, iv. 5, 7; v. 9, 36: "Weigh me ... the fire, or measure me ... the wind," etc.

4. _God ... is the best known, not...._ _August. de Ord._ ii. 16: [Deus] scitur melius nesciendo.

5. _Supraentity_, τὸ ὑπερόντως ὄν, Plotinus.

7. _His wrath is free from perturbation._ August. _de Civ. Dei_, ix. 5: Ipse Deus secundum Scripturas irascitur, nec tamen ullâ passione turbatur. _Enchir. ad Laurent._ 33: Cum irasci dicitur Deus, non significatur perturbatio, qualis est in animo irascentis hominis.

9. _Those Spotless two Lambs._ "This is the offering made by fire which ye shall offer unto the Lord: two lambs of the first year without spot, day by day, for a continual burnt-offering." (Numb. xxviii. 3.)

17. _An Anthem sung in the Chapel of Whitehall._ This may be added to Nos. 96-98, and 102, the poems on which Mr. Hazlitt bases his conjecture that Herrick may have

held some subordinate post in the Chapel Royal.

37. _When once the sin has fully acted been._ Tacitus, _Ann._ xiv. 10: Perfecto demum scelere, magnitudo ejus intellecta est.

38. _Upon Time._ Were this poem anonymous it would probably be attributed rather to George Herbert than to Herrick.

41. _His Litany to the Holy Spirit._ We may quote again from Barron Field's account in the _Quarterly Review_ (1810) of his cross-examination of the Dean Prior villagers for Reminiscences of Herrick: "The person, however, who knows more of Herrick than all the rest of the neighbourhood we found to be a poor woman in the 99th year of her age, named Dorothy King. She repeated to us, with great exactness, five of his _Noble Numbers_, among which was his beautiful 'Litany'. These she had learnt from her mother, who was apprenticed to Herrick's successor at the vicarage. She called them her prayers, which she said she was in the habit of putting up in bed, whenever she could not sleep; and she therefore began the 'Litany' at the second stanza:--

'When I lie within my bed,' etc."

Another of her midnight orisons was the poem beginning:--

"Every night Thou dost me fright, And keep mine eyes from sleeping," etc.

The last couplet, it should be noted, is misquoted from No. 56.

54. _Spew out all neutralities._ From the message to the Church of the Laodiceans, Rev. iii. 16.

59. _A Present by a Child._ Cp. "A pastoral upon the Birth of Prince Charles" (_Hesperides_ 213), and Note.

63. _God's mirth: man's mourning._ Perhaps founded on Prov. i. 26: "I also will laugh at your calamity; I will mock when your fear cometh".

65. _My Alma._ The name is probably suggested by its meaning "soul". Cp. Prior's _Alma_.

72. _I'll cast a mist and cloud._ Cp. Hor. I. _Ep._ xvi. 62: Noctem peccatis et fraudibus objice nubem.

75. _That house is bare._ Horace, _Ep._ I. vi. 45: Exilis domus est, ubi non et multa supersunt.

77. _Lighten my candle_, etc. The phraseology of the next five lines is almost entirely from the Psalms and the Song of Solomon.

86. _Sin leads the way._ Hor. _Odes_, III. ii. 32: Raro antecedentem scelestum Deseruit pede Poena claudo.

88. _By Faith we ... walk ..., not by the Spirit._ 2 Cor. v. 7: "We walk by faith, not by sight". 'By the Spirit' perhaps means, 'in spiritual bodies'.

96. _Sung to the King._ See Note on 17.

Composed by M. Henry Lawes. See _Hesperides_ 851, and Note.

102. _The Star-Song._ This may have been composed partly with reference to the noonday star during the Thanksgiving for Charles II.'s birth. See _Hesperides_ 213, and Note.

We'll choose him King. A reference to the Twelfth Night games. See _Hesperides_ 1035, and Note.

108. _Good men afflicted most._ Taken almost entirely from Seneca, _de Provid._ 3, 4: Ignem experitur [Fortuna] in Mucio, paupertatem in Fabricio, ... tormenta in Regulo, venenum in Socrate, mortem in Catone. The allusions may be briefly explained for the unclassical. At the siege of Dyrrachium, Marcus Cassius Scæva caught 120 darts on his shield; Horatius Cocles is the hero of the bridge (see Macaulay's _Lays_); C. Mucius Scævola held his hand in the fire to illustrate to Porsenna Roman fearlessness; Cato is Cato Uticensis, the philosophic suicide; "high Atilius" will be more easily recognised as the M. Atilius Regulus who defied the Carthaginians; Fabricius Luscinus refused not only the presents of Pyrrhus, but all reward of the State, and lived in poverty on his own farm.

109. _A wood of darts._ Cp. Virg. _Æn._ x. 886: Ter secum Troius heros Immanem aerato circumfert tegmine silvam.

112. _The Recompense._ Herrick is said to have assumed the lay habit on his return to London after his ejection, perhaps as a protection against further persecution. This quatrain may be taken as evidence that he did not throw off his religion with his cassock. Compare also 124.

All I have lost that could be rapt from me. From Ovid, III. _Trist._ vii. 414: Raptaque sint adimi quae potuere mihi.

123. _Thy light that ne'er went out._ Prov. xxxi. 18 (of 'the Excellent Woman'): "Her candle goeth not out by night". _All set about with lilies._ Cp. _Cant. Canticorum_, vii. 2: Venter tuus sicut acervus tritici, vallatus liliis.

Will show these garments. So Acts ix. 39.

134. _God had but one son free from sin._ Augustin. _Confess._ vi.: Deus unicum habet filium sine peccato, nullum sine flagello, quoted in Burton, II. iii. 1.

136. _Science in God._ Bp. Davenant, _on Colossians_, 166, _ed._ 1639; speaking of Omniscience: Proprietates Divinitatis non sunt accidentia, sed ipsa Dei essentia.

145. _Tears._ Augustin. _Enarr. Ps._ cxxvii.: Dulciores sunt lacrymae orantium quàm gaudia theatorum.

146. _Manna._ Wisdom xvi. 20, 21: "Angels' food ... agreeing to every taste".

147. _As Cassiodore doth prove._ Reverentia est enim Domini timor cum amore permixtus. Cassiodor. _Expos. in Psalt._ xxxiv. 30; quoted by Dr. Grosart. My clerical predecessor has also hunted down with much industry the possible sources of most of the other patristic references in _Noble Numbers_, though I have been able to add a few. We may note that Herrick quotes Cassiodorus (twice), John of Damascus,

Boethius, Thomas Aquinas, St. Bernard, St. Augustine (thrice), St. Basil, and St. Ambrose--a goodly list of Fathers, if we had any reason to suppose that the quotations were made at first hand.

148. _Mercy ... a Deity._ Pausanias, _Attic._ I. xvii. 1.

153. _Mora Sponsi, the stay of the bridegroom._ Maldonatus, _Comm. in Matth._ xxv.: Hieronymus et Hilarius moram sponsi pœnitentiae tempus esse dicunt.

157. _Montes Scripturarum._ See August. _Enarr. in Ps._ xxxix., and passim.

167. _A dereliction._ The word is from Ps. xxii. 1: Quare me dereliquisti? "Why hast Thou forsaken me?" Herrick took it from Gregory's _Notes and Observations_ (see infra), p. 5: 'Our Saviour ... in that great case of dereliction'.

174. _Martha, Martha._ See Luke x. 41, and August. _Serm._ cii. 3: Repetitio nominis indicium est dilectionis.

177. _Paradise._ Gregory, p. 75, on "the reverend Say of Zoroaster, Seek Paradise," quotes from the Scholiast Psellus: "The Chaldæan Paradise (saith he) is a Quire of divine powers incircling the Father".

178. _The Jews when they built houses._ Herrick's rabbinical lore (cp. 180, 181, 193, 207, 224), like his patristic, was probably derived at second hand through some biblical commentary. Much of it certainly comes from the _Notes and Observations upon some Passages of Scripture_ (Oxford, 1646) of John Gregory, chaplain of Christ Church, a prodigy of oriental learning, who died in his 39th year, March 13, 1646. Thus in his Address to the Reader (3rd page from end) Gregory remarks: "The Jews, when they build a house, are bound to leave some part of it unfinished in memory of the destruction of Jerusalem," giving a reference to Leo of Modena, _Degli Riti Hebraici_, Part I.

180. _Observation. The Virgin Mother_, etc. Gregory, pp. 24-27, shows that Sitting, the usual posture of mourners, was forbidden by both Roman and Jewish Law "in capital causes". "This was the reason why ... she stood up still in a resolute and almost impossible compliance with the Law.... They sat ... after leave obtained ... to bury the body."

181. _Tapers._ Cp. Gregory's _Notes_, p. 111: "The funeral tapers (however thought of by some) are of the same harmless import. Their meaning is to show that the departed souls are not quite put out, but having walked here as the children of the Light are now gone to walk before God in the light of the living."

185. _God in the holy tongue._ J. G., p. 135: "God is called in the Holy Tongue ... the Place; or that Fulness which filleth All in All".

186, 187, 188, 189, 197. _God's Presence, Dwelling_, etc. J. G., pp. 135-9: "Shecinah, or God's Dwelling Presence". "God is said to be nearer to this man than to that, more in one place than in another. Thus he is said to depart from some and come to others, to leave this place and to abide in that, not by essential application of Himself, much less by local motion, but by impression of effect." "With just men (saith St. Bernard) God is present, _in veritate_, in deed, but with the wicked,

dissemblingly." "He is called in the Holy Tongue, Jehovah, He that is, or Essence." "He is said to dwell there (saith Maimon) where He putteth the marks ... of His Majesty; and He doth this by His Grace and Holy Spirit."

190. _The Virgin Mary._ J. G., p. 86: "St. Ephrem upon those words of Jacob, This is the House of God, and this is the Gate of Heaven. This saying (saith he) is to be meant of the Virgin Mary ... truly to be called the House of God, as wherein the Son of God ... inhabited, and as truly the Gate of Heaven, for the Lord of heaven and earth entered thereat; and it shall not be set open the second time, according to that of Ezekiel (xliv. 2): I saw (saith he) a gate in the East; the glorious Lord entered thereat; thenceforth that gate was shut, and is not any more to be opened (_Catena Arab._ c. 58)."

192. _Upon Woman and Mary._ The reference is to Christ's appearance to St. Mary Magdalene in the Garden after the Resurrection, John xx. 15, 16.

193. _North and South._ Comp. _Hesper._ 429. _Observation_. J. G., pp. 92, 93: "Whosoever (say the Doctors in Berachoth) shall set his bed N. and S., shall beget male children. Therefore the Jews hold this rite of collocation ... to this day.... They are bound to place their ... house of office in the very same situation ... that the uncomely necessities ... might not fall into the Walk and Ways of God, whose Shecinah or dwelling presence lieth W. and E."

195. _Noah the first was_, etc. Cp. Gregory, _Notes_, p. 28.

201. _Temporal goods._ August., quoted by Burton, II. iii. 3: Dantur quidem bonis, saith Austin, ne quis mala aestimet, malis autem ne quis nimis bona.

203. _Speak, did the blood of Abel cry_, etc. Cp. Gregory's _Notes_, pp. 118: "But did the blood of Abel speak? saith Theophylact. Yes, it cried unto God for vengeance, as that of sprinkling for propitiation and mercy."

204. _A thing of such a reverend reckoning._ Cp. Gregory, 118-9: "The blood of Abel was so holy and reverend a thing, in the sense and reputation of the old world, that the men of that time used to swear by it".

205. _A Position in the Hebrew Divinity._ From Gregory's _Notes_, pp. 134, 5: "That old position in the Hebrew Divinity ... that a repenting man is of more esteem in the sight of God than one that never fell away".

206. _The Doctors in the Talmud._ From Gregory's _Notes_, _l.c._: "The Doctors in the Talmud say, that one day spent here in true Repentance is more worth than eternity itself, or all the days of heaven in the other world".

207. _God's Presence._ Again from Gregory's Notes, pp. 136 sq.

208. _The Resurrection._ Gregory's _Notes_, pp. 128-29, translating from a Greek MS. of Mathæus Blastares in the Bodleian: "The wonder of this is far above that of the resurrection of our bodies; for then the earth giveth up her dead but one for one, but in the case of the corn she giveth up many living ones for one dead one".

243. _Confession twofold is._ August, in Ps. xxix. _Enarr._ ii. 19: Confessio gemina est, aut peccati, aut laudis.

254. _Gold and frankincense._ St. Matt. ii. 11. St. Ambrose. Aurum Regi, thus Deo.

256. _The Chewing the Cud._ Cp. Lev. xi. 6.

258. _As my little pot doth boil_, etc. This far-fetched little poem is an instance of Herrick's habit of jotting down his thoughts in verse. In cooking some food for a charitable purpose he seems to have noticed that the boiling pot tossed the meat to and fro, or "waved" it (the priest's work), and that he himself was giving away the meat he lifted off the fire, the "heave-offering," which was the priest's perquisite. This is the confusion or "level-coil" to which he alludes.

NOTES TO ADDITIONAL POEMS.

The Description of a Woman. Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1645, and contained also in Ashmole MS. 38, where it is signed: "Finis. Robert Herrick." Our version is taken from _Witts Recreations_, with the exception of the readings _show_ and _grow_ (for _shown_ and _grown_, in ll. 15 and 16). The Ashmole MS. contains in all thirty additional lines, which may or may not be by Herrick, but which, as not improving the poem, have been omitted in our text in accordance with the precedent set by the editor of _Witts Recreations_.

Mr. Herrick: his Daughter's Dowry. From Ashmole MS. 38, where it is signed: "Finis. Robt. Hericke."

Mr. Robert Herrick: his Farewell unto Poetry. Printed by Dr. Grosart and Mr. Hazlitt from Ashmole MS. 38. I add a few readings from Brit. Mus. Add. MS. 22, 603, where it is entitled: _Herrick's Farewell to Poetry_. The importance of the poem for Herrick's biography is alluded to in the brief "Life" prefixed to vol. i.

For _some sleepy keys_ the Museum MS. reads, _the sleeping keys_; for _yet forc't they are to go_ it has _and yet are forc't to go_; _drinking to the odd Number of Nine_ for _Number of Wine_, as to which see below; _turned her home_ for _twirled her home_; _dear soul_ for _rare soul_. All these are possible, but _beloved Africa_, and the omission of the two half lines, "'tis not need The scarecrow unto mankind," are pure blunders.

Drinking to the odd Number of Nine. I introduce this into the text from the Museum manuscript as agreeing with the

"Well, I can quaff, I see, To th' number five Or nine"

of _A Bacchanalian Verse_ (_Hesperides_ 653), on which see Note. Dr. Grosart explains the Ashmole reading _Wine_ by the Note "_οἶνος_ and _vinum_ both give five, the number of perfection"; but this seems too far-fetched for Herrick.

Kiss, so depart. By a strange freak Ashmole MS. writes _Guesse_, and the Museum MS. _Ghesse_; but the emendation _Kiss_ (adopted both by Dr. Grosart and Mr. Hazlitt) cannot be doubted.

Well doing's the fruit of doing well. Seneca, _de Clem._ i. 1: Rectè factorum verus fructus [est] fecisse. Also _Ep._ 81: Recte facti fecisse merces est. The latter, and Cicero, _de Finib._ II. xxii. 72, are quoted by Montaigne, _Ess._ II. xvi.

A Carol presented to Dr. Williams. From Ashmole MS. 36, 298. For Dr. Williams, see Note to _Hesperides_ 146. This poem was apparently written in 1640, after the removal of the bishop's suspension.

His Mistress to him at his Farewell. From Add. MS. 11, 811, at the British Museum, where it is signed "Ro. Herrick".

Upon Parting. From Harleian MS. 6917, at the British Museum.

Upon Master Fletcher's Incomparable Plays. Printed in Beaumont and Fletcher's Works, 1647, and Beaumont's Poems, 1653.

The Golden Pomp is come. Ovid, "Aurea Pompa venit" (as in _Hesperides_ 201).

To be with juice of cedar washed all over. Horace's "linenda cedro," as in _Hesperides_.

Evadne. See Note to _Hesperides_ 575.

The New Charon. First printed in "Lachrymae Musarum. The tears of the Muses: exprest in Elegies written by divers persons of Nobility and Worth, upon the death of the most hopefull Henry, Lord Hastings.... Collected and set forth by R[ichard] B[rome]. _London_, 1649." This is the only poem which we know of Herrick's, written after 1648, and even in this Herrick uses materials already employed in "Charon and the Nightingale" in _Hesperides_.

Epitaph on the Tomb of Sir Edward Giles. First printed by Dr. Grosart from the monument in Dean Prior Church. Sir Edward Giles was the occupant of Dean Court and the magnate of the parish.

APPENDIX I.

HERRICK'S POEMS IN WITTS RECREATIONS.

Both Mr. Hazlitt and Dr. Grosart have slightly misrepresented the relation of _Hesperides_ to the anthology known as _Witts Recreations_: Mr. Hazlitt by mistakes as to their respective contents; Dr. Grosart (after a much more careful collation) by taking down the date of the wrong edition. To put matters straight four editions have to be examined:--

I. "Witts Recreations. Selected from the finest Fancies of Moderne Muses, With a Thousand out Landish Proverbs. _London. Printed for Humph. Blunden at ye Castle in Cornhill, 1640._ 8vo."

This general title-page is engraved by W. Marshall. The Outlandish Proverbs were selected by George Herbert, and, like the first part, have a printed title-page of their own.

II. "Witts Recreations. Augmented with Ingenious Conceites for the wittie and Merrie Medicines for the Melancholie. _London. Printed for Humph. Blunden: at ye Castle in Cornhill, 1641._ 8vo."

In this, and subsequent editions, Marshall's title-page is re-engraved and the Outlandish Proverbs are omitted. The printed title-page reads: "Wit's Recreations. Containing 630 Epigrams, 160 Epitaphs. Variety of Fancies and Fantasticks, Good for Melancholly humours. _London. Printed by Thomas Cotes_," etc. The epigrams vary considerably from the selection in the previous edition.

III. "Witts Recreations refined. Augmented, with Ingenious Conceites for the wittie, and Merrie Medicines for the Melancholie...."

In the Museum copy of this edition the imprint to the engraved title has been cropped away. The printed title-page reads: "Recreation for Ingenious Head-peeces. Or, A Pleasant Grove for their Wits to walke in. Of Epigrams, 630: Epitaphs, 180: Fancies, a number: Fantasticks, abundance, Good for melancholy Humors. _Printed by R. Cotes for H. B. London, 1645._ 8vo." Two poems of Herrick's occur in the additional "Fancies and Fantasticks," first printed in this edition, viz.: _The Description of a Woman_ (not contained in _Hesperides_), and the _Farewell to Sack_.

IV. "Witts Recreations refined. Augmented, with Ingenious Conceites for the wittie and Merrie Medicines for the Melancholie. _Printed by M. S. sould by I. Hancock in Popes head Alley, 1650._ 8vo."

The printed title-page reads: "Recreations for Ingenious Head-peeces. Or, A Pleasant Grove for their Wits to Walke in. Of Epigrams, 700: Epitaphs, 200: Fancies, a number: Fantasticks, abundance. With their Addition, Multiplication, and Division. _London, Printed by M. Simmons_," etc. In this edition many of the Epigrams are omitted and more than one hundred fresh ones added. Additions are also made to the Epitaphs and Fancies and Fantasticks. Of the new Epigrams and Poems no less than seventy-two had been printed two years earlier in Herrick's _Hesperides_, and ten others were added in 1654 from the same source.

Witts Recreations was again reprinted in 1663, 1667, and perhaps oftener. In 1817 it was issued as vol. ii. of a collection of _Facetiæ_, of which Mennis and Smith's _Musarum Deliciæ_ and _Wit Restor'd_ formed vol. i. On the title-page _Witts Recreations_ is said to be printed from edition 1640, with all the wood engravings and improvements of subsequent editions, and in the preface it is explained to be "reprinted after a collation of the four editions, 1640, 41, 54, and 63, for the purpose of bringing together in one body all the various articles spread throughout, and not to be found in any one edition". This 1817 reprint was re-issued by Hotten in 1874, and this re-issue, as his references to pagination show, was the one used by Dr. Grosart. The date 1640 on the title-page may have caught his eye and led to his mistaken allusion to the "prior publication" of the Herrick poems in 1640, whereas _Hesperides_ was published in 1648, and the editions of _Witts Recreations_ which contain anything of his besides the _Description of a Woman_ and _A Farewell to Sack_, in 1650, 1654, etc.

In the Notes to the present edition I have drawn attention to all variations in the text of the poems as printed by Herrick and the later editors, and now subjoin a complete list of the poems under the titles which they take in _Witts Recreations_, with their numbers in this edition.

1645 Edition.

128. A Farewell to Sack. [Not in _Hesp._] The Description of a Woman.

1650 Edition Adds:--

123. A Tear sent to his Mis. 159. The Cruel Maid. 162. His Misery. 172. With a Ring to Julia. 200. On Gubbs. 206. On Bunce. 239. On Guesse. 241. On a Painted Madam. 310. On a Child. 311. On Sneape. 328. A Foolish Querie. 340. A Check to her Delay. 352. Nothing New. 357. Long and Lazy. 367. To a Stale Lady. 374. Gain and Gettings. 379. On Doll. 380. On Skrew. 381. On Linnit. 400. On Raspe. 407. On Himself. 408. Love and Liberty. 409. On Skinns. 428. On Craw. 434. On Jack and Jill. 517. Change. 534. To Julia. 572. On Umber. 600. Little and Loud. 616. Abroad with the Maids. 637. On Lungs. 640. On a Child. 644. On an Old Man, a Residentiary. 648. On Cob. 649. On Betty. 650. On Skoles. 661. Ambition. 666. On Zelot. 669. On Crab. 675. On Women's Denial. 676. Adversity. 693. On Tuck. 697. Adversity. 703. On Trigg. 711. Possessions. 735. Maids' Nays. 743. On Julia's Weeping. 752. No Pains No Gains. 761. Alvar and Anthea. 772. A Hymn to Bacchus. 776. Anger. 791. Verses. 795. On Bice. 796. On Trencherman. 797. Kisses. 832. On Punchin. 838. On a Maid. 840. Beauty. 846. Writing. 849. Satisfaction. 873. On Love. 881. ll. 13, 14, Sharp Sauce. 886. On Lulls. 902. Truth. 910. On Ben Jonson. 946. An Hymn to Love. 950. Leaven. 1025. On Boreman. 1084. On Love. 1085. On Gut. 1106. On Rump. 1119. Sauce for Sorrows. 1126. Of this Book.

1654 Edition Adds:--

49. Cherry Pit. 85. On Love. 92. The Bag of a Bee. 208. To make much of Time. 235. On an Old Batchelor. 238. Another. (On the Rose.) 253. Counsel not to Love. 260. How the Violets came blue. 337. A Vow to Cupid. 446. The Farewell to Love and to his Mistress.

APPENDIX II.

HERRICK'S FAIRY POEMS AND THE DESCRIPTION OF THE KING AND QUEENE OF FAYRIES PUBLISHED 1635.

The publisher's freak, by which Herrick's three chief Fairy poems ("The Fairy Temple; or, Oberon's Chapel," "Oberon's Feast," and "Oberon's Palace") are separated from each other, is greatly to be regretted. The last two, both dedicated to Shapcott, are distinctly connected by their opening lines, and "Oberon's Chapel," dedicated to Mr. John Merrifield, Herrick's other fairy-loving lawyer, of course belongs to the same group. All three were probably first written in 1626 and cannot be dissociated from Drayton's _Nymphidia_, published in 1627, and Sir Simeon Steward's "A Description of the King of Fayries clothes, brought to him on New-yeares day in the morning, 1626 [O. S.], by his Queenes Chambermaids". In

1635 there was published a little book of a dozen leaves, most kindly transcribed for this edition by Mr. E. Gordon Duff, from the unique copy at the Bodleian Library. It is entitled:--

"A | Description | of the King and Queene of | Fayries, their habit, fare, their | abode pompe and state. | Beeing very delightfull to the sense, and | full of mirth. | [Wood-cut.] London. | _Printed for Richard Harper, and are to be sold | at his shop, at the Hospitall gate._ 1635."

Fol. 1 is blank; fol. 2 occupied by the title-page; ff. 3, 4 (verso blank) by a letter "To the Reader," signed: "Yours hereafter, If now approved on, R. S.," beginning: "Courteous Reader, I present thee here with the Description of the King of the Fayries, of his Attendants, Apparel, Gesture, and Victuals, which though comprehended in the brevity of so short a volume, yet as the Proverbe truely averres, it hath as mellifluous and pleasing discourse, as that whose amplitude contains the fulnesse of a bigger composition"; on fol. 5 (verso blank) occurs the following poem [spelling here modernised]:--

"Deep-skilled Geographers, whose art and skill Do traverse all the world, and with their quill Declare the strangeness of each several clime, The nature, situation, and the time Of being inhabited, yet all their art And deep informèd skill could not impart In what set climate of this Orb or Isle, The King of Fairies kept, whose honoured style Is here inclosed, with the sincere description Of his abode, his nature, and the region In which he rules: read, and thou shalt find Delightful mirth, fit to content thy mind. May the contents thereof thy palate suit, With its mellifluous and pleasing fruit: For nought can more be sweetened to my mind Than that this Pamphlet thy contentment find; Which if it shall, my labour is sufficed, In being by your liking highly prized. "Yours to his power, "R. S."

This is followed (pp. 1-3) by: "A Description of the Kings [sic] of Fayries Clothes, brought to him on New-Yeares day in the morning, 1626, by his Queenes Chambermaids:--

"First a cobweb shirt, more thin Than ever spider since could spin. Changed to the whiteness of the snow, By the stormy winds that blow In the vast and frozen air, No shirt half so fine, so fair; A rich waistcoat they did bring, Made of the Trout-fly's gilded wing: At which his Elveship 'gan to fret The wearing it would make him sweat Even with its weight: he needs would wear A waistcoat made of downy hair New shaven off an Eunuch's chin, That pleased him well, 'twas wondrous thin. The outside of his doublet was Made of the four-leaved, true-loved grass, Changed into so fine a gloss, With the oil of crispy moss: It made a rainbow in the night Which gave a lustre passing light. On every seam there was a lace Drawn by the unctuous snail's slow pace, To which the finest, purest, silver thread Compared, did look like dull pale lead. His breeches of the Fleece was wrought, Which from Colchos Jason brought: Spun into so fine a yarn No mortal wight might it discern, Weaved by Arachne on her loom, Just before she had her doom. A rich Mantle he did wear, Made of tinsel gossamer. Beflowered over with a few Diamond stars of morning dew: Dyed crimson in a maiden's blush, Lined with humble-bees' lost plush. His cap was all of ladies' love, So

wondrous light, that it did move If any humming gnat or fly Buzzed the air in passing by, About his neck a wreath of pearl, Dropped from the eyes of some poor girl, Pinched, because she had forgot To leave clean water in the pot."

The next page is occupied by a woodcut, and then (pp. 5, misnumbered 4, and 6) comes the variation on Herrick's "Oberon's Feast":--

"A DESCRIPTION OF HIS DIET.

"Now they, the Elves, within a trice, Prepared a feast less great than nice, Where you may imagine first, The Elves prepare to quench his thirst, In pure seed pearl of infant dew Brought and sweetened with a blue And pregnant violet; which done, His killing eyes begin to run Quite o'er the table, where he spies The horns of watered butterflies, Of which he eats, but with a little Neat cool allay of cuckoo's spittle. Next this the red-cap worm that's shut Within the concave of a nut. Moles' eyes he tastes, then adders' ears; To these for sauce the slain stags' tears, A bloated earwig, and the pith Of sugared rush he glads him with. Then he takes a little moth, Late fatted in a scarlet cloth, A spinner's ham, the beards of mice, Nits carbonadoed, a device Before unknown; the blood of fleas, Which gave his Elveship's stomach ease. The unctuous dew-laps of a snail, The broke heart of a nightingale O'ercome in music, with the sag And well-bestrutted bee's sweet bag. Conserves of atoms, and the mites, The silk-worm's sperm, and the delights Of all that ever yet hath blest Fairy-land: so ends his feast."

On the next page is printed: "Orpheus. Thrice excelling, for the finishment of this Feast, thou must music it so that the Deities may descend to grace it." This is succeeded by a page bearing a woodcut, then we have "The Fairies Fegaries," a poem occupying three more pages followed by another woodcut, and then "The Melancholly Lover's Song," and a third woodcut. The occurrence of the _Melancholy Lover's Song_ (the well-known lines beginning: "Hence all you vain delights") in print in 1635 is interesting, as I believe that _The Nice Valour_, the play in which they occur, was not printed till 1647, and Milton's _Il Penseroso_, which they suggested, appeared in 1645. But the verses are rather out of place in the little Fairy-Book.

APPENDIX III.

POOR ROBIN'S ALMANACK.

Herrick's name has been so persistently connected with _Poor Robert's Almanack_ that a few words must be said on the subject. There is, we are told, a Devonshire tradition ascribing the _Almanack_ to him, and this is accepted by Nichols in his _Leicestershire_, and "accredited" by Dr. Grosart. The tradition apparently rests on no better basis than Herrick's Christian name, and of the poems in the issues of the _Almanack_ which I have seen, it may be said, that, while the worst of them, save for some lack of neatness of turn, might conceivably have been by Herrick--on the principle that if Herrick could write some of his epigrams, he could write anything--the more ambitious poems it is quite impossible to attribute to the author of the _Hesperides_. But apart from opinion, the negative evidence is overwhelming. Of

the three earliest issues in the British Museum, 1664, 1667 and 1669 (all in the annual collections of Almanacs, issued by the Stationers' Company, and all, it may be noted, bound for Charles II.), I transcribe the title-page of the first. "Poor Robin. 1664. An Almanack After a New Fashion wherein the Reader may see (if he be not blinde) many remarkable things worthy of Observation. Containing a two-fold Kalendar, viz. the Iulian or English, and the Roundheads or Fanaticks: with their several Saints daies and Observations, upon every month. Written by Poor Robin, Knight of the burnt Island and a well-willer to the Mathematicks. Calculated for the Meridian of Saffron Walden, where the Pole is elevated 52 degrees and 6 minutes above the Horizon. London: Printed for the Company of Stationers."

In the 1667 issue the paragraph about the Pole runs: "Where the Maypole is elevated (with a plumm cake on the top of it) 5 yards ¾ above the Market Cross". The mention of Saffron Walden had apparently been ridiculed, and the author in this year joins in the laugh, and in 1669 omits the paragraph altogether. But what had Herrick at any time to do with Saffron Walden, and why should the poet, whose politics, apart from some personal devotion to Charles I., were distinctly moderate, mix himself up with an ultra-Cavalier publication? Also, if Herrick be "Poor Robin" we must attribute to him, at least, the greater part of the twenty-one "Poor Robin" publications, of which Mr. H. Ecroyd Smith gave a list in _Notes and Queries_, 6th series, vii. 321-3, _e.g._, "Poor Robin's Perambulation from the Town of Saffron Walden to London" (1678), "The Merrie Exploits of Poor Robin, the Merrie Saddler of Walden," etc. These have been generally assigned to William Winstanley, the barber-poet, on the ground of a supposed similarity of style, and from "Poor Robin" having been written under a portrait of him. Mr. Ecroyd Smith, however, attributes them to Robert Winstanley (born, 1646, at Saffron Walden), younger brother of Henry Winstanley, the projector of the Eddystone Lighthouse. He assigns the credit of the "identification" to Mr. Joseph Clark, F.S.A., of the Roos, Saffron Walden, but does not state the grounds which led Mr. Clark to his conclusion, in itself probable enough. In any case there is no valid ground for connecting Herrick either with the _Almanack_ or with any of the other "Poor Robin" publications.

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Stand with thy graces forth, brave man, and rise, I. 226.
Stately goddess, do thou please, I. 178.
Stay while ye will, or go, I. 102.
Still take advice; though counsels, when they fly, II. 146.

Still to our gains our chief respect is had, I. 175.

Store of courage to me grant, I. 189.

Stripes justly given yerk us with their fall, II. 148.

Studies themselves will languish and decay, II. 144.

Suffer thy legs but not thy tongue to walk, II. 172.

Suspicion, discontent, and strife, I. 58.

Sweet Amarillis, by a spring's, I. 55.

Sweet are my Julia's lips, and clean, II. 95.

Sweet, be not proud of those two eyes, I. 74.

Sweet Bridget blush'd, and therewithal, I. 255.

Sweet country life, to such unknown, II. 33.

Sweet Œnone, do but say, II. 81.

Sweet virgin, that I do not set, I. 182.

Sweet western wind, whose luck it is, I. 128.

Take mine advice, and go not near, II. 98.

Tears most prevail; with tears, too, thou mayst move, II. 107.

Tears quickly dry, griefs will in time decay, II. 115.

Tears, though they're here below the sinner's brine, II. 29.

Tell if thou canst, and truly, whence doth come, I. 196.

Tell me, rich man, for what intent. II. 244.

Tell me, what needs those rich deceits, II. 101.

Tell me, young man, or did the muses bring, II. 122.

Tell that brave man, fain thou wouldst have access, II. 125.

Tell us, thou clear and heavenly tongue, II. 207.

Temptations hurt not, though they have access II. 196.

Thanksgiving for a former, doth invite, II. 181

Th' art hence removing (like a shepherd's tent), I. 235.

Th' 'ast dar'd too far; but, fury, now forbear, I. 100.

That Christ did die, the pagan saith, II. 245.

That flow of gallants which approach, II. 47.

That for seven lusters I did never come, I. 31.

That happiness does still the longest thrive, II. 81.

That hour-glass which there you see, I. 52.
That little, pretty, bleeding part, II. 279.
That love last long, let it thy first care be, I. 232.
That love 'twixt men does ever longest last, II. 157.
That manna, which God on His people cast, II. 224.
That morn which saw me made a bride, I. 136.
That prince must govern with a gentle hand, II. 153.
That prince takes soon enough the victor's room, I. 136.
That prince who may do nothing but what's just, II. 162.
That princes may possess a surer seat, I. 203.
That there's a God we all do know, II. 243.
The bad among the good are here mixed ever, II. 229.
The blood of Abel was a thing, II. 235.
The body is the soul's poor house or home, II. 98.
The body's salt, the soul is; which when gone, II. 162.
The bound almost now of my book I see, II. 140.
The doctors in the Talmud, say, II. 235.
The factions of the great ones call, II. 101.
The fire of hell this strange condition hath, II. 235.
The gods require the thighs, II. 60.
The gods to kings the judgment give to sway, I. 136.
The hag is astride, II. 27.
The Jews their beds and offices of ease, II. 233.
The Jews, when they built houses, I have read, II. 230.
The less our sorrows here and suff'rings cease, II. 214.
The lictors bundled up their rods; beside, II. 113.
The longer thread of life we spin, II. 224.
The May-pole is up, II. 46.
The mellow touch of music most doth wound, I. 12.
The mountains of the Scriptures are, some say, II. 226.
The only comfort of my life, II. 149.
The person crowns the place; your lot doth fall, II. 128.

The power of princes rest in the consent, II. 155.

The readiness of doing doth express, II. 92.

The repetition of the name made known, II. 229.

The rose was sick, and smiling died, II. 44.

The saints-bell calls, and, Julia, I must read, II. 7.

The same who crowns the conquerer, will be, II. 227.

The seeds of treason choke up as they spring, I. 9.

The shame of man's face is no more, II. 228.

The strength of baptism that's within, II. 247.

The sup'rabundance of my store, II. 220.

The tears of saints more sweet by far, II. 224.

The time the bridegroom stays from hence, II. 225.

The twilight is no other thing, we say, II. 148.

The Virgin Mary was, as I have read, II. 232.

The Virgin Mother stood at a distance, there, II. 230.

The work is done, now let my laurel be, II. 249.

The work is done: young men and maidens, set, II. 164.

Then did I live when I did see, II. 140.

There is no evil that we do commit, II. 233.

There's no constraint to do amiss, II. 239.

These fresh beauties (we can prove), I. 16.

These springs were maidens once that lov'd, I. 225.

These summer-birds did with thy master stay, I. 189.

These temporal goods God, the most wise, commends, II. 234.

Things are uncertain, and the more we get, II. 144.

This axiom I have often heard, II. 39.

This crosstree here, II. 253.

This day is yours, great Charles! and in this war, II. 87.

This day, my Julia, thou must make, II. 83.

This I'll tell ye by the way, II. 152.

This is my comfort when she's most unkind, II. 151.

This is the height of justice: that to do, II. 14.

This rule of manners I will teach my guests, II. 137.
This stone can tell the story of my life, II. 128.
Those ends in war the best contentment bring, II. 144.
Those garments lasting evermore, II. 242.
Those ills that mortal men endure, I. 192.
Those possessions short-liv'd are, II. 50.
Those saints which God loves best, II. 175.
Those tapers which we set upon the grave, II. 230.
Thou art a plant sprung up to wither never, I. 122.
Thou art to all lost love the best, I. 132.
Thou bid'st me come away, II. 186.
Thou bid'st me come; I cannot come; for why? II. 186.
Thou cam'st to cure me, doctor, of my cold, I. 121.
Thou gav'st me leave to kiss, I. 178.
Thou had'st the wreath before, now take the tree, I. 188.
Thou hast made many houses for the dead, II. 95.
Thou hast promis'd, Lord, to be, II. 179.
Thou knowest, my Julia, that it is thy turn, I. 247.
Thou mighty lord and master of the lyre, II. 100.
Thou sail'st with others in this Argus here, I. 26.
Thou say'st I'm dull; if edgeless so I be, II. 157.
Thou sayest Love's dart, II. 90.
Thou say'st my lines are hard, I. 173.
Thou say'st thou lov'st me, Sappho; I say no, II. 98.
Thou see'st me, Lucia, this year droop, II. 126.
Thou sent'st to me a true love-knot, but I, I. 217.
Thou shall not all die; for while love's fire shines, I. 179.
Thou, thou that bear'st the sway, II. 100.
Thou who wilt not love, do this, I. 93.
Though a wise man all pressures can sustain, I. 72.
Though by well warding many blows we've pass'd, II. 45.
Though clock, II. 55.

Though frankincense the deities require, II. 117.
Though from without no foes at all we fear, II. 114.
Though good things answer many good intents, I. 137.
Though hourly comforts from the gods we see, I. 137.
Though I cannot give thee fires, I. 161.
Though long it be, years may repay the debt, II. 31.
Though thou be'st all that active love, II. 245.
Thousands each day pass by, which we, II. 39.
Three fatal sisters wait upon each sin, II. 172.
Three lovely sisters working were, I. 20.
Thrice, and above, bless'd, my soul's half, art thou, I. 40.
Thrice happy roses, so much grac'd to have, II. 60.
Through all the night, II. 187.
Thus I, I. 222.
Thy azure robe I did behold, I. 80.
Thy former coming was to cure, II. 248.
Thy sooty godhead, I desire, II. 14.
Till I shall come again let this suffice, I. 183.
Time is the bound of things where e'er we go, II. 71.
Time was upon, II. 178.
'Tis a known principle in war, I. 147.
'Tis but a dog-like madness in bad kings, II. 115.
'Tis evening, my sweet, I. 245.
'Tis hard to find God, but to comprehend, II. 171.
'Tis heresy in others: in your face, I. 225.
'Tis liberty to serve one lord; but he, II. 103.
'Tis much among the filthy to be clean, II. 147.
'Tis never, or but seldom known, II. 80.
'Tis no discomfort in the world to fall, II. 147.
'Tis not a thousand bullocks' thighs, I. 24.
'Tis not every day that I, II. 51.
'Tis not greatness they require, I. 24.

'Tis not the food but the content, I. 154.
'Tis not the walls or purple that defends, II. 53.
'Tis said as Cupid danc'd among, II. 49.
'Tis still observ'd that fame ne'er sings, II. 55.
'Tis still observ'd those men most valiant are, II. 134.
'Tis the chyrurgeon's praise and height of art, II. 84.
'Tis worse than barbarous cruelty to show, I. 251.
To a love feast we both invited are, II. 191.
To all our wounds here, whatsoe'er they be, II. 238.
To an old sore a long cure must go on, II. 138.
To bread and water none is poor, I. 38.
To conquered men, some comfort 'tis to fall, I. 60.
To fetch me wine my Lucia went, I. 234.
To find that tree of life whose fruits did feed, I. 74.
To gather flowers Sappha went, II. 62.
To get thine ends lay bashfulness aside, I. 7.
To him who longs unto his Christ to go, II. 222.
To his book's end this last line he'd have placed, II. 165.
To house the hag, you must do this, II. 104.
To join with them who here confer, II. 255.
To me my Julia lately sent, I. 14.
To-morrow, Julia, I betimes must rise, I. 127.
To mortal men great loads allotted be, II. 51.
To my revenge, and to her desperate fears, I. 107.
To print our poems, the propulsive cause, I. 211.
To read my book the virgin shy, I. 5.
To safeguard man from wrongs, there nothing must, I. 81.
To seek of God more than we well can find, II. 192.
To sup with thee thou did'st me home invite, II. 78.
To this white temple of my heroes, here, I. 232.
To work a wonder, God would have her shown, II. 231.
Touch but thy lyre, my Harry, and I hear, II. 94.

Trap of a player turn'd a priest now is, II. 155.

Tread, sirs, as lightly as you can, II. 28.

True mirth resides not in the smiling skin, II. 172.

True rev'rence is, as Cassiodore doth prove, II. 224.

True to yourself and sheets, you'll have me swear, I. 171.

Trust me, ladies, I will do, I. 222.

Truth, by her own simplicity is known, II. 160.

Truth is best found out by the time and eyes, II. 108.

Tumble me down, and I will sit, II. 41.

'Twas but a single rose, I. 61.

'Twas Cæsar's saying: kings no less conquerors are, II. 88.

'Twas not love's dart, I. 201.

Twice has Pudica been a bride, and led, I. 225.

Twilight, no other thing is, poets say, II. 96.

'Twixt kings and subjects there's this mighty odds, I. 12.

'Twixt kings and tyrants there's this difference known, II. 96.

'Twixt truth and error there's this difference known, II. 144.

Two instruments belong unto our God, II. 244.

Two of a thousand things are disallow'd, I. 10.

Two parts of us successively command, I. 171.

Two things do make society to stand, II. 93.

Under a lawn, than skies more clear, I. 29.

Upon her cheeks she wept, and from those showers, I. 256.

Ursley, she thinks those velvet patches grace, I. 248.

Virgins promis'd when I died, I. 52.

Virgins, time past, known were these, I. 77.

Want is a softer wax, that takes thereon, II. 108.

Wantons we are, and though our words be such, II. 19.

Wanton wenches do not bring, II. 160.

Wash clean the vessel, lest ye sour, II. 149.

Wash your hands, or else the fire, II. 80.

Wassail the trees, that they may bear, II. 80.

Water, water I desire, I. 23.

Water, water I espy, I. 75.

We are co-heirs with Christ; nor shall His own, II. 246.

We blame, nay we despise her pains, II. 98.

We credit most our sight; one eye doth please, II. 108.

We merit all we suffer, and by far, II. 243.

We pray 'gainst war, yet we enjoy no peace, II. 81.

We trust not to the multitude in war, II. 112.

We two are last in hell; what may we fear, I. 38.

Weep for the dead, for they have lost this light, II. 121.

Weigh me the fire; or canst thou find, II. 170.

Welcome! but yet no entrance, till we bless, I. 155.

Welcome, great Cæsar, welcome now you are, II. 123.

Welcome, maids-of-honour, I. 101.

Welcome, most welcome to our vows and us, I. 28.

Welcome to this my college, and though late, II. 129.

Well may my book come forth like public day, _Dedication_.

Were I to give the baptism, I would choose, I. 32.

What can I do in poetry, I. 164.

What! can my Kellam drink his sack, II. 112.

What, conscience, say, is it in thee, I. 210.

What fate decreed, time now has made us see, II. 66.

What God gives, and what we take, II. 202.

What here we hope for, we shall once inherit, II. 200.

What I fancy I approve, I. 11.

What is a kiss? Why this, as some approve, II. 18.

What is't that wastes a prince? example shows, II. 162.

What need we marry women, when, II. 120.

What needs complaints, II. 141.

What now we like, anon we disapprove, I. 240.

What offspring other men have got, II. 42.

What others have with cheapness seen and ease, II. 161.

What sweeter music can we bring, II. 202.
What though my harp and viol be, II. 199.
What though the heaven be lowering now, I. 236.
What though the sea be calm? Trust to the shore, I. 104.
What times of sweetness this fair day foreshows, I. 52.
What was't that fell but now, I. 90.
What will ye, my poor orphans, do, II. 19.
What wisdom, learning, wit or wrath, I. 57.
What's got by justice is established sure, II. 141.
What's that we see from far? the spring of day, I. 139.
Whatever comes, let's be content withal, II. 187.
Whatever men for loyalty pretend, II. 163.
Whatsoever thing I see, II. 65.
When a daffodil I see, I. 45.
When a man's faith is frozen up, as dead, II. 196.
When after many lusters thou shalt be, II. 36.
When age or chance has made me blind, I. 38.
When all birds else do of their music fail, II. 57.
When as in silks my Julia goes, II. 77.
When as Leander young was drown'd, I. 49.
When Chub brings in his harvest, still he cries, II. 157.
When fear admits no hope of safety, then, II. 163.
When first I find those numbers thou dost write, II. 125.
When flowing garments I behold, II. 138.
When I a ship see on the seas, II. 214.
When I a verse shall make, II. 11.
When I behold a forest spread, I. 254.
When I behold Thee, almost slain, II. 252.
When I consider, dearest, thou dost stay, I. 243.
When I departed am, ring thou my knell, I. 138.
When I did go from thee, I felt that smart, I. 50.
When I go hence, ye closet-gods, I fear, II. 30.

When I love (as some have told), II. 1.
When I of Villars do but hear the name, I. 172.
When I shall sin, pardon my trespass here, II. 206.
When I through all my many poems look, I. 117.
When I thy parts run o'er, I can't espy, I. 9.
When I thy singing next shall hear, I. 25.
When Julia blushes she does show, I. 150.
When Julia chid, I stood as mute the while, I. 70.
When laws full powers have to sway, we see, II. 12.
When man is punished, he is plagued still, II. 211.
When my date's done, and my grey age must die, I. 47.
When my off'ring next I make, I. 197.
When one is past, another care we have, I. 20.
When once the sin has fully acted been, II. 178.
When once the soul has lost her way, II. 243.
When out of bed my love doth spring, I. 193.
When some shall say, Fair once my Silvia was, I. 24.
When that day comes, whose evening says I'm gone, I. 15.
When thou dost play and sweetly sing, I. 178.
When Thou wast taken, Lord, I oft have read, II. 251.
When times are troubled then forbear; but speak, II. 155.
When to a house I come and see, II. 136.
When to thy porch I come, and ravish'd see, II. 154.
When we 'gainst Satan stoutly fight, the more, II. 213.
When well we speak and nothing do that's good, II. 247.
When what is lov'd is present, love doth spring, I. 13.
When winds and seas do rage, II. 215.
When with the virgin morning thou dost rise, I. 159.
When words we want, Love teacheth to indite, II. 92.
Whene'er I go, or whatsoe'er befalls, II. 86.
Whene'er my heart love's warmth but entertains, I. 47.
Where God is merry, there write down thy fears, II. 191.

Where love begins, there dead thy first desire, II. 100.
Where others love and praise my verses, still, I. 80.
Where pleasures rule a kingdom, never there, II. 157.
Whether I was myself, or else did see, II. 156.
While Fates permit us let's be merry, I. 215.
While leanest beasts in pastures feed, I. 93.
While, Lydia, I was loved of thee, I. 85.
While the milder fates consent, I. 46.
While thou didst keep thy candour undefil'd, I. 5.
White as Zenobia's teeth, the which the girls, II. 62.
White though ye be, yet, lilies, know, I. 89.
Whither dost thou whorry me, I. 197.
Whither, mad maiden, wilt thou roam? I. 4.
Whither? say, whither shall I fly, I. 48.
Who after his transgression doth repent, II. 84.
Who begs to die for fear of human need, II. 95.
Who forms a godhead out of gold or stone, I. 147.
Who may do most, does least; the bravest will, II. 150.
Who plants an olive but to eat the oil? II. 151.
Who, railing, drives the lazar from his door, II. 46.
Who read'st this book that I have writ, II. 32.
Who violates the customs, hurts the health, II. 147.
Who will not honour noble numbers when, II. 81.
Who with a little cannot be content, II. 12.
Whom should I fear to write to if I can, I. 77.
Whose head befringed with bescattered tresses, II. 257.
Why do not all fresh maids appear, I. 128.
Why do ye weep, sweet babes? Can tears, I. 129.
Why dost thou wound and break my heart, II. 158.
Why I tie about thy wrist, I. 159.
Why, madam, will ye longer weep, I. 237.
Why should we covet much, when as we know, II. 134.

Why so slowly do you move, II. 93.
Why this flower is now call'd so, I. 16.
Why wore th' Egyptians jewels in the ear? II. 178.
Will ye hear what I can say, I. 173.
Wilt thou my true friend be? II. 2.
With blameless carriage, I lived here, I. 48.
With golden censors and with incense here, II. 208.
Woe, woe to them, who by a ball of strife, I. 29.
Women, although they ne'er so goodly make it, II. 41.
Words beget anger; anger brings forth blows, II. 107.
Would I see lawn, clear as the heaven and thin? I. 197.
Would I woo, and would I win, II. 106.
Would ye have fresh cheese and cream? I. 229.
Would ye oil of blossoms get? II. 54.
Wrinkles no more are or no less, I. 179.
Wrongs, if neglected, vanish in short time, II. 75.
Ye have been fresh and green, I. 136.
Ye may simper, blush, and smile, I. 89.
Ye pretty housewives, would ye know, I. 204.
Ye silent shades, whose each tree here, I. 211.
You are a lord, an earl; nay more, a man, I. 215.
You are a tulip seen to-day, I. 108.
You ask me what I do, and how I live, II. 138.
You have beheld a smiling rose, I. 90.
You may vow I'll not forget, II. 268.
You say I love not 'cause I do not play, I. 16.
You say to me-wards your affection's strong, I. 61.
You say you're sweet; how should we know, I. 139.
You see this gentle stream that glides, II. 54.
Young I was, but now am old, I. 18.

APPENDIX OF EPIGRAMS, etc.

NOTE.

Herrick's coarser epigrams and poems are included in this Appendix. _A few decent, but somewhat pointless, epigrams have been added._

APPENDIX OF EPIGRAMS.

5. [TO HIS BOOK.] ANOTHER.

Who with thy leaves shall wipe, at need, The place where swelling piles do breed; May every ill that bites or smarts Perplex him in his hinder parts.

6. TO THE SOUR READER.

If thou dislik'st the piece thou light'st on first, Think that of all, that I have writ, the worst: But if thou read'st my book unto the end, And still do'st this and that verse, reprehend; O perverse man! if all disgustful be, The extreme scab take thee, and thine, for me.

41. THE VINE.

I dreamt this mortal part of mine Was metamorphos'd to a vine; Which crawling one and every way Enthrall'd my dainty Lucia. Methought, her long small legs and thighs I with my tendrils did surprise; Her belly, buttocks, and her waist By my soft nerv'lets were embrac'd; About her head I writhing hung, } And with rich clusters, hid among } The leaves, her temples I behung: } So that my Lucia seem'd to me Young Bacchus ravish'd by his tree. My curls about her neck did crawl, And arms and hands they did enthrall: So that she could not freely stir, All parts there made one prisoner. But when I crept with leaves to hide Those parts, which maids keep unespy'd, Such fleeting pleasures there I took, That with the fancy I awoke; And found, ah me! this flesh of mine More like a stock than like a vine.

64. ONCE POOR, STILL PENURIOUS.

Goes the world now, it will with thee go hard: The fattest hogs we grease the more with lard. To him that has, there shall be added more; Who is penurious, he shall still be poor.

99. UPON BLANCH.

Blanch swears her husband's lovely; when a scald Has blear'd his eyes: besides, his head is bald Next, his wild ears, like leathern wings full spread, Flutter to fly, and bear away his head.

109. UPON CUFFE. EPIG.

Cuffe comes to church much: but he keeps his bed Those Sundays only whenas briefs are read. This makes Cuffe dull; and troubles him the most, Because he cannot sleep i' th' church free cost.

Briefs.--Letters recommending the collection of alms.

110. UPON FONE A SCHOOLMASTER. EPIG.

Fone says, those mighty whiskers he does wear Are twigs of birch, and willow, growing there: If so, we'll think too, when he does condemn Boys to the lash, that he does whip with them.

126. UPON SCOBBLE. EPIG.

Scobble for whoredom whips his wife; and cries He'll slit her nose; but blubb'ring, she replies, Good sir, make no more cuts i' th' outward skin, One slit's enough to let adultry in.

129. UPON GLASCO. EPIG.

Glasco had none, but now some teeth has got; Which though they fur, will neither ache or rot. Six teeth he has, whereof twice two are known Made of a haft that was a mutton bone. Which not for use, but merely for the sight, He wears all day, and draws those teeth at night.

131. THE CUSTARD.

For second course, last night, a custard came To th' board, so hot as none could touch the same: Furze three or four times with his cheeks did blow Upon the custard, and thus cooled so; It seem'd by this time to admit the touch, But none could eat it, 'cause it stunk so much.

135. UPON GRYLL.

Gryll eats, but ne'er says grace; to speak the truth, Gryll either keeps his breath to cool his broth, Or else, because Gryll's roast does burn his spit, Gryll will not therefore say a grace for it.

148. UPON STRUT.

Strut, once a foreman of a shop we knew; But turn'd a ladies' usher now, 'tis true: Tell me, has Strut got e're a title more? No; he's but foreman, as he was before.

163. UPON JOLLY'S WIFE.

First, Jolly's wife is lame; then next loose-hipp'd: Squint-ey'd, hook-nos'd; and lastly, kidney-lipp'd.

171. UPON PAGGET.

Pagget, a schoolboy, got a sword, and then He vow'd destruction both to birch and men: Who would not think this younker fierce to fight? Yet coming home, but somewhat late (last night), Untruss, his master bade him; and that word Made him take up his shirt, lay down his sword.

183. UPON PRIG.

Prig now drinks water, who before drank beer; What's now the cause? we know the case is clear; Look in Prig's purse, the chev'ril there tells you Prig money wants, either to buy or brew.

Chevril, kid.

184. UPON BATT.

Batt he gets children, not for love to rear 'em; But out of hope his wife might die to bear 'em.

188. UPON MUCH-MORE. EPIG.

Much-more provides and hoards up like an ant, Yet Much-more still complains he is in want. Let Much-more justly pay his tithes; then try How both his meal and oil will multiply.

199. UPON LUGGS. EPIG.

Luggs, by the condemnation of the Bench, Was lately whipt for lying with a wench. Thus pains and pleasures turn by turn succeed: He smarts at last who does not first take heed.

200. UPON GUBBS. EPIG.

Gubbs calls his children kitlings: and would bound, Some say, for joy, to see those kitlings drown'd.

206. UPON BUNCE. EPIG.

Money thou ow'st me; prethee fix a day For payment promis'd, though thou never pay: Let it be Dooms-day; nay, take longer scope; Pay when th'art honest; let me have some hope.

221. GREAT BOAST SMALL ROAST.

Of flanks and chines of beef doth Gorrell boast He has at home; but who tastes boil'd or roast? Look in his brine-tub, and you shall find there Two stiff blue pigs'-feet and a sow's cleft ear.

222. UPON A BLEAR-EY'D WOMAN.

Wither'd with years, and bed-rid Mumma lies; Dry-roasted all, but raw yet in her eyes.

233. NO LOCK AGAINST LETCHERY.

Bar close as you can, and bolt fast too your door, To keep out the letcher, and keep in the whore; Yet quickly you'll see by the turn of a pin, The whore to come out, or the letcher come in.

237. UPON SUDDS, A LAUNDRESS.

Sudds launders bands in piss, and starches them Both with her husband's and her own tough fleam.

239. UPON GUESS. EPIG.

Guess cuts his shoes, and limping, goes about To have men think he's troubled with the gout; But 'tis no gout, believe it, but hard beer, Whose acrimonious humour bites him here.

242. UPON A CROOKED MAID.

Crooked you are, but that dislikes not me: So you be straight where virgins straight should be.

261. UPON GROYNES. EPIG.

Groynes, for his fleshly burglary of late, Stood in the holy forum candidate; The word is Roman; but in English known: Penance, and standing so, are both but one.

Candidate, clothed in white.

272. UPON PINK, AN ILL-FAC'D PAINTER. EPIG.

To paint the fiend, Pink would the devil see; And so he may, if he'll be rul'd by me; Let but Pink's face i' th' looking-glass be shown, And Pink may paint the devil's by his own.

273. UPON BROCK. EPIG.

To cleanse his eyes, Tom Brock makes much ado, But not his mouth, the fouler of the two. A clammy rheum makes loathsome both his eyes: His mouth, worse furr'd with oaths and blasphemies.

277. LAUGH AND LIE DOWN.

Y'ave laughed enough, sweet, vary now your text! And laugh no more; or laugh, and lie down next.

292. UPON SHARK. EPIG.

Shark, when he goes to any public feast, Eats to one's thinking, of all there, the least. What saves the master of the house thereby When if the servants search, they may descry In his wide codpiece, dinner being done, Two napkins cramm'd up, and a silver spoon?

305. UPON BUNGY.

Bungy does fast; looks pale; puts sackcloth on; Not out of conscience, or religion: Or that this younker keeps so strict a Lent, Fearing to break the king's commandement: But being poor, and knowing flesh is dear, He keeps not one, but many Lents i' th' year.

311. UPON SNEAPE. EPIG.

Sneape has a face so brittle, that it breaks Forth into blushes whensoe'er he speaks.

315. UPON LEECH.

Leech boasts, he has a pill, that can alone With speed give sick men their salvation: 'Tis strange, his father long time has been ill, And credits physic, yet not trusts his pill: And why? he knows he must of cure despair, Who makes the sly physician his heir.

317. TO A MAID.

You say, you love me! that I thus must prove: It that you lie, then I will swear you love.

326. UPON GREEDY. EPIG.

An old, old widow Greedy needs would wed, Not for affection to her or her bed; But in regard, 'twas often said, this old Woman would bring him more than could be told. He took her; now the jest in this appears, So old she was, that none could tell her years.

357. LONG AND LAZY.

That was the proverb. Let my mistress be Lazy to others, but be long to me.

358. UPON RALPH. EPIG.

Curse not the mice, no grist of thine they eat; But curse thy children, they consume thy wheat.

361. UPON MEASE. EPIG.

Mease brags of pullets which he eats: but Mease Ne'er yet set tooth in stump or rump of these.

363. UPON PASKE, A DRAPER.

Paske, though his debt be due upon the day Demands no money by a craving way; For why, says he, all debts and their arrears Have reference to the shoulders, not the ears.

368. UPON PRIGG.

Prigg, when he comes to houses, oft doth use, Rather than fail, to steal from thence old shoes: Sound or unsound be they, or rent or whole, Prigg bears away the body and the sole.

369. UPON MOON.

Moon is a usurer, whose gain, Seldom or never knows a wain, Only Moon's conscience, we confess, That ebbs from pity less and less.

372. UPON SHIFT.

Shift now has cast his clothes: got all things new; Save but his hat, and that he cannot mew.

Mew, change feathers.

373. UPON CUTS.

If wounds in clothes Cuts calls his rags, 'tis clear His linings are the matter running there.

374. GAIN AND GETTINGS.

When others gain much by the present cast, The cobblers' getting time is at the last.

379. UPON DOLL. EPIG.

Doll, she so soon began the wanton trade, She ne'er remembers that she was a maid.

380. UPON SKREW. EPIG.

Skrew lives by shifts; yet swears by no small oaths For all his shifts he cannot shift his clothes.

381. UPON LINNET. EPIG.

Linnet plays rarely on the lute, we know; And sweetly sings, but yet his breath says no.

385. UPON GLASS. EPIG.

Glass, out of deep, and out of desp'rate want, Turn'd from a Papist here a Predicant. A vicarage at last Tom Glass got here, Just upon five and thirty pounds a year. Add to that thirty-five but five pounds more, He'll turn a Papist, ranker than before.

398. UPON EELES. EPIG.

Eeles winds and turns, and cheats and steals; yet Eeles Driving these sharking trades, is out at heels.

400. UPON RASP. EPIG.

Rasp plays at nine-holes; and 'tis known he gets Many a tester by his game and bets: But of his gettings there's but little sign; When one hole wastes more than he gets by nine.

401. UPON CENTER, A SPECTACLE-MAKER WITH A FLAT NOSE.

Center is known weak-sighted, and he sells To others store of helpful spectacles. Why wears he none? Because we may suppose, Where leaven wants, there level lies the nose.

410. UPON SKINNS. EPIG.

Skinns, he dined well to-day: how do you think? His nails they were his meat, his rheum the drink.

411. UPON PIEVISH. EPIG.

Pievish doth boast that he's the very first Of English poets, and 'tis thought the worst.

412. UPON JOLLY AND JILLY. EPIG.

Jolly and Jilly bite and scratch all day, But yet get children (as the neighbours say). The reason is: though all the day they fight, They cling and close some minutes of the night.

419. UPON PATRICK, A FOOTMAN. EPIG.

Now Patrick with his footmanship has done, His eyes and ears strive which should fastest run.

420. UPON BRIDGET. EPIG.

Of four teeth only Bridget was possest; Two she spat out, a cough forced out the rest.

424. UPON FLIMSEY. EPIG.

Why walks Nick Flimsey like a malcontent! Is it because his money all is spent? No, but because the dingthrift now is poor, And knows not where i' th' world to borrow more.

425. UPON SHEWBREAD. EPIG.

Last night thou didst invite me home to eat; And showed me there much plate, but little meat. Prithee, when next thou do'st invite, bar state, And give me meat, or give me else thy plate.

428. UPON ROOTS. EPIG.

Roots had no money; yet he went o' the score, For a wrought purse; can any tell wherefore? Say, what should Roots do with a purse in print, That had not gold nor silver to put in't?

429. UPON CRAW.

Craw cracks in sirrop; and does stinking say, Who can hold that, my friends, that will away?

430. OBSERVATION.

Who to the north, or south, doth set His bed, male children shall beget.

433. PUTREFACTION.

Putrefaction is the end Of all that nature doth intend.

434. PASSION.

Were there not a matter known, There would be no passion.

435. JACK AND JILL.

Since Jack and Jill both wicked be; It seems a wonder unto me, That they, no better do agree.

436. UPON PARSON BEANES.

Old Parson Beanes hunts six days of the week, And on the seventh, he has his notes to seek. Six days he hollows so much breath away, That on the seventh, he can nor preach or pray.

438. SHORT AND LONG BOTH LIKES.

This lady's short, that mistress she is tall; But long or short, I'm well content with all.

440. UPON ROOK. EPIG.

Rook he sells feathers, yet he still doth cry Fie on this pride, this female vanity. Thus, though the Rook does rail against the sin, He loves the gain that vanity brings in.

456. UPON SPUNGE. EPIG.

Spunge makes his boasts that he's the only man Can hold of beer and ale an ocean; Is this his glory? then his triumph's poor; I know the tun of Heidleberg holds more.

464. UPON ONE WHO SAID SHE WAS ALWAYS YOUNG.

You say you're young; but when your teeth are told To be but three, black-ey'd, we'll think you old.

465. UPON HUNCKS. EPIG.

Huncks has no money, he does swear or say, About him, when the tavern's shot's to pay. If he has none in 's pockets, trust me, Huncks Has none at home in coffers, desks, or trunks.

476. UPON A CHEAP LAUNDRESS. EPIG.

Feacie, some say, doth wash her clothes i' th' lie That sharply trickles from her either eye. The laundresses, they envy her good-luck, Who can with so small charges drive the buck. What needs she fire and ashes to consume, Who can scour linens with her own salt rheum?

Drive the buck, wash clothes.

482. UPON SKURF.

Skurf by his nine-bones swears, and well he may: All know a fellon eat the tenth away.

Fellon, whitlow.

500. UPON JACK AND JILL. EPIG.

When Jill complains to Jack for want of meat, Jack kisses Jill and bids her freely eat: Jill says, Of what? says Jack, On that sweet kiss, Which full of nectar and ambrosia is, The food of poets. So I thought, says Jill, That makes them look so lank, so ghost-like still. Let poets feed on air, or what they will; Let me feed full, till that I fart, says Jill.

503. UPON PARRAT.

Parrat protests 'tis he, and only he Can teach a man the art of memory: Believe him not; for he forgot it quite, Being drunk, who 'twas that can'd his ribs last night.

514. KISSING AND BUSSING.

Kissing and bussing differ both in this; We buss our wantons, but our wives we kiss.

520. UPON MAGGOT, A FREQUENTER OF ORDINARIES.

Maggot frequents those houses of good-cheer, Talks most, eats most, of all the feeders there. He raves through lean, he rages through the fat, (What gets the master of the meal by that?) He who with talking can devour so much, How would he eat, were not his hindrance such?

533. ON JOAN.

Joan would go tell her hairs; and well she might, Having but seven in all: three black, four white.

534. UPON LETCHER. EPIG.

Letcher was carted first about the streets, For false position in his neighbour's sheets: Next, hanged for thieving: now the people say, His carting was the prologue to this play.

535. UPON DUNDRIGE.

Dundrige his issue hath; but is not styl'd, For all his issue, father of one child.

553. WAY IN A CROWD.

Once on a Lord Mayor's Day, in Cheapside, when Skulls could not well pass through that scum of men, For quick despatch Skulls made no longer stay Than but to breathe, and everyone gave way; For, as he breathed, the people swore from thence A fart flew out, or a sir-reverence.

Sir-reverence, "save-reverence," the word of apology used for the indecency itself.

557. UPON ONE-EY'D BROOMSTED. EPIG.

Broomsted a lameness got by cold and beer: And to the bath went, to be cured there: His feet were helped, and left his crutch behind; But home returned, as he went forth, half blind.

563. UPON SIBILLA.

With paste of almonds, Syb her hands doth scour; Then gives it to the children to devour. In cream she bathes her thighs, more soft than silk; Then to the poor she freely gives the milk.

570. UPON TOOLY.

The eggs of pheasants wry-nosed Tooly sells, But ne'er so much as licks the speckled shells: Only, if one prove addled, that he eats With superstition, as the cream of meats. The cock and hen he feeds; but not a bone He ever picked, as yet, of anyone.

Superstition, reverence.

573. UPON BLANCH. EPIG.

I have seen many maidens to have hair, Both for their comely need and some to spare; But Blanch has not so much upon her head As to bind up her chaps when she is dead.

574. UPON UMBER.

Umber was painting of a lion fierce, And, working it, by chance from Umber's erse Flew out a crack, so mighty, that the fart, As Umber states, did make his lion start.

579. UPON URLES.

Urles had the gout so, that he could not stand; Then from his feet it shifted to his hand: When 'twas in's feet, his charity was small; Now 'tis in's hand, he gives no alms at all.

580. UPON FRANCK.

Franck ne'er wore silk she swears; but I reply, She now wears silk to hide her blood-shot eye.

590. UPON A FREE MAID, WITH A FOUL BREATH.

You say you'll kiss me, and I thank you for it; But stinking breath, I do as hell abhor it.

591. UPON COONE. EPIG.

What is the reason Coone so dully smells? His nose is over-cool'd with icicles.

596. UPON SPALT.

Of pushes Spalt has such a knotty race, He needs a tucker for to burl his face.

Pushes, pimples. _Tucker_, a fuller. _Burl_, to remove knots from cloth.

597. OF HORNE, A COMBMAKER.

Horne sells to others teeth; but has not one To grace his own gums, or of box, or bone.

600. UPON A SOUR-BREATH LADY. EPIG.

Fie, quoth my lady, what a stink is here? When 'twas her breath that was the carrionere.

Carrionere, carrion-carrier.

612. UPON COCK.

Cock calls his wife his Hen: when Cock goes to't, Cock treads his Hen, but treads her underfoot.

632. UPON BRAN. EPIG.

What made that mirth last night? the neighbours say, That Bran the baker did his breech beray: I rather think, though they may speak the worst, 'Twas to his batch, but leaven laid there first.

Beray, befoul.

633. UPON SNARE, AN USURER.

Snare, ten i' th' hundred calls his wife; and why? She brings in much by carnal usury. He by extortion brings in three times more: Say, who's the worst, th' exactor or the whore?

634. UPON GRUDGINGS.

Grudgings turns bread to stones, when to the poor He gives an alms, and chides them from his door.

638. UPON GANDER. EPIG.

Since Gander did his pretty youngling wed, Gander, they say, doth each night piss a-bed: What is the cause? Why, Gander will reply, No goose lays good eggs that is trodden dry.

639. UPON LUNGS. EPIG.

Lungs, as some say, ne'er sets him down to eat But that his breath does fly-blow all the meat.

650. UPON COB. EPIG.

Cob clouts his shoes, and, as the story tells, His thumb nails par'd afford him sparrables.

Sparrables, "sparrow-bills," headless nails.

652. UPON SKOLES. EPIG.

Skoles stinks so deadly, that his breeches loath His dampish buttocks furthermore to clothe; Cloy'd they are up with arse; but hope, one blast Will whirl about, and blow them thence at last.

661. UPON JONE AND JANE.

Jone is a wench that's painted; Jone is a girl that's tainted; Yet Jone she goes Like one of those Whom purity had sainted.

Jane is a girl that's pretty; Jane is a wench that's witty; Yet who would think, Her breath does stink, As so it doth? that's pity.

668. UPON ZELOT.

Is Zelot pure? he is: yet! see he wears The sign of circumcision in his ears.

670. UPON MADAM URSLY. EPIG.

For ropes of pearl, first Madam Ursly shows A chain of corns picked from her ears and toes; Then, next, to match Tradescant's curious shells, Nails from her fingers mew'd she shows: what else? Why then, forsooth, a carcanet is shown Of teeth, as deaf as nuts, and all her own.

Tradescant, a collector of curiosities. See Note. _Mew'd_, moulted. _Deaf as nuts._ _Cf._ De Quincey, "a deaf nut offering no kernel."

705. UPON TRIGG. EPIG.

Trigg having turn'd his suit, he struts in state, And tells the world he's now regenerate.

706. UPON SMEATON.

How could Luke Smeaton wear a shoe, or boot, Who two-and-thirty corns had on a foot.

714. LAXARE FIBULAM.

To loose the button is no less, Than to cast off all bashfulness.

730. UPON FRANCK.

Franck would go scour her teeth; and setting to 't Twice two fell out, all rotten at the root.

733. UPON PAUL. EPIG.

Paul's hands do give; what give they, bread or meat, Or money? no, but only dew and sweat. As stones and salt gloves use to give, even so Paul's hands do give, nought else for ought we know.

734. UPON SIBB. EPIG.

Sibb, when she saw her face how hard it was, For anger spat on thee, her looking-glass: But weep not, crystal; for the same was meant Not unto thee, but that thou didst present.

755. UPON SLOUCH.

Slouch he packs up, and goes to several fairs, And weekly markets for to sell his wares: Meantime that he from place to place does roam, His wife her own ware sells as fast at home.

797. UPON BICE.

Bice laughs, when no man speaks; and doth protest. It is his own breech there that breaks the jest.

798. UPON TRENCHERMAN.

Tom shifts the trenchers; yet he never can Endure that lukewarm name of serving-man: Serve or not serve, let Tom do what he can, He is a serving, who's a trencher-man.

801. UPON COMELY, A GOOD SPEAKER BUT AN ILL SINGER. EPIG.

Comely acts well; and when he speaks his part, He doth it with the sweetest tones of art: But when he sings a psalm, there's none can be More curs'd for singing out of tune than he.

802. ANY WAY FOR WEALTH.

E'en all religious courses to be rich Hath been rehers'd by Joel Michelditch: But now perceiving that it still does please The sterner fates, to cross his purposes; He tacks about, and now he doth profess Rich he will be by all unrighteousness; Thus if

our ship fails of her anchor hold We'll love the divel, so he lands the gold.

803. UPON AN OLD WOMAN.

Old Widow Prouse, to do her neighbours evil, Would give, some say, her soul unto the devil. Well, when she's kill'd that pig, goose, cock, or hen, What would she give to get that soul again?

804. UPON PEARCH. EPIG.

Thou writes in prose how sweet all virgins be; But there's not one, doth praise the smell of thee.

818. UPON LOACH.

Seal'd up with night-gum, Loach each morning lies, Till his wife licking, so unglues his eyes. No question then, but such a lick is sweet, When a warm tongue does with such ambers meet.

824. UPON NODES.

Wherever Nodes does in the summer come, He prays his harvest may be well brought home. What store of corn has careful Nodes, think you, Whose field his foot is, and whose barn his shoe?

831. UPON TAP.

Tap, better known than trusted, as we hear, Sold his old mother's spectacles for beer: And not unlikely; rather too than fail, He'll sell her eyes, and nose, for beer and ale.

834. UPON PUNCHIN. EPIG.

Give me a reason why men call Punchin a dry plant-animal. Because as plants by water grow, Punchin by beer and ale spreads so.

836. UPON BLINKS. EPIG.

Tom Blinks his nose is full of weals, and these Tom calls not pimples, but pimpleides; Sometimes, in mirth, he says each whelk's a spark, When drunk with beer, to light him home i' th' dark.

837. UPON ADAM PEAPES. EPIG.

Peapes he does strut, and pick his teeth, as if His jaws had tir'd on some large chine of beef. But nothing so: the dinner Adam had, Was cheese full ripe with tears, with bread as sad.

Sad, heavy: "watery cheese and ill-baked bread".

844. HANCH, A SCHOOLMASTER. EPIG.

Hanch, since he lately did inter his wife, He weeps and sighs, as weary of his life. Say, is't for real grief he mourns? not so; Tears have their springs from joy, as well as woe.

845. UPON PEASON. EPIG.

Long locks of late our zealot Peason wears, Not for to hide his high and mighty ears; No, but because he would not have it seen That stubble stands where once large ears have been.

880. KISSES LOATHSOME.

I abhor the slimy kiss, Which to me most loathsome is. Those lips please me which are placed Close, but not too strictly laced: Yielding I would have them; yet Not a wimbling tongue admit: What should poking-sticks make there, When the ruffe is set elswhere?

881. UPON REAPE.

Reape's eyes so raw are that, it seems, the flies Mistake the flesh, and fly-blow both his eyes; So that an angler, for a day's expense, May bait his hook with maggots taken thence.

882. UPON TEAGE.

Teage has told lies so long that when Teage tells Truth, yet Teage's truths are untruths, nothing else.

884. UPON TRUGGIN.

Truggin a footman was; but now, grown lame, Truggin now lives but to belie his name.

886. UPON SPENKE.

Spenke has a strong breath, yet short prayers saith; Not out of want of breath, but want of faith.

888. UPON LULLS.

Lulls swears he is all heart; but you'll suppose By his proboscis that he is all nose.

897. SURFEITS.

Bad are all surfeits; but physicians call That surfeit took by bread the worst of all.

898. UPON NIS.

Nis he makes verses; but the lines he writes Serve but for matter to make paper kites.

905. UPON PRICKLES. EPIG.

Prickles is waspish, and puts forth his sting For bread, drink, butter, cheese; for everything That Prickles buys puts Prickles out of frame; How well his nature's fitted to his name!

945. UPON BLISSE.

Blisse, last night drunk, did kiss his mother's knee; Where will he kiss, next drunk, conjecture ye.

946. UPON BURR.

Burr is a smell-feast, and a man alone, That, where meat is, will be a hanger on.

947. UPON MEG.

Meg yesterday was troubled with a pose, Which, this night harden'd, sodders up her nose.

Pose, rheum, cold in the head.

961. UPON RALPH.

Ralph pares his nails, his warts, his corns, and Ralph In sev'rall tills and boxes, keeps 'em safe; Instead of hartshorn, if he speaks the troth, To make a lusty-jelly for his broth.

966. UPON VINEGAR.

Vinegar is no other, I define, Than the dead corps, or carcase of the wine.

967. UPON MUDGE.

Mudge every morning to the postern comes, His teeth all out, to rinse and wash his gums.

971. UPON LUPES.

Lupes for the outside of his suit has paid; But for his heart, he cannot have it made; The reason is, his credit cannot get The inward garbage for his clothes as yet.

972. RAGS.

What are our patches, tatters, rags, and rents, But the base dregs and lees of vestiments?

974. UPON TUBBS.

For thirty years Tubbs has been proud and poor; 'Tis now his habit, which he can't give o'er.

984. UPON SPOKES.

Spokes, when he sees a roasted pig, he swears Nothing he loves on't but the chaps and ears: But carve to him the fat flanks, and he shall Rid these, and those, and part by part eat all.

988. UPON FAUNUS.

We read how Faunus, he the shepherds' god, His wife to death whipped with a myrtle rod. The rod, perhaps, was better'd by the name; But had it been of birch, the death's the same.

989. THE QUINTELL.

Up with the quintell, that the rout, May fart for joy, as well as shout: Either's welcome, stink or civit, If we take it, as they give it.

999. UPON PENNY.

Brown bread Tom Penny eats, and must of right, Because his stock will not hold out for white.

1013. UPON BUGGINS.

Buggins is drunk all night, all day he sleeps; This is the level-coil that Buggins keeps.

1027. UPON BOREMAN. EPIG.

Boreman takes toll, cheats, natters, lies; yet Boreman, For all the devil helps, will be a poor man.

1068. UPON GORGONIUS.

Unto Pastillus rank Gorgonius came To have a tooth twitched out of's native frame; Drawn was his tooth, but stank so, that some say, The barber stopped his nose, and ran away.

1079. UPON GRUBS.

Grubs loves his wife and children, while that they Can live by love, or else grow fat by play; But when they call or cry on Grubs for meat, Instead of bread Grubs gives them stones to eat. He raves, he rends, and while he thus doth tear, His wife and children fast to death for fear.

1080. UPON DOLL.

No question but Doll's cheeks would soon roast dry, Were they not basted by her either eye.

1081. UPON HOG.

Hog has a place i' the' kitchen, and his share, The flimsy livers and blue gizzards are.

1087. UPON GUT.

Science puffs up, says Gut, when either pease Make him thus swell, or windy cabbages.

1101. UPON SPUR.

Spur jingles now, and swears by no mean oaths, He's double honour'd, since he's got gay clothes: Most like his suit, and all commend the trim; And thus they praise the sumpter, but not him: As to the goddess, people did confer Worship, and not to th' ass that carried her.

1108. UPON RUMP.

Rump is a turn-broach, yet he seldom can Steal a swoln sop out of a dripping-pan.

1109. UPON SHOPTER.

Old Widow Shopter, whensoe'er she cries, Lets drip a certain gravy from her eyes.

1110. UPON DEB.

If felt and heard, unseen, thou dost me please; If seen, thou lik'st me, Deb, in none of these.

1112. UPON CROOT.

One silver spoon shines in the house of Croot; Who cannot buy or steal a second to't.

1114. UPON FLOOD OR A THANKFUL MAN.

Flood, if he has for him and his a bit, He says his fore and after grace for it: If meat he wants, then grace he says to see His hungry belly borne on legs jail-free. Thus have, or have not, all alike is good To this our poor yet ever patient Flood.

1115. UPON PIMP.

When Pimp's feet sweat, as they do often use, There springs a soap-like lather in his shoes.

1116. UPON LUSK.

In Den'shire Kersey Lusk, when he was dead, Would shrouded be and therewith buried. When his assigns asked him the reason why, He said, because he got his wealth thereby.

1117. FOOLISHNESS.

In's Tusc'lans, Tully doth confess, No plague there's like to foolishness.

1118. UPON RUSH.

Rush saves his shoes in wet and snowy weather; And fears in summer to wear out the leather; This is strong thrift that wary Rush doth use Summer and winter still to save his shoes.

1124. THE HAG.

The staff is now greas'd; And very well pleas'd, She cocks out her arse at the parting, To an old ram goat That rattles i' th' throat, Half-choked with the stink of her farting.

In a dirty hair-lace She leads on a brace Of black boar-cats to attend her: Who scratch at the moon, And threaten at noon Of night from heaven for to rend her.

A-hunting she goes, A cracked horn she blows, At which the hounds fall a-bounding; While th' moon in her sphere Peeps trembling for fear, And night's afraid of the sounding.

Lace, leash. _Boar-cat_, tom-cat.

NOTES TO APPENDIX.

64. _To him that has, etc._ The quotation is not from the Bible, but from Martial, v. 81:--

"Semper pauper eris, si pauper es, Aemiliane. Dantur opes nulli nunc nisi divitibus."

Cp. also Davison's Poet. Rhap., i. 95. Ed. Bullen.

126. _Upon Scobble._ Dr. Grosart quotes an Ellis Scobble [_i.e._, Scobell], baptised at Dean Priory in 1632, and Jeffery Scobble buried in 1654.

200. _Upon Gubbs._ Printed in _Witts Recreations_, 1650, without alteration. To save repetition we may give here a list of the other Epigrams in this Appendix which are printed in _Witt's Recreations_, reserving variations of reading for special notes:--206, _Upon Bounce_; 239, _Upon Guess_; 311, _Upon Sneap_; 357, _Long and Lazy_; 379, _Upon Doll_; 380, _Upon Screw_; 381, _Upon Linnit_; 400, _Upon Rasp_; 410, _Upon Skinns_; 429, _Upon Craw_; 435, _Jack and Jill_; 574, _Upon Umber_; 639, _Upon Lungs_; 650, _Upon Cob_; 652, _Upon Skoles_; 668, _Upon Zelot_; 705, _Upon Trigg_; 797, _Upon Bice_; 798, _Upon Trencherman_; 834, _Upon Punchin_; 888, _Upon Lulls_; 1027, _Upon Boreman_; 1087, _Upon Gut_; 1108, _Upon Rump_.

305. _Fearing to break the king's commandement._ In 1608 there was issued a proclamation containing "Orders conceived by the Lords of his Maiestie's Privie Counsell and by his Highnesse speciall direction, commanded to be put in execution for the restraint of killing and eating of flesh the next Lent". This was re-issued ten years later (there is no intermediate issue at the British Museum), and from 1619 onwards became annual under James and Charles in the form of "A proclamation for restraint of killing, dressing, and eating of Flesh in Lent, or on Fish dayes, appointed by the Law, to be hereafter strictly observed by all sorts of people".

420. _Upon Bridget_. Loss of teeth is the occasion of more than one of Martial's epigrams.

456. _The tun of Heidelberg_: in the cellar under the castle at Heidelberg is a great cask supposed to be able to hold 50,000 gallons.

574. _As Umber states_: "as Umber _swears_".--W. R.

639. _His breath does fly-blow_: "doth" for "does".--W. R.

652. _One blast_: "and" for "one".--W. R.

668. _Yet! see_: "ye see".--W. R.

670. _Tradescant's curious shells_: John Tradescant was a Dutchman, born towards the close of the sixteenth century. He was appointed gardener to Charles II. in 1629, and he and his son naturalised many rare plants in England. Besides botanical specimens he collected all sorts of curiosities, and opened a museum which he called "Tradescant's Ark". In 1656, four years after his death, his son published a catalogue of the collection under the title, "Museum Tradescantianum: or, a collection of rarities preserved at South Lambeth, near London, by John Tradescant". After the son's death the collection passed into the hands of Ashmole, and became the nucleus of the present Ashmolean Museum at Oxford.

802. _Any way for Wealth._ A variation on Horace's theme: "Rem facias, rem, si possis, recte, si non quocunque modo, rem". 1 Epist. i. 66.

The Portrait of a Woman: I subjoin here the four passages found in manuscript versions of this poem, alluded to in the previous note. As said before, they do not improve the poem. After l. 45, "Bearing aloft this rich round world of wonder," we have these four lines:

In which the veins implanted seem to lie Like loving vines hid under ivory, So full of claret, that whoso pricks this vine May see it spout forth streams like muscadine.

Twelve lines later, after "Riphean snow," comes a longer passage:

Or else that she in that white waxen hill Hath seal'd the primrose of her utmost skill. But now my muse hath spied a dark descent From this so precious, pearly, permanent, A milky highway that direction yields Unto the port-mouth of the Elysian fields: A place desired of all, but got by these Whom love admits to the Hesperides; Here's golden fruit, that doth exceed all price, Growing in this love-guarded paradise; Above the entrance there is written this: This is the portal to the bower of bliss, Through midst whereof a crystal stream there flows Passing the sweet sweet of a musky rose. With plump, soft flesh, of metal pure and fine, Resembling shields, both pure and crystalline. Hence rise those two ambitious hills that look Into th' middle, sweet, sight-stealing crook, Which for the better beautifying shrouds Its humble self 'twixt two aspiring clouds

The third addition is four lines from the end, after "with a pearly shell":

Richer than that fair, precious, virtuous horn That arms the forehead of the unicorn.

The last four lines are joined on at the end of all:

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Transcriber's Endnotes

Numeration Errors in the Hesperides:

Without an obvious solution to a discrepancy the numbers remain as originally printed, however the following alterations have been made to ensure any details in the NOTES section apply to the relevant poem.

Page 290. Note to 923. "924" changed to _923_. "923. _Revenge_. Tacitus, _Hist_. iv."

Page 295. Note to 967. "726" changed to _724_. "967. _Upon his spaniel, Tracy._ Cp. _supra_, 724."

Page 297. Note to 1035. "664" changed to _662_. "... writing to Endymion Porter (662), and earlier ..."

Page 298. Note to 1045. "406" changed to _405_. "... Herrick addressed the poem (405) ..."

Typographical Errors:

Page 177. 33. AN ODE OF.... "disposses" corrected to _dispossess_. "And as we dispossess Thee ..."

Page 318. Appendix I. "arious" corrected to _various_. "... all the various articles spread throughout ..."

Page 379. 199. UPON LUGG. "LUGG" corrected to _LUGGS_. "199. UPON LUGGS."

Page 382. 277. LAUGH AND DIE DOWN. "DIE" corrected to _LIE_. "277. LAUGH AND LIE DOWN."